

Confident English (B2 Upper-Intermediate)

The full teaching manual for a 13-week adult-education B2 class (26 classes × 90 minutes): lesson stages and timing, board plans, drilling and concept-check questions, pair-work, error correction, differentiation, and L1 watch-outs.

8 modules • 24 lessons

26 classes • 90 min • 13 weeks

Teacher copy • not for students

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Module 1 — Narrating & Looking Back

Three classes that open the B2 level. Learners already know the past simple, the past continuous and the past perfect from B1, plus the first and second conditionals and *wish* + past simple. The B2 work is **layering and control**: the four narrative tenses together, including the new **past perfect continuous**; the **third conditional**, *could have / might have* and **mixed conditionals**; and the "unreal past" family: *wish / if only* + **past perfect**, **would rather** and **it's (high) time**. Class 1 also welcomes a new group and gives you a quick **B1 diagnostic**. By the end of the module learners can tell a layered anecdote, trace imagined consequences, and voice regrets and preferences with the right tense.

3 lessons

Lessons 1.1–1.3

Classes C1–C3

Weeks 1–2

90 min per class

CEFR B2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, mingle) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-1-narrating.html](#). Print [materials/module-1/classroom-materials.html](#) before C1. It holds the flashcards and tense-job cards, the welcome question cards and the B1 diagnostic grid, the new identity cards, the Story Reconstruction strips and retell cards, the Chain of Consequences start and ending cards, the "Would You Rather?" cards, the Wish List Meeting scenario and role cards, a "Find Someone Who" game, and all the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons (with a UK or US voice and a speed control), so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** B1 Lessons 5.1–5.2 taught the past perfect and narrative tenses; B1 2.2–2.3 taught the second conditional and *wish* + past simple. Go fast through what they know and spend the time on what is new: the **past perfect continuous** (1.1), the whole **third conditional** and **mixed conditionals** (1.2), and **wish + past perfect, would rather + someone + past, it's time + past** (1.3).
- Fluency before accuracy.** In every freer task, listen and take notes; don't stop a speaker to fix a tense. The feedback stage is where you fix errors, without names. At B2, give feedback on **two things**: *accuracy* (the form was wrong) and *range* (the form was right, but a richer one was available: "You said *I was tired because I*

worked all day. Correct! Can you make it B2? ...*because I'd been working all day*."). Praise the story or the idea first, then the language.

- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** B2 classes often have one or two very fluent talkers. Give every group **talking tokens** (3 each; you spend one per turn), give the strongest speaker a **job** (the checker, the note-taker, the devil's advocate), and use "**retell your partner's idea, not yours**." Say it kindly: "Great point, Omar. Let's hear from someone who hasn't spoken yet."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C1.** Every lesson has a Stretch box. Typical C1 moves in this module: a wider range of linkers (*no sooner... than, as soon as, it wasn't until...*), hedged results (*might well have, could easily have*), *should have / needn't have* for criticism and wasted effort, and *I'd sooner / I'd prefer it if you...* as alternatives to *would rather*. Stretch is for range; don't teach it to the whole class.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons often use British forms (*film, flat, flatmate, motorway, queuing, neighbours, behaviour, realised, recognised, travelled, organised, practise*, and *got* where American English says *gotten*). Teach *movie, apartment, roommate, highway, waiting in line, neighbors, behavior, realized, recognized, traveled, organized, practice, gotten*. Two to point out: British *wash up* = American *do the dishes* (in American English *wash up* means "wash your hands and face"), and British *shattered* = "exhausted." Accept British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

What happened → what could have happened → what we wish had happened. Every lesson in this module looks back. In C1 learners tell the past in layers: the main events, the background, the earlier events, and how long something had been going on (*By the time I arrived, I'd been traveling for six hours and the party had finished*). In C2 they rewrite that past: *If I'd left earlier, I would have caught the train*, and link it to now (*...and I wouldn't be so tired today*). In C3 they add the feeling: *I wish I'd set an alarm. I'd rather you didn't call so late. It's high time we fixed the printer*. Each class ends with a longer speaking task: a story retold from a new point of view, a group consequence chain, then a meeting where people argue for their wishes.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: THIS MODULE IS ABOUT REGRET — KEEP IT SMALL

The third conditional and *wish + past perfect* are the grammar of regret, and the online lessons invite learners to talk about turning points and regrets (a move is offered as one optional turning point). For many adult learners, the biggest turning points are **leaving a country, losing someone, family separation, war, or a missed goodbye**. **In class, never invite those topics**. Don't ask "What do you regret most?", "How would your life be different if you hadn't come here?", "What would have happened if you had stayed?" or "What do you wish you had told your family?" Keep every personal task in **everyday territory**: small choices (a haircut, a purchase, a movie, a recipe, being late), habits (sleep, phones, exercise), and wishes for the **city, the building, the workplace or the classroom**. Most freer tasks use **invented people and scenarios** on purpose. For every personal task, offer three choices out loud: **your real life (small things), a new identity card, or something invented**. Anyone can say "Pass!" Say it every time, so passing is normal.

If a learner brings up something painful anyway: listen, say something short and human ("Thank you for telling us. That sounds really hard."), **don't correct their grammar**, don't ask follow-up questions, and move the group on gently ("Let's go back to our invented friend Priya..."). Check in privately after class if it feels right. The homework prompts in the workbook are rewritten to stay small; tell learners they don't need the online project's "a move" option.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ **Placement.** Ideally, learners took the toolkit placement test (../instructor-toolkit/placement-test.html) before C1. If not, the C1 welcome mingle doubles as a quick **B1 diagnostic** (see Lesson 1.1). It won't replace a placement test, but it will show you who needs support and who is close to C1.
- ◆ Print the **welcome question cards** (Set B, one set per 12 learners) and **one copy of the B1 diagnostic grid** for you, on a clipboard. Print name tents (folded paper is fine).
- ◆ For C1: one set of **Story Reconstruction strips** per group of 3–4 (half the groups get Story A, half Story B), in envelopes, plus the **retell cards**.
- ◆ For C2: one set of **Chain of Consequences** start and ending cards per group of 4, and a stack of blank slips (or sticky notes) for the links.
- ◆ For C3: one set of **"Would You Rather?"** cards per pair, one **Wish List Meeting** scenario card + 4 role cards per group of 4, and **talking tokens** (3 per learner: coins, paper clips or cut-out squares).
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** (Set C) and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- ◆ Optional but fun: bring one small "prop" for each lead-in: a train or bus ticket for C1, an umbrella for C2 (the rained-out picnic), and a crumpled printer page or an empty coffee jar for C3 (the office kitchen).

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
1.1	C1 · wk 1	Welcome + B1 diagnostic; the four narrative tenses and their jobs (event · background · earlier event · duration); the new past perfect continuous (<i>had been</i> + <i>-ing</i>) vs the past perfect simple; stative verbs; sequencing with <i>by the time, when, while, already, just, until, by then</i>	reconstruct a jumbled story and retell it from another point of view, using all four narrative tenses and at least two sequencing words
1.2	C2 · wk 1	The third conditional (<i>If</i> + <i>had</i> + <i>pp</i> , <i>would have</i> + <i>pp</i>); the "flip" to reality; <i>would / could / might have</i> ; second vs third ("can it still change?"); mixed conditionals (past → present, present → past); <i>would've</i> , never "would of"	build a chain of imagined consequences in a group, ending with a mixed conditional, and talk about small turning points
1.3	C3 · wk 2	wish / if only + past perfect (past regret) vs + past simple (present wish); wish + would (annoyance, someone else); would rather + base verb / + someone + past simple; it's (high / about) time + past simple	express present wishes, small past regrets and preferences, and argue in a meeting for what is "high time" in a building, workplace or neighborhood

Class map: 1.1 = C1 (week 1) · 1.2 = C2 (week 1) · 1.3 = C3 (week 2).

1.1 · C1

Welcome to B2 · Narrative Tenses — Past Perfect & Continuous

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ get to know the group and show the teacher their B1 range (narrative tenses, conditionals, discussion skills) in a friendly mingle
- ◆ name the job of each narrative tense: **past simple** = the main events · **past continuous** = background in progress · **past perfect** = an earlier event · **past perfect continuous** = the duration of an activity before a past moment
- ◆ form the past perfect continuous (*had been + -ing*) and choose it or the past perfect simple (*She'd been writing all night* vs *She'd written three emails*); keep stative verbs simple (*I'd known him for years*)
- ◆ use the past perfect only where the order needs it, and sequence events with *by the time*, *when*, *while*, *already*, *just*, *until*
- ◆ reconstruct a jumbled story and retell it from another character's point of view with all four tenses

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.1 (Welcome box, New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My anecdote planner")
- ◆ Slides 1–9 · name tents · **Welcome question cards** (Set B) · **B1 diagnostic grid** (your copy) · tense-job cards and story-picture flashcards (Set A) · **Story Reconstruction** strips + retell cards (Set D, 1 envelope per group) · New identity cards (Set C)
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.1-A (The wrong train) and 1.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: a timeline: EARLIER ——— STORY MOMENT ——— NOW (telling). Over EARLIER: **had done** (an earlier event) · **had been doing** (how long). Over STORY MOMENT: **did** (main events) · **was doing** (background).

Center: the model sentence, color-coded: "By the time I arrived at the station, the train had already left. I had been rushing all morning, and now I was standing on an empty platform." Under it: FLAT: *I arrived. The train left. I waited.*

Right: **had done** = finished / a number (*She'd written three emails.*) · **had been doing** = the activity, how long (*She'd been writing all night.*) · ~~X had been knowing~~ → **had known** (state). Below: **while** + long background · **when** + short interruption · **by the time** + past simple, *had done* in the other clause.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & name tents	7	T-S	Greet each person at the door. Learners write the name they want to be called on a name tent (a new-identity name is fine). Go around the room and learn to say every name correctly . Introduce yourself with a tiny layered story: "I'm _____. I'd been teaching for two years when I first taught a B2 class, and I was so nervous that I'd prepared three lessons for one class!"
Welcome mingle = B1 diagnostic	15	S-S (mingle)	Slide 3. Each learner takes three welcome question cards , one of each color (STORY · IF · OPINION). They stand, find a partner, ask one question and one follow-up , answer in 3–4 sentences, then swap cards and find a new partner (4 rounds, about 3 min each). You walk with the diagnostic grid and listen (see "Running the diagnostic" below). Last 2–3 minutes: 3–4 learners tell the class something interesting a partner said. ICQs first.
About this course	3	T-S	Slide 2. 26 classes, 2 a week, 13 weeks; the workbook; the online course is homework (show it on a phone and tap a  button). B2 = range and nuance : layering, precision, persuading, and choosing how formal to be. Module 1 = looking back: what happened, what could have happened, what we wish.
Lead-in: flat vs layered	5	T-S	Hold up a train ticket. Board (center): the FLAT version: "I arrived at the station. The train left. I waited two hours." "Is this correct English?" (Yes.) "Is it a good story?" (No, boring.) Slide 5: show the layered version. "What's different? What extra information do we get?" (What happened before, how long, the scene.) Elicit the names of the tenses they recognize.
Grammar: four tenses, four jobs	13	T-S → S-S	Slides 6–7. The timeline on the board (left). One job per tense with the tense-job cards (EVENT · BACKGROUND · EARLIER · DURATION). Then the new form: <i>had been</i> + <i>-ing</i> , and simple vs continuous (right). CCQs (below). Pairs label the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			verbs in the slide 6 model story with the four cards (2 min). Then <i>when / while / by the time</i> (slide 7) and the "don't overuse it" rule.
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: the "why?" drill (<i>He was tired because he'd been...</i>), weak forms of <i>had been</i> , and the <i>by the time</i> chain.
Listening: the wrong train	6	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.1-A once for gist ("Why was the speaker late?"), then again: learners write the verbs. Check, and ask: "Which verbs are the background? Which are earlier?"
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on (usually Ex 3 simple vs continuous). Early finishers start Ex 5 (flat → layered).
Freer: Story Reconstruction	18	S-S (groups) → T-S	Slides 8-9. Read the model anecdote dialogue (slide 8) with a strong learner first. Groups of 3-4 get an envelope: Story A (The Wedding Cake) or Story B (Locked Out), 8 jumbled strips. (1) Put the strips in order, using the tenses and linkers as clues (6 min). (2) Turn the strips face down. Take a retell card : retell the whole story from another character's point of view (the taxi driver, the neighbor), taking turns, one part each. The retell must include two had been + -ing and two sequencing words (8 min). (3) One A-group and one B-group tell their version to the class; the other groups say what they had never heard before (4 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Content first: "Which retelling surprised you?" Then language: 4 sentences you heard (2 good, 2 with errors, no names), e.g. "When I arrived, the party already finished." · "I had been knowing her for years." Plus one range upgrade: a correct flat sentence the class turns into a layered one.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 1.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 15 + 3 + 5 + 13 + 5 + 6 + 8 + 18 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

The welcome mingle is the most important part of C1. Don't cut it: the group needs it, and you need the diagnostic. Cut instead: Ex 4 goes to homework, and the dictation (Script 1.1-B) moves to the C2 warmer. Keep at least 12 minutes for the Story Reconstruction: the **retell** (step 2) is where the past perfect continuous gets used, so if you must, shorten the class sharing instead.

◆ RUNNING THE DIAGNOSTIC – WHAT TO LISTEN FOR

The mingle is a friendly first conversation, not a test. Learners must never feel watched. Hold the grid on a clipboard, stand near a pair for 30–60 seconds, and join in sometimes ("Really? What had happened before that?"). Mark each learner ✓ (easy and accurate) · ~ (understands, some errors) · ✗ (can't produce it yet) in four columns:

- ◆ **NARRATIVE TENSES** (the STORY cards): past simple for events, *was / were + -ing* for background, *had + pp* for an earlier event. Listen for "When I arrived, the bus already left," "I was knowing," irregular past forms, and stories that stay in the present tense.
- ◆ **CONDITIONALS** (the IF cards): first (*If it rains, I'll...*) and second (*If I had a free day, I'd...*), and *I wish I had / could....* Listen for "If I would have...", "If I will...", and the present simple after *would* ("I would to go").
- ◆ **DISCUSSION SKILLS** (the OPINION cards): Does the learner give a reason and an example? Agree or disagree politely (*I see your point, but...*)? Ask the partner a question back? Let the partner finish?
- ◆ **RANGE & FLUENCY**: long turns (4+ sentences), varied vocabulary and linkers, keeping going when they don't know a word, self-correction. At B2, this column matters as much as accuracy.

What to do with the results: mostly ✓ and ~ = ready for B2. Many ~ in the NARRATIVE column is normal: that is exactly what C1 teaches. Many ✗ in the first two columns **and** short turns = check the placement privately (the toolkit's oral placement interview takes 5 minutes); the learner may do better in the B1 course, or may need extra support from Day 1. Lots of ✓ **and** strong range = give the Stretch tasks in every class and consider the C1 course later. **Never share the grid with learners.** Keep it; compare it with Progress Test 1 in C13.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WELCOME MINGLE

SAY: *How many cards do you take? (Three, one of each color.) · How many questions do you ask each person? (One, plus one follow-up.) · How long is your answer: one sentence? (No, three or four.) · After*

you talk, what do you do with the cards? (Swap them.) · Then? (Find a new partner.) · Do you have to answer about your real life? (No. A new identity card, something invented, or "Pass.") · On the **OPINION** card, do you have to give your real opinion? (No, you can play devil's advocate.)

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: four tenses, four jobs. Past simple = the main events, in order (the story's timeline). Past continuous = background in progress around a moment (the scenery). Past perfect = an event *before* the story moment (the "past of the past"). Past perfect continuous = how long an activity had been going on up to that moment, often explaining a result.

SAY: "By the time I arrived, the train had already left." Did I see the train? (No.) Which happened first? (The train left.) · "When I arrived, the train left." Did I see it? (Yes, maybe: I arrived, then it left.) So what does had left tell us? (The order: it left before I got there.)

SAY: "His eyes were red. He'd been crying." Is he crying now, at the story moment? (No, or maybe just stopped.) Was the crying long or short? (Long: an activity over time.) Why are his eyes red? (Because of the crying: it explains the result.)

SAY: "She'd written three emails." / "She'd been writing emails all morning." Which one counts the emails? (The first.) Which one is about the activity and how long? (The second.) Can I say "She'd been writing three emails"? (Not naturally: a number = finished results = simple.)

SAY: "I'd known him for years." Why not "I'd been knowing him"? (Know is a state, not an activity. States stay simple: know, be, have (own), want, like, believe.)

SAY: when vs while: "While I was cooking, the phone rang." Which action was longer? (Cooking.) Which interrupted? (The phone.) Which tense for the long one? (Past continuous.) · "After I finished, I left." Do I need had finished? (No, after already shows the order. Both are OK.)

Form.

Past simple	verb + -ed / irregular	She opened the door.
Past continuous	was / were + -ing	The rain was falling outside.
Past perfect	had + past participle · <i>hadn't</i> · <i>Had you...?</i>	Someone had broken the window.
Past perfect continuous	had been + -ing · <i>hadn't been</i> · <i>Had you been...?</i>	They'd been arguing for hours.

With for / since	had been + <i>-ing</i> + for (a length) / since (a start point)	By 2020 she'd been teaching for ten years.
Sequencing	by the time + past simple → <i>had done</i> · while / as + past continuous · when + past simple · until · already / just between <i>had</i> and the participle	I'd just sat down when he called.

Pronunciation. In speech, *had* becomes 'd: "I'd been waiting" /aɪd bɪn/, and *been* is weak /bɪn/ in American English (not "bean"). "She'd been working" sounds like "sheed-bin-working." Teach learners to decode 'd: 'd + past participle or *been* = *had* (*she'd gone, she'd been*); 'd + base verb = *would* (*she'd go*). In a negative, *hadn't* is stressed: "I **HADn't** seen her for years." Storytelling: slow down and drop your voice for the background ("I'd been waiting for an hour..."), then speed up for the main event ("...when suddenly the lights **went** out!").

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Why?** (T gives a result; learners explain with *had been* + *-ing*): T: "He was exhausted. Why? (run)" → S: "Because he'd been running." T: "Her hands were covered in flour. (bake)" → S: "Because she'd been baking." T: "The ground was wet. (rain)" → S: "Because it had been raining." T: "Their eyes were red. (cry / watch a sad movie)" → S: "They'd been watching a sad movie."
- Weak forms:** choral "I'd been waiting" ×3 (/aɪd bɪn 'weɪtɪŋ/), then "She'd been working for hours" ×2, then "We hadn't eaten" (stress on HAD).
- Simple or continuous?** T: "three books / write" → S: "She'd written three books." T: "all night / write" → S: "She'd been writing all night." T: "for years / know him" → S: "I'd known him for years." (Stop them if they say "been knowing.")
- By the time chain:** T: "By the time I got to the party..." → S1: "...everyone had left." T: "By the time the pizza arrived..." → S2: "...we'd been waiting for an hour." T: "By the time she called back..." → S3: "...I'd already fallen asleep."
- Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 gives a result ("I was so happy yesterday."); S2 asks "Why? What had happened?"; S1 answers with a past perfect or past perfect continuous (real, invented or from a card). Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ STORY RECONSTRUCTION – HOW TO RUN IT

- Groups of 3–4. Half the groups get **Story A • The Wedding Cake** (Priya the baker, a changed hotel, a van that dies, a helpful taxi driver); half get **Story B • Locked Out** (Daniel's first day, a power cut, keys left inside, a helpful neighbor). Each envelope has 8 strips, printed with letters, in a jumbled order.
- Step 1: order (6 min).** Learners lay out the strips and find the order. Tell them the **grammar is the clue**: *By the time...* can't be first; *had been* + *-ing* often looks back from a later moment; *while / when* join

background and interruption. They read the story aloud in order when they finish. Answers are in the classroom materials and the answer key.

- ◆ **Step 2: retell (8 min).** Strips face down. The group takes the **retell card** for their story: Story A from the **taxi driver's** point of view ("I'd been driving since six that morning when I saw a woman pushing a van..."); Story B from **Mrs. Ortiz, the neighbor's** point of view ("I was watering my plants when I heard a door slam..."). They take turns, one part each, and use the card's target: **two *had been* + *-ing* and two sequencing words**. The listener on their left ticks the targets on the card.
- ◆ **Step 3: share (4 min).** One A-group and one B-group retell to the class. The other groups listen for one detail they hadn't heard before.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers:** in the retell, each learner tells **one part at a time** (use the order of the strips: 2 strips each). Give the strongest speaker the job of **checker** (they hold the retell card and tick the targets) in step 2.
- ◆ Both stories are invented and cheerful on purpose. The optional personal step is in the homework ("My anecdote planner"), where learners choose a small real story, a new identity card story, or an invented one.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE STORY RECONSTRUCTION

SAY: *How many strips? (Eight.) · What helps you find the order? (The tenses and the linking words.) · In step 2, can you look at the strips? (No, face down.) · Whose point of view do you use? (The one on the retell card: the taxi driver / the neighbor.) · What two things must you use? (Two *had been* + *-ing* and two sequencing words.) · Who ticks the card? (The checker.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on two jobs: **was / were + -ing** (background) and **had + pp** (earlier). Give a colored strip with two frames: "I **was** ____ing when ____." / "By the time I ____, ____ **had** ____." In the reconstruction, give only the 5 strips marked ★ in the materials (the story still works). In the retell, the learner tells the **first part** (the easiest) and uses the pictures on the retell card. Target: 3 layered spoken sentences, one with *had been* + *-ing* using the drill frame "...because I'd been ____ing."

STRETCH (TOWARD C1)

Use a wider range of sequencing: *as soon as*, *it wasn't until...* *that...*, *no sooner had... than...* (recognize it; don't push the inversion on the class). Add **emphasis and reaction** to the retell: "What I hadn't realized was that..." "To make things worse..." Early finishers do Ex 5 twice: once calm, once dramatic, and compare the verbs they chose. In the retell, the strong learner adds one detail the other character **couldn't** have known ("...though I found out later that she'd been baking since five").

- ◆ **No past perfect at all:** "When I arrived, the train already left." Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai, Indonesian/Malay and Japanese mark the order with time words or context, not with the verb. Learners understand the idea; they just don't need it in their language. Draw the timeline every time and ask "Which happened first?"
- ◆ **Overusing the past perfect:** "Yesterday I had gone to the market and I had bought..." Spanish, Portuguese, French and Italian learners sometimes use the pluperfect for any "far" past, and some Arabic and Persian speakers use it for a completed action. Remind them: the past simple is the story's backbone; *had done* only steps back from it.
- ◆ **"I was knowing / I had been knowing":** Spanish, Portuguese and Italian imperfect (*conocía, sabía*) and the Indian-English style "I was having a car" push states into the continuous. Keep the list of state verbs on the board.
- ◆ **Slipping into the present perfect** inside a past story: "By the time I arrived, the train has left." German, Dutch, French and Italian use their "have + participle" tense for ordinary past narration. The lesson's rule: stay in the past: *had left*.
- ◆ **Aspect confusion:** Russian, Polish and Ukrainian speakers map the past continuous onto the imperfective and may use it for completed or repeated actions ("Every summer I was going to the lake"). Show that a finished action in the story line is past simple.
- ◆ **/bɪn/:** learners who say "bean" /bi:n/ for *been* are understood, but the weak form helps listening. Tagalog, Chinese and Turkish speakers may also mix *he / she* in the retell: point at the character on the retell card.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_01.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 1.1: finish Ex 5 if needed, then "My anecdote planner": plan a **small** memorable event in three layers (a mix-up, a funny surprise, a lucky escape from a rainstorm) from your real life, a new identity card, or an invented one, and tell it out loud (or record it) in 2 minutes. Then "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** had already taken off · Q2 **A** had been studying · Q3 (new) **B** I had known him for ten years when we finally met in person. The wrong train (Ex 1): 1 was going · 2 had been looking · 3 was sitting · 4 had gotten · 5 had traveled · 6 had been reading · 7 hadn't heard · 8 had already started.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ form the third conditional: *If + had + past participle, ... would have + past participle*, with either clause first (comma after the *if*-clause)
- ◆ "flip" a third conditional back to reality (*If you'd told me, I'd have helped* = you didn't tell me; I didn't help) and use it for regret, criticism and relief
- ◆ choose **would have** (certain), **could have** (possible) or **might have** (maybe) in the result, and use *You could have...!* as a criticism
- ◆ choose the second or third conditional by asking "Can it still change?"
- ◆ build **mixed conditionals**: past cause → present result (*If I'd taken that job, I'd be rich now*) and present trait → past result (*If I were more careful, I wouldn't have lost it*)
- ◆ say *would've / could've* naturally and write *would have*, never "would of"

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 1.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "Small turning points")
- ◆ Slides 10–13 · modal cards (*would have · could have · might have*) and "can it still change?" cards (Set A) · **Chain of Consequences** start and ending cards (Set E, 1 set per group of 4) + blank slips · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 1.2-A (The picnic that wasn't) and 1.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: REALITY: I didn't leave early. → I missed the train. · FLIP ↑ · If I **had left** early, I **would have caught** the train. Under it: If + **had + pp**, ... **would / could / might have + pp** · ✗ If I ~~would have known~~ · ✗ ~~would of~~ → *would've / 'wʊdəv/*.

Center: "Can it still change?" YES → 2nd: If I **had** money, I'd **travel**. · NO → 3rd: If I'd **had** money, I'd **have traveled**.

Right: MIXED: (a) past → now: If I **had taken** that job, I **would be** rich now. (b) always → past: If I **were** more careful, I **wouldn't have lost** my keys. Below: the chain: If A hadn't..., B wouldn't have... → If B hadn't..., C wouldn't have... → ... → ...and she wouldn't be... today!

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: tell me your story	8	S-S → T-S	Review C1. Pairs tell their homework anecdote (or retell Priya's or Daniel's story) in 90 seconds each. The listener counts the four narrative tenses on their fingers and asks one "What had happened before that?" question. Two volunteers tell the class. (If you moved the 1.1-B dictation, do it here instead of the retell.)
Lead-in: if only I'd checked	5	T-S	Open an umbrella. Tell a short invented story: "Last Sunday I planned a picnic. I didn't check the weather. It poured. We got soaked." Ask: "What was my mistake?" Elicit anything; then say and write: " If I had checked the weather, I would have stayed home." "Did I check? Did I stay home?" (No, no.) "So is this sentence true?" (No, it's imagined.)
Grammar: the third conditional	12	T-S	Slide 10. The two halves (board, left), the flip test, comma rules, contractions. The two top errors: "If I would have known" and "would of." CCQs (below).
Drill	6	T-S → S	See Drill script: flip drill, the reduced <i>would've</i> , the fast 'd chain.
Listening: the picnic that wasn't	6	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.2-A twice. Learners first answer "What really happened?" (reality), then complete the third conditionals. Check by flipping each one back to reality.
would / could / might · 2nd vs 3rd	8	T-S	Slide 11. The three modals as a confidence dial (certain → possible → maybe) with the modal cards. <i>You could have called!</i> as criticism. Then "Can it still change?" (board, center): hold up the YES / NO cards while learners judge 4 quick situations. CCQs.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-4 alone (third conditional, second or third?, would / could / might), then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 3: learners explain their choice with "It can / can't still change."

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Mixed conditionals	7	T-S → S	Slide 12. Time of the cause + time of the result, dressed separately. Type (a) with the anchor words <i>now, today, still</i> ; type (b) with a permanent trait. CCQs. Then Workbook Ex 5 alone (3 min).
Freer: Chain of Consequences	18	S-S (groups) → T-S	Slide 13. Groups of 4 get a start card (a small invented event: "Monday, 7 a.m.: Ana's alarm didn't go off.") and a face-down ending card (a surprising present: "...and that's why Ana runs a food truck today."). Players take turns adding a link that starts with the last result : "If Ana's alarm had gone off, she wouldn't have missed the bus." → "If she hadn't missed the bus, she wouldn't have walked through the park." Each link is written on a slip and laid in a line. After 4 links, turn over the ending card: the chain must reach it in 3–4 more links, and the last link must be a mixed conditional . Round 1 (8 min), round 2 with a new start card (6 min), then groups read their best chain aloud (4 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Board: 4 heard sentences, e.g. "If I would have known, I would help." · "If she hadn't missed the bus, she wouldn't meet him." · "I would of called." · "If I had taken that job, I would have been rich now." Learners fix them. Add one range upgrade: turn a <i>would have</i> into a more precise <i>might have</i> or <i>could have</i> .
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 1.2; the workbook "Small turning points" task (read the choices aloud; see below). Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 6 + 8 + 10 + 7 + 18 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This is the busiest class of the module (third *and* mixed conditionals). Cut the second round of the chain game, and move Workbook Ex 4 to homework. Never cut the chain itself: it is where learners produce ten or more third conditionals without noticing. With a class that finds mixed conditionals hard, let the final link be a normal third conditional and come back to mixed conditionals in the C3 warmer.

Meaning: an imagined past. The third conditional imagines the opposite of what really happened, so it is impossible to change. The real story is the "flip" of both halves.

SAY: "If you had told me, I would have helped." Did you tell me? (No.) Did I help? (No.) Can we change it now? (No, it's finished.) How do I feel? (Disappointed / a little annoyed: it's a criticism.) · "If she hadn't studied medicine, she would never have met him." Did she study medicine? (Yes.) Did she meet him? (Yes.) Is this regret? (No, it's reflection: "Life is funny.")

SAY: "If we'd left earlier, we **might** have caught the train." Are we sure? (No, maybe.) · "...we **could** have caught it." (It was possible.) · "...we **would** have caught it." (Certain.) · "You could have called!" Is there an if? (No.) What does it mean? (It was possible, and you didn't. I'm annoyed.)

SAY: Second or third? "I don't speak Japanese." Can it still change? (Yes, I can still learn.) So: If I **spoke** Japanese, I'd read that book. · "I didn't save the file." Can it change? (No, the work is lost.) So: If I **had saved** it, I wouldn't have lost my work.

SAY: Mixed (a): "If I had taken that job, I would be rich now." When was the job offer? (In the past.) Am I rich now? (No.) Why would be, not would have been? (Because the result is now.) · **Mixed (b):** "If he weren't so stubborn, he would have apologized." Is he stubborn now? (Yes, always.) Did he apologize? (No, in the past.)

Form.

Third conditional	If + had + pp , ... would have + pp · comma only when <i>if</i> comes first	If I'd known, I would have called you. · I would have called you if I'd known.
Negatives	hadn't + pp · wouldn't have + pp	If they hadn't helped, we wouldn't have finished.
Other modals	could have / might have + pp	If we'd left earlier, we might have made it.
2nd vs 3rd	2nd: past simple, would + base (unreal now) · 3rd: past perfect, would have + pp (unreal past)	If I knew, I'd tell you. · If I'd known, I'd have told you.
Mixed (a)	past cause → present result: If + had + pp , ... would + base	If I'd gone to bed earlier, I wouldn't be so tired today.
Mixed (b)	present trait → past result: If + past simple / were , ... would have + pp	If I were more organized, I wouldn't have forgotten the meeting.

Pronunciation. Both halves contract: "If I'd known, I'd have called" /aɪd əv/. *would have* → **would've** /'wʊdəv/, *could have* → /'kʊdəv/, *might have* → /'maɪtəv/, *wouldn't have* → /'wʊdəntəv/ ("wouldn't-uv"). The *have* sounds exactly like "of," which is why even native speakers write "would of." Stress falls on the main verbs and on any negative: "If I'd **KNOWN**, I'd have **CALLED**." · "If you **HADN'T** told me...". Regret intonation: a slow, falling "If **only** I'd checked..." ↘.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Flip it** (T gives reality; learners give the third conditional): T: "I didn't study. I failed." → S: "If I'd studied, I would've passed." T: "She missed the bus. She was late." → S: "If she hadn't missed the bus, she wouldn't have been late." T: "It rained. We didn't go to the beach." → S: "If it hadn't rained, we would've gone to the beach."
- 2 **Back-chain the reduced form**: "called" → "would've called" → "I'd have called" → "If I'd known, I'd have called." ×3, choral, then fast individuals. Then "wouldn't have come" /'wʊdəntəv/ ×3.
- 3 **Dial the confidence**: T: "If we'd left earlier... (sure)" → S: "...we would've caught it." T: "(possible)" → "...we could've caught it." T: "(not sure)" → "...we might've caught it."
- 4 **Can it still change?** T: "I don't have a car." → S: "If I had a car, I'd drive." T: "I didn't have a car last year." → S: "If I'd had a car, I'd have driven."
- 5 **Chain preview**: S1: "If I hadn't overslept, I wouldn't have missed the bus." S2 starts with S1's result: "If I hadn't missed the bus, I wouldn't have..." Keep going around the room for 6 links; the last learner ends with "...now."

◆ CHAIN OF CONSEQUENCES – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 4. Each group gets **one start card** (face up) and **one ending card** (face down), plus blank slips. The 8 start cards are small, invented everyday events (a missed alarm, a wrong order at a café, a lost umbrella, a spilled coffee). The 8 ending cards are surprising "present" results (running a food truck, being the best dancer at the office party, owning a very large dog).
- ◆ **The rule**: each new link **starts with the result of the last link**, turned into an *if*-clause. S1: "If Ana's alarm had gone off, she wouldn't have missed the bus." S2: "If she hadn't missed the bus, she wouldn't have walked through the park." S3: "If she hadn't walked through the park, she wouldn't have smelled the tacos..." Write each link on a slip and lay the slips in a line on the desk.
- ◆ After 4 links, turn over the **ending card**. Now the group must steer the chain to the ending in 3–4 more links. The **last link must be a mixed conditional**: "...and if she hadn't tasted those tacos, she wouldn't be running a food truck today!"
- ◆ Scoring (optional): 1 point per correct link (both halves right), 2 bonus points for a correct mixed-conditional ending, 1 point for a link that uses *could have* or *might have*. Everyone checks: "Is the *if*-half *had* + *pp*? Is the result *would have* + *pp*?"

- ◆ **Dominant speakers:** strict turns: the slip goes clockwise, and you may not add a link out of turn. Give the strongest speaker the job of **checker** in round 1 (they check every slip before it goes down). Quieter learners may **read** their link from a slip they have written first.
- ◆ Every chain is about **invented people and small events**. Don't let groups use classmates' real lives or big life events. If a chain drifts somewhere sad, steer it back with a silly link.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE CHAIN OF CONSEQUENCES

SAY: *What does your link start with? (The result of the last link, as an if-clause.) · What's the form of the if-half? (had + past participle.) · And the result? (would have + past participle.) · When do you turn over the ending card? (After 4 links.) · What's special about the last link? (It's a mixed conditional: ...would be... now / today.) · Can you add a link when it isn't your turn? (No.) · Is the story about real people in our class? (No, only the card people.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with one frame on a strip: "If ____ **had** ____, ____ **would have** ____." and the 10 most useful participles written under it (*gone, left, missed, seen, met, known, told, taken, bought, eaten*). In the chain, the learner **writes the link first**, then reads it aloud, and may copy the result of the last slip to start their *if*-half. Skip mixed conditionals for now. Target: 4 correct spoken third conditionals, including one negative.

STRETCH (TOWARD C1)

Add precision to the result: *would probably have, might well have, could easily have*. Use *should have / shouldn't have* for criticism and *needn't have* for wasted effort ("I needn't have brought an umbrella"). In the chain, make every other link a different modal, and end with a **type (b)** mixed conditional ("...if she weren't so curious, she'd never have tried them"). Recognize (don't teach) the inverted form: *Had I known, I would have called*.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"If I would have known...":** German (*wenn ich gewusst hätte* uses the same "would" mood in both halves), Dutch, Swedish and many Slavic languages put the conditional in both clauses (Russian *если бы я знал, я бы...*). Also common in casual American speech. Cross out *would* in the *if*-clause every time: ***if + had***.
- ◆ **Second conditional for the past:** "If I knew, I would tell you" (meaning yesterday). Spanish and Portuguese learners know the difference (*si hubiera sabido*), but Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai, Indonesian and Japanese mark "unreal" and "past" with context, so the two English forms feel the same. Use "Can it still change?" as the key question.
- ◆ **Mixed-up halves:** "If I had taken the job, I would have been rich now." Learners who have just learned the third conditional apply it everywhere. Point at *now*: "Is *now* in the past?"

- ◆ **"would of / could of":** a spelling error, not a grammar one. Native speakers make it too. Every learner who writes it gets the "it sounds like 'of'" explanation once; after that, just underline.
- ◆ **Stress and the reduced *have*:** Spanish, Italian, Japanese and Korean speakers, who give every syllable full weight, may say "would HAVE" slowly and stressed, which sounds emphatic or angry. Drill the reduced /əv/. Arabic speakers may add a vowel: "would-uh-have."
- ◆ **Word order in questions:** "What you would have done?" Chinese and Vietnamese keep statement order. Drill "What **would you** have done?" as a chunk.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_02.html. Listen to the model sentences with  and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 1.2: "Small turning points": write 4–5 sentences about **small** turning points (a hobby you started, a course or class you chose, a phone or app you bought, a friend you met by chance at work or in class), **or** the new identity card's turning points, **or** an invented character's. At least one third conditional, one mixed conditional and one *could have / might have*. Tell learners clearly: **the online project's "a move" option is not part of this homework**, and they never need to write about big life decisions. Then "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** If I had seen it, I would have told you. · Q2 **A** had taken ... would be · Q3 (new) **A** You could have told me!
 The picnic that wasn't (Ex 1): 1 had checked ... wouldn't have planned · 2 had brought ... wouldn't have gotten
 · 3 hadn't gone ... wouldn't have met · 4 hadn't met ... wouldn't be.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- contrast a **present wish** (*wish / if only + past simple: I wish I had more time*) with a **past regret** (*wish / if only + past perfect: I wish I'd set an alarm*)
- complain about someone else's behavior with **wish + would** (*I wish the printer would work*), and know it can't be used about yourself
- state their own preference with **would rather + base verb (than...)** and a preference about someone else with **would rather + someone + past simple** (*I'd rather you didn't call so late*)
- say something is due or overdue with **it's time / it's high time / it's about time + past simple**, and *it's time to + verb*
- take part in a meeting about a building, workplace or neighborhood and argue for what is "high time"

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 1.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My wishes & preferences")
- Slides 14–17 · "unreal past" cards (Set A) · **"Would You Rather?"** cards (Set F, 1 set per pair) · **Wish List Meeting** scenario + role cards (Set G, 1 set per group of 4) · talking tokens · Find Someone Who (Set H, optional) · New identity cards
- Listening scripts 1.3-A (The office kitchen) and 1.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: ONE TRICK: a **past form** = **unreal / not yet**. NOW: I wish I **had** more time. (I don't.) · PAST: I wish I **had set** an alarm. (I didn't.) · ANNOYING: I wish the printer **would** work! (someone / something else only) · ✗ ~~I wish I would exercise~~ → I wish I exercised more.

Center: WOULD RATHER: me → I'd rather **walk** (than wait). · I'd rather **not**. · someone else → I'd rather you **didn't** call so late. (now / future!) · done already → I'd rather you **hadn't** told him.

Right: IT'S TIME we **left**. (now!) · It's HIGH time they **fixed** the elevator. (overdue 🙄) · It's ABOUT time... (impatient) · It's time **to** go. (no person) · ✗ ~~It's time we leave~~

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: consequence chains	7	S-S → T-S	Review C2. Pairs read one sentence from their "Small turning points" homework, or play a 6-link chain from a new start card (T reads: "Last Friday, Leo bought the wrong bread."). Quick-fire flip: T

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			says a reality, learners give the third conditional. One or two learners share a mixed conditional.
Lead-in: my tiny regrets	5	T-S	Tell three invented "tiny regrets" with a sigh: "Last month I bought a white sofa. I have two dogs. I wish I hadn't bought a white sofa! ... Last night I ate the whole pizza. If only I hadn't eaten it all! ... And I wish my neighbor's dog would stop barking at 6 a.m." Ask: "Are these big problems?" (No!) "This is what we'll talk about today: small, everyday things."
Grammar: wish now, wish then, wish + would	12	T-S	Slide 14. Present wish (review from B1) vs past regret (new), side by side; <i>if only</i> = stronger. Then <i>wish</i> + <i>would</i> for annoying behavior, and why not "I wish I would...". CCQs (below).
Drill	6	T-S → S	See Drill script: reality → wish, now or then?, and <i>if only</i> intonation.
Listening: the office kitchen	6	T-S → S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 1.3-A twice (two voices, or with a confident learner as Joe). Learners complete the sentences, then say which ones are about now and which about the past.
Would rather · it's time	10	T-S	Slide 15. <i>would rather</i> + base (me) vs + someone + past (someone else): "past form, present meaning." Then <i>it's time</i> / <i>high time</i> / <i>about time</i> + past, and <i>it's time to</i> . CCQs. Quick chorus: "It's high time we left! " (pointing at the clock).
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone (Ex 5 is find-the-mistake), then pairs check. Board-check only Ex 4 items 2 and 5 (<i>would rather</i> + <i>someone</i>).
Freer 1: Would You Rather?	10	S-S	Slide 16. Pairs take turns with the " Would You Rather? " cards: A reads a choice ("Would you rather cook dinner every night or wash the dishes every night?"); B answers with <i>I'd rather... than...</i> + one reason; A reacts and asks the follow-up on the card, which needs <i>I'd rather you...</i> or <i>I'd rather not</i> . Every card has a "Pass / I'd rather not say!" option. Swap after each card. ICQs first.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer 2: Wish List Meeting	16	S-S (groups) → T-S	Slide 16. Groups of 4 get a scenario card (the Maple Street apartment building, the Brightside office, Riverside Park & the bus stop, or Our English classroom) with a list of problems. Each member takes a role card (Chair, Note-taker, Devil's advocate, Timekeeper) and 3 talking tokens. (1) Prepare alone: 2 present wishes, 1 regret about a past decision, 1 <i>It's high time...</i> , 1 <i>I'd rather they...</i> (3 min). (2) The meeting: agree on the top 3 changes (9 min). (3) The note-taker reports to the class: "We wish the elevator worked. It's high time the owner fixed it. We'd rather they didn't..." (4 min). ICQs first.
Feedback + module check	5	T-S	Delayed correction: "I wish I would sleep more." · "It's time we leave." · "I'd rather you don't park there." · "I wish I had spoken French" (meaning now). Then learners tick the three Module 1 "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 1.3; the "My wishes & preferences" writing (read the choices aloud); preview C4: "Next class: <i>I stopped smoking</i> or <i>I stopped to smoke</i> ? One tiny word changes everything."
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 6 + 10 + 8 + 10 + 16 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Cut Freer 1 to 6 minutes (3 cards each), or use the Find Someone Who (Set H) as the C4 warmer instead. Never cut the Wish List Meeting: it is the module's discussion task, and it keeps the whole lesson in safe, shared, everyday territory. If time is very short, skip the report stage and ask each note-taker for just one sentence.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: one trick. In all these structures a past form doesn't mean past time. It means "unreal" or "not yet."

SAY: "I wish I had a car." Do I have a car? (No.) Is this about the past? (No, about now.) · "I wish I had bought that car." Did I buy it? (No.) When? (In the past.) Can I change it? (No, it's a regret.) · "If only I'd bought it!" Same meaning? (Yes, but stronger, more emotional.)

SAY: "I wish my roommate would wash the dishes." Does he wash them? (No.) Am I annoyed? (Yes.) Who has to change? (He does.) · Can I say "I wish I would go to the gym"? (No, you can't be annoyed with yourself this way.) What can I say? (I wish I went to the gym more. / I wish I could find the motivation.)

SAY: "I'd rather walk." Who walks? (Me.) What does 'd rather mean? (Would prefer.) · "I'd rather you didn't call after ten." Who calls? (You.) Is didn't about the past? (No! About now and the future.) · "I'd rather you hadn't told him." Did you tell him? (Yes, already. I'm sorry you did.)

SAY: "It's high time we fixed the printer." Have we fixed it? (No.) Should we do it now? (Yes, it's overdue.) Is the speaker happy? (No, a little annoyed.) · "It's time we left." Did we leave? (No, we should leave now.) · "It's time to go." Who? (Not said: everybody.)

Form.

Present wish	wish / if only + past simple · <i>could</i> · <i>were</i> (all persons, more formal)	I wish I could drive. · If only it weren't raining.
Past regret	wish / if only + past perfect	I wish we'd booked earlier. · If only I hadn't said that.
Annoyance	wish + someone / something else + would + base	I wish it would stop raining. · I wish you wouldn't interrupt.
would rather (me)	'd rather + base (+ than + base) · 'd rather not	I'd rather walk than wait for the bus.
would rather (someone)	'd rather + someone + past simple (now / future) · + past perfect (already done)	I'd rather you came tomorrow. · I'd rather you hadn't told him.
it's time	it's (high / about) time + subject + past simple · it's time to + base	It's about time they fixed that road. · It's time to go.

Pronunciation. *I'd rather* = /aɪd 'ræðər/ (American: the *a* in *rather* as in *cat*; British /'rɑ:ðə/). Learners often don't hear the 'd: drill "I'd rather" as one chunk. *If only* carries the regret: high, slow start, falling end: "If ONLY I'd known... ↘." *wish* is stressed, and so is the contrast word: "I wish I **HAD** more time" vs "I wish I **HAD** set an alarm" (the second *had* is often weak: "I wish I'd set..."). *It's high time* is stressed on **HIGH**, with an annoyed, falling tone.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Reality → wish** (T gives a present fact): T: "I don't have much time." → S: "I wish I had more time." T: "I can't cook." → S: "I wish I could cook." T: "It's cold." → S: "I wish it weren't so cold."
- Now or then?** (T gives a fact; learners decide): T: "I didn't bring an umbrella." → S: "I wish I'd brought an umbrella." T: "I don't have an umbrella." → S: "I wish I had an umbrella." T: "I ate too much cake." →

S: "If only I hadn't eaten so much cake!"

- 3 **Annoyed:** T (pointing at an imaginary noisy neighbor): "music!" → S: "I wish they'd turn the music down!" T: "the bus / late" → S: "I wish the bus would come on time!"
- 4 **Would rather two ways:** T: "walk / take the bus" → S: "I'd rather walk than take the bus." T: "you / not call after ten" → S: "I'd rather you didn't call after ten." T: "we / leave now" → S: "I'd rather we left now."
- 5 **It's high time:** T points at pictures or mimes: a clock → "It's time we left." · a broken elevator sign → "It's high time they fixed it." · a messy desk → "It's about time I cleaned it!" Choral with the annoyed tone, then individuals.

◆ "WOULD YOU RATHER?" – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Pairs, one set of 16 cards face down. Every card is light and everyday (food, weekends, chores, phones, work habits, travel around town). No card asks about the past, the family or the home country.
- ◆ A reads the choice. B answers in two sentences: "**I'd rather** wash the dishes **than** cook every night. Cooking takes too long." A reacts, then asks the card's **follow-up**, which needs the "someone else" pattern: "So if we were roommates, would you rather I cooked or I washed the dishes?" → B: "**I'd rather you cooked**, definitely!"
- ◆ "I'd rather not say!" is always a correct answer. It's also useful grammar.
- ◆ Stretch: answer with a reason and a condition: "I'd rather live without my phone for a day than without coffee, but if I had a job interview, I'd rather have my phone."

◆ WISH LIST MEETING – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 4. Each group gets one **scenario card**: **A · Maple Street apartments** (the elevator, the laundry room, noise, the trash area) · **B · Brightside office** (the printer, the kitchen, meetings, the air conditioning) · **C · Riverside Park & the bus stop** (lights, benches, the bus schedule, dogs) · **D · Our English classroom** (the room, the timetable, homework, the coffee). All are about shared places, never about anyone's private life.
- ◆ **Roles:** the **Chair** opens and closes the meeting and makes sure everyone speaks; the **Note-taker** writes the top 3 changes and reports; the **Devil's advocate** argues against at least two ideas ("I'd rather they didn't spend money on that..."); the **Timekeeper** gives warnings at 5 and 2 minutes. Give the strongest speaker the Chair or the Note-taker role, **not** the Devil's advocate.
- ◆ **Talking tokens:** 3 each. You put one in the middle every time you speak. When yours are gone, you listen until everyone has used theirs, then everyone takes them back. This stops one person running the meeting.
- ◆ **Language targets** (on the role card): 2 present wishes (*I wish the elevator worked*), 1 regret about a past decision (*I wish they hadn't moved the bus stop*), 1 *It's high time...*, 1 *I'd rather they...*, and one polite disagreement (*I see your point, but...*).

- ◆ The meeting speaks about **decisions and places**, not people: no complaints about real named neighbors, coworkers or classmates. In scenario D, learners may complain about the classroom and the teacher's homework. Take it with a smile.

◆ ICQS BEFORE WOULD YOU RATHER AND THE MEETING

SAY: *Would You Rather: What words start your answer? ("I'd rather... than...") · How many sentences? (Two: the choice and a reason.) · The follow-up question is about who? (The other person: "I'd rather you...") · Can you say "I'd rather not say"? (Yes, always.)*

SAY: *Meeting: How many changes do you agree on? (Three.) · Who reports? (The Note-taker.) · What do you do with a token? (Put one in the middle when you speak.) · What does the Devil's advocate do? (Argue against some ideas.) · Can we complain about real neighbors or coworkers? (No, only about the place and the decisions.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Two frames only: "I wish I **had** / **could** ____." (now) and "I wish I **had** ____ed." (then), plus the chunk "I'd rather ____ than ____." Give the learner the 8 "Would You Rather?" cards marked ★ (short, with a picture). In the meeting, the learner is the **Timekeeper** (a real job, less speaking pressure) and prepares 2 sentences from the frames. Target: 2 present wishes, 1 regret, 2 *I'd rather* answers.

STRETCH (TOWARD C1)

Use alternatives with slightly different register: *I'd prefer it if you didn't..., I'd sooner..., It's (well) past time..., I regret not...ing / I regret having...,* and the formal *If only I had..., ...but there we are.* In the meeting, the strong learner summarizes both sides before the vote: "So, on the one hand we'd rather they didn't..., but on the other hand it's high time...". Early finishers write three sentences where *wish* + *past simple* and *wish* + *past perfect* use the same verb with different meanings (*I wish I knew / I wish I'd known*).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I wish I would..." / "I wish I will..."**: Spanish (*ojalá* + subjunctive), Portuguese, Arabic (*atamannā an...*) and Chinese (我希望 *xīwàng* = both "hope" and "wish") use one structure for hopes and wishes, so learners say "I wish you will pass" (= *hope*). Contrast: **hope** = possible (*I hope you pass*); **wish** = unreal (*I wish you'd told me*).
- ◆ **Present tense after *would rather you* / *it's time we***: "I'd rather you don't go." · "It's time we go." Almost every learner does this, because the meaning is present. Keep repeating "past form, present meaning."

- ◆ **Now / then mix-up:** "I wish I had spoken French" (meaning "I wish I could speak it now"). Russian, Polish and Czech speakers use one conditional form (*бы*) for both, and Spanish and Portuguese speakers may map *had spoken* to their imperfect subjunctive. Ask: "Is it about now or about a finished moment?"
- ◆ **"I'd rather to stay":** Spanish *prefiero quedarme*, French *je préfère rester* and Arabic *ufaddil an* pull in *to*. Compare: *I'd prefer to stay* but *I'd rather stay*.
- ◆ **Not hearing 'd:** "I rather walk." Vietnamese, Cantonese and Thai speakers, whose languages don't end words in *-d* clusters, often drop the 'd in *I'd rather* and *I'd set*. Exaggerate it in the drill, then accept it in fast speech.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 1.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_03.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 1.3: "My wishes & preferences": six sentences about **everyday things** (a habit, a purchase, your week, your street, your workplace or this class), or the new identity card's wishes, or an invented person's. At least one each: *wish + past perfect*, *wish + past simple*, *I'd rather + base*, *I'd rather + someone + past*, *it's (high) time + past*. Say out loud: "Small things only. You never have to write about anything you don't want to." Then "My new words" and the journal (turn one small regret into a plan: "I wish I'd drunk more water this week, so from tomorrow I'll...").

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A I wish I had applied for the scholarship. · Q2 A washed · Q3 (new) A I'd rather you didn't play your music so loud at night. The office kitchen (Ex 1): 1 had brought · 2 would clean · 3 had · 4 hadn't finished · 5 got · 6 'd rather · 7 we asked.

END OF C3: MODULE 1 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 17, "three ways to look back": **what happened** (*By the time I arrived, I'd been traveling for hours and the party had finished*) → **what could have happened** (*If I'd left earlier, I would've caught it... and I wouldn't be so tired now*) → **what we wish** (*I wish I'd set an alarm. I'd rather you didn't call so late. It's high time we fixed the printer.*). One idea joins 1.2 and 1.3: **a past form can mean "unreal."** Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C4 warmer and again in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 2: gerunds and infinitives (*stop doing / stop to do, remember doing / remember to do*) meet this module in *regret*: "I regret not studying" = "I wish I'd studied." Past modals of deduction in 2.2 (*must have, might have, can't have*) use the same *modal + have + pp* form as the third conditional, so learners will mix "might have" (maybe, in a conditional) with "might have" (a guess about the past). That's useful: link them explicitly. Keep a 2-minute "flip it" warmer (one third conditional, one wish) in C4–C6.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: the four narrative tenses and their jobs, past perfect simple vs continuous (including state verbs), *by the time / when / while*; the third conditional (form and the "flip"), *would / could / might have*, second vs third, both types of mixed conditional, *would have* spelling; *wish / if only* + past simple vs past perfect, *wish + would, would rather* (both patterns) and *it's (high) time* + past simple.

Module 2 — Verb Patterns & Modality

Three classes about the small words that carry a lot of meaning. First, gerunds and infinitives: which verbs take *-ing* and which take *to*, the rules for prepositions and purpose, and the verbs whose meaning changes with the form (*remember, forget, stop, try, regret, go on, mean*). Then **past deduction**: *must have / can't have / might have + past participle* to reason about what happened, plus *should have* and *could have* for judging past choices. Last, the famous look-alikes **used to / be used to / get used to**: a past habit, a familiar state, and the process of adapting.

3 lessons

Lessons 2.1-2.3

Classes C4-C6

Weeks 2-3

90 min per class

CEFR B2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, mingle) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-2-verb-patterns.html](#). Print [materials/module-2/classroom-materials.html](#) before C4. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the **Pattern Path** board game and referee sheet, the "Two minutes about me" interview cards, the **Mystery of Room 12** clue cards and detective notes, the "Adjusting to something new" change cards and role-plays, the Find-someone-who grid and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** B1 taught all three topics at a basic level: verb patterns and *stop to / stop -ing* (B1 6.2), present deduction *must be / can't be* (B1 4.2), and *used to* and *would* for past habits (B1 1.3). Test first in each lead-in and move fast where the class is strong. The new B2 work is **precision**: the whole meaning-change set, *to* as a preposition, past deduction on a certainty scale, the two jobs of *could have*, and the state / process contrast of *be used to* vs *get used to*.
- Fluency before accuracy.** In every freer task, listen and take notes; don't stop a speaker to fix a verb pattern. The feedback stage is where you fix errors, without names. At B2, feed back on **accuracy and range**: write up

two or three errors *and* two or three good, ambitious phrases you heard ("*I can't afford to waste time*" · "*They can't possibly have eaten it*"). Praise the risk-taking as much as the correct forms.

- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** All three freer tasks are built to share the floor: the board game has a rotating **referee**, the mystery is an **information gap** (each learner holds clues nobody else has, so everyone must speak), and the "adjusting" discussion uses a **talking-turn token**. Give your strongest speaker a job that makes them listen: referee, note-taker, or "the person who summarizes last." Say it kindly: "Great ideas, Omar. Let's hear Lin's clues first."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C1.** Each lesson has a stretch box with C1-flavored options (perfect and passive gerunds, *may well have*, *needn't have*, *be accustomed to*). Offer them as options for early finishers, not as new content for the whole class.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British forms (*practise*, *memorise*, *apologise*, *travelling*, *holiday*, *neighbour*, *flat*, *cinema*, *at the weekend*, *binned*, *half four*, *ill*) and the British present perfect *I've got used to*. Teach *practice*, *memorize*, *apologize*, *traveling*, *vacation*, *neighbor*, *apartment*, *movie theater*, *on the weekend*, *threw it away*, *four-thirty*, *sick* and ***I've gotten used to***. Accept the British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

What we do → what must have happened → what we're used to. In C4 learners talk about their habits, goals and likes with exactly the right verb pattern: *I've stopped staying up late*. *I'm hoping to run a 10K*. In C5 they turn detective and reason about the past with the right amount of certainty: *They must have left in a hurry*. *They can't have eaten the cake*. In C6 they describe change over time: *I used to work in an office*. *I'm used to the early start now, but I'm still getting used to the new app*. Every class ends with a real communicative task: a two-minute talk, a group verdict on a mystery, and a discussion about adjusting to something new.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: MYSTERIES, REGRETS AND "BIG CHANGES"

Three places in this module need care. (1) **Deduction.** Keep deduction scenarios harmless. In class, use the **Mystery of Room 12** instead: a surprise birthday party that moved to the park. Nobody is hurt, no police, no crime. Don't add crime or disappearance stories. (2) **Regret.** *Should have / shouldn't have* can open heavy memories. Keep examples small and everyday (the umbrella, a late night, a missed bus), and never ask "What do you regret most in your life?" (3) **"A big change."** The online lesson 2.3 project lists "moving country" as one optional choice. In class, the "adjusting" discussion is about **neutral changes**: a new job, a new schedule, new technology, a new neighborhood across town, a new hobby. **Never ask** "What was it like when you came to this country?" or "What do you miss about home?" If a learner *chooses* to talk about moving countries, listen warmly and don't ask probing follow-ups. For every personal task, offer three choices out loud: **your real life**, **a new identity card** (in the classroom materials), or **something imagined**. Anyone can say "Pass."

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the activity pictures, the *-ing / to* verb cards, the meaning-change cards, the past-modal cards and the three *used to* cards. Card stock helps. Cut them before C4.
- For C4: one **Pattern Path** board (A3 if you can) + one **referee sheet** + a coin or die per group of 3–4, and one set of **"Two minutes about me"** interview cards (A/B) per pair.
- For C5: one set of **Room 12 clue cards** (A, B, C, D) per group of 4, and one **detective notes** sheet per learner. With groups of 3, give one learner cards C and D together. Optional: put a real paper cup, a phone charger and an umbrella on your desk for the lead-in. Learners enjoy it.
- For C6: one **Find someone who** grid per learner, one set of **change cards** per group of 3, and the **role-play cards** (A/B) for pairs who finish early.
- Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
2.1	C4 • wk 2	Verb + -ing (<i>enjoy, avoid, mind, consider...</i>) and verb + to (<i>want, decide, afford, refuse...</i>); gerund after prepositions (incl. <i>look forward to</i>) and as subject ; infinitive after adjectives and for purpose ; verb + object + <i>to</i> ; bare infinitive after <i>let / make</i> ; meaning change : <i>remember, forget, stop, try, regret, go on, mean</i>	talk for two minutes about their habits, goals and likes with a wide range of verb patterns, and choose the form that says what they mean with <i>remember / stop / try</i>
2.2	C5 • wk 3	Past deduction : <i>must have / can't (couldn't) have / might (may, could) have + past participle</i> on a certainty scale; <i>might not have</i> ; never <i>mustn't have</i> , never <i>could of</i> ; should(n't) have for criticism and regret; could have's two jobs; present vs past deduction	reason aloud from clues about what happened, say how sure they are, rule possibilities in and out, and reach a group verdict on a mystery
2.3	C6 • wk 3	used to + base verb (past habit / state, <i>didn't use to</i>) vs be used to + noun / -ing (familiar now) vs get used to + noun / -ing (adapting); the "it" test; <i>to</i> as a preposition	describe a change in their life (a new job, schedule, technology, neighborhood or hobby): how things used to be, what they're used to now and what they're still getting used to

2.1 · C4

Gerunds & Infinitives

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use the gerund after common verbs (*enjoy, avoid, finish, mind, suggest, consider, keep, miss, can't stand*) and the infinitive after others (*want, decide, hope, promise, agree, offer, refuse, manage, afford, seem*)
- ◆ use the gerund after **any preposition**, including *to* when it is a preposition (*look forward to seeing, be committed to helping*), and as the **subject** of a sentence
- ◆ use the infinitive after adjectives (*happy to help, difficult to explain*) and the **infinitive of purpose** (*I went out to buy milk, not for buying*)
- ◆ use verb + object + infinitive (*She encouraged him to apply*) and the bare infinitive after modals and *let / make*
- ◆ choose the form that matches the meaning with *remember, forget, stop, try* (and *regret, go on, mean*): -*ing* = memory / the activity itself · *to* = duty / purpose / attempt

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "Two minutes about me" notes)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Activity picture flashcards · *-ing / to* verb cards · meaning-change cards · **Pattern Path** board + referee sheet + coin (1 per group of 3–4) · **"Two minutes about me"** interview cards A/B · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.1-A (Kai's new routine) and 2.1-B (meaning-change dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: two columns. **-ING:** enjoy · avoid · finish · mind · suggest · consider · keep · miss · can't stand · any preposition (good at, interested in, without, instead of, **look forward to**) · subject: *Learning English takes time*. **TO:** want · decide · hope · promise · agree · offer · refuse · manage · afford · seem · adjective + to (happy to help) · purpose: I went out **to buy** milk (not ~~for buying~~).

Center: the object pattern: want / ask / tell / advise / allow / encourage + **someone** + to · but **let / make** + someone + **base verb** (Let me help. They made him wait.)

Right: the meaning-change table with a ← (looks back: memory / the activity) over the *-ing* column and a → (looks forward: duty / purpose / attempt) over the *to* column: I remember **locking** it ← · Remember **to** lock it → · He stopped **smoking** (quit) · He stopped **to** smoke (paused) · Try **adding** salt (experiment) · I tried **to** open it (attempt).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: small regrets	8	S-S → T-S	Review C3 (1.3: <i>wish, if only, would rather, it's time</i>). On the board: "I wish I had... · If only I hadn't... · It's time I... · I'd rather...". Pairs finish each one with something small and everyday (real, from a new identity card, or invented). Two pairs share their best line. Note one or two good lines and one error for later.
Test: Error Hunt	8	S-S	Test-teach-test. Slide 3. Pairs do Workbook Ex 4 (Error Hunt: 12 sentences, 8 have a mistake) without help, as a diagnostic. Don't give answers yet. Walk around and notice which patterns the class already controls (usually <i>want to, enjoy -ing</i>) and which it doesn't (usually <i>look forward to seeing, suggest -ing, made him wait, to buy</i> for purpose). Spend the next stage on the gaps.
Clarify: the patterns	12	T-S	Slides 4–5. Build the left and center of the board with the class, eliciting what they know. Focus on the gaps you saw: prepositions (and the "noun test" for <i>to</i>), the gerund as subject, purpose (<i>to</i> , not <i>for</i> + <i>-ing</i>), verb + object + <i>to, let / make</i> . CCQs (below). Then pairs go back to Ex 4 and change any answers (2 min). Check together.
Drill	5	T-S → S	Picture-card drill (see Drill script): hold up an activity card with a verb card. Fast, choral then individual.
Clarify: same verb, different meaning	12	T-S	Slide 6. Mime the lead pair: walk across the room, stop, pretend to tie your shoe: "I stopped to tie my shoe." Then mime quitting a habit (throw away an imaginary cigarette): "I stopped smoking ." Elicit the difference. Build the right side of the board: <i>remember, forget, stop, try</i> , then <i>regret, go on, mean</i> more briefly. CCQs. Then Script 2.1-B : learners write the 6 sentences and label each one  or  .
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Read Script 2.1-A (Kai's new routine) twice: learners do Workbook Ex 1. Then Ex 2, 3 and 5 alone; pairs compare. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. Early finishers start the "Two minutes about me" notes.
Freer 1: Pattern Path	15	S-S (groups)	Slide 7. Groups of 3–4, one board, one coin, one referee sheet. Three kinds of square: Complete , Meaning (explain the difference), Error Hunt (find and fix), plus Talk squares

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			(20 seconds). The referee checks with the sheet and passes it to the left after every turn. ICQs first. See "how to run it."
Freer 2: Two minutes about me	10	S → S-S	Slide 8. (1) Learners finish their notes under Habits / Goals / Likes & dislikes (2 min, key words only). (2) Pairs: A talks for two minutes from the notes; B listens, ticks the patterns on the interview card, then asks two follow-up questions from the card ("Why did you stop...?" "What are you hoping to...?"). Swap (8 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction, no names: 3 errors you heard, e.g. "I'm looking forward to see my son." · "I went there for buying shoes." · "My boss made me to stay." Learners fix them. Then 2 examples of good range you heard (" <i>I can't stand waiting in line</i> " · " <i>I'm considering taking a course</i> "); praise them by name only if the learner is comfortable.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 2.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 8 + 12 + 5 + 12 + 10 + 15 + 10 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This lesson has a lot of form. If the Error Hunt test shows the class already controls the basic verb lists, cut "Clarify: the patterns" to 6 minutes and go straight to the meaning-change verbs, which are the heart of the lesson. Never cut the Pattern Path or the two-minute talk: that is where the patterns start to become automatic. Workbook Ex 5 can move to homework.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the "feel" behind the lists. Many *-ing* verbs describe your relationship to an activity as a whole thing (enjoy it, avoid it, finish it, miss it). Many *to* verbs point forward to something that hasn't happened yet (want, hope, plan, decide, promise). It is a helpful feel, not a perfect rule.

SAY: "*I'm considering taking a course.*" Have I decided? (No, I'm thinking about it.) Is it considering to take? (No, consider + *-ing*.) · "*We managed to finish.*" Was it easy? (No, but we did it.) Did we finish? (Yes.)

Meaning: prepositions and the *to* trap.

SAY: "*I'm looking forward to the weekend.*" Can a noun come after *to* here? (Yes.) So is this *to* an infinitive or a preposition? (A preposition.) So: looking forward to... (seeing you, not see.) · "*I want to the*

weekend"? (No! So want to is an infinitive: want to go.)

Meaning: purpose.

SAY: "I went out to buy milk." Why did I go out? (To buy milk.) Can I say "for buying milk"? (No, not for the reason of an action.) · "This knife is for cutting bread." Is that OK? (Yes, it's what the thing is for, its function.)

Meaning: the meaning-change verbs.

SAY: "I remember locking the door." Did I lock it? (Yes.) Is this a memory or a job to do? (A memory.) · "Remember to lock the door." Have you locked it yet? (No.) Memory or job? (A job, a duty.)

SAY: "He stopped smoking." Does he smoke now? (No, he quit.) · "He stopped to smoke." Does he smoke? (Yes!) Why did he stop? (To have a cigarette. He paused his walk or his work.)

SAY: "Try adding salt." Is it hard to add salt? (No.) Why add it? (To see if the soup tastes better: an experiment.) · "I tried to open the jar." Was it easy? (No.) Did I open it? (Maybe not: an attempt.)

SAY: "I regret to tell you the class is canceled." Is the speaker sorry about the past or about news now? (News now: formal.) · "I regret telling him." Did I tell him? (Yes, and I'm sorry.) · "This job means traveling a lot." = intend or involve? (Involve.) · "I meant to call you." = intend or involve? (Intend: I wanted to, but I didn't.)

Form.

Verb + -ing	enjoy, avoid, finish, mind, suggest, imagine, consider, keep, practice, miss, can't stand, don't mind	We're considering moving. · Keep trying.
Verb + to	want, decide, hope, promise, agree, offer, refuse, manage, learn, seem, afford, plan	We can't afford to wait. · She offered to drive.
Preposition + -ing	good at, interested in, tired of, instead of, before, after, without, look forward to, be committed to, be used to	He left without saying goodbye. · I look forward to hearing from you.
-ing as subject	activity = the subject	Getting up early is hard in winter.
Adjective + to	happy, difficult, easy, ready, surprised + to	It's difficult to explain.
Purpose	to + base verb (= in order to)	I'm calling to confirm my appointment.

Verb + object + to	want, ask, tell, advise, allow, encourage + person + to	She encouraged him to apply.
Bare infinitive	modal + base verb · let / make + person + base verb	Let me go. · They made him wait.
Either, little change	like, love, hate, prefer, begin, start, continue	I like swimming ≈ I like to swim.

Pronunciation. *to* before a verb is weak /tə/: "I want /tə/ go" (and in fast American speech, *want to* → *wanna*; recognize it, don't write it). But *to* as a preposition before *-ing* is also weak: "looking forward /tə/ seeing you." The **-ing** ending is /ɪŋ/ with no hard /g/ at the end: "cooking" /'kʊkɪŋ/, not "cooking-guh." Stress in the meaning-change pairs carries the meaning: "I stopped **TO** buy coffee" (contrastive, when you correct someone) · "He **STOPPED** smoking." *can't stand*: Americans say /kænt/ with a clear vowel and a short, soft *t*. Listen for the vowel, not the *t*.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Picture + verb card:** hold up the *swim* picture and the **enjoy** card → S: "I enjoy swimming." *cook* + **want** → "I want to cook." *dance* + **can't stand** → "I can't stand dancing." *hike* + **decide** → "We decided to hike." *play the guitar* + **good at** → "She's good at playing the guitar." Choral, then fast individuals.
- Purpose chain:** T: "Why do you go to the library?" → S: "To borrow books." T: "Why did you call the clinic?" → S: "To make an appointment." (Short answers with *to* are natural English: praise them.)
- Memory or duty?** (point  or  on the board) T: "remember / lock" +  → S: "I remember locking it." T: +  → S: "Remember to lock it." T: "stop / buy coffee" +  → "I stopped buying coffee." +  → "I stopped to buy coffee."
- Pronunciation:** "I'm looking forward /tə/ seeing you." ×3 (weak *to*, clear *-ing*); "I can't afford /tə/ wait." ×2.
- Open pairs:** S1 asks "What have you stopped doing this year?" S2 answers with *-ing*; S3 asks "What do you have to remember to do this week?" S4 answers with *to*. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ PATTERN PATH – HOW TO RUN IT

- Groups of 3–4, one board, one coin (heads = move 1, tails = move 2) or a die, and one **referee sheet** face down. Each player uses a small object as a counter (a coin, an eraser, a paper clip).
- Land on a square and do the task. **Complete:** say the whole sentence with the right form. **Meaning:** explain the difference between the two sentences in your own words ("The first one is a memory, the second is a duty"). **Error Hunt:** find the mistake *and* say the correct sentence. **Talk:** speak for 20 seconds using the pattern on the square.
- The **referee** is the player to the right of the speaker. They check the sheet and say "Correct, stay!" or "Not quite, go back to where you were." Then the sheet moves one person to the left. Everyone referees, so a

strong speaker can't take over.

- ◆ A **Talk** square is correct if the speaker keeps going for 20 seconds and uses the pattern at least once. Fluency counts; small slips are OK.
- ◆ First to FINISH wins, but keep playing until time is up. Groups that finish early start again from square 1 and must answer the Talk squares with a *different* example.
- ◆ While they play, write down errors and good phrases for the feedback stage. Don't correct during the game unless the referee asks you.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE GAME AND THE TALK

SAY: Game: What does heads mean? (Move 1.) Tails? (Move 2.) · On an Error Hunt square, is it enough to find the mistake? (No, you fix it too.) · Who checks the answer? (The referee: the person on your right.) · What happens to the sheet after each turn? (It moves to the left.) · Wrong answer? (Go back to where you were.)

SAY: Talk: How long does A talk? (Two minutes.) · Can A read a script? (No, only key words.) · What does B do while A talks? (Listens and ticks the patterns.) · And after? (Asks two follow-up questions.) · Must it be your real life? (No, a new identity card or invented is fine.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with three frames only, color-coded on a strip: **I enjoy + -ing** (blue) · **I want to + verb** (green) · **I remember + -ing / Remember to + verb** (both). Use the activity pictures as prompts rather than written sentences. In the Pattern Path, pair the learner with a partner who reads the square aloud; they answer orally. In the talk, one minute is enough, from picture notes. Target: 6 spoken sentences with the right form and one meaning-change pair.

STRETCH (TOWARD C1)

Perfect and passive forms: *I remember being told...* · *She denied having taken it* · *He seems to have left* · *I hate being interrupted*. More meaning-change verbs: *need doing* (= need to be done: "The car needs washing") and *be afraid of falling* vs *be afraid to ask*. In the talk, use at least one perfect or passive gerund. Early finishers write three Pattern Path squares of their own for another group.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Base verb after a preposition:** "without say goodbye," "before eat," "interested in learn." Spanish (*sin decir, antes de comer*), Portuguese, French, Italian and Arabic use the infinitive after prepositions. Keep saying: "After a preposition: -ing. Always."
- ◆ **for + -ing / for to for purpose:** "I came for asking...", "I went for to buy..." (Spanish *para comprar*, French *pour acheter*, Portuguese *para comprar*, Tagalog *para*). Teach *to* as the purpose word.

- ◆ **"I want that you come" / "I want you come":** Spanish *quiero que vengas*, Russian *хочу, чтобы ты пришел*, Arabic *ureed an*, Chinese 我想你來. Drill "want **you to** come" as one chunk.
- ◆ **"She suggested me to go" / "suggested to go":** very common across languages (French *suggérer de*, Spanish *sugerir que*). *suggest* takes *-ing* or a *that*-clause: "She suggested going / that I go."
- ◆ **"They made him to wait" / "Let me to help":** Spanish, Arabic, Russian and Chinese learners often add *to*. Cross it out on the board every time.
- ◆ **Infinitive as subject:** "To learn English is difficult" (Spanish *Aprender inglés es difícil*, French, Italian, Portuguese). It's grammatical but stiff; recast: "Learning English is difficult."
- ◆ **No -ing form:** Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Indonesian speakers have no verb endings and may say "I enjoy cook." Tap the board where *-ing* goes.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_04.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 2.1: finish anything left from Ex 1–5, record (or say to a family member or friend) the "Two minutes about me" talk, "My new words" and the journal (six sentences: two *-ing* verbs, two *to* verbs, one meaning-change pair).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** I'm tired of waiting. · Q2 **A** to buy · Q3 (new) **B** I remember calling my mom on her birthday. Kai's routine (Ex 1): 1 to change · 2 staying · 3 to be · 4 to clear · 5 getting · 6 joining · 7 meeting · 8 buying · 9 to charge.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ make deductions about the past with **modal + have + past participle**: *must have* (almost sure it happened), *can't / couldn't have* (almost sure it didn't), *might / may / could have* (possible), *might not / may not have* (possibly not)
- ◆ avoid the two classic errors: **mustn't have** for a negative deduction and **could of / must of** in writing
- ◆ use **should have / shouldn't have** to criticize, regret or give too-late advice
- ◆ tell the two jobs of **could have** apart: a past possibility (*He could have gone home*) and a missed chance (*I could have gone, but I didn't*)
- ◆ turn a present deduction into a past one (*must be* → *must have been*) and reason aloud with a group to a verdict on a mystery

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Room 12 detective notes)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Past-modal flashcards (*must have* · *can't have* · *might have* · *should have* · *could have*) · **Room 12 clue cards** A–D (1 set per group of 4) · detective notes (1 per learner) · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.2-A (three short puzzles) and 2.2-B (Maria's voicemail: the solution)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the certainty scale as a vertical line: 95% ✓ **must have** + pp · 50% **might / may / could have** + pp · 30% **might not / may not have** + pp · 95% ✗ **can't / couldn't have** + pp. Beside it in red: ~~mustn't have~~ · ~~must of~~ · ~~must has~~ · ~~must have rain~~.

Center: NOW → PAST: He must **be** tired → He must **have been** tired · She can't **know** → She can't **have known** · It might **be** a mistake → It might **have been** a mistake.

Right: JUDGING: You **should have** told me. (You didn't. ✗) · I **shouldn't have** eaten that. (I did. ✗) · **could have** ① He could have gone home. (possible) ② I could have gone, but I stayed home. (a missed chance)

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: patterns quick-fire	8	S–S → T–S	Review C4. Pairs tell each other one thing from their homework talk with each of: <i>I've stopped...</i> · <i>I'm looking forward to...</i> · <i>I must remember to....</i> Then a 2-minute "Error Hunt"

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			on the board: 4 errors from C4 (e.g. "I went for buying bread," "She made me to laugh"). Learners fix them.
Lead-in: what happened here?	5	T-S	Put a paper cup, a phone charger and a wet umbrella on your desk (or draw them). "When I came into this room today, I found these. What's happening?" Elicit present deductions from B1: "Someone must be here." Then: "The cup is cold. It was here <i>before</i> . So...?" Elicit or model: "Someone must have been here earlier." Write both on the board.
Clarify: past deduction	13	T-S	Slides 9–10. Form (modal + have + past participle; the modal never changes), the certainty scale, the negative pair (<i>must have</i> ↔ <i>can't have</i> , never <i>mustn't have</i>), <i>might not have</i> , and present → past. CCQs (below). Stick the modal cards on the scale as you go.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Clue → verdict drill and weak <i>have</i> /əv/ (see Drill script).
Clarify: should have & could have	8	T-S	Slide 11. "Deduction = what happened. <i>Should have</i> = was it a good idea?" Two situations: a friend forgot an umbrella and got soaked; you had a free ticket to a concert but stayed home. Elicit "She should have taken an umbrella" and "I could have gone, but I didn't." Then the two jobs of <i>could have</i> . CCQs. Link back to C2 (third conditional) and C3 (<i>I wish I had...</i>).
Controlled practice	12	S → S-S	Pairs read the office dialogue (slide 12 / workbook) aloud and underline every modal + <i>have</i> + participle (3 min). Then Workbook Ex 1–4 alone (clues, how sure, correct the error, react), then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 3: learners come up and cross out <i>of</i> , <i>mustn't</i> and <i>has</i> in red. Early finishers do the stretch line in Ex 4.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Listening: three puzzles	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 5. Read Script 2.2-A (three short puzzles), pausing after each. Learners write one <i>must have</i> and one <i>can't have / might have</i> sentence for each. Pairs compare: "Did we reach the same verdict? Who's more sure?"
Freer: The Mystery of Room 12	20	S-S (groups of 4) → T-S	Slide 13. Read the setting aloud. Each learner gets one clue card (A, B, C or D) and must not show it. (1) Round the table: each learner reads their three clues aloud, the others take notes (5 min). (2) Discuss and write at least six deductions on the detective notes, each with a certainty level (8 min). (3) Each group gives its verdict in 3–4 sentences: "We're almost sure that... They can't have... They might have..." (4 min). (4) Read Script 2.2-B (Maria's voicemail). Which group was closest? (3 min). ICQs first. See "how to run it."
Feedback	7	T-S	Delayed correction: 3 errors ("She mustn't have known." · "They must of left." · "He must has dropped the keys.") and 2–3 good examples of range from the verdicts ("They <i>can't possibly have eaten it</i> ," "Lin <i>must have been soaked</i> "). Praise the groups that said <i>how sure</i> they were.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 2.2; workbook journal. Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 13 + 6 + 8 + 12 + 6 + 20 + 7 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: deduction about the past. We use evidence to reach a confident guess about something that already happened. The modal shows *how sure* we are.

SAY: "The ground's wet. It *must have rained*." Did I see the rain? (No.) How do I know? (The evidence: the wet ground.) How sure am I? (Almost sure, about 95%). · "He *can't have finished already*." Do I think he finished? (No, I'm almost sure he didn't.)

SAY: "She might have missed the bus." Am I sure? (No, it's one possibility.) Can I say may have or could have? (Yes, the same meaning.) · "She mustn't have seen us." Correct? (No! "She can't have seen us.") Why? (mustn't means "it's not allowed.")

Meaning: should have.

SAY: "You should have called me." Did you call me? (No.) Was that a good idea? (No, a mistake.) · "I shouldn't have eaten that." Did I eat it? (Yes.) Do I feel good about it? (No, I regret it.) · Is should have about how sure I am? (No, it judges a choice.)

Meaning: could have (two jobs).

SAY: "Where's Sam? He could have gone home." Do I know where Sam is? (No: it's a possibility.) · "I could have gone to the concert, but I stayed home." Did I go? (No.) Was it possible? (Yes, a missed chance.) · "You could have warned me!" Did you warn me? (No.) Am I a little annoyed? (Yes.)

Form.

Sure it happened	must have + past participle	Everyone's talking about it. It must have been a great night.
Possible	might / may / could have + pp	They might have taken a wrong turn.
Possibly not	might not / may not have + pp	Ben may not have gone. He was sick.
Sure it didn't	can't / couldn't have + pp	It can't have finished early. The photos are from 2 a.m.
Judging a choice	should / shouldn't have + pp	I should have checked the forecast.
Missed chance	could have + pp (but didn't)	We could have won, but we missed the penalty.
Now → past	modal + be / verb → modal + have + pp	must be → must have been · might know → might have known
Continuous	modal + have + been + -ing	She looked exhausted. She must have been working late.

Pronunciation. In speech, *have* is weak and joins the modal: **must've** /'mʌstəv/, **might've** /'maɪtəv/, **could've** /'kʊdəv/, **should've** /'ʃʊdəv/. That's why native speakers sometimes *write* "could of": it's always wrong in writing. Stress the modal and the main verb, not *have*: "She **MUST've** **LEFT**." In American English, *can't have* /'kænt əv/ and *can have* sound close: the difference is the **stressed, longer vowel** in *can't*, so teach learners to say "**CAN'T** have" with strong stress, or use *couldn't have*, which is easier to hear.

- 1 **Weak "have"**: must've · might've · could've · should've · can't've: choral ×2 each, then in a phrase: "She must've left." "He can't've known."
- 2 **Clue → verdict** (T gives evidence, S gives the deduction): T: "The street is wet." → S: "It must have rained." T: "He was at work in Denver until nine. The party was in Chicago at nine." → S: "He can't have been at the party." T: "She didn't answer my call." → S: "She might have been busy."
- 3 **Now → past**: T: "He must be tired." → S: "He must have been tired." T: "She can't know." → S: "She can't have known." T: "They might be lost." → S: "They might have been lost."
- 4 **Fix it**: T: "She mustn't have seen us." → S: "She can't have seen us." T: "He must have forgotten." → S: "He must have forgotten."
- 5 **Judge it**: T: "I didn't study and I failed." → S: "You should have studied." T: "He ate three pieces of cake and felt sick." → S: "He shouldn't have eaten so much."

◆ THE MYSTERY OF ROOM 12 – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Setting** (read aloud, slide 13): "It's Saturday, 9:15 a.m. You arrive early at the Maple Street Community Center for your 9:30 English class in Room 12. The door is open, nobody is there, and something strange has happened. What happened here?"
- ◆ Groups of 4. Each learner gets **one clue card** (A, B, C or D) with three text clues. They read their clues **aloud** but don't show the card: this is an information gap, so every learner must speak. The others take notes on the detective notes sheet.
- ◆ Then the group discusses. Every deduction needs a modal and a reason: "The coffee is still warm, so they **can't have left** long ago." Push for the full scale: at least one *must have*, one *can't have*, one *might have* and one *should have*.
- ◆ **Roles** (useful for dominant speakers): a **secretary** writes the verdict; a **skeptic** must challenge every *must have*: "Are you sure? It might have been someone else." Give the skeptic role to your strongest speaker: it makes them listen and gives others the floor. The secretary is *not* the strongest speaker.
- ◆ Verdict: 3–4 sentences, from most sure to least sure. Then read Script 2.2-B. Score: 1 point for each part of the verdict that matches the voicemail (the surprise party · Rosa's note · Plan B at the park · they left in a hurry · the keys were dropped). Celebrate the best reasoning, not only the right answer.
- ◆ Groups of 3: one learner holds cards C and D. Groups of 5: two learners share card A and take turns reading.
- ◆ It's a happy mystery on purpose: a surprise party, a change of plan, a forgotten umbrella. Don't turn it into a crime.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MYSTERY

SAY: Can you show your card to the group? (No! Read it aloud.) · How many deductions do you write? (At least six.) · Is "They left" a deduction? (No, it needs a modal: "They must have left.") · What does the

skeptic do? (Says "Are you sure?" and suggests another possibility.) · Is it a crime story? (No! Something happy happened.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on two forms: **must have** (sure yes) and **can't have** (sure no), with thumbs up / thumbs down. Give a strip with 5 past participles they will need (*been, left, eaten, seen, gone*). In the mystery, give card D (the shortest clues) and read it quietly with the learner first; their job is to say the key deduction about Rosa's note. Target: 4 spoken deductions with *must have* / *can't have*.

STRETCH (TOWARD C1)

Degrees of certainty: *may well have* (likely), *can't possibly have, is bound to have*. Continuous and passive forms: *must have been waiting · might have been taken. needn't have* (did it, but it wasn't necessary: "We needn't have brought the cake knife") vs *didn't need to*. In the verdict, rank six deductions by certainty and use at least two of these.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"mustn't have" for "can't have"**: learners generalize the negative of *must*. German (*muss nicht* = doesn't have to) and Dutch speakers find it especially confusing. Use the "opposite pair" card: **must have ↔ can't have**.
- ◆ **Missing or wrong participle**: "It must have rain," "She must have went." Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Indonesian have no participle endings; many other learners mix the past simple and the participle. Keep a list of irregular participles on the board (*been, gone, seen, eaten, taken, left, forgotten*).
- ◆ **"must has / must had"**: agreement habits from the present perfect. After a modal, *have* never changes.
- ◆ **A different structure**: Spanish *debe (de) haber salido* and Portuguese *deve ter saído* map well; but Arabic, Russian (*должно быть, он ушёл* = "must be, he left") and Japanese (...□□□□) use an adverb + past tense. Learners may say "Maybe he must left" or "Probably he left." Accept *probably* as good English, then offer the modal.
- ◆ **could of / should of**: learners who learn by ear (and many native speakers) write *of*. Always *have* in writing.
- ◆ **"can" vs "can't"** in American English: learners (and listeners) miss the *t*. Teach stress, and accept *couldn't have* as the clearer choice.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_05.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🗣️ and say them back with weak *have*; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. The online project's case file is optional: learners may use the Room 12 clues or invent a light, everyday scene instead (a

messy kitchen, a canceled event). Workbook 2.2: "My new words" and the journal (a small, puzzling event from the week, real or invented: three deductions + one *should have*).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** must have · Q2 **A** I should have reminded you. · Q3 (new) **B** She can't have seen us. Three puzzles (Ex 5), model answers: 1 Her roommate must have made soup; she can't have left long ago. · 2 Ben must have gone on vacation; he can't have left in a hurry. · 3 The class must have moved to Room 8; the teacher might have written the note.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ use **used to** + **base verb** for past habits and states that are no longer true, with *didn't use to* and *Did you use to...?* (no **d**)
- ◆ use **be used to** + **noun** / **-ing** for something that is familiar and normal for them, in any tense
- ◆ use **get used to** + **noun** / **-ing** for the process of adapting (*I'm getting used to...*, *I got used to...*, *You'll get used to...*)
- ◆ explain why the form changes (in *be / get used to*, *to* is a preposition) and apply the "it" test
- ◆ talk about adjusting to something new (a job, a schedule, technology, a neighborhood, a hobby) using all three structures

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 2.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "Adjusting to something new" notes)
- ◆ Slides 14–19 · The three *used to* cards + the "it" test card · **Find someone who** grid (1 per learner) · **change cards** (1 set per group of 3) · **role-play cards** A/B · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 2.3-A (Dana's new shift) and 2.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: a timeline. PAST (gone): I **used to** work in an office. (base verb) · NOW (a state): I'm **used to** the early start / getting up early. · CHANGING (a process, an arrow getting bigger): I'm **getting used to** the new app / using the scanner.

Center: used to + **BASE VERB** · be used to + **NOUN** / **-ING** · get used to + **NOUN** / **-ING**. The "it" test: I'm used to **it** ✓ → *to* = preposition → -ing · I used to **it** ✗ → base verb.

Right: questions and negatives: Did you **use** to...? · I didn't **use** to... (no **d**) · Present habit? I ~~use to jog~~ → I **usually** jog. · US English: I've **gotten** used to it (UK: I've got used to it).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: what must have happened?	8	S–S → T–S	Review C5. Read 4 quick situations ("Your coworker arrives with a big smile and a box of donuts." · "The bus is 20 minutes late and very full." · "Your neighbor's garden is full of balloons." · "The office printer has a sign: DO NOT USE."). Pairs give a <i>must have</i> , a <i>might have</i>

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			and a <i>can't have</i> for each. Two pairs share. Two learners read their journal (only if they want to).
Lead-in: my new bike	5	T-S	Tell a short invented story: "I used to take the bus to work. Last spring I started biking. At first it was hard: the hills! But I'm used to the hills now. I'm still getting used to the rain, though." Write the three bold phrases. "Which one is finished? Which is normal now? Which is still changing?" Let learners notice.
Clarify: three structures	14	T-S	Slides 14–15. Meaning with the timeline; form (base verb vs noun / -ing); <i>didn't use to</i> ; the "it" test; <i>used to</i> is past only (no present form). Then be used to (state) vs get used to (process): "If you can say <i>become</i> , use <i>get</i> ." CCQs (below). Mention US <i>I've gotten used to</i> .
Drill	6	T-S → S	Structure-switch drill and <i>used to</i> /'ju:stə/ (see Drill script).
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Pairs read the Luis and Grace dialogue (slide 16 / workbook) and sort every <i>used to</i> into past / now / changing (3 min). Then Workbook Ex 1–3 alone (choose the structure, base or -ing, correct the error), then pairs check. Board-check Ex 3 by asking "Which test did you use?"
Listening: Dana's new shift	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 4. Read Script 2.3-A twice. Learners complete the six sentences. Pairs compare, then answer: "What's Dana's advice? Do you agree?" Then Ex 5 (rewrite) if time allows, or as homework.
Freer 1: Find someone who	10	S-S (mingle)	Slide 17. Learners turn each line into a question ("Are you used to getting up before six?" · "Did you use to play an instrument?") and mingle. One name per line, plus one follow-up detail. ICQs first. Anyone can answer as their new identity card or say "Pass."
Freer 2: Adjusting to	18	S → S-S (groups of 3)	Slide 18. (1) Each learner chooses a change card (a new job, a new schedule, new technology, a

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
something new			new neighborhood across town, a new hobby...) or a change from their own life, real or invented, and makes notes: 2 <i>used to</i> , 2 <i>be used to</i> , 1 <i>getting used to</i> , 1 piece of advice (3 min). (2) Groups of 3 with a talking-turn token: each learner talks for about 2 minutes; the others ask two follow-up questions and then give advice with <i>You'll get used to...</i> / <i>It took me... to get used to...</i> (12 min). (3) Each group shares the best piece of advice they heard (3 min). Pairs who finish early do a role-play card . ICQs first.
Feedback + module check	7	T-S	Delayed correction: "I'm used to work nights." · "I didn't used to like coffee." · "I use to drink tea every morning." · "I'm used to it" when the speaker meant "still adapting." Two good phrases you heard (<i>It took me ages to get used to...</i>). Then learners tick the three Module 2 "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 2.3; the workbook journal; preview C7: "Next class: <i>It is believed that...</i> The passive, advanced."
Total	90		8 + 5 + 14 + 6 + 10 + 7 + 10 + 18 + 7 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: used to (past). A habit or state in the past that is not true now.

SAY: "I used to take the bus." Do I take the bus now? (No.) Did I take it once or many times? (Many times: a habit.) · "There used to be a bakery here." Is it still here? (No.) · Can I say "I use to take the bus" about now? (No! "I usually take the bus.")

Meaning: be used to (a state) vs get used to (a process).

SAY: "I'm used to the hills." Are the hills difficult for me now? (No, they're normal.) Were they difficult before? (Yes, maybe.) · "I'm getting used to the rain." Is the rain normal for me yet? (Not yet, but it's getting easier.) Is it finished or still happening? (Still happening.)

SAY: "She got used to working nights." Was it easy at first? (No.) Is it OK now? (Yes, the change is finished.) · "You'll get used to it." When? (In the future.) · "I'm used to work long hours." Correct? (No:

"used to **working**!.) Why? (to is a preposition. Test: "I'm used to it" ✓.)

Form.

used to	used to + base verb · past only · didn't use to · Did you use to...?	She used to play tennis. · He didn't use to like coffee.
be used to	am / is / are / was / will be + used to + noun / pronoun / -ing	I'm used to the noise. · She's used to working nights.
get used to	get / am getting / got / will get / have gotten + used to + noun / -ing	I'm getting used to the commute. · You'll get used to living alone.
Useful chunks	It took me (a month) to get used to... · I still can't get used to... · It takes some getting used to.	It took me months to get used to the new system.

Pronunciation. In all three structures, *used to* is /'ju:stə/: an s sound, not a z, and a weak to. Compare *used* = "utilized" /ju:zd/: "I **used** /ju:zd/ a knife." In speech, *used to* and *use to* sound the same, so the d problem is a writing problem: say it, then check the spelling after *did* / *didn't*. The contraction does a lot of work: "I'm used to it" vs "I used to..." — the 'm is small but essential. Drill it with a clear /m/.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 /'ju:stə/: "used to" ×3 (hiss the s), then "I used to..." · "I'm used to..." · "I'm getting used to..." (clear 'm).
- 2 **Switch** (T says a situation, S chooses): T: "In the past: I lived near the beach. Not now." → S: "I used to live near the beach." T: "Early meetings are normal for me." → S: "I'm used to early meetings." T: "The new app is still strange, but it's getting easier." → S: "I'm getting used to the new app."
- 3 **Base or -ing?** T: "used to / drive" → S: "used to drive." T: "be used to / drive" → S: "I'm used to driving." T: "get used to / wake up early" → S: "I'm getting used to waking up early."
- 4 **Did you use to...?** Chain: S1 asks S2 "Did you use to play a sport?" S2 answers ("Yes, I used to play volleyball." / "No, I didn't use to..."), then asks S3 a new question.
- 5 **Advice:** T: "I just started the night shift. It's terrible!" → S: "Don't worry, you'll get used to it." T: "It took me two months." → S: "It took me two months to get used to it."

◆ ADJUSTING TO SOMETHING NEW – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Put the **change cards** face up on each table. Each card names a neutral change and three prompts: *How did things use to be? What are you used to now? What are you still getting used to?* Learners may pick a card, use a change from their own life, or use their new identity card's change. All are equal.
- ◆ Notes, not a script: 2 *used to* + 2 *be used to* + 1 *getting used to* + 1 piece of advice for someone starting the same change.

- ◆ Groups of 3, one **talking-turn token** (a pen). Only the person holding it talks; after 2 minutes, the listeners each ask one follow-up question ("How long did it take you to get used to...?" · "What do you miss about how it used to be?"), then give one piece of advice ("You'll get used to..." · "Try...ing").
- ◆ **Dominant speakers:** the token helps; also give the strongest speaker the job of speaking *last* and summarizing the group's best advice. **Quiet learners:** they can talk from the card prompts, and 1 minute is fine.
- ◆ **Keep it neutral.** The changes on the cards are everyday (a new job, a night shift, a new phone or app, self-checkout, a new neighborhood across town, a new hobby). Don't add "moving to a new country" as a card and don't ask about it. If a learner chooses it themselves, that's their choice: listen and respond warmly, without probing.
- ◆ **Early finishers:** role-play cards (A = two weeks into a change, B = a friend who went through it). They act it out for 3 minutes, then swap cards.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MINGLE AND THE DISCUSSION

SAY: *Mingle: How many names on each line? (One.) · Do you say "Find someone who is used to..."? (No, make a question: "Are you used to...?") · Can someone say "Pass"? (Yes.) · What do you write next to the name? (One detail.)*

SAY: *Discussion: Do you have to talk about your real life? (No: a card, a new identity, or invented.) · Who can talk? (Only the person with the pen.) · How long? (About two minutes.) · What do the listeners do after? (Ask a question and give advice.) · Which structure is for "still changing"? (getting used to.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Color-code the three structures on a strip: **used to + verb** (past, gray) · **I'm used to + -ing** (now, green) · **I'm getting used to + -ing** (changing, orange). Give the learner a change card with one sentence head for each color. In the mingle, give a grid with 5 lines instead of 10. Target: one spoken sentence with each structure, with *-ing* after *be / get used to*.

STRETCH (TOWARD C1)

would for past habits in a story (*We would walk to school together*) and why it can't do states (*It would have long hair*); *be accustomed to + -ing* (more formal); *grow used to*; *It takes some getting used to*; *I've never gotten used to...* In the discussion, use all of these once and narrate the change as a mini-story. Early finishers write the dialogue from their role-play.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I use to get up early"** for a present habit: Spanish *suelo*, Portuguese *costumo*, Italian *di solito* and Tagalog *kadalasan* have a present "habit" verb or adverb, so learners invent a present *use to*. Teach **usually** for now.

- ◆ **"I'm used to work":** Spanish *estoy acostumbrado a trabajar*, French *être habitué à travailler*, Portuguese *estou acostumado a trabalhar* all use the infinitive. The "it" test is the fix.
- ◆ **"I didn't used to":** a spelling error that everyone makes (native speakers too). Drop the **d** after *did*.
- ◆ **Mixing state and process:** many languages (Chinese 习惯, Japanese 慣れる, Korean привыкаться) use one expression for both "be used to" and "got used to." Use the timeline: a dot (state) vs an arrow (process).
- ◆ **Dropping "be":** "I used to the cold" (Arabic, Russian, Chinese, Haitian Creole speakers may drop *be*). This accidentally makes a different structure. Point at the missing 'm.
- ◆ **/ju:zd tu:/**: learners who read the spelling say "use-d to" with a **z** and a strong *to*. Model /'ju:stə/.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 2.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_06.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. For the online project ("a big change"), learners can talk about any change from class (a job, schedule, technology, neighborhood, hobby) or their new identity card: moving countries is *not* required. Workbook 2.3: finish Ex 5 if needed, "My new words" and the journal (three true or invented sentences, one with each structure).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** am used to · Q2 **B** I'm used to working long shifts. · Q3 (new) **B** used to. Dana's new shift (Ex 4): 1 start · 2 sleeping · 3 got used to · 4 is (she's) used to · 5 get used to · 6 get used to.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C6: MODULE 2 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 19, "three tools for precision": **I stopped to...** / **I stopped ...ing** (verb patterns that change meaning) → **They must have...** / **can't have...** / **might have...** (how sure you are about the past) → **I used to...** / **I'm used to...** / **I'm getting used to...** (past, now, changing). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C7 warmer and again in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 3: the advanced passive (*It is believed that...*, *He is said to have left*) uses the **perfect infinitive** (*to have + pp*), which looks a lot like the past modals from C5. Learners who just mastered *must have left* may say "He is said to must have left." Also, the reporting verbs in 3.3 are verb-pattern verbs (*suggest -ing*, *refuse to*, *advise someone to*): recycle the Pattern Path board as a C9 warmer.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: verb + *-ing* vs verb + *to*, preposition + *-ing* (including *look forward to*), the infinitive of purpose, *let / make + base verb*, the meaning-change verbs (*remember, forget, stop, try*), past deduction on the certainty scale (*must have / can't have / might have*, never *mustn't have*), *should have* and the two jobs of *could have*, and the three *used to* structures with the right form after each.

Module 3 — Advanced Structures

Three classes that take structures learners met at B1 (the passive, relative clauses, reported speech) and turn them into tools for precision and economy. First, the passive across every tense and modal, plus the impersonal reporting passive of news and formal writing (*It is said that...* · *He is thought to have...*) and a first look at the causative (*I had my car repaired*). Then relative clauses reduced to participle clauses (*the man standing there* · *a letter written in haste* · *Having finished, she left*) and the dangling-participle trap. Last, precise reporting verbs and the pattern each one demands (*suggested going* · *insisted on paying* · *denied taking* · *refused to sign*).

3 lessons

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C7–C9

Weeks 4–5

90 min per class

CEFR B2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (a real communicative task) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-3-advanced-structures.html](#). Print [materials/module-3/classroom-materials.html](#) before C7. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the **Newsroom A/B** story cards, the **Editor's Desk** drafts and combine-and-reduce strips, the **Spot the Difference** scene cards, the **Meeting** role cards and minutes sheet, the **Report It!** board game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** At B1 learners met the basic passive (B1 Module 4), relative clauses with commas (B1 3.3) and reported speech with backshift (B1 3.1–3.2). Don't re-teach those. Check them fast in each lead-in and spend the time on what is new at B2: **modal-perfect and impersonal passives, reduced clauses and participle clauses**, and **verb + pattern** reporting. The causative gets a short first look in C7. Lesson 5.2 (C15) teaches it fully, so keep it to five minutes here.
- Fluency before accuracy.** In every freer task, listen and take notes in two columns: **accuracy** (errors to fix) and **range** (good, ambitious language to praise and spread). Don't stop a newsreader or a meeting to fix a pattern. In the feedback stage, write 2–3 errors and 1–2 "range" examples on the board without names. At B2, feedback

on range matters as much as feedback on errors: "Someone said *It is widely believed that*.... Excellent. Who else can use *widely*?"

- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** All three tasks have built-in roles. Use them. Give the strongest speaker the job that needs listening rather than talking: the **editor** in the newsroom (checks, doesn't read), the **word-counter** in the compression workshop, the **minute-taker** in the meeting. Use a talking-turn token (a pen: you speak only when you hold it) in the meeting. Say it kindly: "Great point, Omar. Let's hear from someone who hasn't spoken yet."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C1.** Each lesson has a stretch box. The C1 direction for this module is **choice and register**, not new forms: *why* the passive here, *when not* to reduce a clause, which reporting verb carries the most exact meaning (*claimed vs admitted vs insisted*). Ask strong learners to explain the choice, not only produce the form.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British spellings and words (*analysed, apologise, organise, memorise, signalling, cancelled, queue, resit, film*). Teach *analyzed, apologize, organize, memorize, signaling, canceled, line (up), retake, movie*. Also teach the American pattern **suggest / insist / recommend that + base verb** (*She suggested that we **meet** on Friday · He insisted that we **stay** for dinner*). Accept British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Shift the focus → cut the words → name the act. In C7 learners move the doer out of the spotlight and speak in the calm voice of the news: *The tortoise is thought to be 120 years old*. In C8 they compress: two or three short sentences become one tight one (*Built in 1890, the station is the oldest building in town.*). In C9 they compress other people's words: a whole line of speech becomes one exact verb (*She refused to sign. He admitted forgetting.*). Every class ends with a real product that other learners hear or read: a radio bulletin, an edited notice, a set of meeting minutes.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: LIGHT NEWS, LOW STAKES

The language of this module lives close to hard topics: news of disasters and crime, *He is believed to have been killed, She had her identity stolen*, accusations, denials, interviews. **In class, keep everything light and invented.** Use only the invented stories on the Newsroom cards (a 120-year-old tortoise, a piano in the train station, a library book returned 50 years late). Don't bring in real headlines, and don't ask learners to report news from their home countries. In the causative, prefer services (*had my hair cut, got my phone fixed*) over misfortunes; if you teach the misfortune meaning, use *had my flight canceled*, not theft or violence. The meetings in C9 are about a laundry room, a café schedule and a community garden. **Never** role-play a police interview, a court, an immigration or asylum interview, or a family argument. For every personal task, offer three choices out loud: **your real life, a new identity card, or something invented**. Opinion roles in the meeting are **assigned**: learners play the card, not themselves.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the passive-pattern cards and the service picture cards (C7), the participle cards and place picture cards (C8), and the reporting-verb cards, color-coded by pattern (C9). Card stock helps. Cut them before C7.
- For C7: the **Newsroom** A/B story cards (6 stories, one A and one B card each) and one **bulletin frame** per pair. Optional: a table bell or a phone timer for the "on air" signal.
- For C8: one **Editor's Desk** draft per group of 3 (4 different drafts), one envelope of **combine-and-reduce strips** per pair, and one **Spot the Difference** A/B pair per pair of learners.
- For C9: **Meeting** role cards (3 meetings × 4 roles; one meeting per group of 4–5) and one **minutes sheet** per learner. The **Report It!** board game (1 board per group, 1 die, counters) is for early finishers in C9 and for the C10 warmer.
- Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking.
- Optional: bring one real English-language local newspaper or community newsletter. Learners enjoy finding "It is expected that..." and "Located near..." in real print. Pick light pages (events, sports, the weather, the library).

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
3.1	C7 • wk 4	The passive across tenses and modals (<i>has been done, is being done, must be done, should have been done</i>); impersonal reporting passives : Pattern A <i>It is said that...</i> and Pattern B <i>He is said to be / to be doing / to have done</i> ; a first look at have / get something done ; choosing the passive for formal and news register	rewrite chatty local news as a formal radio bulletin with six or more passive structures, including two impersonal reporting passives, and read it "on air"
3.2	C8 • wk 4	Defining vs non-defining clauses (quick review); reducing relative clauses: active → <i>-ing</i> , passive → past participle; participle clauses for time, reason and sequence (<i>Feeling tired, ... · Not knowing..., · Having finished, ...</i>); the dangling participle	combine and reduce short sentences into a tight, correct paragraph under a word limit, and describe a scene concisely with participle clauses
3.3	C9 • wk 5	Reporting verbs + patterns : to-infinitive (<i>agree, refuse, offer, promise</i>), object + to-infinitive (<i>advise, warn, remind</i>), that-clause (<i>admit, explain, insist</i>), -ing (<i>deny, suggest, recommend</i>), preposition + -ing (<i>apologize for, accuse sb of, insist on</i>); the <i>suggest / recommend</i> trap	take part in a short meeting, then write and read aloud accurate minutes using at least six different reporting verbs, including <i>suggest, insist, deny, admit, agree, refuse</i>

3.1 · C7

The Passive — Advanced & Impersonal

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ form the passive in any tense or with any modal by changing only **be**: *is done, was being done, has been done, will be done, must be done, should have been done*
- ◆ report a general belief without naming who believes it, in two ways: **Pattern A** *It is said / believed / expected that...* and **Pattern B** *She is said to be...*
- ◆ choose the right infinitive in Pattern B for timing: **to be** (same time), **to be + -ing** (in progress now), **to have + past participle** (earlier)
- ◆ say that someone else did a job for them with **have / get + object + past participle**: *I had my car repaired.*
- ◆ choose the passive on purpose for a formal or news register, and switch back to the active when the doer matters

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, News Report Rewrite)
- ◆ Slides 3–7 · Passive-pattern flashcards · Service picture cards (causative) · **Newsroom** A/B story cards (6 stories) + bulletin frames · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 3.1-A (Riverside Community Radio bulletin) and 3.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the ladder (only BE moves). *is done · is being done · was done · was being done · has been done · had been done · will be done · is going to be done · must / can / should be done · should / must / might have been done.*

Center: two patterns. People say (that) he is rich. → **A** *It is said that he is rich.* → **B** *He is said to be rich.*
Timing strip under B: now → **to be** · in progress → **to be living** · earlier → **to have left / to have been.**
Verbs: say · believe · think · know · report · expect · consider · understand.

Right: causative. *I had my car repaired.* (a mechanic did it) · *I had repaired my car* ✕ (= I did it, earlier) · *get = more informal.* Phrase bank: *It is widely believed that... · It has been reported that... · ... is expected to...*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer:	7	S–S	Review C6 (2.3, used to / be used to / get used to). Board: "When I started this class / my job / living here, I wasn't used to... Now

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
to it			I'm getting used to... I used to..., but now..." Pairs share two true or invented sentences (new identity cards available), then tell the class one thing their partner said. Note one error and one good example for later.
Lead-in: headlines	5	T-S	Board: three invented headlines: "RIVERSIDE ZOO TORTOISE THOUGHT TO BE 120" · "MYSTERY PIANO LEFT IN STATION" · "LIBRARY BOOK RETURNED 50 YEARS LATE." Ask: "Who thinks the tortoise is 120? Who left the piano? Do we know? Does it matter?" Elicit: the news focuses on the event, not the person. "Today you're going to be newsreaders."
The passive ladder	8	T-S	Slide 3. Fast review, not re-teaching: elicit the ladder with <i>do</i> from learners, writing only what they can't produce. Focus on the B2 forms: modal perfect (<i>should have been done</i>) and the two continuous passives (<i>is / was being done</i>). CCQs (below).
Impersonal reporting passives	15	T-S	Slides 4–5. Write the active source sentence "People say he is rich." Build Pattern A, then B. Then the timing strip: <i>to be / to be living / to have left</i> . Board three more transformations with learners (<i>believe, expect, report</i>). Meaning, form, pronunciation, CCQs.
Drill	7	T-S → S	Transformation drill (see Drill script): A → B, active → A, then timing. Choral, then individuals, then open pairs.
Listening: the 3 o'clock bulletin	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 3.1-A twice in a calm "radio" voice. First listening: "How many stories? Which one is the funniest?" Second: learners complete the seven passive forms. Pairs compare. Point out that the bulletin is almost all passive: why? (The events matter, not the people.)
Causative: a first look	5	T-S	Slide 6. Hold up the service picture cards: "I didn't fix my car. A mechanic did. So... I had my car repaired ." Elicit 4–5 more from the pictures (<i>had a key cut, got my shoes repaired, had my passport renewed</i>). One CCQ on word order. Tell learners: "We'll do much more with this in Lesson 5.2."
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone (the ladder, Pattern A and B, the timing choice, the causative), then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. Early finishers start the "Rewrite it formally" box in the News Report Rewrite section.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Freer: News Report Rewrite	16	S-S → T-S	Slide 7. Pairs get a Newsroom story: A has what people are <i>saying</i> (the rumors), B has the <i>official facts</i> . They tell each other their half without showing the card (3 min), then write a 6-sentence formal bulletin on the frame (7 min) with at least 2 impersonal passives, 1 modal passive and 1 other tense. Then (6 min) pairs go "on air": each reads the bulletin in a newsreader voice; the class asks one follow-up question. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction. Board 3 errors you heard (no names): "It is said him to be..." · "The piano is thought to leave by a musician." · "It should have done yesterday." And 1–2 range examples to praise (" <i>is widely believed</i> ," " <i>is expected to be completed</i> "). Learners fix and discuss.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 8 + 15 + 7 + 7 + 5 + 10 + 16 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: why the passive. The passive moves the doer out of the spotlight. We use it when the doer is unknown, obvious or unimportant, or when we want to keep the topic in the subject position. It is the normal voice of news, science and official notices.

SAY: "*The road has been closed.*" Do we know who closed it? (No / not important.) What's the important thing? (The road: you can't use it.) · "*The novel was written by a teenager.*" Why add "by a teenager"? (It's surprising; real information.)

Meaning: the modal perfect passive.

SAY: "*The form should have been sent yesterday.*" Was it sent? (No.) Is this about the past or the future? (The past.) Is it a criticism? (Yes, a mild one.) · "*The package might have been delivered to the wrong address.*" Are we sure? (No, it's a possibility.)

Meaning: impersonal reporting passives. We report a general belief or claim without naming who believes it. It sounds neutral and careful: the reporter doesn't say it's true.

SAY: "*The tortoise is thought to be 120.*" Who thinks so? (People / experts: we don't say.) Is the reporter 100% sure? (No.) Is it a fact or a belief? (A belief.) · "*It is expected that the station will reopen in May.*" Has it reopened? (No.) Is it certain? (Not completely: it's the plan.)

Meaning: timing in Pattern B.

SAY: "He is said **to be** rich." Is he rich now? (Yes, people say so now.) · "He is said **to have been** rich." Now or before? (Before: he was rich in the past.) · "She is thought **to be living** in Florida." Right now? (Yes, in progress.) · "The piano is believed **to have been left** by a musician." Did the leaving happen before people started believing it? (Yes.) Did the musician leave it, or did the piano leave? (The musician left it: passive.)

Meaning: the causative.

SAY: "I had my hair cut." Did I cut it? (No, a hairdresser did.) Did I pay / arrange it? (Yes.) · "I had cut my hair." Who cut it? (I did, before another past moment. Different meaning!) · "I got my phone fixed." Same meaning as "had"? (Yes, more informal.)

Form.

Any tense	form of be + past participle (only <i>be</i> changes)	It has been done. · It was being done.
Modals	modal + be + pp · modal + have been + pp	It must be done. · It should have been done.
Pattern A	It + passive reporting verb + that + clause	It is believed that she is honest.
Pattern B	Subject + passive reporting verb + to -infinitive	She is believed to be honest.
B · timing	same time: to be / to do · in progress: to be doing · earlier: to have done / to have been	He is thought to have left the country.
Causative	have / get + object + past participle	We had the roof repaired. · I'm getting my hair cut.

Pronunciation. In the passive, *be* and *been* are weak and the **past participle** carries the stress: "It's been closed" /ɪts bɪn 'kloʊzɪd/, "It should've been done" /ʃʊdəv bɪn 'dʌn/ (the *have* is only /əv/: never write "should of"). In Pattern A, *It is* is often "It's": "It's **said** that..."; in formal news reading, keep it full and slow. Pattern B: stress the reporting verb and the key word: "He's **thought** to be a **millionaire**." Newsreader voice: steady pace, falling intonation at the end of each sentence, a short pause after the place and time ("In Riverside today | a mystery piano...").

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Up the ladder** (point at the board): T: "They clean the room. Present perfect passive?" → S: "The room has been cleaned." T: "Past continuous?" → S: "The room was being cleaned." T: "Should, past?" → S: "The room should have been cleaned." Choral, then fast individuals.

- 2 **A to B:** T: "It is said that the castle is haunted." → S: "The castle is said to be haunted." T: "It is believed that the economy is recovering." → S: "The economy is believed to be recovering." T: "It is known that she was a brilliant scientist." → S: "She is known to have been a brilliant scientist."
- 3 **Now or earlier?** T gives only the timing clue: T: "He's rich. Now." → S: "He is said to be rich." T: "He stole the money. Earlier." → S: "He is said to have stolen the money." T: "She's living in Florida. Right now." → S: "She is thought to be living in Florida."
- 4 **Newsroom voice:** T reads a chatty line, S says it on air: T: "Everyone thinks the tortoise is about 120." → S: "The tortoise is thought to be about 120 years old." / "It is thought that..."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 gives a chatty rumor about an invented person or place ("People say the new bakery uses a secret recipe."); S2 reports it on air in Pattern A; S3 in Pattern B. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ NEWS REPORT REWRITE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Pairs. Give each pair one **Newsroom** story: learner A gets the "**What people are saying**" card (chatty rumors: "Everyone says...", "Apparently...", "People think..."), learner B gets the "**Official facts**" card (what the town, the zoo or the library has confirmed, with plans and dates). Don't let them show the cards.
- ◆ **Share (3 min):** A and B tell each other their half, in normal spoken English. They take notes.
- ◆ **Rewrite (7 min):** together they write a **six-sentence bulletin** on the frame: a headline, then the story. Required: at least **2 impersonal passives** (one Pattern A, one Pattern B), at least **1 modal passive** (*must be, will be, should have been*) and at least **1 other tense** (*has been, was being*). The frame has a tick-box for each. Rumors become Pattern A / B; facts become ordinary passives.
- ◆ **On air (6 min):** each pair reads its bulletin in a newsreader voice (one sentence each, alternating). Ring a bell or say "You're on air." Listeners ask one follow-up question, which the pair answers in character.
- ◆ **Roles:** in a group of 3, the third learner is the **editor**: checks the tick-boxes and the *to be / to have been* timing but doesn't read on air. Give this job to a dominant speaker.
- ◆ All the stories are invented and light. Say before you start: "These are not real places. Nobody gets hurt in these stories."

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE NEWS REPORT REWRITE

SAY: Can you show your card to your partner? (No, tell them.) · How many sentences in the bulletin? (Six.) · How many "It is said that / is said to" sentences? (At least two.) · The rumors: passive reporting verb or ordinary passive? (Reporting verb: "is said to...") · Who reads on air? (Both, one sentence each.) · Are these real stories? (No, invented.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on **Pattern B with *to be*** and three verbs only: *said, thought, believed*. Give a sentence strip: "The ___ is said to be ___. · The ___ is thought to be ___." In the newsroom, pair the learner with a supportive partner and make them the **reader** of 2 sentences (after practicing them with you). Fewer items in the workbook: Ex 2 items 1–4, Ex 3 items 1–2. Target: 2 correct impersonal passives, said aloud.

STRETCH (TOWARD C1)

Add adverbs of attitude and hedging: *widely believed, generally accepted, reportedly, allegedly*. Use Pattern B with the passive infinitive: *The station is expected **to be reopened** in May*. Ask: "Is the passive the *best* choice in every sentence of your bulletin? Change one back to the active and say why." Early finishers turn their bulletin into a two-sentence "spoken" version for a friend and compare the registers.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **No dummy "It"**: "Is said that he is rich." Spanish, Portuguese, Italian and Arabic don't need a subject here (*se dice que, diz-se que, si dice che, yuqāl inna*). Point at the empty subject position: "English needs a subject: **It** is said..."
- ◆ **Mixing A and B**: "It is said him to be rich." / "He is said that he is rich." Common for everyone. Show the two patterns as two different doors: *It... that* or *He... to*, never both.
- ◆ **"They say" / "One says"** everywhere: Russian and Polish (*govoryat, mówią*), German (*man sagt*) and French (*on dit*) report beliefs with an active impersonal subject. That's fine in speech. In the bulletin, ask for the passive.
- ◆ **Missing *be / been***: "The bridge built in 1890." (as a whole sentence) · "It should have done." Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Indonesian speakers often drop the auxiliary. Underline *be* in a different color on the ladder.
- ◆ **The passive = something bad**: Chinese (Ø *bèi*), Korean and Japanese passives often suggest an unpleasant event, so some learners avoid the passive for neutral news. Show neutral examples ("The results are expected to improve").
- ◆ **"I cut my hair" for a haircut**: Spanish *me corté el pelo*, Portuguese *cortei o cabelo*, Italian, Tagalog and others say "I cut my hair" when a hairdresser did it. In English that means *you* held the scissors. Teach "**I had / got my hair cut.**"

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_07.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Formal Briefing" project (record it on a phone if possible). Workbook 3.1: finish the News Report Rewrite (write a second bulletin from the other story on your card, or an invented one), "My new words" and the journal (three chatty sentences

rewritten as impersonal passives + one causative sentence about something you had done recently, real or invented).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** The manager is thought to have left the company last year. · Q2 **C** I had my brakes fixed yesterday. · Q3 (new) **B** The form should have been sent yesterday. Radio bulletin (Ex 1): 1 is thought to be · 2 was found · 3 is believed to have been left · 4 has been asked · 5 was returned · 6 is said to have been borrowed · 7 will be held.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ tell **defining** clauses (no commas, *that* OK) from **non-defining** clauses (commas, no *that*) and know which ones can be reduced
- ◆ reduce a defining relative clause to a participle: **active** → **-ing** (*the man standing there*), **passive** → **past participle** (*the letter written by John*), using the test "Does the noun **do** the action or **receive** it?"
- ◆ join two sentences with a participle clause that shows **time** (*Walking home, I...*), **reason** (*Feeling tired, ...* · *Not knowing..., ...*) or **sequence** (*Having finished, ...*)
- ◆ find and fix a **dangling participle** by checking that the participle and the main clause have the same subject
- ◆ decide when *not* to reduce: single finished past actions, non-defining clauses in careful writing, and relaxed speech

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 3.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Sentence Compression Workshop)
- ◆ Slides 8–12 · Participle flashcards (*-ing* = does · *-ed / 3rd form* = receives · *having + pp* · *Not + -ing*) · Place picture cards · **Editor's Desk** drafts (4) · **Combine-and-reduce strips** (1 envelope per pair) · **Spot the Difference** A/B scenes · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 3.2-A (Old Town audio tour) and 3.2-B ("Dangler or not?")

BOARD PLAN

Left: reduce it. The man ~~who is~~ standing there · The woman ~~who lives~~ **living** next door · The letter ~~which was~~ written by John · Test: does the noun **DO** it? → **-ing** · **RECEIVE** it? → **past participle**. The books ~~selling~~ ✗ **sold** here ✓.

Center: join it. ⌚ time: *Walking home, I saw...* · 💡 reason: *Feeling tired, he went to bed.* · *Not knowing the way, we got lost.* · *Made of glass, it breaks easily.* · ➡ sequence: *Having finished, she left.*

Right: the subject rule. *Walking home, the rain started.* ✗ (the rain walked?) · *Walking home, I got caught in the rain.* ✓ · Check the **first noun after the comma**. Don't reduce: *the man who called me yesterday* (one finished action) · *My sister, who lives in Ohio, ...* (careful writing).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: the rumor mill	8	S–S	Review C7. Each learner writes one light rumor about an invented place or person on a slip ("People say the new gym

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			has a swimming pool on the roof."). Mingle: swap slips; each partner reports the slip on air in Pattern A and B. Then 3 volunteers read the best ones. Note errors (<i>to be</i> vs <i>to have been</i>) for the feedback stage.
Lead-in: signs and captions	5	T-S	Board: "Made in Mexico." · "Products sold here are final sale." · "Passengers traveling with children may board first." Ask: "What words are missing?" (<i>which were / that are / who are</i>). "Why do signs cut them?" (short, clear, space). "Today: fewer words, same meaning."
Quick recap: two kinds of clause	7	T-S	Board only (no slide). Fast check of B1 knowledge: "The woman who lives next door is a doctor" vs "My sister, who lives next door, is a doctor." Commas? <i>that</i> ? How many sisters? Keep it to 7 minutes: they know this.
Reducing clauses	12	T-S	Slides 8–9. The core move: delete the pronoun (+ <i>be</i>) and keep the participle. Build the does / receives test with 4 examples each, then hold up the place picture cards and give reduced-clause clues for learners to guess: "It's a place full of people waiting for trains" (station), "a place filled with stalls selling fruit" (market), "a building located in every town, used for sending packages" (post office). Learners then give one clue each. CCQs. Then "when not to reduce" (the man who called me yesterday).
Drill	6	T-S → S	Reduction drill and "do or receive?" (see Drill script). Choral, then individuals.
Participle clauses & danglers	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 10–11. Time, reason, sequence (<i>having</i> + <i>pp</i>), negatives (<i>Not knowing</i> ...). Then the dangler: read "Walking home, the rain started" with a puzzled face; let learners laugh and explain. Listening Script 3.2-B : learners hold up ✓ or ✗ cards (or thumbs) for "Dangler or not?"
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1 (Script 3.2-A, the Old Town audio tour: read it once), then Ex 2–5 alone (reduce, combine, fix the dangler, reduce or not?). Pairs check. Board-check the disagreements only.
Freer: Sentence	20	S-S → T-S	Slide 12. Round 1 (6 min), strips : pairs open the envelope of combine-and-reduce strips and join each set of 2–3 short sentences into one, reading each result aloud. Round 2 (10

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Compression Workshop			min), Editor's Desk: groups of 3 get a wordy draft (a community notice, a museum label, a mini-biography, an apartment ad) of about 100 words and must cut it to 60 words or fewer without losing any fact, using at least 4 participle clauses. The word-counter counts. Round 3 (4 min): each group reads its version aloud; the class votes for the clearest one and checks it for dangles. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Board 3 errors (no names): "The books selling here..." · "Having finished the report, the printer broke." · "The man calling me yesterday was angry." And 1-2 range examples (" <i>Surrounded by trees, the park...</i> "). Learners fix them and say why.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.2 and a  button. Set the homework (below), including Spot the Difference if you didn't have time (it works as a C9 warmer too). Learners tick "I can..."
Total	90		8 + 5 + 7 + 12 + 6 + 12 + 10 + 20 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: reduction. A reduced clause says exactly the same thing as the full clause, with fewer words. Neither is "more correct." The reduced one is tighter and more written; the full one is more relaxed and more spoken.

SAY: "The man standing by the door is my uncle." Which man? (The one by the door.) Is he standing there now? (Yes.) Full version? (The man who is standing by the door.) · "The car parked outside has been there all week." Did the car park itself? (No, someone parked it: passive → parked.) Full version? (The car which is / was parked outside.)

SAY: Does or receives? "The people ___ outside look cold." (wait: they do it → waiting) · "The paintings ___ in 2004 were found." (steal: they received it → stolen) · "The books ___ here are second-hand." (sell: do the books sell? No, they are sold → sold.)

Meaning: when not to reduce. -ing reduction works for something in progress, a habit or a state (the woman living next door), not for one finished action in the past.

SAY: "The man who called me yesterday was angry." Can I say "the man calling me yesterday"? (No: one finished call. Keep who called.) · "Passengers who are traveling with children may board first." Reduce? (Yes: Passengers traveling with children.) · "My sister, who lives in Ohio, is a nurse." Reduce in careful writing? (No: keep the commas and who.)

Meaning: participle clauses for time, reason and sequence.

SAY: "Feeling tired, he went to bed." Why did he go to bed? (Because he felt tired.) · "Walking home, I saw an accident." When did I see it? (While I was walking home: same time.) · "Having finished work, she went home." Which happened first? (Finishing work.) Could we say "After finishing work"? (Yes.) · "Not knowing the way, we got lost." Did we know the way? (No.) Where does not go? (At the start.)

Meaning: the subject rule.

SAY: "Reading the letter, tears filled her eyes." Who is reading, grammatically? (The tears!) Can tears read? (No: it's a dangler.) How do we fix it? ("Reading the letter, **she** began to cry." or "While she was reading the letter, tears filled her eyes.")

Form.

Active → -ing	who / which / that + verb → verb-ing	The train that leaves at noon → The train leaving at noon
Passive → pp	who / which / that + be + pp → pp	The bridge which was built in 1890 → The bridge built in 1890
Time / reason	- ing clause, comma, main clause (same subject)	Driving to work, he heard the news.
Reason (passive)	pp clause, comma, main clause	Made of glass, it breaks easily.
Sequence	Having + pp, main clause · After + -ing	Having lost the map, they turned back.
Negative	Not + participle	Not having a plan, we improvised.

Pronunciation. A fronted participle clause is its own tone unit: pause at the comma and let the voice rise slightly, then fall at the end of the main clause: "Feeling tired ↗ | he went to bed ↘." The -ed of reduced passives follows the usual rule: /t/ parked, finished · /d/ closed, delivered · /ɪd/ painted, located, surrounded; irregular forms (built, written, stolen, sold) need practice. In "Having finished," having is short and the participle takes the stress: /hævɪŋ 'fɪnɪʃt/.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Cut it:** T: "The man who is standing there." → S: "The man standing there." T: "The woman who lives next door." → S: "The woman living next door." T: "The letter which was written by John." → S: "The letter written by John." T: "Products that are made locally." → S: "Products made locally."
- Do or receive?** (point at the -ing / pp cards): T: "books · sell · here" → S: "books **sold** here." T: "people · wait · outside" → S: "people **waiting** outside." T: "a car · park · outside" → S: "a car **parked** outside." T: "students · take · the test" → S: "students **taking** the test."

- 3 **Join it:** T: "She didn't feel well. She stayed home." → S: "Not feeling well, she stayed home." T: "They had finished dinner. They went for a walk." → S: "Having finished dinner, they went for a walk."
- 4 **Dangler doctor:** T: "Running for the bus, my bag fell open." → S: "Running for the bus, I dropped my bag." / "As I ran for the bus, my bag fell open."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 gives two short facts about a place in town (real or invented): "The market is near the river. It is open on Sundays." S2 joins them: "Located near the river, the market is open on Sundays." Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ SENTENCE COMPRESSION WORKSHOP – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Round 1: strips (pairs, 6 min).** Each envelope has 12 strips; each strip holds 2–3 short sentences. Pairs join each set into **one** sentence with a reduced clause or a participle clause, and say it aloud before they write it. The target sentence is on your answer key (materials, set D); accept any correct version.
- ◆ **Round 2: Editor's Desk (groups of 3, 10 min).** Each group gets a wordy draft of about 100 words (A: a community center notice, B: a museum label, C: a mini-biography of an invented local baker, D: an apartment ad). The "editor-in-chief" says: **60 words or fewer, no fact lost, at least 4 participle clauses, no danglers.** Roles: a **writer**, a **word-counter** (counts after each sentence and says "over / under"), a **fact-checker** (ticks each fact on the draft as it survives). Give the word-counter job to a dominant speaker.
- ◆ **Round 3: read-out (4 min).** Each group reads its version. Class votes on "clearest," not "shortest." Anyone who hears a dangler says "Dangler!" and the group fixes it.
- ◆ **Honesty rule:** if a reduced sentence sounds worse, un-reduce it. "Learning when not to reduce is a B2 skill too." Praise a group that explains why they kept one full clause.
- ◆ If time is short, skip Round 1 and go straight to the Editor's Desk. **Spot the Difference** (A/B scenes, set E) is the spoken extension: A describes a street scene using reduced clauses ("a man wearing a red hat standing at the bus stop"), B finds 5 differences. Use it for early finishers or as the C9 warmer.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WORKSHOP

SAY: *Strips: how many sentences at the end? (One.) · Say it first or write it first? (Say it first.) · Editor's Desk: maximum words? (Sixty.) · Can you delete a fact? (No! Every fact stays.) · How many participle clauses? (At least four.) · Who counts the words? (The word-counter.) · Which version wins: the shortest or the clearest? (The clearest.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on the **reduction** move only (no fronted participle clauses yet): *who is -ing* → *-ing*, *which was + pp* → *pp*. Give the does / receives cards to hold during Ex 2. In Round 1, give the learner 6 strips instead of 12 and let them cross out words with a pencil instead of rewriting. In the Editor's Desk, make them the fact-checker (tick the facts) rather than the writer. Target: 4 correct reductions, said aloud.

STRETCH (TOWARD C1)

Use participle clauses in the **middle** and **end** of sentences: "The storm hit the coast, **leaving** thousands without power" (result). Use *having been + pp*: "**Having been told** the news, she called her sister." In the Editor's Desk, aim for 50 words and justify one clause they chose *not* to reduce. Early finishers rewrite the "Old Town" script as a relaxed spoken version and compare the registers.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **-ing for passive meaning:** "the books selling here," "a house building in 1900." Very common for all L1s. Always ask the does / receives question.
- ◆ **Loose participle clauses (danglers):** Spanish and Portuguese use the *gerundio* / *gerúndio* more freely, with a different subject ("Llegando a casa, el teléfono sonó"), and French *en + participe* is sometimes used loosely too. Danglers are also common in native-speaker writing, so present them as a *writing* check, not a sign of a weak learner.
- ◆ **Modifier before the noun:** Chinese, Japanese and Korean put the whole describing phrase before the noun ("the at-the-door-standing man"), so learners may avoid post-noun participles. Praise every attempt.
- ◆ **Extra pronoun:** "The man standing there **he** is my uncle." Arabic, Hebrew, Persian and some Chinese speakers add a resumptive pronoun. Cross it out.
- ◆ **Irregular past participles:** "the bridge builded," "the paintings stealed," "the letter wrote by John." Keep an irregular-verb list handy; Spanish and Tagalog speakers may pronounce *-ed* as an extra syllable (/ 'parkəd/).

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_08.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back, pausing at the commas; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Describe It Concisely" project (6+ sentences, 4 participle clauses). Workbook 3.2: finish the Sentence Compression Workshop (your own 60-word version of a second draft, or of a real notice or label you find), "My new words" and the journal (three sentences of your own reduced, and one honest line: better or not?).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** The report prepared by the committee is on your desk. · Q2 **B** Sleeping deeply, the alarm didn't wake me. (the dangler) · Q3 (new) **B** The books sold here are second-hand. Old Town tour (Ex 1): 1 Built · 2 standing · 3 Located · 4 painted · 5 Having climbed · 6 selling · 7 Surrounded.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- report the **function** of what someone said (an offer, a refusal, an apology, a denial, a suggestion) with one precise verb instead of *said / told*
- use each verb with its pattern: + **to-infinitive** (*agree, refuse, offer, promise*), + **object + to-infinitive** (*advise, warn, remind, persuade*), + **(that) clause** (*admit, explain, insist, deny*), + **-ing** (*deny, admit, suggest, recommend*), + **preposition + -ing** (*apologize for, accuse sb of, insist on, blame sb for*)
- avoid the classic B2 errors: *suggested me to...*, *apologized to be...*, *accused me to...*, *reminded to call* (no object)
- keep the backshift inside *that*-clauses, and use *suggest / insist that + base verb* for proposals and demands
- write and read aloud accurate **meeting minutes** with at least six different reporting verbs

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 3.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Meeting Minutes sheet)
- Slides 13–18 · Reporting-verb cards (color-coded by pattern) · **Meeting** role cards (3 meetings × 4 roles) + minutes sheets · **Report It!** board game (early finishers / C10 warmer) · New identity cards
- Listening scripts 3.3-A (the Riverside Apartments residents' meeting) and 3.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: vague → precise. She said she'd help. → She **offered to help**. · He said he didn't take it. → He **denied taking it**. · She said sorry for being late. → She **apologized for being late**.

Center: five patterns (five colors). ① + to: agree, refuse, offer, promise, threaten · ② + person + to: advise, ask, warn, remind, persuade, invite · ③ + (that): admit, explain, claim, deny, insist, complain · ④ + -ing: deny, admit, suggest, recommend, mention · ⑤ + prep + -ing: apologize **for**, accuse sb **of**, insist **on**, blame sb **for**, congratulate sb **on**, warn sb **against**.

Right: the meeting six. suggested **going** / suggested (that) we **go** · insisted **on paying** / insisted (that) she **had paid** · denied **taking** · admitted **forgetting** / (that) he **had forgotten** · agreed **to help** · refused **to sign**. Trap: suggested ~~me to~~ ✗ · recommended ~~me to~~ ✗.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: compress it /	7	S–S	Review C8. Board three pairs of short sentences; pairs join them with participle clauses in 3

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Spot the Difference			minutes ("The café is located near the park. It serves great coffee." → "Located near the park, the café serves great coffee."). Or, if C8 ran out of time, run Spot the Difference (set E) in pairs.
Lead-in: what was she doing?	6	T-S	Slide 13. Two learners read the Dana and Marco dialogue aloud. Show the "vague" report (all <i>said</i>). Ask: "What was Dana doing with her words in line 1?" (apologizing) "...in line 3?" (promising). Show the precise report. "Which report is more useful for someone who wasn't there?"
Patterns: meaning & form	18	T-S → S-S	Slides 14–15. Build the five-pattern table on the board with the color-coded verb cards: learners hear a direct line and decide the function, then the pattern. Spend the most time on the meeting six : <i>suggest, insist, deny, admit, agree, refuse</i> , each with its two possible patterns and the <i>suggest</i> trap. CCQs (below). Pairs then sort a spare set of verb cards into the five columns (2 min).
Drill	7	T-S → S	"Name the act" drill (see Drill script). Choral, then individuals, then chains.
Listening: the residents' meeting	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 3.3-A (four voices: change your voice or give three confident learners the lines). First listening: "What's the problem? What do they decide?" Second: learners match each speaker to a verb and complete the model minutes. Then show slide 16: the model minutes. This is the model for the freer task.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone (choose the verb, the right pattern, fix the error, report with the meeting six), then check in pairs. Board-check disagreements. Early finishers play Report It!
Freer 1: the meeting	12	S-S (groups of 4–5)	Slide 17. Groups of 4 (+1 minute-taker in groups of 5). Each group gets one meeting: Riverside Apartments (the laundry room), Brightside Café (the new schedule), or Green Street Community Garden (August watering). Each learner has a role card with 3 secret "moves" (e.g., <i>suggest...</i> , <i>refuse</i>

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			<i>to...</i> , <i>admit...</i>). The chair (card A) opens and closes the meeting. 8 minutes to reach a decision. Learners play their card , not themselves. ICQs first.
Freer 2: the minutes	10	S → S-S	Each learner writes the minutes on the sheet: 6–8 sentences, at least 6 different reporting verbs , including as many of the meeting six as possible, no <i>said</i> / <i>told</i> . Then they swap with a group member and check the patterns against the cheat-sheet (tick = correct pattern).
Share	4	T-S	One learner from each group reads its minutes aloud. Other groups listen for the decision and one precise verb they liked.
Feedback & module wrap-up	5	T-S	Board 3 errors (no names): "She suggested me to change the day." · "He denied to take the key." · "They apologized to be late." And 1–2 range examples (" <i>insisted on covering</i> the shift"). Then slide 18, the module recap. Learners tick the three "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 3.3 and a  button. Set the homework (below). Remind learners that Module 3 is in Progress Test 1 (C13).
Total	90		7 + 6 + 18 + 7 + 6 + 10 + 12 + 10 + 4 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: reporting the function. A reporting verb tells the listener what the speaker was *doing* with the words (offering, refusing, admitting), so we don't repeat the words themselves. It also shows the reporter's interpretation, so choose carefully: *claimed* suggests you doubt it; *admitted* suggests it was hard to say.

SAY: "I'll carry that for you." Is he giving an order or an offer? (An offer.) → He offered to carry it. · "No, I won't sign." → She... (refused to sign.) Do we need "not"? (No: refuse is already negative.) · "OK, it was my mistake." Was that easy to say? (No.) → He admitted (that) it was his mistake / admitted making the mistake.

Meaning: the meeting six.

SAY: suggest: "Why don't we change the day?" Is it an order? (No, an idea.) Who will change it? (We, all of us.) → She suggested changing the day / suggested (that) we change the day. Can I say "suggested us

to change"? (No!)

SAY: insist: "No, really, I'll pay. I insist." Did he accept a "no"? (No.) → He insisted on paying. · "I paid! I definitely paid." → She insisted (that) she had paid. Is this about a future action or a fact? (A fact: she is sure it's true.)

SAY: deny vs refuse: "I didn't take the key." → He denied taking the key. Is it about the past or the future? (The past: he says it didn't happen.) · "I won't give you the key." → He refused to give me the key. Past or future? (Future: he says no to doing it.) Can I say "He denied to give"? (No: deny is about facts; refuse is about actions.)

SAY: admit: "Yes, OK, I forgot to order the soap." → He admitted forgetting / admitted (that) he had forgotten to order the soap. · **agree:** "Fine, I'll do the Saturday shift." → She agreed to do the Saturday shift. Can I say "She was agree"? (No! agree is a verb: she agreed.)

Form.

① + to-infinitive	agree, offer, promise, refuse, threaten, claim, decide	She refused to sign .
② + object + to	advise, ask, tell, warn, remind, encourage, persuade, invite, order	He reminded us to lock the door.
③ + (that) clause	admit, explain, claim, deny, insist, complain, promise, agree (backshift)	She admitted (that) she had forgotten .
④ + -ing	admit, deny, suggest, recommend, mention, regret	He denied taking the key.
⑤ + prep + -ing	apologize for, accuse sb of, insist on, blame sb for, congratulate sb on, warn sb against	He insisted on paying .
suggest / insist that	for a proposal or demand: that + subject + base verb (American) · <i>should</i> + base (also OK)	She suggested (that) we meet on Friday. · He insisted that we stay .

Pronunciation. The reporting verb carries the meaning, so stress it: "She **refused** to sign." "He **denied** taking it." Word stress to check: **suggest** /səg'dʒest/ (not *SUG-gest*), **insist**, **admit**, **refuse** (verb; *REF-use* /'rɛfjuːs/ is the noun "trash"), **apologize**, **recommend**. Past -ed: /d/ in *apologized, refused, denied, agreed, accused, offered, warned, blamed* · /t/ in *promised*. The ones to drill are the verbs that add a syllable, /ɪd/: *suggested, insisted, admitted, recommended, reminded*. Learners often swallow that syllable ("He suggest going"), and then the listener hears the present tense.

- 1 **Pattern snap** (hold up a verb card): T: "refuse" → S: "refuse **to** do." T: "suggest" → S: "suggest **doing**." T: "remind" → S: "remind **someone to** do." T: "apologize" → S: "apologize **for** doing." T: "deny" → S: "deny **doing**." T: "insist" → S: "insist **on** doing / insist **that**..." Choral, then fast individuals.
- 2 **Name the act**: T (acting): "Sorry, sorry, I'm late!" → S: "She apologized for being late." T: "I didn't eat your sandwich!" → S: "He denied eating my sandwich." T: "Let's order pizza." → S: "She suggested ordering pizza." T: "OK, I'll bring the drinks." → S: "He agreed to bring the drinks." T: "No. I won't work on Sunday." → S: "She refused to work on Sunday." T: "Yes, I broke the printer." → S: "He admitted breaking the printer."
- 3 **Two ways**: T: "He admitted breaking it." → S: "He admitted that he had broken it." T: "She suggested going out." → S: "She suggested that we go out."
- 4 **Trap check** (T says a wrong one, learners shout the fix): T: "She suggested me to go." → S: "She suggested going! / suggested that I go!" T: "He apologized to be late." → S: "He apologized for being late!"
- 5 **Chain**: S1 says a line of direct speech with a clear function; S2 reports it with a precise verb; S3 names the pattern (① to ⑤). Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ MEETING MINUTES – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 4** (or 5 with a minute-taker). Each group gets one meeting and four role cards (A = chair, B, C, D). Each card has the situation, the role and **3 moves**, each labeled with a function (*SUGGEST · REFUSE · ADMIT · DENY · INSIST · AGREE* plus one free move). Learners say the move in their own words in the meeting; they must not say the function word ("I suggest..." is fine; "I refuse!" is fine too, but encourage natural lines like "No, I'm sorry, I can't do that").
- ◆ **The meeting (8 min + 4 min buffer)**: the chair opens ("OK, let's start. The problem is..."), makes sure everyone speaks and closes with a decision ("So we agree that..."). The chair's card has a talking-turn rule: nobody speaks twice before everyone has spoken once.
- ◆ **The minutes (10 min)**: everyone writes their own minutes on the sheet (date, present, the problem, what each person did, the decision). No *said* or *told*. At least 6 different reporting verbs. The five-pattern cheat-sheet is on the sheet.
- ◆ **Peer check**: swap minutes; the partner ticks each verb whose pattern is right and circles any *suggested me to*. Then one reader per group shares.
- ◆ **Minute-taker**: in a group of 5, give the fifth learner (or a dominant speaker) the minute-taker job during the meeting. They don't speak until the end, when they read the draft and the group corrects it ("No, I didn't refuse! I agreed to do it on Tuesday!"). This correction round is excellent practice.
- ◆ All roles are assigned. Nobody has to share their own opinions. The stakes are small on purpose (a laundry room, a café schedule, watering tomatoes).

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE MEETING

SAY: *Do you play yourself or the card? (The card.) · How many moves on your card? (Three.) · Can you show your card? (No.) · Who opens and closes the meeting? (The chair, card A.) · Can someone speak twice before everyone has spoken once? (No.) · In the minutes, can you write "said"? (No!) · How many different reporting verbs? (At least six.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on **four verbs and two patterns**: *agree to* / *refuse to* (①) and *suggest -ing* / *deny -ing* (④). Give a card with four sentence frames: "___ agreed to ___ · ___ refused to ___ · ___ suggested ___-ing · ___ denied ___-ing." In the meeting, give the learner card D (the shortest moves) and let them read their moves from the card. For the minutes, target 4 sentences with the frames. Fewer items in Ex 3–4.

STRETCH (TOWARD C1)

Report **attitude** as well as function: *claimed* (the reporter doubts it), *conceded*, *acknowledged*, *urged*, *proposed*, *objected to -ing*. Use the passive infinitive and perfect -ing: "She denied **having been told**." "He admitted **having forgotten**." In the minutes, add one sentence with an impersonal passive from C7 ("It was agreed that...") and one participle clause from C8 ("Having discussed the options, the committee decided..."). That's the whole module in one text.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"suggested me to" / "recommended me to"**: French *suggérer à qqn de*, Spanish *sugerir a alguien*, Italian, Portuguese, German (*jdm vorschlagen*) and Russian (*predlozhit' komu + infinitive*) all allow a person + infinitive. The most common error in this lesson for almost everyone. Write it on the board crossed out and keep it there.
- ◆ **deny vs refuse**: Spanish *negarse a* and Portuguese *negar-se a* mean **refuse**, while *negar* means **deny**, so learners say "He denied to pay." Use the past / future CCQ every time.
- ◆ **"I am agree" / "She was agree"**: Spanish *estar de acuerdo*, French *être d'accord*, Portuguese *estar de acordo*. Drill "I agree / She agreed" as a verb.
- ◆ **"explained me the problem"**: Spanish *me explicó*, French *il m'a expliqué*, Italian *mi ha spiegato*. Teach "explained the problem **to me**" / "explained (to me) that...". Same for "suggested me."
- ◆ **Wrong preposition**: "insist in" (Spanish *insistir en*), "accuse for" / "blame of" (mixing), "apologize to be" (French *s'excuser de + infinitive*). Teach the verb + preposition as one chunk, and the rule "after a preposition → -ing."
- ◆ **No backshift in that-clauses**: "He admitted that he forgets." Chinese, Japanese, Korean, Russian and Vietnamese keep the original tense. This is B1 language; recast gently.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 3.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_09.html. Listen to the five model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3, the Quick Quiz and the "Report a Conversation" project (a light, everyday conversation: planning a trip, sharing a bill, a work schedule). Workbook 3.3: finish the Meeting Minutes (a clean final copy with 6+ verbs), "My new words" and the journal (five reporting verbs from five different patterns, one sentence each about a real or invented conversation from your week).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** She warned us not to walk on the ice. · Q2 **C** He suggested eating out that night. · Q3 (new) **A** He denied breaking the printer. Residents' meeting (Ex 1): 1 Ms. Park · suggested · 2 Mr. Diaz · denied · 3 Tom · admitted · 4 Mr. Diaz · refused · 5 Ms. Okafor · agreed · 6 Tom · insisted on · 7 Ms. Park · reminded.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C9: MODULE 3 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "shift, cut, name": **It is said that...** / **He is thought to have...** (shift the focus) → **the man standing there** · **Having finished, she...** (cut the words) → **She refused to sign. He denied taking it. They suggested meeting on Friday.** (name the act). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C10 warmer (the **Report It!** board game is ready for that) and again in the C13 progress-test catch-up.

Watch for in Module 4: linking words in 4.1 (*despite, owing to*) take **-ing** after a preposition, just like the pattern-⑤ verbs (*despite feeling tired · apologize for being late*): make that connection out loud. Cleft sentences in 4.2 ("What she suggested was...") work well with reporting verbs. And the 4.3 review project (present, argue and discuss) is the natural place to recycle impersonal passives ("It is often said that...") in formal openings.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it tests: passives across tenses and modals (including *should have been + pp*), impersonal passives in both patterns with the right infinitive (*to be / to have been*), the causative word order, reducing relative clauses (*-ing* vs past participle), participle clauses for time, reason and sequence, spotting a dangling participle, and reporting verbs with their patterns (especially *suggest, deny / refuse, admit, insist on, apologize for, accuse of*).

Module 4 — Fluency & Style

Three classes that finish the first half of B2 and move learners from *correct* English to *effective* English. First comes **linking ideas**: contrast, cause and result, and above all the grammar that follows each linker (*although + clause, despite + noun / -ing, however + new sentence*). Then **emphasis**: *it*-clefts, *what*-clefts and other cleft frames, and basic **negative inversion** (*Never have I..., Not only did..., No sooner had...than*). Last, a task-based review, **Present, Argue & Discuss**: learners give a short signposted presentation and take part in a small-group discussion with assigned sides, while you score a speaking checklist that feeds Progress Test 1 (C13).

3 lessons

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C10–C12

Weeks 5–6

90 min per class

CEFR B2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, discussion) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. C12 is task-based: the tasks come first and the language work comes out of them.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-4-fluency-style.html](#). Print [materials/module-4/classroom-materials.html](#) before C10. It holds the flashcards, the linker sort cards, the **Argument Builder** kit (topic cards, point cards, linker play cards, listener tally), the **Plain → Dramatic** rewrite cards, the **Set the Record Straight** A/B cards, the emphatic-opinion prompts, the C12 presentation topics, side cards and persona cards, the **C12 speaking checklist**, the Module 1–4 Review Race board game and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** At B1 (Module 3 and 4.3) learners met *because, so, although, however*, relative clauses and the basic opinion phrases. They know what most linkers *mean*. The B2 work in 4.1 is the **grammar after the linker** (clause, noun / -ing, or a new sentence) and the **register and punctuation** of connectors. Clefts and negative inversion (4.2) are genuinely new for most learners; keep inversion to the triggers the lesson teaches (*Never, Not only, No sooner...than, Hardly / Scarcely...when, Rarely / Seldom, Little, Only then / Only after*).

- ◆ **Fluency before accuracy.** In every freer task, listen and take notes; don't stop a speaker to fix a linker or an inversion. The feedback stage is where you fix errors, without names. At B2, feed back on **accuracy and range**: one or two "fix it" sentences, and one or two "upgrade it" sentences (a correct but plain sentence that a cleft or a better linker would make stronger). Praise the *argument* first ("That was really convincing"), then the form.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** Argument tasks reward the loudest voice, so build in turn-taking: **talking tokens** in the discussions, **fixed-order rounds** before open rounds, and **jobs** for strong speakers (the chair who must invite everyone, the listener who keeps the linker tally, the devil's advocate who may speak only after two others). Say it kindly: "Great point, Ivan. Let's hear the other side first."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C1.** Don't hand them new C1 grammar. Stretch them with **choice and control**: vary linkers (no linker twice in one talk), match register to the situation (*therefore* in the talk, *so* in the chat), use the rarer triggers the lesson teaches (*Seldom*, *Little did...*, *Only after...*) sparingly and exactly, hedge their claims (*arguably*, *to some extent*), summarize the other side fairly before countering, and self-correct in real time.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British forms (*emphasise*, *apologise*, *realise*, *practised*, *organised*, *programme*, *cancelled*, *film*, *holiday*, *moved house*, *full stop*). Teach *emphasize*, *apologize*, *realize*, *practiced*, *organized*, *program*, *canceled*, *movie*, *vacation*, *moved*, *period*. Accept the British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Connect it → stress it → use it all. In C10 learners stop producing lists of facts and start building arguments: *Although remote work saves time, it can feel isolating, so many teams keep an office day.* In C11 they learn to put the spotlight exactly where they want it: *It was Maria who booked it, not me. What we really need is more time. Not only did the deadline move, but we also lost two people.* In C12 everything from Modules 1–4 goes to work in two real tasks: a short signposted presentation and a small-group discussion in which learners concede, counter and persuade. Every class ends with a speaking task where the argument matters as much as the grammar.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: ARGUE THE CARD, NOT YOUR LIFE

Opinion tasks can feel risky for adults who have lived where disagreeing in public was dangerous, and some topics touch raw nerves. The online lesson 4.3 suggests broad topics ("technology & society, the environment, education... the media"). **In class, keep every topic everyday:** work, the neighborhood, shopping, technology at home, school and learning, health habits, free time. **No** politics, religion, immigration policy, war or national identity; if a learner raises one, thank them and steer back: "Interesting, but let's keep today's topics local." **Every opinion task has assigned sides** (the side cards and Argument Builder cards), a **devil's advocate** role and **persona cards**, so nobody has to reveal what they really think. Say it every time: "Good speakers can argue any side. Today you argue your card." Anyone can say "Pass" on a personal question, and anyone may present to you alone instead of to a group.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (Set A, one set for the board): the linker cards color-coded by what follows them, the emphasis-frame cards and the topic picture cards. Card stock helps. Cut them before C10.
- For C10: one set of **linker sort cards** (Set B) per pair, and one **Argument Builder** kit (Set C) per group of 3: a topic card, its six point cards, a set of 12 linker play cards and a listener tally. An envelope per group keeps the pieces together.
- For C11: one set of **Plain → Dramatic** cards (Set D) per pair, one pair of **Set the Record Straight** A/B cards (Set E) per pair, and the **emphatic-opinion prompts** (Set F) on a side table.
- For C12: one **Review Race** board (Set I) per group of 3–4 with a die and counters; the **presentation topic cards**, **side cards**, **persona cards** and **talking tokens** (Set G); one **speaking checklist** class grid for you and one score slip per learner (Set H). A phone timer for each group.
- Optional: learners' phones for recording their C12 presentation (useful for anyone you don't manage to hear live).

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
4.1	C10 · wk 5	Contrast & concession (<i>although / though / even though + clause · despite / in spite of + noun / -ing / the fact that · however / nevertheless + new sentence · whereas / while</i>); cause (<i>because / since / as + clause · because of / due to / owing to + noun</i>); result & purpose (<i>so · so + adj + that · such + noun + that · therefore / consequently · so as to / in order to</i>); register and punctuation of connectors	build a balanced two-minute spoken argument on an everyday trade-off, using at least two contrast, one cause and one result linker with the correct grammar after each

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
4.2	C11 · wk 6	<i>It</i> -clefts (<i>It was Maria who...</i> / <i>It was on Monday that...</i>); <i>what</i> -clefts (<i>What I need is...</i> · <i>What he did was (to)...</i>); other frames (<i>The thing that... is</i> · <i>The reason... is</i> · <i>All I want is...</i>); negative inversion with question word order (<i>Never have I...</i> · <i>Not only did... but also</i> · <i>No sooner...than</i> · <i>Hardly...when</i> · <i>Rarely does...</i> · <i>Little did...</i> · <i>Only then did...</i>)	correct a wrong assumption with an <i>it</i> -cleft, build up to a key point with a <i>what</i> -cleft, and give a 60–90 second emphatic opinion with one well-placed inversion
4.3	C12 · wk 6	Review project. Signposting a talk; building a case (reasons, ranking, balance, evidence, hedging); discussion moves (concede, then counter ; persuade; hedge); the full B2 toolkit from Modules 1–4; the C12 speaking checklist (feeds C13)	give a signposted two-minute presentation with 2–3 supported points, answer a challenge by conceding and countering, and take part in a group discussion from an assigned side

4.1 · C10

Linking Ideas — The Argument Builder

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ express contrast and concession with *although, though, even though, despite, in spite of, whereas, while, however, nevertheless, on the other hand*
- ◆ express cause with *because, since, as* (+ clause) and *because of, due to, owing to* (+ noun)
- ◆ express result and purpose with *so, so + adjective / adverb + that, such (a / an) + noun + that, therefore, consequently, as a result, so as to, in order to*
- ◆ choose the right grammar after each linker (**clause**, **noun** / **-ing**, or a **new sentence**) and punctuate sentence connectors correctly
- ◆ give a balanced two-minute mini-talk on an everyday trade-off, from an assigned side or a balanced view

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, the Argument Builder planner)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Linker flashcards and topic pictures (Set A) · **Linker sort cards** (Set B, 1 set per pair) · **Argument Builder** kits (Set C, 1 per group of 3)
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.1-A (Two speakers), 4.1-B (City or countryside? mini-talk) and 4.1-C (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: three columns with headings. + **CLAUSE** (subject + verb): *although · though · even though · whereas · while · because · since · as · so* + **NOUN** / **-ING**: *despite · in spite of · because of · due to · owing to* · **NEW SENTENCE** + **COMMA**: *However, · Nevertheless, · On the other hand, · Therefore, · Consequently, · As a result,* (Stick the Set A linker cards in the right column as you teach them.)

Center: the bridge: *Despite the rain ✓ · Despite being wet ✓ · Despite ~~it was raining~~ ✗ → Despite **the fact that** it was raining ✓ · Although ~~the rain~~ ✗*. Under it: *so + adj / adv + that* (so cold that...) · *such + (a / an) + noun + that* (such a cold day that...).

Right: punctuation: *It was late. However, we stayed. · It was late; however, we stayed. · Although it was late, we stayed.* Register ladder: *so* (chat) → *that's why* → *therefore / consequently* (talk, essay).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Report the	8	S–S → T–S	Review C9 (3.3, reporting verbs and patterns). On the board: "Your coworker ____

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
complaint			(deny / admit / suggest / insist on / apologize for / warn) ...". Pairs invent a small office drama in three reported sentences ("Sam denied taking the last coffee. Rita insisted on checking the camera. In the end, Sam apologized for lying."). Two pairs share. Note one pattern error for the feedback slot (typically "suggested me to...").
Lead-in: Two speakers	6	T-S	Read Script 4.1-A : the same four facts about remote work, first as a flat list, then linked. "Which speaker was easier to follow? Why?" Elicit that the second speaker <i>told us in advance</i> what kind of idea was coming. Underline <i>although, because, however, as a result</i> on the slide (slide 3). "You already know these words. Today is about the grammar after them."
Contrast: clause, noun or new sentence?	14	T-S → S-S	Slides 4–5. Present the three-column board. Meaning first (contrast vs concession, CCQs below), then form: <i>although</i> + clause, <i>despite</i> / <i>in spite of</i> + noun / -ing, the bridge <i>the fact that</i> , <i>however</i> as a sentence connector, <i>whereas</i> / <i>while</i> for comparing two things. Then pairs do the linker sort (Set B): 18 linker cards go under the right column heading (+ clause / + noun / -ing / new sentence), and the pair says one quick sentence for each card; check against the board.
Drill: switch it	6	T-S → S	Transformation drill (see Drill script): <i>although</i> → <i>despite</i> , <i>because</i> → <i>because of</i> , <i>but</i> → <i>however</i> , <i>so</i> → <i>such...that</i> . Choral, then fast individuals. Keep the pace up; the point is automatic grammar after the linker.
Cause, result & register	10	T-S	Slides 6–7. <i>because</i> / <i>since</i> / <i>as</i> + clause vs <i>because of</i> / <i>due to</i> / <i>owing to</i> + noun; <i>so...that</i> vs <i>such...that</i> ("if a noun follows, use

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			<i>such</i> "); <i>therefore</i> / <i>consequently</i> (formal, new sentence) vs <i>so</i> (spoken, same sentence); <i>so as to</i> / <i>in order to</i> + verb for purpose. The register ladder and the punctuation line. CCQs.
Listening: City or countryside?	7	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.1-B twice. First listen: "Does the speaker prefer the city or the countryside?" (Neither: it depends on your stage of life.) Second listen: learners write the ten missing linkers and label each C (contrast), Ca (cause) or R (result). Pairs compare.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone (choose the linker, join the ideas, <i>so</i> / <i>such</i> , fix the mistake), then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. Early finishers start the Argument Builder planner.
Freer: The Argument Builder	19	S-S (groups of 3) → T-S	Slide 8. See "How to run it" below. Round 1 (7 min): in each trio, A argues FOR the topic and B argues AGAINST (1 minute each), using the point cards and playing a linker card face up each time they use it correctly; C is the listener with the tally and checks the grammar after each linker. Then C gives a 30-second verdict: "Although A made a good point about..., B convinced me because...". Round 2 (10 min): new topic card; everyone gives a balanced two-minute mini-talk (hook → side 1 → pivot with a contrast linker → side 2 → balanced conclusion) while the others tally. Rotate roles. ICQs first (2 min).
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed error correction: write 4 sentences you heard (no names): 2 to fix, 2 to upgrade. E.g. "Despite it is cheaper, many people drive." · "It was so a long journey that I slept." · "Because of the rent is high, people share." (fix) · "It's cheap. But it's far." →

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			<i>Although it's cheap, it's far.</i> (upgrade). Praise the most convincing argument first.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 4.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 14 + 6 + 10 + 7 + 10 + 19 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: contrast vs concession. Contrast = two things are different (*He likes tea, whereas she prefers coffee.*). Concession = "Yes, this is true, but the other thing is true anyway" (*Although it was raining, we went out.*).

SAY: "*Although it was raining, we went out.*" Was it raining? (Yes.) Did we go out? (Yes.) Is that surprising? (A little: we expected them to stay in.) • "*Even though I warned him, he did it.*" Stronger or weaker than *although*? (Stronger: more surprise.)

SAY: "*He likes tea, whereas she prefers coffee.*" Is one fact surprising because of the other? (No, we're just comparing two people.) Can I say "*Although he likes tea, she prefers coffee*"? (It sounds strange: there's no surprise. *whereas / while* is better.)

Form: what comes after the linker. This is the heart of the lesson.

SAY: "*Despite ____, we went out.*" Can I put "*it was raining*" there? (No: *despite* takes a noun or -ing.) What can I put? (*the rain • the bad weather • being tired.*) And if I really want the full sentence? (*Despite the fact that it was raining... or change to Although.*) • "*Although ____, we went out.*" "*the rain*"? (No: *although* needs subject + verb.)

SAY: "*It was late. However, we stayed.*" How many sentences? (Two.) What's after *However*? (A comma.) Can I say "*However it was late, we stayed*"? (No, that's *although's* job.)

SAY: "*We were late because of the traffic.*" "...because the traffic was terrible." Same meaning? (Yes.) Same grammar? (No: *because of* + noun; *because* + clause.) "*The match was canceled due to rain.*" Formal or informal? (More formal; common in announcements and writing.)

SAY: "*It was so cold that the lake froze.*" "*It was such a cold day that we stayed in.*" What comes after *so*? (An adjective: *cold.*) After *such*? (*a / an* + noun: *a cold day.*) "*They were such kind people.*" Why no *a*?

(Plural noun.) · "She left early so as to catch the train." Why did she leave early? (To catch the train: purpose.)

+ clause	although · though · even though · whereas · while · because · since · as · so · so + adj / adv + that · such + (a / an) + noun + that	Although he had trained for months, he didn't finish the race.
+ noun / -ing	despite · in spite of · because of · due to · owing to	Despite the heavy rain, the concert went ahead. · In spite of being tired, she finished.
the bridge	despite / in spite of + the fact that + clause	Despite the fact that it was raining, we went out.
new sentence	However, · Nevertheless, · On the other hand, · Therefore, · Consequently, · As a result, (after a period or a semicolon)	Sales fell sharply; therefore, the launch was postponed.
purpose	so as to / in order to + base verb	She left early in order to catch the train.

Pronunciation. In speech, a sentence connector is its own small chunk with a pause after it: "It was expensive. | **However**, | we bought it." Stress: al**THOUGH**, de**SPITE**, how**EVER**, **THERE**fore, **CON**sequently, **WHERE**as. *Though* at the end of a sentence is light and falling: "We bought it, **though** ↘." *Due to* /'du tə/ (American) — accept /'dju:/. In *so...that* and *such...that*, the stress goes on *so* / *such* and the adjective, and *that* is weak /ðət/: "It was **SO COLD** that we stayed in." Teach the "pivot" intonation for the mini-talk: a fall at the end of side 1, a pause, then a fresh, higher start on the contrast linker.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Although → despite** (T gives a clause, S gives the noun version): T: "Although it was raining..." → S: "Despite the rain..." T: "Although she was tired..." → S: "Despite being tired... / Despite her tiredness..." T: "Although the tickets were expensive..." → S: "Despite the expensive tickets... / Despite the price of the tickets..."
- 2 Because → because of / due to**: T: "because the traffic was bad" → S: "because of the bad traffic." T: "because it was foggy" → S: "due to the fog." T: "because the rent is high" → S: "because of the high rent."
- 3 But → However** (two sentences, say the pause): T: "It's cheap, but it's far." → S: "It's cheap. | However, it's far."
- 4 So or such?** T: "cold" → S: "so cold that..." T: "a cold day" → S: "such a cold day that..." T: "friendly people" → S: "such friendly people that..." T: "quickly" → S: "so quickly that..."

- 5 **Chain the argument** (open pairs → closed pairs): S1 says a plain fact ("Online shopping is convenient."); S2 adds a contrast ("...whereas shopping in person is more fun."); S3 adds a cause ("...because you can touch things."); S4 adds a result ("...so I still go to the market."). Then all trios, 1 minute.

◆ THE ARGUMENT BUILDER – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Groups of 3**, one kit per group (Set C). Each kit has a **topic card** (e.g., *Working from home is better than working in an office.*), **6 point cards** (3 FOR, 3 AGAINST, written as short notes, not sentences: "no commute → more free time"), **12 linker play cards** and a **listener tally**.
- ◆ **Round 1 — assigned sides**. A takes the three FOR cards, B the three AGAINST cards. Each speaker holds 4 linker cards (dealt at random). When a speaker uses a linker *with the right grammar after it*, they put the card down. C (the listener) says "✓" or "Check the grammar!" and ticks the tally. Most cards played wins a point, but **C's verdict** ("...convinced me more, because...") is the real prize.
- ◆ **Round 2 — the balanced mini-talk**. Draw a new topic. Each learner plans for 1 minute with the point cards, then speaks for up to 2 minutes following the shape on slide 8: **hook → side 1 → pivot (contrast linker) → side 2 → balanced conclusion** (with a result linker). Listeners tally linkers and write one "best sentence" they heard.
- ◆ **Assigned sides make it safe**. Nobody argues their real opinion in Round 1, and the Round 2 talk is balanced by design. Topics are everyday trade-offs only (work, city and country, phones, shopping, school, transportation).
- ◆ **Dominant speakers** get the listener role first: they have to stay quiet for two minutes and judge fairly. Quieter learners speak second in Round 1 (they hear a model first).
- ◆ Walk around with a notepad. Write down 2 sentences to fix and 2 to upgrade for the feedback stage. Don't correct during the talks.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE ARGUMENT BUILDER

SAY: Round 1: Do you give your real opinion? (No, you argue your side's cards.) · When do you put a linker card down? (When I use it with the right grammar.) · What does the listener do? (Checks the grammar, ticks the tally, gives a verdict.) · Round 2: How long is the talk? (Up to two minutes.) · How many sides? (Both.) · Where does the contrast linker go? (In the middle: the pivot.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with **one linker from each column** only: *although* (+ clause), *because of* (+ noun), *However*, (new sentence), plus *so*. Give a **sentence frame strip**: "Although ____, ____. · ____ because of ____. · _____. However, ____. · ____, so ____." The point cards have an arrow picture ("no commute → free time"), so learners can speak from the picture. In the Argument Builder, the learner is the listener in Round 1 (they hear two models) and gives a one-minute talk in Round 2 with the frame strip. Target: 4 linked sentences with the right grammar.

STRETCH

No linker twice in one talk. Use the more formal set (*nevertheless*, *owing to*, *consequently*, *whereas*) in Round 2 and the informal set (*though* at the end, *that's why*, *so*) in Round 1, and notice the difference in tone. Use *despite* / *in spite of* + -ing and + *the fact that* in the same talk. In Workbook Ex 3, write each answer two ways. For homework, write the Round 2 talk as a 120-word paragraph with correct connector punctuation.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"Although..., but..." and "Because..., so..."**: Chinese (*suīrán... dànshì, yīnwèi... suǒyǐ*), Vietnamese (*tuy... nhưng*), Korean, Thai and Indonesian speakers often use both halves of a pair. In English, one linker is enough: *Although it was cheap, ~~but~~ I didn't buy it.*
- ◆ **"Despite of"**: Spanish *a pesar de*, Portuguese *apesar de* and Italian *nonostante* + the English *in spite of* mix into "despite of." Say: "*in spite of*, but *despite* alone."
- ◆ **"Despite + clause"**: learners whose L1 linker takes a full clause (French *bien que*, Spanish *aunque*, Arabic *raghma anna*) put one after *despite*. Point at the middle column every time.
- ◆ **"However" as a clause linker / comma splice**: Spanish *sin embargo*, Portuguese *no entanto* and many other L1s allow "..., however, ..." joining two clauses with commas. In writing, *however* needs a period or semicolon before it.
- ◆ **"so a good movie" / "such good"**: Spanish *tan*, French *si / tellement*, Portuguese *tão* and Russian *takoy / tak* map onto *so* and *such* differently. The quick test: a noun follows → *such*.
- ◆ **Long "and" chains**: Arabic (*wa*) and Tagalog (*at*) storytelling style links many clauses with "and." Praise the fluency, then offer one upgrade: "and" → *whereas / so / as a result*.
- ◆ **"since" = time or reason?** German *seit*, Spanish *desde* and French *depuis* are time only. Show both: "*Since 2020...*" (time) · "*Since you're here, let's start.*" (reason).

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_10.html. Listen to the model sentences with 📻 and say them back; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Record your Round 2 mini-talk on your phone (or a new topic) and listen back: did *despite* take a noun? Did *however* start a new sentence?

Workbook 4.1: finish the Argument Builder planner, "My new words" and the journal (a short opinion paragraph with one contrast, one cause and one result linker, each labeled clause / noun / new sentence).

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** Despite the delay, we caught the train. · Q2 **C** such an ... that · Q3 (new) **A** The shop was losing money; therefore, it closed. Mini-talk (Ex 1, Script 4.1-B): 1 because (Ca) · 2 since (Ca) · 3 However (C) · 4 so (R, *so high that*) · 5 whereas (C) · 6 Despite (C) · 7 due to (Ca) · 8 such (R, *such a peaceful place that*) · 9 Even though (C) · 10 Therefore (R).

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ spotlight a person, thing, time or place with an *it*-cleft (*It was Maria who booked it.* · *It was on Monday that I called.*), especially to correct a wrong assumption
- ◆ build up to a key idea with a *what*-cleft (*What I need is a vacation.* · *What he did was (to) apologize.*)
- ◆ use other cleft frames: *The thing (that)... is* · *The reason (why)... is* · *The place where... is* · *All (that) I want is...*
- ◆ use negative inversion with question word order after the triggers the lesson teaches (*Never, Not only, No sooner...than, Hardly / Scarcely...when, Rarely / Seldom, Little, Only then / Only after*), and know that it is formal and dramatic
- ◆ give a 60–90 second emphatic opinion with at least two clefts and, optionally, one inversion

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.2 (New phrases, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Make It Emphatic planner)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Emphasis-frame flashcards (Set A) · **Plain → Dramatic** cards (Set D, 1 set per pair) · **Set the Record Straight** A/B cards (Set E, 1 pair per pair) · **Emphatic-opinion prompts** (Set F) · Linker sort cards from C10 (warmer)
- ◆ Listening scripts 4.2-A (The team lunch) and 4.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the plain sentence *John broke the window yesterday.* and three spotlights: **It was John who** broke the window yesterday. (...not Sam) · **It was the window that** John broke. (...not the door) · **It was yesterday that** John broke the window. (...not last week). Frame: **It + be + [SPOTLIGHT] + who / that + the rest.**

Center: the build-up: **What I need is** → a vacation. · **What annoys me is** → the noise. · **What he did was** → (to) apologize. Cousins: *The thing that... is* · *The reason... is* · *The place where... is* · *All I want is...*
 Arrow: "the important part comes LAST."

Right: the flip: I have never seen such a mess. → **Never have I** seen such a mess. Trigger + **auxiliary + subject** (question order!) · no auxiliary? add **do / does / did**: Rarely **does** she complain. Partners: No sooner... **than** · Hardly... **when**. Label: ⚠ formal / dramatic: use like a spice.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Linker tennis	8	S-S	Review C10. Pairs, one set of linker sort cards (Set B) face down. A says a clause ("I love my job"); B turns a linker card and must continue with the right grammar ("...even though the pay is low" / "Despite the low pay..."). Then swap. 1 point per correct return. Listen for <i>despite</i> + <i>clause</i> and <i>however</i> without a new sentence; save one for feedback.
Lead-in: "So you booked the hotel?"	5	T-S	Act out a mistake: "So, Ana, I heard you broke the printer yesterday!" Ana (primed, or you play both roles): "No! It was Luis who broke it!" Write the reply. "Why not just say 'Luis broke it'?" Elicit: it corrects the wrong idea and puts a spotlight on <i>Luis</i> . Slide 9.
<i>It</i> -clefts	10	T-S	Slide 9. The John / window / yesterday board. Meaning (spotlight + implied contrast), form (<i>It</i> + <i>be</i> + <i>X</i> + <i>who</i> / <i>that</i> ; <i>be</i> matches the time: <i>It is...</i> / <i>It was...</i>), and the key pronunciation point: the spotlight word carries the main stress. CCQs.
<i>What</i> -clefts & other frames	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 10. <i>What</i> + clause + <i>be</i> + key idea; the "save the best for last" idea; actions with <i>What he did was (to)</i> + <i>verb</i> ; the cousins <i>The thing that...</i> , <i>The reason...</i> , <i>All I want...</i> CCQs. Quick pairs: A says a plain complaint ("The noise annoys me."), B says it as a <i>what</i> -cleft and then as a frame.
Drill: spotlight it	6	T-S → S	See Drill script: moving spotlight, <i>what</i> -cleft build-up, stress. Choral, then individual.
Negative inversion	12	T-S → S	Slide 11. Start from a question: "Have I ever seen such a mess?" → "Never have I seen such a mess." Present the trigger table (the lesson's list only), the partner words (<i>No sooner...than</i> , <i>Hardly...when</i>), past perfect for the earlier action, and <i>do</i> / <i>does</i> / <i>did</i> when there's no auxiliary. Register warning: formal, dramatic, for speeches, stories and a strong close. Drill steps 4-5.
Listening: The team lunch	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 4.2-A twice. First listen: "Who really organized the lunch?" (Tomás.) Second listen: answer the five questions and write down the three inversions. Pairs compare.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	9	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2-5 (it-clefts, what-clefts and frames, inversion rewrites, find the error). Pairs check. Board-check the inversions: learners read their sentence as a question first, then as the inversion.
Freer: Make It Emphatic	14	S-S → S-S (trios)	Slides 12-13. Part 1 • Set the Record Straight (5 min): pairs with A/B cards (Set E). A states the wrong "facts" ("So Sam organized the party, right?"); B corrects each one with an <i>it</i> -cleft and adds the truth ("Actually, it was Nadia who organized it. What Sam did was bring the music."). Swap cards. Part 2 • Plain → Dramatic + emphatic opinion (9 min): each learner draws a Plain → Dramatic card (Set D) and rewrites it aloud two ways; then, in trios, each learner gives a 60-90 second emphatic opinion on a Set F prompt with at least two clefts and one optional inversion as a strong close. Listeners raise a hand silently when they hear a cleft and say which one they liked best at the end.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed error correction: 2 fixes ("Never I have seen..." · "No sooner we had arrived when..." · "What I need it is a rest.") and 2 upgrades (a plain sentence you heard → a cleft). Ask: "Which inversion today sounded natural, and which sounded like a movie trailer?" Praise the best emphatic close.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 4.2, the journal prompt (one true sentence, four versions), and prepare for C12 : choose a presentation topic card (Set G, on the side table) or think of one. "Next class you'll give a short talk and then discuss. It's the review for Modules 1-4."
Total	90		8 + 5 + 10 + 10 + 6 + 12 + 6 + 9 + 14 + 5 + 5

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the *it*-cleft spotlights one element and suggests a contrast.

SAY: "It was Maria who booked the hotel." Who booked it? (Maria.) Did the listener think someone else booked it? (Probably, yes: maybe me.) · "It was on Friday that she sent the report." What's the important information? (Friday.) What might the listener have thought? (Another day, like Thursday.)

SAY: "It is her decision that matters." Is this about the past? (No, now: is.) · "It was the noise that woke me." Why that, not who? (The noise is a thing.) · "It was my sister who / that paid." Both OK? (Yes: for people, who or that.)

Meaning: the *what*-cleft delays the key idea to the end, where English puts its weight.

SAY: "What I need is a vacation." What's the most important word? (vacation.) Where is it? (At the end.) · "What he did was ignore me." Is the focus a thing or an action? (An action: ignoring.) Can I say "What he did was to ignore me"? (Yes, both are fine.) · "All I want is a quiet weekend." Do I want a lot? (No: only that; nothing more.)

Meaning: negative inversion = drama and formality.

SAY: "Never have I seen such a mess." Is it a question? (No.) Why does it look like one? (After Never at the start, we use question word order.) Would you say this to a friend about their kitchen? (Only as a joke: it's dramatic.) Where is it natural? (Speeches, stories, formal writing, a strong ending.)

SAY: "No sooner had we sat down than the alarm went off." Which happened first? (We sat down.) How long between them? (Almost no time.) Why had sat? (Past perfect for the earlier action.) Can I say "... when the alarm went off"? (No: No sooner... than; Hardly... when.) · "Little did they know what was coming." Did they know? (No, not at all.)

it-cleft	It + be + spotlight + who / that + rest	It was your support that got me through the hardest weeks.
what-cleft	What + clause + be + key idea	What I really need right now is a proper night's sleep .
action	What + subject + did + was (to) + base verb	What she did was (to) call the manager.
frames	The thing (that)... is · The reason (why)... is · The place where... is · All (that)... is	The thing that annoys me most is being interrupted.
inversion	trigger + auxiliary + subject + main verb (add do / does / did if needed)	Not only did she apologize, but she also offered to fix it.
partners	No sooner + had + subject + p.p. ... than · Hardly / Scarcely + had ... when	Hardly had I arrived when it began to rain.

Pronunciation. Clefts only work if the **stress lands on the spotlight**: "It was **MA**ria who booked it" (low, quick "who booked it" after the peak). In *what*-clefts, the first part rises and hangs, then there's a small pause and the key idea falls: "What I **need** ↗ | is a va**CA**tion ↘." In inversions, stress the trigger and the main verb, and keep the auxiliary weak: "**NE**ver have I **SE**EN such a mess." *Not only* takes a strong stress on **only**, and *but also* is said as one chunk. Model a slightly slower, deliberate pace: emphasis is partly about timing.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Moving spotlight** (hold up the sentence strip *My colleague sent the report on Friday*; point at one part):
T points at *my colleague* → S: "It was my colleague who sent the report on Friday." T points at *the report* → S: "It was the report that my colleague sent on Friday." T points at *on Friday* → S: "It was on Friday that my colleague sent the report." Stress the spotlight.
- 2 **Correct me:** T makes a wrong statement; S corrects with a cleft. T: "You broke the vase!" → S: "No, it was the cat that broke it." T: "You called on Tuesday." → S: "No, it was on Monday that I called."
- 3 **Build it up** (*what*-clefts): T: "I need a vacation." → S: "What I need is a vacation." T: "The traffic frustrates me." → S: "What frustrates me is the traffic." T: "He just apologized." → S: "What he did was apologize." Say the rise-pause-fall together.
- 4 **Question first, then flip:** T: "I have never eaten such good food." → S (question): "Have I ever eaten...?" → S: "Never have I eaten such good food." T: "She rarely complains." → S: "Does she complain?" → "Rarely does she complain."
- 5 **Two-part triggers:** T: "She won. She also broke the record." → S: "Not only did she win, but she also broke the record." T: "We had just sat down. Then the alarm went off." → S: "No sooner had we sat down than the alarm went off." Then open pairs with the Plain → Dramatic cards, 1 minute.

◆ MAKE IT EMPHATIC – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Part 1 • Set the Record Straight.** Pairs get matching A/B cards (Set E). A reads three wrong "facts" as questions with a confident face ("So Sam organized the party, right?"). B looks at the true facts and corrects each one with an *it*-cleft, then adds a *what*-cleft about what really happened ("Actually, it was Nadia who organized it. What Sam did was bring the music."). Swap to the second pair of cards. The scenarios are invented office, neighborhood and family-trip situations; nobody talks about their real life.
- ◆ **Part 2 • Plain → Dramatic.** Each learner draws a card with a plain sentence and a hint (e.g., "*We had just arrived when the power went out.*" → *No sooner...*). They say two versions aloud: the one on the hint, and a cleft of their choice. The partner says "✓" or "Try the question first."
- ◆ **Part 2 • The emphatic opinion.** Trios. Each learner takes a Set F prompt (e.g., *Something about public transportation that should change*) or their own everyday topic, plans for 1 minute, and speaks for 60–90 seconds: open with a frame ("The thing that really bothers me is..."), give a reason, correct a common view with an *it*-cleft ("People think it's the price, but it's the waiting that..."), and close with a *what*-cleft or one inversion ("Never have I...").
- ◆ **Keep inversion honest.** One inversion per talk is plenty. If a learner stacks three, praise the control and ask: "Which one is the strongest? Keep that one." That is a real B2/C1 skill: choosing.

◆ ICQS BEFORE MAKE IT EMPHATIC

SAY: Part 1: Who has the true facts, A or B? (B.) What structure does B use to correct? (It was... who / that...) · Part 2: How many versions do you say for each card? (Two.) · How long is the opinion? (60 to 90

seconds.) · How many inversions must you use? (Zero or one: it's optional.) · What do listeners do when they hear a cleft? (Raise a hand, silently.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on **two frames**: "It was ___ **who** / **that** ___." and "**What I need / want / like** is ___." plus one inversion chunk learned by heart: "**Never have I** seen...". Give a frame strip and color the spotlight part. In Set the Record Straight, the learner plays B with the facts already written as clefts on the back of the card (read, then say without looking). Target: three correct *it*-clefts and one *what*-cleft, spoken with stress on the spotlight.

STRETCH

Use the rarer triggers the lesson teaches, correctly and sparingly: *Seldom...*, *Scarcely... when*, *Little did...*, *Only after...did*. Rewrite one Plain → Dramatic card in **three** ways and explain the difference in focus. In the emphatic opinion, use *The reason... is that...*, an *it*-cleft that corrects a common view, and *All I'm asking is....* Write the talk as a short speech for homework and mark where your voice goes up and pauses.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ "**Never I have seen...**": in Spanish (*Nunca he visto*), Portuguese, Italian and Arabic the subject can disappear or stay after the adverb without inversion, so learners keep statement order. Always go through the question first: "Have I ever seen...? → Never have I seen..."
- ◆ **Over-inversion from German / Dutch** (verb-second rule): learners may invert after any fronted adverb ("Yesterday went I...", "Often do I go..."). English inverts only after the negative / limiting triggers.
- ◆ **Topic-fronting instead of a cleft**: Chinese, Japanese, Korean and Vietnamese speakers often front the topic ("The window, John broke it."). Accept it in speech and show the English cleft.
- ◆ "**What I need it is...**" (an extra pronoun): Arabic, Persian and some Romance-language speakers repeat the subject. Rule: no *it* between the *what*-clause and *is*.
- ◆ **Tense of *be* in the cleft**: French *c'est... qui* and Spanish *es... quien* are often present even about the past, giving "It is John who broke it yesterday." Match *be* to the time: *It was*.
- ◆ "**No sooner... when**" / "**Hardly... than**": many learners from all L1s swap the partner words. Teach them as fixed pairs on one card each.
- ◆ **Stress**: speakers of syllable-timed languages (Spanish, French, Tagalog, Turkish, Cantonese) may give every word the same weight, which flattens the cleft. Exaggerate the peak in the drill and let learners overdo it at first.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_11.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and copy the stress; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 4.2: finish the Make It Emphatic

planner, "My new words" and the journal (one true, plain sentence from your week, rewritten four ways: an *it*-cleft on the person, an *it*-cleft on the time, a *what*-cleft and an inversion). **For C12:** choose a presentation topic (from the Set G cards or your own everyday topic) and jot down three points.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** It was the cat that broke the vase. · Q2 **B** Never have I felt so proud. · Q3 (new) **A** What I need is a quiet weekend. The team lunch (Ex 1, Script 4.2-A): 1 Tomás · 2 on Monday · 3 the service · 4 the price · 5 Never have I seen... · Not only was it... · No sooner had I sat down than....

A TASK-BASED REVIEW, NOT A NEW-GRAMMAR CLASS

There is no new grammar today. The new language is **functional**: signposting a talk, building a case, and the discussion moves (**concede, then counter**; persuade; hedge). The class is built around two real tasks: a **two-minute signposted presentation** given to a small group, followed by questions, and a **small-group discussion** in which learners argue **assigned sides**. Learners plan, rehearse, then perform while you listen with the **speaking checklist** (Set H). Language work comes *from* the tasks: a short focus-on-form "clinic" between them, not a presentation. The checklist results feed C13 (Progress Test 1): they are your spoken evidence for Modules 1–4, and they tell you who goes to which catch-up station.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ structure a short presentation: open and state the topic, preview the structure, move between points, conclude (*I'd like to talk about... · I'll cover three points... · Moving on to... · To sum up...*)
- ◆ build a case with reasons, ranking, balance, evidence and hedging (*One key advantage is... · On the one hand... on the other hand... · The evidence suggests... · It could be argued that... · arguably*)
- ◆ answer a challenge by **conceding, then countering** (*That's a fair point, but... · I take your point; however,... · Granted, but we shouldn't forget that...*)
- ◆ take part in a 12-minute group discussion from an assigned side, responding to the previous speaker and inviting others
- ◆ use a range of B2 structures from Modules 1–4 in extended, fluent speech

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 4.3 (phrase banks, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, the **talk planner**, the **discussion card**, the Module 4 "I can" checklist)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · **Review Race** board game (Set I) + dice + counters · **Presentation topic cards, side cards, persona cards, talking tokens** (Set G) · **Speaking checklist**: one class grid + score slips (Set H) · a phone timer per group
- ◆ Listening script 4.3-A (the model presentation and discussion: the four-day week) · optional: phones for recording

BOARD PLAN

Left: the talk map: ① **OPEN** I'd like to talk about... / I'd like to argue that... → ② **PREVIEW** I'll cover three points... → ③ **POINTS** Firstly... · Moving on to... · Turning now to... · Finally... (each point = claim + reason + example / evidence) → ④ **CLOSE** To sum up... / So, to bring it all together...

Center: 🙏 **concede** → **counter**: That's a fair point, but... · I take your point; however,... · You're right to an extent, though... · Granted, but we shouldn't forget that... 🎯 **persuade** (save for your best point): The fact is... · What we can't ignore is... · The bottom line is... 🛡️ **hedge**: arguably · to some extent · It seems to me that... · up to a point

Right: the B2 toolkit, one line per module: **M1** had done / had been doing · If I had..., I would have... / would now... · I wish I had... **M2** can't afford to... / stop -ing · must have / can't have · be used to -ing **M3** It is widely believed that... · Having considered... · Critics have argued that... **M4** Despite this, ... · Consequently, ... · What really matters is... · Not only... but also...

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Review Race	10	S-S (groups of 3-4)	Review C1-C11 with the Review Race board game (Set I). Roll, move, answer the square in full sentences. The group says "Good!" or helps. Stop after 10 minutes; the player nearest the finish wins. Walk around and note which squares (which modules) are hard: early evidence for C13.
Presenting & discussion language	12	T-S → S-S	Slides 14-15. Elicit "how a good talk sounds." Present the talk map (signposts) and the concede → counter / persuade / hedge banks. CCQs. Drill with intonation (see notes). Quick pairs: T reads a claim ("Cash will disappear in ten years."); A concedes and counters, B hedges. Swap. Workbook Ex 1 fast.
Model: listen	7	T-S	Read Script 4.3-A twice (the presentation, then the two questions; ask a confident learner to read Dana and Leo). First listen: "What's the proposal? How many points? What objection comes up?" Second listen: Workbook Ex 2: number the signposts in order and tick the B2 structures you hear.
Plan the talk	10	S	Slide 16. Learners fill the talk planner (Workbook 4.3): notes, not a script . A topic from the Set G cards (drawn or chosen) or their own everyday topic from the C11 homework. Each point = claim + reason +

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			example. Plus two likely objections and a concede-and-counter answer to each. Check that each planner has at least one M1–M3 structure and one M4 linker or cleft. Early finishers rehearse under their breath with a timer.
Presentation circles + checklist	16	S–S (groups of 4) • T–S	Groups of 4. Each speaker presents for up to 2 minutes (planner turned over; a quick look is OK), then takes 1–2 questions or objections (1 minute) and answers by conceding and countering. Listeners each ask or challenge using a question starter (Set G). A timekeeper in each group. You sit with one group at a time and score criteria 1, 2 and 5 of the speaking checklist.
Focus-on-form clinic	5	T–S	Write 4 sentences you heard (no names): 2 to fix, 2 to upgrade (e.g., "It is believe that..." • "Not only it saves money..." → fix; "Cars are bad. Also they are expensive." → <i>Not only are cars bad for the air, but they're also expensive.</i> → upgrade). Learners fix them in pairs, then we check. Keep it short and positive.
Discussion prep	5	S (then S–S)	Slide 17. New groups of 4. Each group takes one discussion question (from the presentation topic cards). Deal the side cards face down: For, Against, Devil's advocate (argues whichever side is losing) and Chair (manages turns, speaks too, sums up). Optional persona cards. Each learner fills the discussion card in the workbook: 2 points for their side + 1 concession they're ready to make.
Group discussion + checklist	15	S–S (groups) • T–S	Round 1 (4 min, fixed order): each speaker opens their side in 45 seconds. Round 2 (8 min, open, talking tokens): every turn starts by responding to the last speaker (concede, then counter). Round 3 (2 min): the chair

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			sums up both sides fairly: "On the one hand... on the other hand... Most of us felt...". You sit with one group at a time and score criteria 3 and 4 (and finish 1, 2 and 5 for learners you didn't hear in the presentations).
Feedback + module wrap	5	T-S	Content first: "Who changed your mind, even a little? Which argument was the strongest?" Then 2-3 sentences from your checklist notes, no names. Learners tick the Module 4 "I can..." lists. Celebrate: halfway through B2.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 4.3; record the full 3-4 minute version of your talk at home; the journal. Tell learners plainly about C13: "Next class is a friendly check of Modules 1-4. It helps me help you." Hand out score slips in C13, not today.
Total	90		10 + 12 + 7 + 10 + 16 + 5 + 5 + 15 + 5 + 5

HEARING EVERYONE

In 31 minutes of tasks you can score about 8-10 learners well. Choose one of these for the rest, and tell the class which one before the presentations: **(a)** learners record their presentation on a phone during the circles and play it for you during the C13 catch-up time; **(b)** the rest present to you in the C13 catch-up stations; **(c)** in a large class, score the presentations in C12 and the discussion skills in C13 (a 5-minute three-person discussion at your station). Anyone who prefers to present only to you, not a group, may do so. That is a normal choice, not a problem.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION (REVIEW FOCUS)

Meaning: signposts are a map for the listener (and for you).

SAY: "I'll cover three points: the cost, the benefits and one objection." What does the listener know now? (How many parts, and what they are.) Who else does it help? (The speaker: it's a plan.) · "Moving on to..." Is the speaker starting, changing or finishing? (Changing to the next point.) · "To sum up..." How much longer will the talk be? (Very little: it's the end.)

Meaning: concede, then counter.

SAY: "That's a fair point, but the evidence suggests they still emit less overall." Does the speaker agree completely? (No.) Do they agree at all? (Yes, partly.) Why start with "That's a fair point"? (It shows they listened; it keeps it polite; it makes their own view sound reasonable.) · "No, you're wrong." Same effect? (No: it sounds combative, and the discussion stops.)

SAY: "Arguably, the office is still important." How sure is the speaker? (Quite sure, but not claiming it's a fact.) Is hedging weak? (No, in formal English it sounds careful and credible.) · "The bottom line is, a rested team costs less." Hedge or persuade? (Persuade: their strongest point.) How often should you use it? (Once or twice, or it loses force.)

Form: the review table.

Signpost	I'd like to talk about... · Today I'll cover three points... · Let me start by... · Firstly, · Moving on to... · Turning now to... · This brings me to... · Finally, · To sum up, · In conclusion,	Let me start by looking at the cost.
Build a case	There are several reasons for this. · One key advantage is... · A further point is that... · The evidence suggests... · It could be argued that... · The main drawback is...	Perhaps the most important factor is time.
Concede → counter	That's a fair point, but... · I take your point; however,... · You're right to an extent, though... · I see where you're coming from, yet... · Granted, but we shouldn't forget that... · There's some truth in that; even so,...	Granted, but we shouldn't forget the cost of overtime.
Persuade / hedge	Surely you'd agree that... · The fact is,... · What we can't ignore is... · The bottom line is... / It seems to me that... · to some extent · arguably · up to a point · as far as I can tell	What we can't ignore is how tired people are.
Module 1	narrative tenses · third and mixed conditionals · <i>wish / if only / would rather / it's time</i>	If we had started sooner, we wouldn't be so far behind now.
Module 2	gerunds & infinitives · past deduction (<i>must / might / can't have</i>) · <i>used to / be used to / get used to</i>	People are used to working from home now.
Module 3	advanced & impersonal passive · relative & participle clauses · reporting verbs	It is widely believed that... · Having looked at the data, I... · Critics have argued that...
Module 4	contrast / cause / result linkers · clefts · negative inversion	Despite this, support has grown. · What really matters is the long term.

Pronunciation. Signposts are chunks followed by a clear pause: "**M**oving on to | the **cost**." Slow down for the preview and the conclusion; speed up a little in the examples. The concede-and-counter move has two tunes: a warm, falling "That's a **fair** point ↘" and then a fresh, higher start on "**but**..." / "however...". Hedges are said lightly and quickly ("*arguably*" /'ɑrgjuəbli/), the persuade phrases slowly and with weight ("The **BOT**tom line **IS**..."). Remind learners of C11: the spotlight word in a cleft carries the stress.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Signpost chain:** T: "Topic: city bikes." → S1: "I'd like to talk about city bikes." → S2: "I'll cover three points: ..." → S3: "Firstly, ..." → S4: "Moving on to..." → S5: "To sum up, ..." Round the room; say the pause after each signpost.
- 2 **Concede → counter:** T reads a claim ("Online classes are just as good as real ones."); learners answer only with the frame and one reason: "That's a fair point, but you can't practice speaking as much." Rotate the frames: *I take your point; however...* · *Granted, but...* · *You're right to an extent, though...*
- 3 **Hedge it / push it:** T: "Cars are the main problem in cities." → S (hedge): "Arguably, cars are one of the main problems." → S (persuade): "The fact is, cars are the main problem."
- 4 **Upgrade with a module:** T says a plain sentence and names a module; S upgrades it. T: "People think the plan is too expensive. M3." → S: "It is widely believed that the plan is too expensive." T: "We didn't plan, so we're late now. M1." → S: "If we had planned, we wouldn't be late now." T: "This matters: the long term. M4." → S: "What really matters is the long term."

◆ PRESENTATIONS AND THE DISCUSSION – HOW TO RUN THEM

- ◆ **Two minutes, not four.** The online project asks for 3–4 minutes; in class, two minutes per speaker keeps the circles moving and still shows structure. The full version is homework (a phone recording).
- ◆ **Topics.** Presentation topics are everyday proposals and trade-offs (the four-day week, phones at the dinner table, cashless shops, homework for children, self-checkout machines, learning online vs in person). A learner's own topic is welcome if it stays everyday. The presenter may argue either side of their topic; the **side** they choose is not their personal opinion unless they want it to be.
- ◆ **Questions after each talk.** Every listener has a question starter (Set G: "What about people who...?" · "Isn't there a risk that...?" · "How would that work for...?"). The presenter answers at least one by conceding, then countering. The timekeeper stops the Q&A after one minute, kindly.
- ◆ **Side cards make it safe.** In the discussion, learners argue the **card's** side (they may swap inside the group if a topic feels personal). The **devil's advocate** argues whichever side is losing and speaks third in Round 1. The **chair** keeps time, invites quiet speakers ("Mei, where do you stand on this?"), stops long turns ("Thanks, Pavel. Let's hear the other side.") and sums up fairly. Give the chair card to a dominant speaker: the job needs listening.
- ◆ **Talking tokens** in Round 2: 3 each; put one in the middle every time you speak. No tokens left? Listen until everyone has used theirs, then everyone gets 3 more.

- ◆ **Persona cards** (a night-shift nurse, a café owner, a college student, a parent of three, a retired bus driver, a delivery driver) give learners a point of view that isn't theirs: "As a café owner, I'd have to say...". Great for quieter learners and for anyone who doesn't want to speak for themselves.
- ◆ If a group gets heated, the chair (or you) says: "Great energy. Let's hear one reason from each side and sum up." Push the idea, never the person.

◆ THE SPEAKING CHECKLIST – HOW TO SCORE IT (FEEDS C13)

Five criteria, 0–3 points each, /15: 0 = no response · 1 = not yet B2 · 2 = B2 · 3 = strong B2 (moving toward C1). Score the **whole performance** across the presentation, the Q&A and the discussion. Tick the **module boxes** (M1–M4) when you hear a structure from that module used correctly. The full grid and descriptors are in the classroom materials (Set H).

Criterion	What 3 points sounds like
1 · Task & organization	Presentation: clear opening and preview, 2–3 points each with a reason and an example or evidence, a real conclusion; signposts guide the listener. Discussion: contributions are relevant and developed, not one-liners.
2 · Range (Modules 1–4)	Structures from at least 3 of the 4 modules, used naturally and without prompting; varied linkers; at least one well-placed cleft or inversion.
3 · Accuracy	Good control of the B2 grammar; errors are occasional, rarely cause misunderstanding, and are often self-corrected.
4 · Interaction & discussion moves	Concedes before countering; hedges claims appropriately; responds directly to the previous speaker; invites others; answers challenges calmly.
5 · Fluency & pronunciation	Keeps going at an even pace with natural pauses at signposts; stress highlights key and contrasting information; easy to follow throughout.

Feeding C13. Record each learner's scores and module ticks on the class grid. In C13, send learners to a **catch-up station** for any module with no tick and to the station for their lowest criterion: **no M1 tick** → narrative & hypotheticals station (past perfect, third / mixed conditionals, *wish*); **no M2 tick** → verb patterns & modality station (gerund / infinitive, *must have / can't have, be / get used to*); **no M3 tick** → passive, clauses & reporting station; **no M4 tick** → linkers & emphasis station (Sets B and D of this pack); **criterion 4 ≤ 1** → discussion-moves station (Workbook 4.3 Ex 1 and 5, a 3-minute concede-and-counter round); **criterion 5 ≤ 1** → shadowing station (the 🗣️ model sentences of lessons 4.1–4.3). If Progress Test 1 has its own speaking task, keep this grid anyway: it is your evidence of extended speaking for Modules 1–4, and it lets you give each learner one kind, specific next step.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PRESENTATIONS AND THE DISCUSSION

SAY: *Presentations: How long do you speak? (Up to two minutes.) · Can you read your notes? (Only a quick look.) · What do the listeners do? (Ask one question or challenge.) · How do you answer a*

challenge? (Concede, then counter: "That's a fair point, but...") · Do you have to present to the group? (No, you can present only to the teacher.)

SAY: Discussion: Do you argue your real opinion? (No, your side card's.) · What does the devil's advocate do? (Argues the side that's losing.) · What does the chair do? (Keeps time, invites everyone, sums up both sides.) · How do you start each turn in Round 2? (By responding to the last speaker.) · What's a token for? (One turn.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give a **talk strip** with 5 lines: "I'd like to talk about... · I'll make two points. · Firstly, ... because ... · Secondly, ... For example, ... · To sum up, ..." and a **reply strip**: "That's a fair point, but... · I see where you're coming from, yet...". A 60–90 second talk with two points is a complete task. In the discussion, take the For or Against card (not chair or devil's advocate) and speak second in Round 1. Score on the same checklist: a clear, well-signposted short talk can earn full marks on criteria 1 and 5.

STRETCH

Be the chair or the devil's advocate. In the presentation, preview three points, use one structure from **each** module, hedge one claim and use one persuade phrase for your strongest point only. In the Q&A, summarize the challenge before answering ("So your concern is... That's fair. However..."). In the discussion, sum up the other side so fairly that they agree with your summary, then counter it. Homework: the 3–4 minute version with no notes.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ "I am agree" / "Are you agree?" (Spanish *estar de acuerdo*, French *être d'accord*, Portuguese, Italian): still common at B2 under pressure. Drill "I agree. · Do you agree?" once, then leave it for delayed feedback.
- ◆ "We discussed about..." (Spanish *discutir sobre*, Arabic, Russian *obsuzhdat' o*): *discuss* has no preposition. Note that Spanish *discutir* can mean *argue* (have a fight).
- ◆ **False friends in signposts**: "Resuming..." (Spanish *resumiendo*, French *en résumé*) → *To sum up*; "Actually..." meaning "currently" (Spanish *actualmente*, French *actuellement*, German *aktuell*); "Eventually..." meaning "possibly" (Spanish *eventualmente*, French *éventuellement*, German *eventuell*). "At the end" → *Finally* / *In the end*.
- ◆ "make a presentation": fine in American English; also *give a presentation*. Not "do a speech" → *give a speech*.
- ◆ "According to me..." (French *selon moi*, Spanish *según yo*, Indian English): *according to* is for other sources ("according to a recent study"). Offer "As far as I can tell..." or "It seems to me that...".

- ◆ **Directness differs.** Dutch, German, Russian and Hebrew speakers may counter without conceding ("No, this is wrong."); Japanese, Korean, Thai and Filipino speakers may concede without countering, so their view disappears. Teach the English middle path, **concede and then counter**, as a technique, not a personality change. Both styles are normal; English discussion just has its own.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 4.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_12.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Record the full 3–4 minute version of your talk on your phone, plus answers to your two objections, and listen back with the project checklist. Workbook 4.3: the journal (one paragraph of argued English with three B2 structures underlined, then two sentences to the learner you were at the start of this course). Review the Module 1–4 "I can..." lists before C13.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 B "That's a fair point; however, the bigger picture tells a different story." · Q2 C "Not only does it reduce costs, but it also improves safety." · Q3 (new) A "Moving on to my second point, ..." Model presentation (Ex 2a, Script 4.3-A): signposts in order: I'd like to talk about (1) · I'll cover three points (2) · Let me start with (3) · Moving on to (4) · Finally (5) · To sum up (6). Ex 2b structures heard: impersonal passive (*It is widely believed that*), *what*-cleft (*What most people need is*), participle clause (*Having spoken to...*), mixed conditional (*if we had tried... we might already be seeing*), inversion (*Not only would it...*). Not heard: *used to*, *must have*.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C12: MODULE 4 WRAP-UP AND THE HALFWAY POINT

Recap on slide 18: **Although... / Despite... / However, · because of... / due to... · so... that / such... that · Therefore, · It was... who... · What I need is... · Never have I... · I'd like to talk about... · That's a fair point, but...** Learners tick the three "I can..." lists. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Use those notes, the Review Race observations and your speaking checklist to plan the C13 catch-up stations.

Celebrate the halfway point. Learners have finished half of B2. Ask each person to say one thing they can do now that they couldn't do in Week 1, with an emphasis structure if they like ("What I'm proudest of is...", "Never have I talked so much in English!"). Keep it short and warm.

Progress Test 1 (C13) covers Modules 1–4. From this module it can test: the grammar after each linker (*although / despite / because of / due to / however*), *despite the fact that*, *so...that* vs *such...that*, connector punctuation, *it*-clefts and *what*-clefts, the other cleft frames, negative inversion with the lesson's triggers (question word order, *do / does / did*, *No sooner...than / Hardly...when*), and signposting and concede-and-counter phrases. The C12 speaking checklist gives you the spoken evidence.

Watch for in Module 5: the future perfect and future continuous (5.1) bring new auxiliary chains (*will have finished*, *will be working*); learners who have just practiced inversion may over-apply it ("Rarely will have I..."). The causative (5.2) looks like the passive from 3.1 (*have it done* vs *it was done*). Keep a 2-minute "linker tennis" or "spotlight it" warmer in C14–C16: it is quick, and it keeps Module 4 range alive in speech.

Module 5 — Precision Grammar

Three classes about the small choices that make English exact. First, the **future continuous** and **future perfect** place an action precisely on a future timeline: still happening (*This time next year we'll be running evening classes*) or already finished (*By June we'll have painted every classroom*). Second, the **causative** shows exactly who did the work: *I fixed the sink* vs *I had the sink fixed*, plus the "misfortune" meaning and *get someone to / have someone do*. Third, **determiners and quantifiers** say exactly how much of a group you mean: *all / whole, every / each, both / neither / either, most (of), none of*, with correct agreement. The module starts right after Progress Test 1, so C14 opens by handing the tests back in a warm, low-stress way.

3 lessons

Lessons 5.1–5.3

Classes C14–C16

Weeks 7–8

90 min per class

CEFR B2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, mingle) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-5-precision.html](#). Print [materials/module-5/classroom-materials.html](#) before C14. It holds the service picture cards and grammar cards, the project and character cards with the timeline frame, the Errand Week information gap, the Services & Errands role-play cards, the class survey cards with the tally sheet and report frame, the "Precision Path" board game, and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** B1 Lesson 5.3 taught the future continuous (*This time tomorrow I'll be flying*) and time clauses with the present (*when I land*). B1 learners also met *some / any / much / many / a few / a little*. Check what they know in each lead-in and move quickly where they are strong. The new B2 work is the **future perfect** and the **continuous-vs-perfect choice** against one reference point, the **causative** (new for almost everyone), and the **near-neighbor contrasts** in 5.3 (*all / whole, every / each, both / neither / either, most / most of*) with their verb agreement.

- ◆ **Precision is the theme, but fluency still comes first.** In every freer task, listen and take notes; don't stop a speaker to fix *will have* or *every people*. The feedback stage is where you fix errors, without names. Praise the *message* first ("Your timeline was so clear, I could picture opening day"), then the form. At B2, give feedback on **accuracy and range**: one thing to fix, and one "upgrade" (a better word or structure the speaker could have used). Write the upgrades in a separate column on the board ("You said: *a lot of us* → Try: *the majority of us*").
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** All three freer tasks have built-in roles. Use them: the strongest speaker is the **timekeeper** or the "**council member**" who must ask questions (C14), the **service provider** who has to explain problems (C15), or the **data checker** who verifies the tally before the pair reports (C16). Use **talking chips** (3 per learner; you spend one each time you speak) in group discussions. Say it kindly: "Thanks, Omar. Let's hear from someone who hasn't spoken yet."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C1.** Each class has a "Stretch" box with C1-leaning language (the future perfect continuous, *be due to* / *be set to*, the stress contrast in service vs misfortune causatives, *the vast majority of* / *hardly any* / *each and every* / *none of which*). Offer it; don't require it.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use many British forms in this module: *flat*, *film*, *trousers*, *tyres*, *neighbour*, *the underground*, *valeted*, *boiler*, "*sitting an exam*," "*book it in*," "*travelling*," "*timetable*," "*enquiries*," "*recognise*," "*memorise*". Teach *apartment*, *movie*, *pants*, *tires*, *neighbor*, *the subway*, *detailed*, *water heater* / *furnace*, *taking a test*, *make an appointment*, *traveling*, *schedule*, *inquiries*, *recognize*, *memorize*. Accept the British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

When exactly → who exactly → how many exactly. In C14 learners place actions precisely on a future timeline, against one reference point: still happening, or already done? In C15 they say precisely who did the work: me, or someone I paid (or someone I didn't want to)? In C16 they say precisely how much of a group they mean, and make the verb agree. Each class ends with a task where one small grammar choice changes the message: a project timeline presented to a "town council," a service-counter role-play where the customer must be clear about what they need done and by when, and a class survey reported as data.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: FUTURES, MISFORTUNES AND SURVEYS

Futures. For some adults the future is uncertain: a visa or asylum decision, a job search, family far away, health. The online lesson's project and journal ask learners to picture "your life in five years." **In class, don't press personal futures.** The C14 timeline task is about **work and community projects** (a community center, a food co-op, a bike-share launch) or a **fictional character** on a card. The only personal option is small and safe: "this time tomorrow" or "by the end of this week." **Never ask** "Where will you be living next year?", "Will you have gotten your papers by then?" or "When will you see your family?"

Misfortunes. The causative also describes bad things that happen to you (*She had her bag stolen*). Keep every misfortune **light and invented** (a canceled flight, a car towed, a phone screen cracked) and on the cards. **Never ask** "Has anything ever been stolen from you?" Keep "documents" in C15 to a print shop (flyers, copies, photos); don't use immigration, court or benefits paperwork as examples.

Surveys. The C16 survey questions are light on purpose (coffee or tea, bus or bike, mornings or evenings). No questions about age, family, income, home country, religion or health. **"Pass" is a real answer** and gets its own column in the tally. Reports use the group, not names ("Only one of us...", never "Only Ana..."), and anyone can ask to take their answer out. Offer these choices every time, so choosing a card or passing is normal and not a sign that something is wrong.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ **Mark Progress Test 1** before C14. Write a short, positive comment on every paper: one thing they did well + one thing to practice. Collect **4–5 common errors** from different papers for the C14 board (no names). Note which learners scored below about 60% so you can offer a quiet 1:1 chat at the break.
- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (Set A): 12 service picture cards and the grammar cards (future markers, causative patterns, determiners). Card stock helps.
- ◆ For C14: one **project or character card** per group of 3 (Set B) and one **timeline frame** per group. Put the cards in two piles: "projects" and "characters." Groups choose.
- ◆ For C15: one **Errand Week A/B** pair per two learners (Set C) and one set of **Services & Errands role-play cards** (Set D). Cut A and B apart.
- ◆ For C16: one **survey card** and one **tally sheet** per pair (Set E), a **report frame** for anyone who wants it, and the **"Our class in numbers"** poster (enlarge it to A3 / tabloid, or copy it onto the board). One **Precision Path** board (Set F) per group of 3–4, a die or a coin, and a counter for each player (coins, paper clips).
- ◆ Have a phone ready to "play" the voicemails in C14 and C15 (read the script while holding the phone to your ear).

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
5.1	C14 · wk 7	Progress Test 1 return · future continuous <i>will be + -ing</i> (in progress at a future moment; neutral, polite inquiries: <i>Will you be using the car tonight?</i>) · future perfect <i>will have + past participle</i> (finished before a future point) · markers <i>by, by then, by the time</i> (+ present), <i>in + period, this time next...</i> , <i>at + time</i> · <i>by</i> vs <i>until</i>	present a project or character timeline to a group, with at least three things that will be happening and three that will already be done, and answer neutral questions about it
5.2	C15 · wk 8	The causative <i>have / get + object + past participle</i> across tenses and with modals; word order vs the past perfect; <i>have</i> (neutral) vs <i>get</i> (informal, effort); the misfortune meaning; <i>get someone to do, have someone do, have someone doing</i>	arrange everyday services at a counter or on the phone (car, apartment repairs, haircut, printing), say what they did themselves and what they had done, and report a week of errands
5.3	C16 · wk 8	all vs whole · every vs each · both / neither / either (+ <i>and / nor / or</i>) · most, none, all, some with and without <i>of</i> · singular agreement after <i>every, each, neither, either</i> · avoiding <i>every people, all of people, most of teachers, all the day</i>	run a class survey and report the results as data, with a range of quantifiers and correct agreement, and compare two options with <i>both / neither / either</i>

5.1 · C14

Future Perfect & Future Continuous

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ reflect on their Progress Test 1 results and set one personal goal
- ◆ use the **future continuous** (*will be + -ing*) for an action in progress at a future moment: *At ten tomorrow the mayor will be cutting the ribbon.*
- ◆ use the future continuous for **neutral, polite inquiries**: *Will you be coming to the meeting?*
- ◆ use the **future perfect** (*will have + past participle*) for an action finished before a future point: *By June we'll have painted every classroom.*
- ◆ choose between them with *by, by then, by the time* (+ present), *this time next...*, *at + time, in + period*, and not confuse *by* with *until*
- ◆ present a project timeline with three or more of each form and answer questions about it

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Marked Progress Test 1 papers (in folders or face-down) · sticky notes · Workbook "My goal after Progress Test 1" box
- ◆ Workbook 5.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Project Timeline frame)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Future-marker cards (*by, by then, by the time, until, this time next...*, *at + time, in + period*) · **Project & character cards** (1 per group of 3) + **timeline frames**
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.1-A (Lena's project update) and 5.1-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: a long arrow (the future), with **NOW** at the left and a big dot labeled **8 p.m.** A wavy line runs across the dot: "We'll **be eating**." (still at the table). A short solid line ends *before* the dot with a ✓: "We'll **have eaten**." (plates cleared).

Center: **will be + -ing** · I'll be working · Will you be using...? (polite) | **will have + p.p.** · I'll have finished · won't have arrived · Will you have eaten?

Right: markers in two columns: **continuous** ← this time tomorrow / next year · at 10 a.m. · in two hours (landing) **perfect** ← *by* · *by then* · *by the time* + present · in two years (qualified). Under it: **by** = no later than ✓ · ~~until~~ ✗ with the future perfect.

Far right (upgrades column): left empty for feedback.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Welcome & Progress Test 1 return	12	T-S • S-S • S	Slide 3. See "Returning Progress Test 1" below: strengths on the board, papers back privately, pairs fix 4 anonymous errors, each learner writes one goal in the workbook box.
Lead-in: opening day	6	T-S	"Our community center is opening on June 14th. It's March now. Look at the timeline." Draw March → June 14th. Ask: "On June 14th at ten, what will the mayor be doing?" (cutting the ribbon) "And the roof, the painting: will they still be happening on June 14th?" (No, finished.) Elicit or give: "By June 14th, they'll have finished the roof." Get 3–4 learners to repeat both. Don't explain yet.
Future continuous	11	T-S	Slides 4–5. Meaning 1: in progress across a future moment (wavy line). Meaning 2: neutral, polite inquiries (compare "Will you use the car?" and "Will you be using the car?"). Form and contractions. CCQs (below). Recycle B1: "Who remembers <i>This time tomorrow I'll be...</i> ?"
Future perfect + markers	12	T-S	Slide 6. The deadline idea ("finished by when?"), form, <i>by</i> / <i>by then</i> / <i>by the time</i> + present, <i>by</i> vs <i>until</i> . Then the contrast table on slide 4 again: same reference point, two meanings. CCQs. Stick the marker cards on the board in two columns as you go.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Drill	6	T-S → S	See Drill script: the "8 p.m." gesture drill, the contraction drill (<i>I'll have</i> /'aɪləv/), and the "make it polite" drill.
Listening: Lena's project update	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Hold a phone to your ear and read Script 5.1-A twice. Learners complete the gaps. Pairs compare. Ask: "Is Lena worried?" (No, they're ahead of schedule.) This is also the model for the freer task.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone (continuous or perfect, <i>by/ until / by the time</i> , polite inquiries, find the mistake), then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. Early finishers start the Project Timeline frame.
Freer: Project Timeline	17	S-S (groups) → S-S (groups meet)	Slide 8. (1) Groups of 3 choose a project card or a character card and fill in the timeline frame: 4 points (next month · by the time... · this time next year · in five years' time), key words only (6 min). (2) Two groups meet. Group 1 presents its timeline as a "status forecast" to Group 2, who are the town council or the character's friends ; each speaker takes one point on the timeline (3 min). The council must ask at least two neutral questions with <i>Will you be...?</i> or <i>Will you have... by...?</i> (2 min). Swap (5 min). (3) One volunteer per group tells the class their

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			most impressive milestone (1 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed correction: 4 sentences you heard, no names (2 good, 2 with errors), e.g. "By the time the center will open, we'll have hired six teachers." · "We'll have finished the roof until April." · "This time next year we'll have run evening classes." (meaning: in progress) · plus one upgrade ("We'll finish soon" → "We'll have finished by the end of May"). Praise one clear timeline.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 5.1 on screen; point at a  button. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		12 + 6 + 11 + 12 + 6 + 6 + 10 + 17 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

The test return must stay at 12 minutes. Cut Workbook Ex 5 and the dictation (Script 5.1-B) and set them as homework. If time is short in the freer task, groups present to each other without the class round-up. Never cut the presentations: the council's questions are where the polite *Will you be...?* becomes real.

RETURNING PROGRESS TEST 1 (12 MIN) — KEEP IT WARM

1. Celebrate first (3 min). Before any paper comes out, write "**We can...**" on the board and list three things the whole class did well (for example: *tell a story with the past perfect continuous · imagine a different past with the third conditional · report what people said with suggest, deny, admit · add emphasis with What I need is...*). Say it out loud.

SAY: *Four modules of B2! You can tell stories with layers of time, imagine a different past, report exactly how people said things, and argue a point in a discussion. That's upper-intermediate English. Give yourselves a hand.*

2. Return privately (2 min). Hand papers back face-down or in folders. **Never read scores aloud** and never compare learners. Everyone gets a written comment: one strength + one thing to practice.

3. "Let's fix it!" (5 min). Show 4 anonymous errors from the tests. Use your own learners' errors if you can; typical ones at this point: *If I would have known, I would have called you. · I wish I didn't say that yesterday. · She suggested me to apply for the job. · I'm used to get up at five.* (Also common: *She must have forget her keys. · Despite of the rain, we went. · Never I have seen such a mess.*) Pairs fix them. Take answers. Praise the fixing, not the mistake-free papers.

4. One goal (2 min). Each learner writes one goal in the workbook box ("My goal after Progress Test 1"): *"I want to practice _____. Every week I will _____."* Give two examples: "I want to practice the third conditional. Every week I'll write three 'If I had...' sentences about my week." / "I want to speak more in discussions. I'll listen to one English podcast a week and summarize it to a friend."

SAY: *A test is a map. It tells us where we are. It doesn't tell us who we are.*

Some adults carry hard memories of school and tests. Keep your voice light and move on quickly. Offer a **1:1 chat at the break** to anyone who struggled (below about 60%), and plan catch-up with the Module 1–4 online lessons. Don't let the test return grow past 12 minutes. The best encouragement is a good, successful lesson straight after it, and today's grammar is kind: the forms are completely regular, and learners already know *will*, *-ing* and past participles.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: one reference point, two camera angles. Fix a future moment first (a time, a date, an event). Then ask: is the action *still happening* at that moment (continuous), or *already finished* by then (perfect)?

SAY: *"At 8 p.m. we'll be eating dinner." Will we be at the table at 8? (Yes.) Did dinner start before 8? (Yes, probably.) Will it continue after 8? (Yes, probably.) · "At 8 p.m. we'll have eaten." Are we at the table at 8? (No, finished.) Are the plates clean? (Yes, cleared.)*

SAY: *"This time next year Maya will be working at the clinic." Is she working there now? (No, not yet.) Next year, is the job finished or in progress? (In progress.) · "By next June she'll have finished her training." Will she still be training in July? (No, finished before June.)*

Meaning: neutral, polite inquiries. The future continuous asks about someone's *plans*, not for a *decision*, so it sounds softer.

SAY: "Will you use the car tonight?" Could this sound like I want the car? (Yes, a bit.) · "Will you be using the car tonight?" Am I asking for a decision or just asking about your plans? (Just plans: softer.) · Where do you hear "Will you be paying by card?" (Hotels, stores, restaurants.) Is it rude? (No, very polite.)

Meaning: by vs until.

SAY: "I'll have finished by six." Can I finish at five? (Yes: no later than six.) · "I'll be working until six." Do I stop before six? (No, I work all the time up to six.) · "I'll have finished until six." Correct? (No! by.)

SAY: "By the time you arrive, we'll have left." Which happens first: you arrive, or we leave? (We leave.) Why not "you will arrive"? (Time clause: present tense, like when and before.)

Form.

Future continuous	will be + -ing · 'll be · won't be · Will you be...?	This time tomorrow, I'll be flying to Tokyo. · We won't be using the meeting room.
Polite inquiry	Will you be + -ing...? · How long will you be + -ing?	Will you be joining us? · How long will you be staying?
Future perfect	will have + past participle · 'll have · won't have · Will you have...?	By 2030, I'll have finished my degree. · He won't have arrived by six.
by the time	by the time + present , + future perfect	By the time you read this, I'll have left.
Markers	continuous: <i>this time tomorrow / next week, at + time</i> · perfect: <i>by, by then, by the time</i> · either: <i>in + period</i>	In two hours we'll be landing. / In two years she'll have qualified.
Recognize (stretch)	future perfect continuous: will have been + -ing (how long, up to a future point)	By December, I'll have been working here for ten years.

Pronunciation. In speech *will have* is almost always contracted: *I'll have* /'aɪləv/, *we'll have* /'wiːləv/, *won't have* /'wʊntəv/. Learners often hear it as "I'll of" and some write "will of": show the written form next to the sound. *I'll be* is /aɪ biː/ make sure the dark /l/ is there, or it becomes "I be." *by the time* is one chunk /baɪðə'taɪm/. Neutral inquiries sound friendly with a gentle rise at the end: "Will you be **paying by card?** ↗" Main stress falls on the main verb, not on *will / have / be*: "By June we'll have **painted** every **classroom**."

- 1 **8 p.m. gesture drill** (point at the board dot; wavy hand = in progress, flat "done" hand = finished): T: "eat" + wavy hand → S: "At 8 we'll be eating." T: "eat" + done hand → S: "By 8 we'll have eaten." Repeat with *work, watch the game, clean up, leave*. Choral, then fast individuals.
- 2 **Contraction drill**: T: "I will have finished" → S: "I'll have finished" /'aɪləv/. T: "They will not have arrived" → S: "They won't have arrived." Back-chain: "...finished" → "have finished" → "I'll have finished" → "By Friday I'll have finished."
- 3 **Make it polite**: T (as a receptionist): "Pay by card?" → S: "Will you be paying by card?" T: "Stay long?" → S: "How long will you be staying?" T: "Use the projector?" → S: "Will you be using the projector?" Model the gentle rise.
- 4 **By the time**: T: "you / arrive · we / leave" → S: "By the time you arrive, we'll have left." T: "the movie / start · I / buy the popcorn" → S: "By the time the movie starts, I'll have bought the popcorn."
- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs**: S1 names a future moment ("This time tomorrow..." / "By Sunday night..."); S2 finishes it with the right form, real or imagined. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ PROJECT TIMELINE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 3. Put two piles of cards on the front table: **projects** (a community center renovation, a food co-op opening, a city bike-share launch, a new clinic wing, a grocery store's new app, a school library makeover) and **characters** (Maya, a trainee nurse; Dev, who is starting a food truck; Rosa, a new bus driver; Sam, who is building a small web-design business). Each card gives real-sounding milestones and dates.
- ◆ Groups fill in the **timeline frame** (key words only): **next month** (what will be happening?) · **by the time...** (a milestone) · **this time next year** · **in five years' time**. Each point needs one *will be* + *-ing* idea and one *will have* + *p.p.* idea. They may invent details.
- ◆ Two groups meet. Group 1 gives a "status forecast": each learner presents one or two points on the timeline, in order. Group 2 is the **town council** (for a project) or the character's **friends** (for a character) and must ask at least two neutral questions: "Will you be hiring local people?" · "Will you have finished the parking lot by opening day?" Then they swap.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers**: give the strongest speaker in each group the **council chair** job: they may not present, but they must ask the most questions and give the other group a "vote" at the end ("We approve your project!"). Quieter learners present the first and last points, which are easiest to prepare.
- ◆ The personal option stays small and safe: a learner who wants to may add one sentence about **this time tomorrow** or **the end of this week**. No one talks about their own long-term future.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PROJECT TIMELINE

SAY: *Do you talk about your own life in five years? (No, a project or a character from a card.) · How many points on the timeline? (Four.) · For each point, how many sentences? (Two: one "will be -ing," one*

"will have done.") · Do you write full sentences on the frame? (No, key words.) · What does the council do? (Listens and asks at least two "Will you be..." questions.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with two frames on a strip: "At __, we'll **be** __ing." and "By __, we'll **have** __ed." Highlight **be** in one color and **have** in another on the board and on the strip. Choose the project card with the shortest text (the bike-share launch) and read it aloud to the group. In the presentation, the learner takes the first point only. Target: 2 sentences of each kind, spoken; in writing, Workbook Ex 2 items 1–4 only.

STRETCH

Add the **future perfect continuous** for duration ("By June we'll have been working on it for two years") and C1-style planning language: *be due to*, *be set to*, *be on track to* ("The center is due to open on June 14th"). Use *by which time* to join ideas ("We open in June, by which time we'll have hired six teachers"). As council members, ask the harder questions: "Will you have secured the funding by then?" Early finishers rewrite Lena's voicemail as a formal email to volunteers.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"By the time you will arrive":** French (*quand tu arriveras*), Russian, Polish and Ukrainian (future perfective in time clauses), Greek, and Portuguese (future subjunctive *quando chegares*, which feels "future") often put a future in the time clause. Spanish speakers use the subjunctive (*cuando llegues*) and are usually fine. Keep pointing at "time clause = present."
- ◆ **by / until:** German *bis*, Dutch *tot*, Russian and Polish *do*, Arabic *ḥattā* and Turkish *-e kadar* can mean both "by" and "until," so "I'll have finished until six" is very common. Use the "no later than" test: if it fits, it's **by**.
- ◆ **Dropping have or be:** "By 2030 I will finished," "This time tomorrow I will flying." Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Indonesian speakers (no verb inflection) and learners who "hear" only the main verb in contracted speech. Show the three-part form with three colors: **will + have + finished**.
- ◆ **Overusing the continuous:** Indian and Pakistani English and many Hindi, Urdu and Tamil speakers use *will be + -ing* for simple future promises ("I will be sending it tomorrow"). It's understood and often fine, but show when plain *will* or the perfect is clearer.
- ◆ **Present for future:** Spanish, Portuguese, Italian, Japanese and Korean speakers may use the present where English needs a future form ("At 8 we eat dinner" for "we'll be eating"). The meaning is often clear; recast with the camera image.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_13.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz. For the online "Postcard from the Future" project, learners may choose the project or character from class instead of their own life. Workbook 5.1: finish the Project Timeline (on the back of the page, write 6 full sentences from your group's frame: 3 *will be* + *-ing*, 3 *will have* + *p.p.*, one with *by the time*), "My new words" and the journal (a project, a character, or "this time tomorrow / by Sunday night").

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A will be having · Q2 A By the time you arrive, I'll have cooked dinner. · Q3 (new) B Will you be paying by card? Lena's update (Ex 1): 1 will have finished · 2 will be working · 3 starts · 4 will have painted · 5 will have arrived · 6 will be cutting · 7 will be serving · 8 Will you be coming.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ tell the difference between doing something yourself (*I cut my hair*) and arranging for someone else to do it (*I had my hair cut*)
- ◆ form the causative **have / get + object + past participle** in any tense and after modals (*You should get your eyes checked*), keeping the object before the participle
- ◆ choose *have* (neutral) or *get* (informal, sometimes "finally managed")
- ◆ understand and use the **misfortune** meaning (*They had their flight canceled*) and tell it apart from the past perfect (*He had stolen a wallet*)
- ◆ use *get someone to do* and *have someone do*, and recognize *have someone doing*
- ◆ arrange everyday services in a role-play and report a week of errands

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 5.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, "My services" table)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · **Service picture cards** (12) · causative pattern cards · **Errand Week A/B cards** (1 pair per 2 learners) · **Services & Errands role-play cards** (8 scenarios, A and B)
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.2-A (Marco's busy Saturday) and 5.2-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: two stick figures. Figure 1 with scissors: "I **cut** my hair." (me ✂). Figure 2 in a chair, a hairdresser behind: "I **had** my hair **cut**." (someone else ✂, I arranged it).

Center: the recipe in three boxes: **have / get → thing → done**. Below it the "only have changes" ladder: I **have** it serviced · I'm **having** it serviced · I **had** it serviced · I've **had** it serviced · I'll **have** it serviced · You **should get** it serviced.

Right: ✓ I had my car repaired. (service) · ⚠ She had her bag stolen. (misfortune) · ✗ I had repaired my car. (= past perfect: I did it!) · *get him to help* · *have him help* (no to).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: by the end of today...	8	S-S → T-S	Review C14. Pairs finish on the board: "By the end of today's class, we'll have... · At 9 tonight, I'll be... (real or imagined) · Will you be...?" Then two groups give their C14 project's best milestone in one

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			sentence. Correct <i>by the time</i> + <i>present</i> on the spot only if the whole class is making the error.
Lead-in: who did it?	5	T-S	Point at your hair (or show a photo of a clean car): "Look! New haircut! Did I cut it?" (No!) "Who cut it?" (A hairdresser / a barber.) "So I don't say 'I cut my hair.' I say..." Elicit or give: "I had my hair cut ." Draw the two stick figures (board left). "Who cut it? Who paid? Who's the subject of the sentence?"
Causative: M / F / P	14	T-S	Slides 9–10. Meaning (someone else does a service; I arrange it), the recipe, the "only <i>have</i> changes" ladder through tenses and modals, the service picture cards (<i>car serviced, sink fixed, keys copied, pants shortened, documents printed...</i>). CCQs (below). Word order vs past perfect with the  example.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Picture-card drill and tense ladder (see Drill script). Keep a fast pace.
have vs get · misfortune · people	10	T-S	Slides 11–12. <i>have</i> vs <i>get</i> (register, and "finally got it fixed"). Misfortune: "She had her bag stolen." (Did she arrange it? No!) The past perfect trap. Then the person patterns: <i>I got my landlord to fix it</i> (persuaded) · <i>I'll have the porter bring your bags</i> (arranged, no to) · <i>She had everyone laughing</i> . Model dialogue on slide 12 in pairs, once each way.
Listening: Marco's Saturday	6	T-S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1. Read Script 5.2-A (voicemail) twice. Learners complete the gaps and decide who did each job. Pairs compare. Ask: "What did Marco do himself?" (washed the dog)
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 3 (myself or a professional?) and Ex 4 (service / misfortune / past perfect), which carry the meaning.
Freer 1: Errand Week	10	S-S (pairs)	Slide 13. Information gap. A has Sam's to-do list ; B has Sam's receipts and texts . A asks: "Did Sam get the oil changed?" B answers from the receipts: "Yes, he had it changed on Monday. And he had the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			brakes checked." Together they decide what Sam did himself , what he had done , what went wrong (a misfortune), and what he still needs to get done . They write 3 sentences for the last group. ICQs first.
Freer 2: Services & Errands	13	S-S (pairs, rotate)	Slide 13. Role-play at the counter or on the phone: A = customer, B = service provider (auto shop, building manager, hair salon, print shop, phone repair, alterations, dry cleaner, key counter). A must arrange two things with the causative, ask when it will be ready (recycle C14: "Will you have finished it by Friday?"), and ask one neutral question ("Will you be needing my phone number?"). B has information on the card (price, time, one small problem). 4 minutes per role-play; swap roles and cards; 3 rounds. Then pairs report: "I'm getting my pants shortened, and they'll have finished them by Thursday."
Feedback	5	T-S	Board: 4 heard sentences, e.g. "I had repaired my car at the shop." · "I got fixed my phone." · "The manager will have the plumber to come." · "I cut my hair at the salon yesterday." (natural in casual speech, but upgrade: "I got my hair cut / I got a haircut"). Learners fix them. Praise one great role-play from each part of the room.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 5.2; workbook "My services" and the journal.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 14 + 6 + 10 + 6 + 8 + 10 + 13 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This is the busiest class of the module. Do only 2 role-play rounds, and move Workbook Ex 5 to homework. Never cut the Errand Week gap: it is where learners must decide "did he do it, or did someone do it for him?", which is the whole point of the lesson. With a very strong class, shorten the drill instead.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: who actually does it? The causative keeps *me* as the subject, but someone else does the work, usually a professional I arrange and pay.

SAY: "I had my car repaired." Did I repair it? (No.) Who did? (A mechanic, a garage.) Who arranged it? (I did.) Do we know the mechanic's name? (No, and we don't need it.) · "I repaired my car." Who had the tools in their hands? (I did.)

SAY: "I'm getting my hair cut this afternoon." Is it finished? (No, later today.) Will I use the scissors? (No, the hairdresser.) · "You should get your eyes checked." Is this advice? (Yes.) Who checks the eyes? (An eye doctor.)

Meaning: have vs get. The same meaning; get is more informal and common in speech, and can suggest effort.

SAY: "It took weeks, but I finally got the heater repaired." Was it easy? (No, it took effort.) · A formal email to a customer: "We will ___ your order delivered by Friday." have or get? (have: more neutral / formal.)

Meaning: misfortune, and the past perfect trap.

SAY: "She had her bag stolen on the train." Did she arrange this? (No!) Did she steal it? (No, someone stole it from her.) · "He had stolen a wallet." Who was the thief? (He was.) What changed? (The order: object before the participle = causative.)

Meaning: the person patterns.

SAY: "I got my brother to help me move." Did my brother want to help at first? (Maybe not; I persuaded him.) Is there a to? (Yes, with get.) · "I'll have the porter bring your bags up." Who says this? (A hotel receptionist.) Is there a to? (No, with have.) · "She had everyone laughing." Did she ask them to laugh? (No, she made it happen: funny story.)

Form.

Recipe	have / get + object + past participle	I had my car repaired. · We got the carpets cleaned.
Tenses	change only <i>have / get</i> : have · am having · had · have had · will have · am going to have	She's having her hair cut right now. · I've just had my eyes tested.
Modals	modal + have / get + object + p.p. · should have had + object + p.p.	You should get your teeth checked. · We should have had it fixed sooner.
Misfortune	same form; something bad happened to you	They had their flight canceled at the last minute.
Person: persuade	get + person + to + verb	I got him to help me move the sofa.

Person: arrange	have + person + verb (no <i>to</i>)	The manager had her assistant reschedule the meeting.
Recognize	have + person + -ing (cause an ongoing action)	She soon had everyone laughing.

Pronunciation. The past participle ending is easy to lose: *fixed* /fɪkst/, *serviced* /'sɜːvɪst/, *checked* /tʃɛkt/, *cleaned* /klaɪnd/, *painted* /'peɪntɪd/. If the ending disappears, "I had my car fix" sounds like a mistake, so drill the final sound. Linking: *had it* /'hædɪt/, *got it* /'gɒtɪt/ (American flap t), *get it done* /'ɡeɪt dʌn/. Stress usually falls on the **thing**: "I had my **hair** cut." Stretch: in a misfortune, the stress often moves to the participle because it's the surprising news: "She had her bag **stolen**!"

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Picture cards** (hold up a service card): car → S: "I had my car serviced." · sink → "I had the sink fixed." · keys → "I had a key copied." · pants → "I had my pants shortened." · phone → "I had the screen replaced." Choral, then individuals.
- Tense ladder** (T says a time word; learners change only *have*): T: "every year" → S: "I have my car serviced every year." T: "right now" → "I'm having my car serviced right now." T: "last week" → "I had..." T: "just" → "I've just had..." T: "next week" → "I'll have / I'm going to have..." T: "should" → "I should get my car serviced."
- Pronunciation:** choral *fixed* /fɪkst/, *serviced* /'sɜːvɪst/, *painted* /'peɪntɪd/; then "I had it fixed" /aɪ 'hædɪt fɪkst/ ×3, fast.
- Me or them?** T describes; learners choose: T: "My neighbor painted my kitchen for money." → S: "You had your kitchen painted." T: "I painted my kitchen on Sunday." → S: "You painted it yourself!" T: "Someone broke my window." → S: "You had your window broken." (misfortune)
- Get him to / have him:** T: "My landlord / fix the heater (persuade)" → S: "I got my landlord to fix the heater." T: "The hotel / a porter / bring the bags (arrange)" → S: "The hotel had a porter bring the bags."

◆ ERRAND WEEK – HOW TO RUN IT

- Pairs. **Card A** is Sam's to-do list for the week (8 jobs: oil change and brakes, flyers for the block party, the dripping kitchen faucet, a haircut before Saturday's wedding, new suit pants that are too long, a spare key for his mom, photos for a new work ID badge, a flat bike tire). **Card B** has Sam's receipts, texts and calendar notes for the same week. Neither partner can see the other card.
- A asks about each job with the causative: "Did Sam get the flyers printed?" B answers from the evidence: "Yes, he had 200 flyers printed on Tuesday." Some jobs Sam did himself (B's text says "Fixed the faucet myself! YouTube!"), one went wrong (a misfortune: "Got my car towed from the store parking lot. Ugh."), and some are still open.

- ◆ Together, pairs sort the 8 jobs into four columns on the back of card A: **did it himself** · **had it done** · **something went wrong** · **still needs to get it done**. Then they write 3 sentences for the last column: "He still needs to get his pants shortened. He should have them done before the wedding on Saturday."
- ◆ Check with the model answers on the materials sheet. A pair that gets the meaning right with one word-order slip has succeeded; fix the slip at feedback.

◆ SERVICES & ERRANDS ROLE-PLAY – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Eight scenarios, each with a **customer card (A)** and a **service card (B)**: the auto shop, the building manager (apartment repairs), the hair salon / barber shop, the print & copy shop, the phone repair kiosk, the alterations shop, the dry cleaner, and the key counter at the hardware store.
- ◆ **A (customer)** must: (1) explain two things they need done, with the causative ("I'd like to have the oil changed and get the brakes checked"); (2) ask when it will be ready, with the future perfect or continuous ("Will you have finished by five?"); (3) ask one neutral question ("Will you be calling me when it's ready?"). **B (service provider)** uses the card: price, time, and one small problem to explain ("We'll have to order the part, so we won't have finished until Thursday").
- ◆ Rounds of 4 minutes. After each round, the customer swaps cards with another pair. Swap roles every round, so everyone is a customer at least once.
- ◆ Finish with a 1-minute report to a new partner: "I'm getting my jacket dry-cleaned. They'll have done it by Saturday, and they're having a new button sewn on too."
- ◆ **Dominant speakers** make good service providers: give them the cards with a "problem" and the job of explaining it clearly. Quieter learners start as customers, with the phrase bank on the card.

◆ ICQS BEFORE ERRAND WEEK AND THE ROLE-PLAY

SAY: *Errand Week: Can you show your partner your card? (No.) · Who asks, A or B? (A.) · What do you find out? (What Sam did himself, what he had done, what went wrong, what he still needs to get done.) · How many sentences do you write? (Three, for the last column.)*

SAY: *Role-play: Customer, how many things do you need done? (Two.) · What else do you ask? (When it will be ready, and one "Will you be...?" question.) · Service provider, where's your information? (On my card.) · When do you swap? (After 4 minutes.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with the past simple only and three picture cards: "I **had** my ___ **fixed** / **cleaned** / **cut**." Give a strip with the three boxes (have / thing / done) and let learners build sentences by putting the picture card in the middle box. In the role-play, take the customer role with the auto shop or hair salon card (picture on the card) and one required sentence plus "When will it be ready?" Target: 4 spoken causative sentences; in writing, Workbook Ex 2 items 1–4.

STRETCH

Use the passive-like and C1 forms: *get* + *object* + *-ing* ("I finally got the engine running"), *have something done* with the future perfect ("I'll have had the roof repaired by winter"), and *need* + *-ing* for services ("The car needs servicing" = needs to be serviced). Contrast stress in service vs misfortune. In the role-play, handle a complaint politely: "I had my suit dry-cleaned here, but the stain is still there. Could you have it looked at again?" Early finishers write a short, polite complaint email.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I cut my hair" for a salon haircut:** Spanish *me corté el pelo*, Portuguese *cortei o cabelo*, Russian *я подстригся*, Chinese 剪头发 and Arabic use the plain verb (or a reflexive) for both meanings. Note: American speakers also say "I cut my hair" casually for a salon visit, but *I got my hair cut* / *I got a haircut* is clearer. Accept it in speech; teach the causative for precision.
- ◆ **Word order:** "I had repaired my car" / "I got fixed my phone." French *j'ai fait réparer ma voiture*, Italian *ho fatto riparare*, and Spanish *mandé arreglar el coche* put the verb before the object, so learners write the past perfect by mistake. Point at the three boxes: **have → thing → done**.
- ◆ **"make" for "have / get":** French *faire*, Japanese *-saseru*, Korean -시키/시키다, Chinese 让 and Turkish *-dir* causatives often come out as "I made the mechanic repair my car," which sounds like force in English. Show: **make** = force · **get ... to** = persuade · **have** = arrange.
- ◆ **"have someone to do":** very common across languages. **have** + person + verb (no *to*); **get** + person + **to** + verb.
- ◆ **Lost endings:** Vietnamese, Cantonese, Thai and Korean speakers often drop final /t/ /d/ /st/: "I had it fix." Drill the final sound and link it to the next word ("fixed_on Monday").

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_14.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz. For the online project's "misfortune" example, learners may invent one or use a character. Workbook 5.2: finish "My services" (6 sentences in at least three tenses, one with *get*, one plain active "I do it myself"), "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** I had my hair cut yesterday. · Q2 **A** had her bag stolen · Q3 (new) **B** Ana got her brother to help. Marco's Saturday (Ex 1): 1 serviced · 2 tires · 3 printed · 4 made · 5 cut · 6 to fix · 7 look · 8 Marco (himself).

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ choose **all** or **whole** (*all the books · the whole book · all day · the whole day*) and avoid "all the day"
- ◆ choose **every** (the group as a whole) or **each** (one by one, often two), with a **singular noun and verb**, and avoid "every people"
- ◆ use **both** (plural verb), **neither** and **either** (singular verb) for two things, and *both ... and*, *neither ... nor*, *either ... or*
- ◆ use *most*, *all*, *some*, *none* with and without **of**: *most people* (general) vs *most of the people here* (specific) · *most of them*
- ◆ run a class survey and report the results with a range of quantifiers and correct agreement

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 5.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Survey & Report frame, "Look back at my goal")
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Determiner cards · **Precision Path** board game (1 per group of 3–4, a die or coin, counters) · **survey cards** + **tally sheets** (1 per pair) · report frames · **"Our class in numbers"** poster
- ◆ Listening scripts 5.3-A (the staff survey) and 5.3-B (dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: a vertical scale from 100% to 0%: **all of us** · **almost all / nearly every one of us** · **most of us** · **about half of us** · **some of us** · **a few of us** · **only one of us** · **none of us**. Next to it: 2 people → **both** (2/2) · **either** (1 of 2) · **neither** (0/2).

Center: all + the + plural / uncountable · the **whole** + singular · ~~all the day~~ → all day / the whole day. **every / each** + singular noun + singular verb: Every room **has**... · Each of the rooms **has**... · ~~every people~~ → every person / all people.

Right: the "of" rule: **of** + the / my / them ✓ (most of the people, most of them) · no the? no **of**! (~~most of people~~ → most people). Verb check: both → **are** · neither / either → **is** · none of → is / are.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: Precision Path	9	S-S (groups)	Review C14–C15. Groups of 3–4 play the Precision Path board game (future perfect / continuous and causative squares). Stop after

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			8 minutes wherever they are; the player furthest along wins. 1 minute: each group reads one "Fix it" square they solved.
Lead-in: every people?	4	T-S	Board: "Every people in this class ____ a phone." "Is this good English?" Let learners argue. Elicit two correct versions: " Every person in this class has a phone." / " All the people in this class have phones." "Today: small words, big precision."
all / whole · every / each	11	T-S	Slide 14. <i>all</i> vs <i>whole</i> (position, "the whole cake" vs "all the cakes," "all day"). <i>every</i> vs <i>each</i> (group vs one by one; <i>each</i> for two; <i>almost every</i>). Singular noun + singular verb. CCQs (below).
both / neither / either	8	T-S	Slide 15. Hold up two pens. "Both pens are blue." (plural) · "Neither pen is red." · "Either pen is fine." (singular) Then <i>both ... and</i> , <i>neither ... nor</i> , <i>either ... or</i> , and <i>neither of them is</i> (formal) vs <i>are</i> (relaxed speech). The model dialogue on slide 15 in pairs.
most / none · the "of" rule	8	T-S	Slide 16. General vs specific: "Most people like weekends." / "Most of the people in this room take the bus." With pronouns, <i>of</i> is compulsory: <i>most of us</i> , <i>none of them</i> . The two classic errors. <i>none of + is / are</i> .
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: the scale drill with the class, the "two pens" drill, the <i>of</i> or <i>no of</i> drill.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1–4 alone, then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 2 (fix the agreement). Ex 5 (listening, Script 5.3-A) is the model for the report: play it now if you have time, or at the start of the survey report stage.
Freer: Class Survey & Report	25	S-S (pairs, mingle) → S-S → T-S	Slide 17. (1) Each pair gets one survey card and a tally sheet (1 min). (2) Mingle: ask everyone in the class, tally the answers, including "Pass" (7 min). (3) Pairs turn the tally into a 4–5 sentence report with the frame: at least one <i>all / most / none of us, one every / each</i> , and one <i>both / neither / either</i> about the two of them or two options (6 min). The data checker in each pair checks the numbers add up and the verbs agree. (4) Pairs read their report to the class; everyone else listens for one fact that surprised them (7 min). (5) Each pair writes its best sentence on the " Our class in numbers " poster (4 min). ICQs first.
Feedback + module check	7	T-S	Delayed correction from the reports: "Most of students take the bus." · "Every people in this class have a phone." · "Neither of us drink coffee." (formal: <i>drinks</i> ; accept <i>drink</i> in speech) · "All the class came by bus." (upgrade: <i>the whole class</i>) · plus 2 good sentences. Then learners tick the three Module 5 "I can..." lists and look back at their Progress Test goal (private).

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 5.3; the "compare two groups" writing; preview C17: "Next class: happy → unhappy → happiness → happily. One word, a whole family."
Total	90		9 + 4 + 11 + 8 + 8 + 5 + 8 + 25 + 7 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Stop the board game after 6 minutes, and move Workbook Ex 3–4 to homework. In the survey, let pairs report to one other pair instead of the whole class, and only the "best sentence" goes to the poster. Never cut the report: it is where the verb agreement and the *of* rule get used for a real purpose.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: all vs whole. *whole* = one complete, unbroken unit; *all* = everything in a set or an amount.

SAY: "I ate the whole cake." How many cakes? (One.) Is any left? (No, every piece.) · "I ate all the cakes." How many? (More than one.) · "It rained all the day." Correct? (No: "all day" or "the whole day.") · Where does *whole* go: before or after *the*? (After: the whole day.)

Meaning: every vs each. Same verb (singular), different view of the group.

SAY: "Every student passed." Am I thinking of the group together or one by one? (Together: all of them.) · "Each student gets a personal report." One report for the whole class? (No, one for each person, individually.) · "She had a bag in every hand." Correct? (No, two hands: each.) · "Every people needs water." Correct? (No: every person or all people.)

Meaning: both / neither / either. Only for two.

SAY: "Both restaurants are good." How many restaurants? (Two.) Are they both good? (Yes.) · "Neither restaurant is cheap." How many are cheap? (Zero.) · "Either day works." Can I choose Monday? (Yes.) Tuesday? (Yes, one or the other.) · "Neither of my three brothers..." Correct? (No! Three → none of.)

Meaning: general vs specific (the "of" rule).

SAY: "Most people like music." People in this room or people in general? (In general.) · "Most of the people here like jazz." General or specific? (Specific: the people here.) · "Most of teachers work hard." Correct? (No: no *the*, no *of*. "Most teachers" or "most of the teachers.") · "All us are here." Correct? (No: "all of us.")

Form.

all / whole	all (+ the) + plural / uncountable · the / my + whole + singular · all day (no <i>the</i>)	all the books · all the information · the whole book · It rained all day / the whole day.
every / each	+ singular noun + singular verb · each of + the + plural + singular verb	Every room has a view. · Each of the candidates was interviewed.
both	two together · plural verb · both ... and ...	Both options are good. · Both of us agree.
neither / either	0 of 2 / 1 of 2 · singular verb · neither ... nor · either ... or	Neither option is cheap. · Either day works for me.
+ of	most / all / some / none / both / neither / each + of + the / my / this / them / us	most of the class · none of us · all of my friends
no of	general statement, bare noun	Most people love music. · All children need sleep.
none of	+ uncountable → singular · + plural → singular (formal) or plural (everyday)	None of the water was clean. · None of the students was / were late.

Pronunciation. *whole* sounds exactly like *hole* /hoʊl/: the **w** is silent. *each* /itʃ/ is a long vowel, not *itch* /ɪtʃ/. *neither* and *either* can be /'niðər/ or /'naɪðər/; most Americans say /'niðər/, and both are correct. *none* /nʌn/ rhymes with *fun*, not *phone*. Linking in the "of" phrases: *all of us* /'ɔləvəs/, *most of them* /'moʊstəvðəm/ (often /'moʊsəvəm/ in fast speech), *none of them* /'nʌnəvəm/. Stress the quantifier when it's the news: "**None** of us drink coffee!"

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Scale drill** (with the class, true facts): T: "Who has a pen? Hands up." Count. S: "All of us have a pen." / "Most of us have a pen." T: "Who is wearing a hat?" → "None of us is / are wearing a hat." / "Only one of us is..." Choral, then individuals.
- 2 Two pens** (hold up two objects): T: "blue?" → S: "Both pens are blue." T: "red?" → "Neither pen is red." T: "can I use one?" → "Either pen is fine." T: "Neither of them..." → S: "Neither of them is red."
- 3 Of or no of?** T: "most / people" → S: "most people." T: "most / the people here" → "most of the people here." T: "all / us" → "all of us." T: "none / them" → "none of them." T: "all / children" → "all children."
- 4 Singular check:** T: "every room / have" → S: "Every room has..." T: "each of the rooms / have" → "Each of the rooms has..." T: "both rooms / have" → "Both rooms have..."
- 5 whole:** T: "all the day" → S: "all day / the whole day." T: "the whole cakes" → S: "all the cakes." T: "the whole team" → S: "Correct!"

◆ CLASS SURVEY & REPORT – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Pairs. Each pair gets one **survey card** with a light question and 2–4 answer options (e.g. "Do you drink coffee, tea, both, or neither?" · "How do you usually get to class?" · "Have you ever had your hair cut by a friend or family member?"). Twelve cards, so every pair has a different question. The tally sheet has a column for each answer and a "**Pass**" column.
- ◆ Mingle: pairs split up and ask **everyone**, including the teacher. Tally marks only, no names. Then they meet and add their tallies. The **data checker** (the stronger learner in the pair) checks that the total equals the number of people in the room.
- ◆ The report (4–5 sentences) uses the frame on the tally sheet: "We asked every person in the class... · Most of us... / None of us... / All of us except two... · Each of us... · Both of us (the two in our pair)... / Neither of us... · The whole class..." Encourage the upgrade phrases from the workbook: *the majority of us, just over half of us, only a handful of us, not a single person*.
- ◆ Reports go to the class. Listeners note one fact that surprised them. Then each pair writes its best sentence on the "**Our class in numbers**" poster. Keep the poster on the wall for the C17 warmer.
- ◆ **Anonymity**: no names in reports. If only one person gave an answer, say "one of us," never who. Anyone can ask a pair to take their answer out. "Pass" is counted and reported like any other answer: "Two of us preferred not to say."

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE SURVEY

SAY: *Who do you ask: three people or everyone? (Everyone, even the teacher.) · Do you write names? (No, tally marks only.) · Can someone say "Pass"? (Yes, and we count it.) · What's the data checker's job? (Check the numbers add up and the verbs agree.) · How many sentences in the report? (Four or five.) · Which words must you use? (One all / most / none of us, one every / each, one both / neither / either.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on three quantifiers and the scale: **all of us** · **most of us** · **none of us**, plus **both of us** / **neither of us** for the pair. Give the report frame with those five sentence starts only. Choose a survey card with a picture (coffee / tea) and two answers. In the mingle, the learner asks and their partner tallies. Target: 3 report sentences, spoken; in writing, Workbook Ex 1 items 1–5.

STRETCH

Use a wider range: *the vast majority of us, hardly any of us, not one of us, each and every one of us, all but two of us*. Use *neither ... nor* with proximity agreement ("Neither my partner nor I **am**... / Neither I nor my partner **is**...", then rephrase to sound natural). Try relative quantifiers (C1): "We asked fourteen people, **most of whom** drink coffee, **none of whom** drink it black." Early finishers write the class report as a short, neutral paragraph for a newsletter.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"all the day":** Spanish *todo el día*, French *toute la journée*, Italian *tutto il giorno*, Portuguese *o dia todo* put "all" before the article with a singular noun. Teach **all day** and **the whole day** as chunks.
- ◆ **"every people / each students":** Arabic *kull* means all, every and each and takes plural nouns in some uses; Chinese 每...每 and Korean 每每 / 每每 don't mark number the same way. Point out that *people* is already plural.
- ◆ **"the most of people / most of people":** Spanish *la mayoría de la gente*, French *la plupart des gens*, Portuguese *a maioria das pessoas*, Italian *la maggior parte delle persone* have an article or "of the" in every case. No **the** in English → no **of**; never "the most" for quantity.
- ◆ **Plural verbs after every / each / neither:** many speakers follow the meaning (many people) rather than the grammar. "Every student have..." is very common. Mark it in writing; in speech, *neither of them are* is normal English, so don't over-correct.
- ◆ **both / neither for more than two:** languages without a "two" form (Tagalog, Vietnamese, Chinese, Japanese) may use *both* for three or more ("both of my three kids"). Hold up two fingers every time.
- ◆ **"none" vs "no one" vs "nobody":** "None came to the party" (for people) sounds odd in everyday English; *nobody / no one came* or *none of them came*.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 5.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_15.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back, listening for the singular verb after *every*, *each* and *neither*; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 5.3: copy the pair's survey report neatly, then "My new words," the journal ("compare two groups": 6 sentences about two teams, two stores, two apps, two workplaces or two neighborhoods, with one *every / each*, one *both / neither / either* and one *most of / none of / all of*) and "Look back at my goal."

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A Every student has a locker. · Q2 A Neither of the plans is ready. · Q3 (new) C Each of the rooms has a window. Staff survey (Ex 5): 1 All · 2 Most · 3 Each · 4 None · 5 Neither · 6 Every / whole · 7 Both.

END OF C16: MODULE 5 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "when, who, how many": **This time next year we'll be...** / **By then we'll have...** (placing actions on a future timeline) → **I had it fixed. I got him to help.** (who did the work) → **Every person has...** · **Neither of us is...** · **Most of us...** (how much of a group). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C17 warmer.

Check the C14 goals. At the end of C16, invite learners to read their Progress Test goal again (the "Look back at my goal" box in Workbook 5.3): "Did you practice it? What will you do next?" This is private: no one reports to the class.

Watch for in Module 6: word formation (6.1) builds naturally on today's data language (*majority, minority, individual, personally*); advanced comparison (6.2) pairs with quantifiers ("*far more of us* take the bus *than* drive"). Learners who just learned *every* + *singular* may over-apply it ("all the student"). Keep a 2-minute warmer in C17–C19 with one line from each lesson: a future perfect deadline, a causative errand, and one fact from the "Our class in numbers" poster.

Module 6 — Words & Questions

Three classes about precision: the right *form* of a word, the right *size* of a difference, and the right *shape* of a question. First comes **word formation**: word families, the suffixes that signal a word's job, the prefixes that flip or shade its meaning, and the stress that moves as a word changes form. Then **advanced comparison**: *far / much / slightly / nowhere near as... / twice as... as, the more..., the more... and better and better*. Last, **asking skillfully**: indirect questions for politeness (*Could you tell me where the station is?*), negative questions for surprise, agreement and persuasion (*Isn't it...? Don't you think...?*), and subject questions with no auxiliary.

3 Lessons

Lessons 6.1–6.3

Classes C17–C19

Weeks 9–10

90 min per class

CEFR B2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (pairs, groups, role-play) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-6-words-questions.html](#). Print [materials/module-6/classroom-materials.html](#) before C17. It holds the affix, scale and opener flashcards, the job and product picture cards, the new identity cards, the Word Family Grid A/B cards, the Prefix/Suffix Race cards, the Comeback Story bingo, the Compare & Recommend fact sheets and client cards, the Polite Enquiry role-play cards and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons (with a US or UK voice and a slower speed), so learners can hear the model sentences again at home.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** Learners already know simple comparatives and superlatives (A2), *as... as* (A2), reported questions with statement word order and *if / whether* (B1 3.2), *Could you...?* requests (B1 7.2) and question tags (B1 8.1). Check in each lead-in and go faster where they are strong. The new B2 work is **choosing the exact form** (a gap-fill skill), **saying how big a difference is**, the **parallel comparative**, and the **register and tone** of questions: when to wrap a question in an opener, and what a negative question really means.
- Fluency before accuracy.** In every freer task, listen and take notes; don't stop a speaker to fix a suffix or a word order. The feedback stage is where you fix errors, without names. Praise the *message* first ("That

recommendation really convinced me."), then the form. At B2, give feedback on **accuracy and range**: note one error to fix *and* one upgrade ("You said *much cheaper* three times. Try *considerably* or *nowhere near as expensive*").

- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** All three freer tasks have built-in turns: use them. Give every group a **talking-turn token** (you speak only when you hold it), give the strongest speaker a **job** (the Race referee, the "client" who must be convinced, the role-play observer with the checklist), and use **"your partner's idea first"** when groups report back. Say it kindly: "Thanks, Omar. Let's hear from someone who hasn't spoken yet."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C1.** Each lesson has a Stretch box with C1-edge language (less transparent suffixes, *by far / every bit as... as, Would you happen to know...? / I don't suppose you could...*). Offer it as an *option*, not a requirement; the class target is solid B2.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British forms (*recognise, modernise, economise, practise, behaviour, flat, motorway, queue, film, loo, full stop, skilfully*). Teach *recognize, modernize, economize, practice* (verb and noun), *behavior, apartment, highway, line, movie, restroom, period, skillfully*. Accept the British forms when learners use them. Lesson 6.1 itself says that *-ise* and *-ize* are both correct: use this to make the point.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

The right form → the right size → the right shape. In C17 learners reshape one idea into four jobs (*decide* → *decision* → *decisive* → *decisively*) and use the forms to tell a short "comeback story." In C18 they weigh options precisely (*far more reliable, only slightly heavier, nowhere near as cheap, twice as big*) and make a recommendation to a "client." In C19 they ask for information at a front desk and in a job interview in a way that sounds considerate (*I was wondering whether...*), and they check and persuade with negative questions (*Isn't it cheaper online? Don't you think the annual plan is better value?*). The C18 comparison language comes back naturally in the C19 role-plays. Point this out: it is the moment learners feel their B2 tools working together.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: STORIES, COMPARISONS AND INTERVIEWS

Three things in this module need care. (1) **Comeback stories (C17)** are about "something that went wrong and then went right." Keep them light: a team project, a cake, a garden, a driving test, a small business on a scenario card. **Never** ask about a personal failure, a loss, or a hard journey. (2) **Comparisons (C18)**: the cities, jobs and products are **invented** on purpose. Don't ask learners to compare "your country and the US" or "your old life and your life now"; it can bring up grief or politics, and the course avoids immigration topics. Pay also needs care: the job cards give the numbers, so no one discusses their own salary. (3) **Interviews (C19)**: the lesson's role-plays are a **job interview** and **customer-service** calls only. **Never** role-play an immigration, asylum, police, court or benefits interview, and don't let a learner play "the officer." The questions in role-play come from the cards, never "Where are you from?" or "Why did you come here?" For every personal task, offer three choices out loud: **your real life**, a **new identity card** (in the classroom materials), or **something imagined**. Opinion tasks always allow an **assigned side** ("You're on Team Kestrel today"). Anyone can say "Pass!"

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (one set for the board): the suffix and prefix cards (color-code them if you can: nouns blue, adjectives green, adverbs orange, verbs red), the **difference-scale** cards and the **question-opener** cards. Card stock helps. Cut them before C17.
- ◆ For C17: one pair of **Word Family Grid** cards (A + B) per pair; one set of **Prefix/Suffix Race** cards (20 base cards + 27 affix cards) per team of 3–4 (an envelope per team); one **Comeback Story bingo** grid per learner (two versions, so neighbors differ) and one set of **comeback scenario** cards.
- ◆ For C18: one **Compare & Recommend** fact sheet per learner (A and B sheets for three topics: phones, jobs, towns) and one set of **client cards** per pair. Put the job and product **picture cards** on the board.
- ◆ For C19: one set of **Polite Enquiry** role-play cards per group of 3 (A = customer or candidate, B = staff or interviewer, C = observer with the checklist). Tape the **opener** cards on the wall where everyone can see them.
- ◆ Print the **new identity cards** and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking. In C19 they double as the candidate profiles for the interview role-play.
- ◆ Optional: a desk bell or a phone for the role-plays ("Good morning, Riverside Community Center, how can I help?"). Learners enjoy the realism, and it makes the register clear.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
6.1	C17 • wk 9	Word families (noun / verb / adjective / adverb); suffixes that signal the part of speech (<i>-tion, -ment, -ness, -ity, -er, -ful, -less, -able, -ive, -ous, -al, -ly, -ize, -en, -ify</i>); prefixes : negatives	build a word family grid, choose the correct form in a gap-fill, and tell a short "comeback story"

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		(<i>un-, in- / im- / il- / ir-, dis-, non-</i>) and <i>re-, over-, under-, mis-, pre-</i> ; choosing the form for a gap; stress shift	using six or more forms from the families
6.2	C18 · wk 9	The size of a difference: <i>far / much / a lot / considerably / significantly vs slightly / a bit / a little / marginally</i> + comparative; <i>not nearly / nowhere near / not quite as... as; as... as, twice / three times / half as... as, the same as; the more..., the more...; better and better; comparative adverbs</i>	compare two products, jobs or towns precisely and recommend one to a "client," using six or more different comparison structures
6.3	C19 · wk 10	Indirect questions (opener + statement word order, no <i>do / does / did</i>); <i>if / whether</i> (+ <i>or not</i>); negative questions for surprise, agreement, confirmation and suggestion (<i>Isn't it...? Didn't you...? Don't you think...?</i>) and answering them by the facts; subject questions; polite intonation	ask six or more polite questions at a front desk, on the phone or in a job interview, check and persuade with negative questions, and sound polite with their voice as well as their words

6.1 · C17

Word Formation — Prefixes, Suffixes & Word Families

90 min

OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- recognize and build **word families**: the noun, verb, adjective and adverb from one base (*decide* → *decision* → *decisive* → *decisively*)
- use a **suffix** to identify a word's job: *-tion / -sion, -ment, -ness, -ity, -er / -or* (nouns) · *-ful, -less, -able / -ible, -ive, -ous, -al* (adjectives) · *-ly* (adverbs) · *-ize, -en, -ify* (verbs)
- choose the right **negative prefix** (*un-, in-, im-* before m / p, *il-* before l, *ir-* before r, *dis-, non-*) and use *re-, over-, under-, mis-, pre-*
- fill a gap with the correct form in two steps: (1) **what job does the slot need?** (2) **build the form**
- hear and say the **stress shift** in a family (*PHOtograph* → *phoTOgraphy* → *photoGRAPHic*) and tell a short comeback story using six or more family members

MATERIALS

- Workbook 6.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Comeback Story)
- Slides 3–7 · Suffix and prefix flashcards (color-coded) · **Word Family Grid A/B** cards (1 pair per pair) · **Prefix/Suffix Race** cards (1 envelope per team) · **Comeback Story bingo** (1 per learner) + scenario cards · New identity cards
- Listening scripts 6.1-A (where's the stress?) and 6.1-B (Race round 3: gap sentences)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the word sum, big: **un** + success + **ful** + **ly** = unsuccessfully. Under it, the family tree: *decide* → *decision* (N) · *decisive* (Adj) · *decisively* (Adv) · *indecisive* (Neg).

Center: four colored columns, "The ending tells you the job": **N** -tion -ment -ness -ity -er · **ADJ** -ful -less -able -ive -ous -al · **ADV** -ly · **V** -ize -en -ify. Under it the stress rule: **-tion, -ic, -ity pull the stress to the syllable just before them**: *PHOtograph* → *phoTOgraphy* → *photoGRAPHic*.

Right: *in-* in disguise: **impossible** (p) · **illegal** (l) · **irregular** (r) · **incorrect**. Others: *re-* (again) · *over-* (too much) · *under-* (too little) · *mis-* (wrongly) · *pre-* (before). A red box:  **invaluable** = VERY valuable!

STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: all, both, neither	7	S-S → T-S	Review C16 (5.3, determiners and quantifiers). Pairs find things in common and write three true sentences about themselves (or their identity cards) with <i>both of</i>

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			<i>us / neither of us / all of us in this class / none of us / each of us</i> : "Neither of us likes getting up early." Two pairs read their best sentence. Quick board fix of any "Both of us doesn't...".
Lead-in: one word becomes four	5	S-S → T-S	Write DECIDE on the board. Teams of 3 have 60 seconds to write every word they know built on it. Elicit: <i>decision, decisive, decisively, indecisive, undecided, decided(ly)</i> . "How many words did we get from one? That's today: one word, a whole family." Show slide 3 (the word sum).
Word families & suffixes	12	T-S	Slides 3–4. Meaning (same idea, different job), the family table (<i>decide, success, create, strength, compete, economy</i>), then the suffix columns with the colored flashcards. Pronunciation: the stress rule for <i>-tion / -ic / -ity</i> and the sound changes (<i>decide → decision, strong → strength</i>). CCQs (below). Play Script 6.1-A : learners mark the stressed syllable in the 🗨️ "Where's the stress?" box under the Workbook 6.1 Grammar box.
Drill	5	T-S → S	Family chain and stress drill (see Drill script). Keep it fast and rhythmic: clap the stressed syllable.
Word Family Grid (info gap)	11	S-S (pairs)	Slide 6. Pairs get Grid A and Grid B (the same 10 families, different cells filled in). Without showing their card, they ask and spell: "What's the adjective from <i>rely</i> ?" " <i>Reliable</i> : R-E-L-I-A-B-L-E." Both complete Workbook Ex 1. Then they check the one negative per row together. ICQs first. Early finishers add the stress marks.
Prefixes	9	T-S	Slide 5. Negative prefixes and "in- in disguise" (say <i>impossible</i> aloud and let learners feel why it became <i>impossible</i>). Then <i>re-, over-, under-, mis-, pre-</i> : prefixes change the meaning, not the job. The trap: <i>invaluable</i> = very valuable; <i>flammable</i> = <i>inflammable</i> . CCQs.
Prefix/Suffix Race	11	S-S (teams)	Slide 6. Teams of 3–4 with an envelope of base and affix cards. Round 1 (3 min) "Flip it": T reads a base, the first team to hold up the right negative prefix card scores. Round 2 (4 min) "Build it": teams build as many <i>real</i> words as they can; other teams may challenge; an

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			invented word (<i>beautiless</i>) loses a point. Round 3 (4 min) "Fit it": T reads Script 6.1-B sentences with a base in capitals; teams write the form that fits. ICQs first.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2–5 alone (form the word, negative prefix, other prefixes, the comeback text), then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on. For every gap ask the class: "What job does the slot need?" before the answer.
Freer: Comeback Story	12	S → S-S (groups)	Slide 7. (1) Each learner picks a scenario card (the night-market stall, the community garden, the soccer team, the bake sale, the neighborhood app, the second driving test) or a light real story, and writes 6 key words from the families (3 min). (2) Groups of 3–4: each learner tells the story in about 1 minute: what went wrong, how it was fixed, how it ended. Listeners mark every form they hear on their Comeback bingo (7 min). (3) The learner with the most bingo marks from one story nominates it; that storyteller retells the "turning point" sentence to the class (2 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Delayed error correction: write 4 sentences you heard (2 good, 2 with errors, no names): "It was a success project." · "He explained it very clear." · "It's impossible." · "The team was very disappointing." (= disappointed). Learners fix them and say what job the slot needed. Then one range upgrade : a plain sentence you heard, rebuilt with a family member ("They improved it" → "They made several key improvements").
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 6.1 on screen; point at a  button and the voice/speed control. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 5 + 11 + 9 + 11 + 8 + 12 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This class has two games and a story task. If time is tight, cut Race Round 2 (Build it) and move Workbook Ex 4 to homework. Never cut the Comeback Story: it is where learners *use* the forms in connected speech instead of just recognizing them. With a very strong class, shorten the prefix presentation to 5 minutes; they will know most negatives already.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: a word family. One idea, several grammatical jobs. The idea stays the same; the ending changes the job in the sentence.

SAY: "She made a quick decision. She's very decisive. She acted decisively." Is the idea the same in all three? (Yes, deciding.) Which one is a thing, a noun? (decision) · Which describes a person? (decisive, an adjective) · Which describes how she acted? (decisively, an adverb) · So what changed? (Only the job, not the idea.)

Meaning: the suffix tells you the job.

SAY: "Kindness", "agreement", "ability": nouns or adjectives? (Nouns.) How do you know without a dictionary? (The endings: -ness, -ment, -ity.) · "Hopeless": full of hope or without hope? (Without.) · "Widen": a verb or an adjective? (A verb: make wider.) · "Carefully": how many l's? (Two: careful + ly.)

Meaning: prefixes. A prefix usually changes the *meaning*, not the job.

SAY: "Happy" and "unhappy": both adjectives? (Yes.) · "Overcook": too much or too little? (Too much.) · "I misread the email." Did I read it correctly? (No, wrongly.) · "Rebuild": for the first time? (No, again.) · "Her help was invaluable." Was her help useless? (No! Extremely valuable.)

Meaning: choosing the form for a gap.

SAY: "It was a ____ launch." (SUCCESS) What comes after the gap? (A noun, launch.) So what job does the gap need? (An adjective.) The answer? (successful) · "They finished it ____." What does the gap describe? (How they finished: a verb.) So? (An adverb: successfully.) · "The first attempt was ____." (SUCCESS) The story says it failed. So? (unsuccessful: adjective + negative.)

Form.

Nouns	-tion / -sion · -ment · -ness · -ity · -er / -or	decision · development · kindness · ability · teacher
Adjectives	-ful · -less · -able / -ible · -ive · -ous · -al	careful · careless · reliable · creative · dangerous · natural
Adverbs	adjective + -ly (-y → -ily; -ful → -fully)	quickly · easily · carefully

Verbs	-ize (US) / -ise (UK) · -en · -ify	modernize · strengthen · simplify
Negatives	un- · in- / im- (m, p) / il- (l) / ir- (r) · dis- · non-	unfair · impossible · illegal · irregular · dishonest · non-smoker
Meaning	re- again · over- too much · under- too little · mis- wrongly · pre- before	rewrite · overwork · underpaid · misunderstand · preview

Pronunciation. Teach one powerful rule: **-tion / -sion, -ic and -ity pull the stress to the syllable just before them:** *eDUcate* → *eduCAtion* · *eCONomy* → *ecoNOMic* · *creAtive* → *creaTivIty* · *PHOtograph* → *phoTOgraphy* → *photoGRAPHic*. Endings like *-ful*, *-less*, *-ness*, *-ment*, *-ly*, *-able* usually **don't** move the stress: *CAREful*, *CARElessly*, *HAPpiness*, *deVELOpment*. Sound changes to model: *decide* /dɪ'saɪd/ → *decision* /dɪ'sɪʒən/ (the vowel changes and d → /ʒ/) · *succeed* → *success* · *strong* → *strength* /strɛŋkθ/ (hard: let learners say "strength" slowly) · *-tion* is always weak /jən/, never "tee-on." Prefixes are normally unstressed (*unHAPpy*, *imPOSSible*), but we stress them to contrast: "I said **POSSible**, not **IMpossible**!"

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Family chain** (hold up a base card): T: "decide" → S1: "decision" → S2: "decisive" → S3: "decisively" → S4: "indecisive." Then *succeed*, *create*, *strong*, *care*. Choral first, then around the room.
- 2 Clap the stress:** T: "PHOtograph" (clap on PHO) → S repeat. "phoTOgraphy" → "photoGRAPHic" → "phoTOgrapher." Then "eCONomy → ecoNOMic," "comPETE → compeTItion → comPETitive." Learners clap with you.
- 3 What's the job?** T says a word; learners hold up a colored card (or say N / V / ADJ / ADV): "happiness" → N · "widen" → V · "dangerous" → ADJ · "easily" → ADV · "agreement" → N · "simplify" → V.
- 4 Flip it:** T: "possible" → S: "impossible." "legal" → "illegal." "regular" → "irregular." "honest" → "dishonest." "correct" → "incorrect." "fair" → "unfair." Fast, then individuals.
- 5 Fit it** (open pairs → closed pairs): S1 says a base; S2 says a sentence frame; S3 fills it: "CARE" + "Please drive..." → "Please drive carefully."

◆ WORD FAMILY GRID – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Pairs sit face to face. A holds **Grid A**, B holds **Grid B**. Both grids have the same 10 bases (*decide*, *succeed*, *create*, *strong*, *compete*, *rely*, *care*, *attract*, *employ*, *responsible*) with columns Noun · Verb · Adjective · Adverb · Negative. Each card shows about half the answers; the missing cells are on the partner's card.
- ◆ Learners **ask, answer and spell**: "What's the noun from *compete*?" "*Competition*: C-O-M-P-E-T-I-T-I-O-N." They write the answers in Workbook Ex 1. No showing the card. (Spelling aloud is useful: many learners have never spelled *-tion* or *-ible* aloud.)
- ◆ The Negative column is empty on both cards: pairs must **agree** on the right prefix together. This is where discussion happens ("Is it *unresponsible*?" "No, *r*, so *ir*-!").

- ◆ Two cells are marked * on both cards: families with **two nouns** (*creation / creativity; employer / employee / employment*). Ask pairs what the difference is.
- ◆ Dominant speakers: A asks all the Noun and Verb questions, B all the Adjective and Adverb questions, so both partners talk equally.

◆ PREFIX/SUFFIX RACE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Teams of 3–4. Each team has an envelope: **20 base cards** (*possible, legal, regular, honest, agree, fair, correct, understand, cook, pay, write, view, care, hope, help, use, kind, create, rely, danger*) and **27 affix cards** (prefixes *un-, in-, im-, il-, ir-, dis-, non-, re-, over-, under-, mis-, pre-* and suffixes *-tion, -ment, -ness, -ity, -er, -ful, -less, -able, -ive, -ous, -al, -ly, -ize, -en, -ify*).
- ◆ **Round 1 · Flip it (3 min):** T reads a base; the first team to hold up the correct negative prefix card and say the word ("*Illegal!*") scores 1. Wrong prefix = the next team can steal.
- ◆ **Round 2 · Build it (4 min):** teams lay out as many *real* words as they can with base + affix cards (up to two affixes, e.g., *un + help + ful*). 1 point per real word. Then teams walk around and **challenge** words they don't believe: a phone dictionary settles it. An invented word (*beautiless, impossible, helpness*) = -1 point. The answer key has the full list of accepted words.
- ◆ **Round 3 · Fit it (4 min):** T reads the 8 sentences in **Script 6.1-B**, saying "BLANK" for the gap and the base in capitals. Teams write the form on paper and hold it up. 2 points for the right form, 1 for the right job with a spelling slip.
- ◆ Give the strongest speaker the **referee** job for Round 2 (with the answer list): they check challenges and add scores. It keeps them busy and gives the quieter learners the building.

◆ COMEBACK STORY – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ The model is the online lesson's passage: "*Despite careful preparation, the first launch was a complete failure. The team felt disappointed, but they responded decisively...*". Read it aloud and ask: "How many forms can you hear?"
- ◆ Scenario cards give a story frame with invented people: the night-market stall that got no customers in the first month, the community garden that flooded, the soccer team that lost every game, the bake sale with burned cakes, the neighborhood app that nobody downloaded, the second driving test. Learners can also tell a real, *light* story, or use their identity card.
- ◆ Each teller must use at least **six forms** from two or more families (e.g., *fail, failure, disappointed, decision, decisively, improvement, succeed, successful*). Listeners mark every form they hear on their **bingo grid**. Three in a row = say "Bingo!" quietly after the story, not during it.
- ◆ Talking-turn token: only the teller speaks; after the story each listener asks **one** follow-up question. The learner who talked longest in the last round tells their story last.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE GRID, THE RACE AND THE STORY

SAY: *Grid: Can you show your card? (No.) · What do you do after you say the word? (Spell it.) · Who decides the negative? (Both of us, together.)*

SAY: *Race: Round 1: what do you hold up? (The negative prefix card.) · Round 2: do invented words score? (No, minus one!) · Who checks a challenge? (The dictionary / the referee.) · Round 3: what do you write? (The form that fits the sentence.)*

SAY: *Story: How many forms from the families? (Six or more.) · What do listeners do? (Mark the forms on the bingo.) · When do you say "Bingo"? (After the story.) · Does it have to be your real life? (No: a card, real, or imagined.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on **four families** (*decide, succeed, care, strong*) and **four endings** (*-tion, -ful, -ly, un- / im-*). Give the colored suffix cards as a strip on the desk: blue = thing, green = describes a person or thing, orange = describes how. In the Grid, the learner asks and their partner spells, then the learner copies. In the Race, pair them with a patient speller and let them do Round 1 (listening, no writing). Target: 4 correct gap-fills and a 3-sentence comeback story with *fail* → *decided* → *successful*. Spelling reminders: **-ful** has one l, **-fully** two.

STRETCH

Push toward C1: less transparent suffixes (*-ance / -ence, -hood, -ship, -dom: reliance, childhood, leadership, freedom*); words that change job with no suffix but move the stress (*a REcord / to reCORD, a PREsent / to preSENT, an INcrease / to inCREASE*); and collocations with the family (*make a decision, reach an agreement, a significant improvement*). In the Race, they may use two affixes only. In the story, they add one *-ance / -ence* noun and one stress-shift pair. Early finishers write a 6-gap word-formation exercise for a classmate.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Wrong part of speech:** "a success project," "He explained very clear," "a decide leader." Chinese, Vietnamese and Thai words don't change form for their job, so the ending feels optional. Ask the two-step question every time: "What job does the slot need?"
- ◆ **Spanish, Portuguese, French and Italian cognates** are a gift (*-ción* → *-tion, -dad / -ité* → *-ity, -oso* → *-ous*) and a trap: *sensible* ≠ *sensible* (Spanish = sensitive), *actually* ≠ *actualmente* (= currently). The prefix *des-* leads to "disfortunate" (*desafortunado*), "discomfortable," "disagradable": English uses *un-* (*unfortunate, uncomfortable, unpleasant*).
- ◆ **Arabic and Hebrew** build words from roots and patterns, so learners understand families quickly, but the English suffixes are unfamiliar: expect "responsibleness," "successness." Praise the logic; give the real word.

- ◆ **Stress in the same place every time:** French speakers stress the last syllable (*photograPHY*), Polish the second-last, Czech, Hungarian and Finnish the first. Learners from these languages often keep one stress position across the family. Clap the stress; it is a listening skill as much as a speaking one.
- ◆ **Spelling:** "carefull," "successfull," "hopefully," "responsible" (Spanish, French, Portuguese *responsable*). Point at the -ful / -fully rule and the -ible in *responsible, possible, visible*.
- ◆ **-ed / -ing adjectives** slip in: "The team was disappointing" (meaning *disappointed*). Many languages use one form for both. Quick check: "Who felt it? → -ed. What caused it? → -ing."

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_16.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back, copying the stress; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 6.1: the **word family map** (six bases useful for you, each with noun, verb, adjective, adverb and a negative, with the stress marked), write your comeback story in 6–8 sentences using at least six forms, "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **C** decisively · Q2 **B** irresponsible · Q3 (new) **B** invaluable (= extremely valuable). Script 6.1-B (Race Round 3): 1 improvement · 2 unreliable · 3 creativity · 4 strengthen · 5 competitive · 6 misunderstood · 7 carelessly · 8 employees.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ show **how big a difference is**: *far / much / a lot / considerably / significantly* + comparative (big) · *slightly / a bit / a little / marginally* + comparative (small), and never "very + comparative"
- ◆ use *not nearly as... as* and *nowhere near as... as* (much less) and *not quite as... as* (almost as)
- ◆ compare with *as... as*, multiples (*twice / three times / half as... as*), *the same as*, *similar to*, *different from*, choosing **than** or **as** correctly
- ◆ link two changes with **the + comparative...**, **the + comparative** (*The earlier we leave, the less traffic we'll hit.*) and describe a trend with **comparative and comparative** (*more and more expensive*)
- ◆ compare two products, jobs or towns and **recommend** one to a "client," using six or more different structures

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, Compare & Recommend notes)
- ◆ Slides 8–12 · **Difference-scale** flashcards · Job and product **picture cards** · **Compare & Recommend** fact sheets (A and B for phones, jobs and towns) + **client cards** · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.2-A (how big is the difference?) and 6.2-B (the highway or the coast road?)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the **difference line**, a long arrow from tiny to huge: marginally · slightly · a bit · a little | ... | a lot · much · far · considerably · significantly · (the other way: nowhere near as / not nearly as). Under it, crossed out in red: ~~very cheaper~~ · ~~more better~~ · ~~more faster~~.

Center: two columns: **THAN** after -er / more / less · **AS** with as... as / the same as / twice as... as. Examples: far cheaper **than** · twice as big **as** · the same **as** · similar **to** · different **from**.

Right: **The** more you practice ↗ | **the** better you get ↘ (two halves, two "the"s, two comparatives). Under it: better **and** better · more **and** more expensive (a trend).

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: family relay	8	S-S → T-S	Review C17. Pairs show each other their homework word family maps and read one sentence from their comeback story. Then a fast relay: T calls a base and a job ("SUCCESS, adverb!"); the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			first team to shout "successfully" scores. Finish with three stress-shift claps (<i>PHOtograph</i> → <i>phoTOgraphy</i>).
Lead-in: which would you buy?	5	T-S	Slide 8 heading, and two invented phones on the board: Nova S \$320 · Kestrel 8 \$640. "Is the Kestrel more expensive?" (Yes.) "Just more expensive?" Elicit <i>much / a lot more</i> ; then "It's exactly...?" (twice as expensive). Then battery: 48 h vs 46 h: "Is the Nova's battery much better?" (No, <i>slightly</i> .) "Today: not <i>that</i> it's different, but <i>how much</i> ."
Grammar: the size of the difference	12	T-S	Slide 8. Build the difference line on the board with the scale flashcards. The <i>very</i> trap. Then <i>not nearly as / nowhere near as</i> (a big gap: much less) vs <i>not quite as</i> (a small gap: almost). CCQs (below). Then Script 6.2-A : learners mark each sentence on the line in Workbook Ex 3.
Drill	6	T-S → S	Scale drill with the cards and the stress on the intensifier (see Drill script).
Grammar: as... as, multiples, same	8	T-S	Slide 9. <i>as... as</i> (equal), <i>not as... as</i> (less), <i>twice / three times / half as... as</i> , <i>the same as</i> · <i>similar to</i> · <i>different from</i> . The than or as? rule. Weak forms: <i>as</i> / əz/, <i>than</i> /ðən/. CCQs.
Controlled practice	8	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1, 4 and 5 alone (complete, rewrite, find the mistake), then check in pairs. Board-check Ex 5: learners come up and correct the red-pen errors.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Grammar + game: the more..., the more...	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 10. Two halves, two <i>thes</i> , two comparatives; the short fixed forms (<i>the sooner, the better; the more, the merrier</i>); then trends: <i>better and better, more and more expensive</i> . CCQs. Then Consequence Chain in groups of 4 (4 min): S1 "The more you practice, the better you get." S2 "The better you get, the more confident you feel." S3 "The more confident you feel..." How long can the chain go? Workbook Ex 2 as a quick check.
Listening: the highway or the coast road?	5	T-S → S-S	Slide 11. Read Script 6.2-B twice (two voices, or with a confident learner). First listening: which road do they choose, and why? Second: learners tick the comparison phrases they hear in the workbook dialogue box, then read it in pairs.
Freer: Compare & Recommend	18	S-S (pairs) → S-S (groups)	Slide 12. Round 1 (7 min) phones: A has the Nova S fact sheet, B the Kestrel 8. Without showing their sheet, they exchange facts and compare aloud ("Mine's <i>twice as</i> expensive, but the camera is <i>far</i> better."). Then they take a client card ("a delivery driver who uses maps all day") and agree on a recommendation. Round 2 (7 min) new partner, jobs or towns. Report (4 min): pairs join into fours and each learner gives their partner's recommendation in 3–4 sentences with one <i>the more..., the more....</i> ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Board: 4 heard sentences (no names), e.g. "It's very cheaper." · "The Kestrel is two times more expensive than the Nova." (accept, then show <i>twice as expensive as</i>) · "The same than mine." ·

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			"More you pay, more you get." Learners fix them. Then one range upgrade: "much better" → "considerably better / nowhere near as good."
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 6.2; workbook "Compare & Recommend" write-up and the journal.
Total	90		8 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 8 + 8 + 10 + 5 + 18 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Do only one round of Compare & Recommend (the phones) and move Workbook Ex 4 to homework. Never cut the recommendation step: comparing is only useful when it leads to a decision, and "So overall, I'd say..." is the moment the structures come together. With a strong class, shorten the *as... as* stage to 4 minutes (it is revision).

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: the size of the difference.

SAY: "The Kestrel is **far** more expensive." Is the difference big or small? (Big.) • "The Nova is **slightly** heavier." Would you notice it in your hand? (Probably not; it's a small difference.) • Can I say "very more expensive"? (No! much / far more expensive.) • Can I say "very expensive"? (Yes: no comparative, so very is fine.)

SAY: "The movie was **nowhere near as good as** the book." Which was better? (The book.) A little better or a lot? (A lot.) • "The bus is **not quite as fast as** the train." Is the bus much slower? (No, only a little.) • Which is the bigger gap: not quite as or not nearly as? (Not nearly as.)

Meaning: multiples and "the same".

SAY: "Rent in the city is twice as high as in the town." The town: \$900. The city? (\$1,800.) • On the fact sheets: \$1,500 and \$950. Twice as high? (Not quite: almost twice as high.) • "The trip took half as long as we expected." We expected 4 hours. It took? (2 hours.) Faster or slower than we thought? (Faster.) • "Her salary is the same as his." Is one higher? (No, equal.)

Meaning: the parallel comparative.

SAY: "The more you practice, the better you get." Two things change: what are they? (Practice and skill.) Do they change together? (Yes: more practice → more skill.) • "The older I get, the less I worry."

Getting older → worrying more or less? (Less.) · "The sooner, the better." What's missing? (...we leave / it happens. The listener knows.)

SAY: "Prices are getting higher and higher." One change or a continuing trend? (A trend: it keeps going.) · "more and more expensive": why not "expensiver and expensiver"? (Long adjective → more and more + adjective.)

Form.

Big difference	far / much / a lot / considerably / significantly + comparative + than	This laptop is far more powerful than my old one.
Small difference	slightly / a bit / a little / marginally + comparative + than	The blue jacket is slightly cheaper than the black one.
Much less	not nearly / nowhere near as + adjective + as	The sequel was nowhere near as good as the original.
Almost as	not quite as + adjective + as	The bus isn't quite as fast as the train.
Equal / less	(not) as + adjective / adverb + as	He works as hard as anyone. · She isn't as tall as her sister.
Multiples	twice / three times / half + as... as	Their house is three times as big as ours.
Same / similar	the same as · similar to · different from	Your phone is the same as mine.
Parallel	the + comparative (+ clause), the + comparative (+ clause)	The bigger the car, the more gas it uses.
Trend	comparative and comparative · more and more + long adjective	Her English is getting better and better.
Adverbs	more quickly / more carefully · faster / harder / better	She types more quickly than I do.

Pronunciation. Stress the intensifier, because it carries the message: "It's **FAR** more expensive." · "It's only **SLIGHT**ly heavier." · "It's **NOW**here near as good." *than* and *as* are weak: /ðən/, /əz/: "as tall as" = /əz 'tɔl əz/, "cheaper than" = /tʃi:pər ðən/. *Twice as* links: /'twaisəz/. The parallel comparative has **two tone units**: the voice **rises** at the end of the first half and **falls** at the end of the second: "The more you **PRACT**ice ↗ | the **BET**ter you get ↘." A short pause at the comma helps listeners. In American English, *better and better* uses the flap: /'bɛrər ən 'bɛrər/.

- 1 **Scale drill** (point at a card on the difference line): T: "cheaper, big" → S: "**far** cheaper / **much** cheaper." T: "cheaper, small" → S: "**slightly** cheaper." T: "good, much less" → S: "**nowhere near as** good." T: "fast, almost" → S: "**not quite as** fast." Choral, then individuals, stressing the intensifier.
- 2 **Very? No!** T: "very cheaper" → S: "much cheaper!" T: "very expensive" → S: "OK!" T: "very more reliable" → S: "far more reliable!"
- 3 **Numbers → multiples**: T: "\$300 and \$600" → S: "twice as expensive as." "100 and 300" → "three times as big as." "4 hours and 2 hours" → "half as long as."
- 4 **Than or as?** T: "bigger..." → S: "than." T: "as big..." → S: "as." T: "the same..." → S: "as." T: "similar..." → S: "to." T: "different..." → S: "from."
- 5 **Rise-fall**: choral "The sooner we leave ↗ | the better ↘." Then open pairs: S1 starts, S2 finishes: S1 "The more you read ↗..." S2 "...the more you learn ↘."

◆ COMPARE & RECOMMEND – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Three topics, each with an **A** and a **B** fact sheet: **phones** (Nova S vs Kestrel 8), **jobs** (Warehouse Team Lead at Brightline vs Delivery Driver at QuickRoute), **towns** (Riverton vs Millbrook). All invented. The numbers are designed so learners *need* the target language: \$320 vs \$640 (*twice as*), 180 g vs 185 g (*slightly*), 45 minutes vs 10 minutes (*far longer / nowhere near as short*).
- ◆ Partners **don't show** their sheets. They tell each other the facts and compare aloud. Each sheet has a checklist of six structures at the bottom: learners tick one each time they use it.
- ◆ Then the pair draws a **client card** (e.g., "a student on a tight budget," "a nurse who works nights," "a retired couple who don't drive") and must agree on one recommendation, ending with "So overall, I'd recommend... because...". If they disagree, they can each argue a side; that's good B2 practice.
- ◆ Keep the comparisons neutral: invented products, invented job ads, invented towns. Nobody compares their own salary, their own country or their own town.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers**: the partner with the *quieter* voice reads the client card and makes the final decision ("You've convinced me" or "Not yet!"). The talkative partner must persuade them.

◆ ICQS BEFORE COMPARE & RECOMMEND

SAY: *Can you show your fact sheet? (No, tell your partner.) · How many different structures do you try to use? (Six: tick them.) · What does the client card tell you? (Who we are recommending for.) · How do you finish? ("So overall, I'd recommend...") · Do we talk about our own salary? (No, only the card.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with three frames only: "X is **much** ___er than Y." · "X is **slightly** ___er than Y." · "X is **twice as** ___ as Y." Give the phones sheet only, with the numbers circled and a picture cue for each row (\$ price, 🔋 battery, 📷 camera, ⚖️ weight). The learner can point at the difference line while speaking. Target: 4 spoken comparisons and one recommendation ("I recommend the Nova because it's much cheaper.").

STRETCH

Push toward C1: *by far the best, every bit as good as, nothing like as expensive as, a great deal more, not remotely as*, and the parallel comparative with a noun (*the more money you earn, the more tax you pay*). Ask them to hedge the recommendation (*On balance... / If budget is the main concern...*). Early finishers describe the trend table on their town sheet in four sentences (*Rents have become more and more expensive: they're now almost twice as high as in 2018.*).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **than / that / as**: Spanish and Portuguese use *que* for both "than" and "that," so learners write "bigger that." French uses *que* for both "than" and "as" (*plus grand que, aussi grand que*): "as big than." Use the board rule: **-er / more → than; as / same → as**.
- ◆ **"the same than" / "the same like"**: Spanish *lo mismo que*, German *gleich wie*, Russian *такой же, как*. Drill "the same as" as one chunk.
- ◆ **Dropping the "the"s**: Spanish *cuanto más... más*, French *plus... plus*, German *je... desto*, Russian *чем... тем*, Chinese 越...越 and Korean -[] [] have no article: "More you practice, better you get." Point at the two "the"s on the board.
- ◆ **"two times more expensive"**: very common for Russian (*в два раза дороже*), Chinese, Spanish and Arabic speakers. It is heard in real English and is understood; accept it in speech, and teach *twice as expensive as* as the clear, standard form.
- ◆ **Double comparatives**: "more better," "more cheaper," "very cheaper": Arabic, Tagalog and many other speakers. Also Chinese and Japanese learners may skip *-er* ([] / [] do the job): "It's cheap than mine."
- ◆ **"The more you practice, the more you get better"**: logical, but English prefers "the better you get." Recast gently.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_17.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back, stressing the intensifier and pausing between the halves of *the more..., the more...*; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 6.2: write up one Compare & Recommend (from class, or two things you know well, such as two apps or two stores) in 6–8 sentences with at least six different structures and a clear recommendation, "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** This one is far more expensive. · Q2 **A** The more · Q3 (new) **C** The Kestrel is twice as expensive as the Nova.
Script 6.2-A (difference line): 1 big · 2 small · 3 much less · 4 almost the same · 5 big · 6 equal.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ turn a direct question into a polite **indirect question**: opener + **statement word order**, no *do / does / did* (*Do you know what time it opens?*)
- ◆ use *if / whether* for yes/no questions, with *or not* in the right place (*whether or not...*, *if... or not*)
- ◆ use **negative questions** to show surprise (*Didn't you get my message?*), invite agreement (*Isn't it beautiful?*), check a belief (*Isn't the office closed on Mondays?*) and persuade (*Don't you think...? Wouldn't it be easier to...?*), and **answer them by the facts**
- ◆ ask **subject questions** with no auxiliary (*Who broke the window?*) and object questions with one (*What did she break?*)
- ◆ sound polite with their **voice** (wide pitch, a gentle rise, a soft fall-rise) in a customer-service call and a job interview

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 6.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, dialogue, role-play planner)
- ◆ Slides 13–17 · **Opener** flashcards (on the wall) · **Polite Enquiry** role-play cards (6 customer-service + 2 job-interview scenarios, A / B / observer) · New identity cards (candidate profiles)
- ◆ Listening scripts 6.3-A (a call to Riverside Community Center), 6.3-B (rise or fall? negative questions) and 6.3-C (the office mystery)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the "sandwich": [**Could you tell me**] + where the station is + ? Under it: Where **is** the station? → ... where the station **is**. · What time **does** it open? → ...what time it opens. (cross out **does** in red) · **Are** they open? → ...**if / whether** they're open.

Center: the opener ladder, from casual to careful: Do you know...? · Could you tell me...? · Do you have any idea...? · Would you mind telling me...? · I was wondering if... · I'd like to know... (statement openers → period OK).

Right: negative questions with arrows: Isn't it beautiful? ↘ (agree with me!) · Isn't the office closed on Mondays? ↗ (I think so: check) · Didn't you get my message? ↗ (surprise) · Don't you think we should wait? ↘ (persuade). Answer by the FACTS: I got it → **Yes, I did**. · I didn't → **No, I didn't**. Under it: **Who** broke it? (no **did**) vs **What did** she break?

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: nowhere near as...	7	S-S → T-S	Review C18. Pairs read their homework recommendation to each other; the listener says one thing they'd compare differently. Then a quick class Consequence Chain (<i>The more..., the more...</i>) started by T: "The more coffee I drink..."
Lead-in: two ways to ask	5	T-S	Slide 13. Act two moments: to a friend, casually, "Where's the restroom?"; to a stranger in a hotel lobby, "Excuse me, could you tell me where the restroom is?" "Who am I talking to each time? Which is better for a stranger? What's different?" Let learners notice the opener <i>and</i> the word order (<i>is</i> moved to the end). Link: "You met this word order in B1: reported questions."
Grammar: indirect questions	12	T-S	Slides 13–14. The sandwich, the three changes (statement order, no <i>do</i> / <i>does</i> / <i>did</i> , <i>if</i> / <i>whether</i> for yes/no), the opener ladder, <i>or not</i> , and punctuation (question opener → ?, statement opener → period, though ? is common). Cross out <i>does</i> / <i>did</i> in red every time. CCQs (below).
Drill	6	T-S → S	Direct → indirect transformation and the polite voice (see Drill script).
Listening: the front- desk call	5	T-S → S	Hold a phone to your ear and read Script 6.3-A (you are the caller; a learner or your second voice is the receptionist). First listening: what does the caller want? (to join the gym / a beginner class). Second: learners write the six indirect questions they hear in Workbook Ex 1's box. Check: which opener was the politest?
Controlled practice 1	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 2 and 3 alone (complete the gap; rewrite with the opener), then pairs check. Board-check: learners come up and cross out the extra <i>does</i> / <i>did</i> .
Negative questions	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. Four jobs (admire / agree, surprise, check a belief, suggest or persuade), including <i>Don't you think...?</i> and <i>Isn't it...?</i> . Script 6.3-B : learners decide rise ↗ or fall ↘ and what the speaker means. Then the answering trap: "Didn't you get my email?" → by the facts. Quick pair drill with Workbook Ex 4.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Subject questions	6	T-S → S-S	Slide 16. Read Script 6.3-C (the office mystery: who ate the birthday cake?). Pairs ask as many questions as they can about it: <i>Who left the fridge open? What did Ms. Tran find?</i> The quick test: "Is the question word the doer?" Then Workbook Ex 5.
Freer: Polite Enquiry role-play	22	S-S (groups of 3)	Slide 17. Groups of 3: A = customer or candidate, B = staff or interviewer, C = observer with the checklist. Round 1 (7 min: 2 min to plan, 4 to play, 1 for the observer's feedback): a customer-service card (gym front desk, hotel, community college, library, furniture delivery, internet provider). Round 2 (7 min): rotate roles, new card. Round 3 (8 min): the job interview cards: the interviewer asks polite indirect questions and checks with negative questions (<i>Didn't you say you'd trained new staff?</i>); the candidate answers from an identity card and asks three indirect questions at the end (<i>Could you tell me what a typical shift looks like?</i>). ICQs first.
Feedback + module check	5	T-S	Delayed correction: "Could you tell me where is the gym?" · "Do you know what time does it open?" · "Who did break the window?" · "Didn't you get my email?" "No, I got it." Learners fix them. Then one tone note: model a flat "Could you tell me when it closes" vs a warm one, and ask which sounded polite. Learners tick the three Module 6 "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 6.3; the "four real questions" writing; preview C20: "Next class: <i>put off</i> or <i>postpone</i> ? <i>Hey!</i> or <i>Dear Sir or Madam</i> ? Register: formal and informal English."
Total	90		7 + 5 + 12 + 6 + 5 + 7 + 10 + 6 + 22 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This class has three grammar points. If time is tight, teach subject questions in 3 minutes (the board contrast + two examples) and move Workbook Ex 5 to homework; do two role-play rounds (one customer-service, one interview). Never cut the interview round: it is the most useful real-life task in the module, and it recycles the comparison language from C18.

Meaning: why indirect? The opener softens the question. It adds a little distance and courtesy: ideal with strangers, at work, on the phone, in emails. With friends, direct questions are normal and not rude.

SAY: "Could you tell me where the station is?" Is the speaker asking if you can tell them? (No, they want the information: where the station is.) · Is this more polite than "Where's the station?" (Yes, better for a stranger.) · Would you say it to your brother at home? (Probably not. It would sound funny, too formal.)

SAY: "Do you know what time it opens?" What was the direct question? ("What time does it open?") Where did does go? (Gone. The -s moved to opens.) · "I was wondering if the bus stops here." Is this a yes/no question or a wh- question? (Yes/no: "Does the bus stop here?") So we add...? (if / whether.)

Meaning: negative questions. They usually don't ask for new information. They show what the speaker already thinks or feels.

SAY: "Isn't it beautiful? ♫" Does she really want to know if it's beautiful? (No, she thinks it is; she wants me to agree.) · "Didn't you get my message? ↗" What did he expect? (That I got it.) How does he feel? (Surprised, maybe a little worried.) · "Don't you think we should wait? ♫" Is it really a question? (Not really: a suggestion; he wants to wait.)

SAY: "Didn't you get my message?" You did get it. Yes or no? (Yes, I did.) · You didn't get it. Yes or no? (No, I didn't.) · So what does "yes" always mean in English? (It's true / it happened.) · Why add "I did / I didn't"? (It removes any doubt.)

Meaning: subject questions.

SAY: "Who broke the window?" Do we know who broke it? (No, that's the question.) Is who the doer? (Yes.) So: did? (No.) · "What did she break?" Who's the doer? (She is.) So: did? (Yes.) · Answer both: "**Maria** broke the window." · "She broke **the window**." Where does the answer go? (Front = subject question; after the verb = object question.)

Form.

Wh-indirect	opener + wh- word + subject + verb (no do / does / did)	Where is the station? → Could you tell me where the station is? · How much did it cost? → Do you know how much it cost?
Yes/No indirect	opener + if / whether + subject + verb	Does the bus stop here? → Could you tell me whether the bus stops here?
or not	whether or not + clause · if + clause + or not	Do you know whether or not they're open? · ...if they're open or not?

Openers	Do you know...? · Could you tell me...? · Do you have any idea...? · Would you mind telling me...? · I was wondering if / whether... · I'd like to know...	Statement openers end with a period (a question mark is common too).
Negative questions	negative auxiliary + subject + verb	Isn't it...? · Didn't you...? · Haven't we...? · Wouldn't it be...? · Don't you think...?
Answers	by the facts: Yes = true / happened · No = not true / didn't happen	"Didn't you go?" (I went.) → Yes, I did. · (I didn't.) → No, I didn't.
Subject questions	Who / What + verb (no auxiliary)	Who lives here? · What happened next? · Who left the door open?
Object questions	Who / What + do / does / did + subject + verb	Who do you live with? · What did she break?

Pronunciation. In English, **politeness lives in the voice** as much as in the words. (1) **Indirect questions with a question opener** (*Could you tell me...? Do you know...?*) are grammatically yes/no questions: a **gentle rise** at the end sounds polite and open ("Could you tell me where the **ST**ation is? ↗"); a fall is also normal and sounds more businesslike. Start a little higher than usual and use a **wide pitch range**: a flat, low voice sounds bored or annoyed, even with perfect grammar. (2) **Statement openers** (*I was wondering if...*) often take a soft **fall-rise** ↘↗ at the end: tentative and very polite ("I was wondering if you had any **OP**enings ↘↗"). (3) **Negative questions**: stress the negative auxiliary (**DID**n't you..., **IS**n't it..., **DON'T** you think...). A **fall** means "I'm sure; agree with me" (*Isn't it beautiful? ↘ · Don't you think we should wait? ↘*); a **rise** means "I thought so; is it true?" or surprise (*Isn't the office closed on Mondays? ↗ · Didn't you get my message? ↗*). Link to B1 question tags: same rule. (4) **Weak forms and linking**: *Could you* /'kʊdʒə/, *Would you* /'wʊdʒə/, *Do you know* /dʒə'noʊ/, *Didn't you* /'dɪdntʃə/, *Don't you* /'daʊntʃə/; *whether* = *weather*.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- Sandwich it** (point at an opener card): T: "Where is the pharmacy? · Could you tell me..." → S: "Could you tell me where the pharmacy is?" T: "What time does the library close? · Do you know..." → S: "Do you know what time the library closes?" T: "How much did the tickets cost? · Do you have any idea..." → S: "...how much the tickets cost?"
- If or whether**: T: "Is this seat free? · I was wondering..." → S: "I was wondering if this seat is free." T: "Do they deliver? · Could you tell me..." → S: "...whether they deliver?" T: "...or not" → S: "Could you tell me whether or not they deliver?"
- The polite voice**: T says one indirect question twice, flat and then warm (higher start, gentle rise). "Which one gets you help?" Choral ×3 with the warm version, then individuals, using a desk bell: T rings, a learner asks.

- 4 **Rise or fall?** T: "Isn't it beautiful? ↘" → S: "Yes, it is!" T: "Didn't you get my email? ↗" → S (card says ✓): "Yes, I did. Sorry!" / (card says ✗): "No, I didn't. Can you resend it?"
- 5 **Doer or not?** T gives an answer; learners make the question: "Tom called." → "Who called?" "Tom called his boss." → "Who did Tom call?" "The printer broke." → "What broke?"

◆ POLITE ENQUIRY ROLE-PLAY – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Six customer-service cards:** the Riverside Community Center gym front desk, a hotel front desk (phone), Lakeview Community College admissions, the public library, a furniture store (delivery), an internet provider (slow Wi-Fi). **Card A** (customer) lists 6 things to find out, including one yes/no question (→ *if / whether*) and one belief to check with a negative question (*Isn't it cheaper online?*). **Card B** (staff) has all the answers, plus one **upsell** to try with *Don't you think...?* or *Wouldn't it be better to...?*. This brings back the C18 comparisons ("The annual plan is far better value").
- ◆ **Two job-interview cards:** café shift supervisor and office assistant at a dental clinic. The interviewer (B) asks at least four indirect questions (*Could you tell me what you enjoy about working with customers?*) and checks two things from the candidate's profile with negative questions (*Didn't you say you'd trained new staff? Haven't you worked weekends before?*). The candidate (A) answers **from an identity card**, never from their real life, and answers the negative questions by the facts. At the end the candidate asks three indirect questions (*I was wondering whether there's any paid training.*).
- ◆ **Observer (C)** has the checklist: 6 indirect questions? statement order? no *do / did?* *if / whether?* one negative question? polite voice (rise, wide pitch)? They give the feedback: **one thing that was great, one thing to fix**. Give the observer job to the strongest speaker in Round 1; it is a real, demanding job.
- ◆ Keep every scenario routine: memberships, check-in times, delivery windows, a slow connection, a job interview. No debt, eviction, police, immigration, medical or benefits calls. The interview is always for an **invented** job, and the candidate always uses an identity card.
- ◆ Planning time (2 minutes) is important at B2: learners write the **key words** of their questions, not full sentences, then speak. Writing full sentences turns the role-play into reading aloud.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE ROLE-PLAY

SAY: *How many indirect questions does A ask? (Six or more.) · What happens to does / did after the opener? (It disappears.) · When do you use if / whether? (For a yes/no question.) · What does B try to do? (Sell something with "Don't you think...?") · What does the observer do? (Listen, tick, and say one great thing and one thing to fix.) · In the interview, do you talk about your real life? (No, the identity card.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use two openers only, **Could you tell me...?** and **Do you know if...?**, on a strip, with the "sandwich" picture (bread = opener, filling = *where it is*). Give the gym card (the simplest) with picture cues (🕒 hours, 💰 price, 🏊 pool, **P** parking). The learner plays the **customer** first, with a supportive partner as staff. Skip subject questions if needed. Target: 4 indirect questions with statement order, and "Yes, I did / No, I didn't" answers.

STRETCH

Push toward C1: *Would you happen to know...? · I don't suppose you could tell me...? · I'd be grateful if you could let me know whether... (email) · What I'd really like to know is...; whether + to-infinitive (I'm not sure whether to upgrade); negative questions with a softener (Wouldn't it make more sense to...?).* In the interview, they combine comparison and questions: *Could you tell me whether the evening shift is much busier than the morning?* Early finishers write the follow-up email in formal register (a preview of C20).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Keeping the question order:** "Could you tell me where is the station?" / "Do you know what time does it open?" Almost every learner does this, because the ear expects a question. Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian and Arabic speakers may also transfer their own embedded-question order (in Spanish ¿*Sabe dónde está la estación?* the verb comes before the subject). Use the red pen and the sandwich.
- ◆ **No if:** "Do you know is the shop open?" Russian (*ли* after the verb), Arabic (*hal*), Chinese and Vietnamese (a question particle) have no joining word like *if*. Drill "Do you know **if**..." as one chunk.
- ◆ **Answering negative questions:** Japanese, Korean, Mandarin and Cantonese speakers (and many others) answer to agree with the question: "Didn't you go?" "Yes" = "Yes, you're right, I didn't." French (*si*) and German (*doch*) have a special word for "yes, I did," which English doesn't. Always teach the full answer: "Yes, I did / No, I didn't."
- ◆ **Politeness in the words, not the tune:** learners whose languages show respect with verb endings, particles or pronouns (Japanese *-masu*, Korean *-yo*, Tagalog *po / opo*, Spanish *usted*, French *vous*, Russian *вы*) may rely on "please" alone and a flat voice. English puts politeness in the **opener and the intonation**. Model the difference without judging.
- ◆ **Auxiliary in subject questions:** "Who did break the window?" / "What did happen?" Spanish, Portuguese, Chinese and many others. The quick test: "Is the question word the doer?" (Note: "Who **DID** break it?" with stress is correct but emphatic; don't teach it here.)
- ◆ **Negative questions can sound like complaints:** "Didn't you read my email?" with a falling, heavy tone sounds like criticism. Learners who translate directly may sound rude by accident. Model the light, surprised rise.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 6.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_18.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and copy the polite rise; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 6.3: "My real questions" (four direct questions you might ask this week at a store, station, office or online, rewritten as indirect questions with four different openers, plus one negative question and one subject question), "My new words" and the journal. Challenge: ask one real indirect question outside class and notice the reaction.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 C Could you tell me where the station is? · Q2 A Who broke the window? · Q3 (new) B "Yes, I did." Script 6.3-A (the six questions): what time the gym opens · how much a monthly membership costs · whether there are classes for beginners · if towels are provided · where I can park · whether I can try a class for free. Script 6.3-B: 1 ↘ agree · 2 ↗ surprise · 3 ↗ check · 4 ↘ persuade · 5 ↘ admire · 6 ↗ surprise.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C19: MODULE 6 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18, "the right form, the right size, the right shape": **decide → decision → decisive → decisively** (word families) → **far cheaper · slightly heavier · nowhere near as good · twice as big · the more..., the better** (comparison) → **Could you tell me where it is? · Isn't it...? · Don't you think...? · Who broke it?** (questions). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you. Review it in the C20 warmer.

Watch for in Module 7: Lesson 7.1 (register) builds directly on today: indirect questions are one of the main tools of formal English, and the word-formation work returns in formal nouns (*a decision was made, an improvement in...*). Keep a 2-minute "make it polite" warmer (one blunt question → indirect) in C20–C22. The comparison structures are ideal for 7.3 (persuasion) and the Module 8 debate: remind learners to reach for *far more... / nowhere near as...* when they argue a case.

Final assessment (C26) covers all eight modules. From this module it tests: choosing the correct form of a base word in a gap (noun / verb / adjective / adverb / negative), negative prefixes (*im- / il- / ir- / in- / un- / dis-*), intensifiers and softeners with comparatives (and "very + comparative" as an error), *not nearly / nowhere near as... as*, multiples, *the more..., the more..., than vs as*, indirect questions (statement order, *no do / did, if / whether*), answering negative questions by the facts, and subject questions.

Module 7 — Communicating with Style

Three classes about *how* we say things, not just what we say. First, **register**: the four features that shift between casual and formal English (word choice, contractions, sentence length, set phrases), polite spoken requests, and the five-part formal email, practiced in a workplace **register-switching workshop**. Then **storytelling**: hooks, scene-setting, narrative connectors, the historic present, direct speech and listener reactions, practiced in an **anecdote circle**. Last, **persuasion**: signposting, claim + reason + evidence, rhetorical techniques, concede-and-counter and handling questions, practiced in a **problem-solution pitch** with audience Q&A.

3 Lessons

Lessons 7.1–7.3

Classes C20–C22

Weeks 10–11

90 min per class

CEFR B2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. Every class follows the same shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** (choral, then individual) → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** (the big communicative task) → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes. In this module the freer task is long (20–22 minutes) on purpose: it *is* the lesson. Protect it; cut controlled practice to homework before you cut the task.
- Present from `slides/module-7-style.html`. Print `materials/module-7/classroom-materials.html` before C20. It holds the flashcards, the new identity cards, the Register Switch situation cards and register-sort strips, the anecdote prompt cards, listener-reaction cards and story-arc planner, the pitch topic cards, objection cards and pitch planner, Persuasion Bingo, and the listening scripts.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each one has  Listen buttons, so learners can hear the model sentences and dialogues again at home and slow them down.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** B1 Module 7 practiced complaints at a counter and job interviews; B1 Module 5 and B2 Lesson 1.1 taught the narrative tenses; B2 Lesson 4.3 used a few presentation phrases; Lesson 6.3 (C19) taught indirect questions (*Could you tell me whether...?*), which are politeness and therefore register. Check what learners know in each lead-in and move faster where they are strong. The new B2 work is **control**: choosing a register on purpose and holding it, shaping a story for a listener, and building an argument that survives a question.

- ◆ **Fluency before accuracy.** In every freer task, listen and take notes; don't stop a speaker to fix a tense or a preposition. The feedback stage is where you fix errors, without names. At B2, give feedback on **two tracks: accuracy** (what was wrong) and **range** (what could be richer). Keep a two-column notebook page: "Fix it" and "Upgrade it" (e.g. *very angry* → *absolutely furious*; *and then... and then* → *just as... before I knew it*; *I think it's good* → *The main advantage is...*). Praise the *effect* first ("Everyone laughed at your ending. That's a landed story.") and then the form.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers.** All three tasks give one person the floor, so structure the turns. Use a **talking-turn token** in the anecdote circle, a **time limit with a visible timer** for pitches, and **jobs** for strong speakers: the **range spotter** (notes one great phrase per speaker), the **timekeeper**, or the **panel chair** who must call on a quiet person first. Say it kindly: "Great question, Mateo. Let's hold it and hear from someone who hasn't asked one yet."
- ◆ **Stretching strong learners toward C1.** Every lesson has a stretch box. The C1 direction in this module is **subtlety**: a register *between* neutral and formal (the everyday workplace email), a story with a well-timed pause and an understated ending, and persuasion that anticipates the objection before anyone raises it ("You might be thinking..."). Don't add new grammar; ask for more precise choices.
- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British forms and conventions: *Mr Clarke* (no period), *enquire / enquiry*, *Yours faithfully / Yours sincerely*, *recognise*, *apologise*, *colour*, *flavour*, *practise*, *mate*, *cheers*, *sorted*, *primary school*, *full stop*, *an engineer* to fix the heating. Teach *Mr.*, *inquire / inquiry*, the US sign-off **Sincerely**, (or *Best regards*), *period*, *elementary school*, a *technician / repair person*. Present the British *faithfully / sincerely* rule as "what you'll see in UK letters and in the online lesson," and accept British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Fit the reader → hold the listener → move the audience. In C20 learners take one message and dress it three ways: a text to a friend, an email to a manager, a formal letter. The skill is *choosing*. In C21 they keep a small group listening to a two-minute story, and they learn to be a good listener too. In C22 they stand up (or sit tall) and persuade a panel to fund a community or workplace improvement, then defend it under questions. Each class uses the one before it: the pitch needs the neutral-to-formal register of C20, and a short anecdote ("Take my coworker Ana...") is one of the best pieces of evidence in a pitch.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: WHOSE STORY, WHOSE OPINION?

Anecdotes (C21) invite personal memories, and some learners' most "memorable" stories are about migration, danger, loss or officials. **Keep every story light:** a mix-up, a coincidence, a cooking disaster, a lost-and-found, a kind stranger, a funny misunderstanding at work. Offer three choices out loud: **a true story, a story from a prompt card or new identity card, or an invented story.** Listeners never ask "Is it true?" (put it on the board as a rule). Never ask for the story of the journey here or a first day in the country. **Register (C20):** the workplace situations include calling in sick. Teach that in English you *don't have to explain* ("I'm unwell and unable to come in today" is complete and professional); no one describes real symptoms. **Persuasion (C22):** pitch topics are everyday community and workplace improvements, drawn from cards. Teams argue for their **card**, not their personal beliefs, and panelists ask questions from **objection cards**, so nobody has to reveal an opinion. No politics, religion or immigration topics, even if a learner suggests one; say "Great energy. Let's keep that one for outside class" and give them a card.

BEFORE THE MODULE

- Print the **flashcards** (set A, one set for the board): the informal → formal word pairs, the register dial, story connectors and openers, extreme-adjective picture cards, and the signpost and technique cards. Card stock helps.
- For C20: one set of **Register Switch situation cards** (set C, 8 cards) per 3 groups, one **three-column workshop sheet** per group (or use Workbook 7.1 "Register Switch Workshop"), and one set of **register-sort strips** (set D) per pair in an envelope.
- For C21: the **anecdote prompt cards** (set E, 12 cards) spread face-up on a side table, one **story-arc planner** per learner, one set of **listener-reaction cards** per circle of 4, and a talking-turn token per circle (a pen or a coin).
- For C22: one **pitch topic card** per team of 3 (set F), one **pitch planner** per team, 2–3 **objection cards** per panelist, and one **Persuasion Bingo** grid per learner (set G; half version A, half version B). A phone timer you can show on screen.
- Print the **new identity cards** (set B) and keep them on a side table where anyone can take one without asking. At B2 they are workplace personas with two story seeds each.
- Optional: a real phone for the two voicemails in Script 7.1-A (read them holding the phone to your ear), and a small "podium" (a music stand or a box on a desk) for C22. It raises the stakes in a good way.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
7.1	C20 • wk 10	Register: the dial (informal → neutral → formal); the four features that shift (word choice, contractions, sentence length, set phrases); polite	rewrite one workplace message as a text to a friend, an email to a manager and a

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
		spoken requests (<i>I was wondering whether it might be possible to...</i>); the five-part formal email; US vs UK sign-offs	formal letter, and hold one register from greeting to sign-off
7.2	C21 · wk 11	Anecdotes: the arc (open → build → climax → land); hooks; past continuous to set the scene; narrative connectors (<i>at first, just as, all of a sudden, before I knew it</i>); the historic present; direct speech with <i>goes / was like</i> ; extreme adjectives with <i>absolutely</i> ; listener reactions; ending phrases	tell a 6–8 sentence anecdote to a small group without a script, and keep a friend's story going with natural reactions and follow-up questions
7.3	C22 · wk 11	Persuasion: signposting; claim + reason + evidence; rhetorical questions, tripling, contrast, appealing to the listener; concede and counter (<i>Admittedly... That said...</i>); handling questions; closing with a call to action	deliver a 2-minute problem–solution pitch for a community or workplace improvement as a team, and answer a panel's questions calmly

7.1 · C20

Register — Formal vs Informal English

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain register as a **dial**, not a switch, and place a sentence as informal, neutral or formal
- ◆ shift the **four features**: word choice (*ask for* → *request*, *put off* → *postpone*), contractions (*I'm* → *I am*), sentence length (short and linked with *and / so* → longer with *as, although, therefore*), and set phrases (*Just wondering...* → *I am writing to inquire about...*)
- ◆ soften a spoken request for a stranger or a manager with *could, would, I was wondering whether, would it be possible to*
- ◆ build a **five-part formal email**: greeting → reason for writing → detail → request/action → sign-off, and match the sign-off to the greeting (US *Sincerely*,; UK *Yours sincerely / faithfully*)
- ◆ take one workplace message and write it three ways (text to a friend, email to a manager, formal letter) without mixing registers

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 7.1 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, "Two voices" dialogue, Register Switch Workshop sheet)
- ◆ Slides 3–8 · Informal → formal word-pair flashcards · Register dial card · **Register-sort strips** (1 envelope per pair) · **Register Switch situation cards** (8) · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 7.1-A (two voicemails: to a friend, to a manager) and 7.1-B (formal-phrase dictation)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the dial, drawn as a long arrow: **INFORMAL** (text a friend) — **NEUTRAL** (talk to a colleague) — **FORMAL** (write to an official). Under it, one message three ways: *Can you get back to me soon?* · *Could you let me know when you have a moment?* · *I would be grateful if you could reply at your earliest convenience.*

Center: the four features with an arrow each way: 1 words: ask for ⇌ **request** · get ⇌ **obtain / receive** · find out ⇌ **discover** · put off ⇌ **postpone** · need ⇌ **require** · 2 I'm ⇌ **I am** · 3 short + and/so ⇌ **longer + as / although / therefore** · 4 Hi Sam, ⇌ **Dear Mr. Clarke:** · Thanks! ⇌ **Thank you for your assistance.**

Right: the email skeleton: ① Dear... ② I am writing to... ③ On May 3, I... ④ I would be grateful if you could... ⑤ I look forward to hearing from you. / **Sincerely**, (US) · UK: *Dear Sir or Madam* → *Yours faithfully* · *Dear Mr Clarke* → *Yours sincerely*. Bottom corner: **ONE REGISTER PER MESSAGE.**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: polite or blunt?	8	S-S → T-S	Review C19 (6.3, indirect and negative questions). Board: three blunt questions: "Where's the bathroom?" · "When does the store close?" · "Is the manager here?" Pairs make each one polite with an indirect frame ("Could you tell me where... / Do you know whether..."). Then ask: "Who would you say the blunt one to? The polite one?" This is today's topic in one question: the words depend on the listener.
Lead-in: three messages, one meaning	6	T-S	Slide 3. Show the three versions of <i>Can you get back to me soon?</i> Ask: "Which one is wrong?" (None!) "Who's the reader of each?" Elicit: a friend, a coworker, a company or an official. Draw the dial. Ask: "What happens if you send the formal one to your best friend?" (It sounds cold, maybe sarcastic.) "And the text to a bank?" (Rude, not serious.)
The four features	14	T-S → S-S	Slides 4–5. Teach the four features with the board center. Word pairs: flip the flashcards (informal side → learners call out the formal side). Contractions and sentence length: read the two "heater" versions from the online lesson. Set phrases: the function table. CCQs (below). Then pairs do the register-sort strips (18 phrases → informal / neutral / formal columns, 4 min). Check with slide 5.
Spoken register + drill	10	T-S → S	Slide 6. Read Script 7.1-A (two voicemails: Ana to her coworker friend, then Ana to her manager) holding a phone. Learners note 3 differences. Then the "Two voices" dialogue in the workbook in pairs, swapping roles. Drill the polite frames (see Drill script): choral, then individual, with falling-rising intonation.
The formal email	8	T-S	Slide 7. The five parts, built on the board from Elena Marsh's complaint in the online lesson (Americanize it: <i>Dear Customer Service Team, ... Sincerely</i>). Then the US / UK sign-off note

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			and the "one register per message" rule. Script 7.1-B (dictation of 4 formal phrases).
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1-4 alone (formal words, I / N / F, the inquiry email, soften the request), then check in pairs. Board-check only items pairs disagree on. Early finishers start Ex 5 (rewrite Ana's text to her manager).
Freer: Register Switch Workshop	22	S-S (groups of 3) → T-S	Slide 8. Groups of 3 take a situation card (one workplace or everyday message). Each learner writes one version: A a text to a friend, B an email to a manager, C a formal letter or email to an organization (7 min). They pass the sheet: each learner checks the next version with the "four features" list and upgrades one line (4 min). Then each group reads its three versions aloud <i>without saying which is which</i> , in random order; the class names the reader and the feature that gave it away (8 min). Last 3 min: each group rotates one version <i>down</i> the dial (formal → neutral) on a new card. ICQs first.
Feedback	7	T-S	Two columns on the board. Fix it (no names): "Dear Mr. Patel, ... Cheers, Ana" · "I am writing for ask about..." · "I would be grateful if you can..." · "I'm writing to inform you I can't come." (in the formal letter). Upgrade it: "I want a refund" → "I would like to request a refund" · "The heater is broke" → "The heating is no longer working." Praise one group whose three versions were clearly different.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 7.1 on screen; point at a  button and the Audio control. Set the homework (below). Learners tick the "I can..." box in the workbook.
Total	90		8 + 6 + 14 + 10 + 8 + 10 + 22 + 7 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Move Workbook Ex 3–4 to homework and do only Ex 1–2 in class. Never cut the Workshop's "read aloud and guess the reader" stage: it's where learners *hear* register, which is the whole point. With a strong class, shorten the register-sort to 2 minutes.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: register = fit, not quality. All registers are good English. The question is who the reader or listener is, how well you know them, and what the message is for.

SAY: "I would be grateful if you could reply at your earliest convenience." Is this better English than "Can you get back to me soon?" (No, just more formal.) Would you text it to your sister? (No, it would sound cold or sarcastic.) Would you write it to a bank? (Yes.) So what decides? (The reader and the situation.)

Meaning: the four features.

SAY: "find out" and "discover": same meaning? (Yes.) Which is more formal? (discover.) Is "find out" wrong in an email? (No, but it leans informal; in a formal letter choose the single verb.) • "I haven't received it" in a formal letter: OK? (Better: "I have not received it.") In a text to a friend? (Contractions are normal.)

SAY: "Sorry to bother you" and "I hope you don't mind my writing": which one for a company you've never contacted? (The second.) • A letter starts "Dear Sir or Madam" and ends "Cheers!" What's the problem? (Mixed registers.) What's the rule? (One register from greeting to sign-off.)

Meaning: polite spoken requests. Formal speech isn't about long words; it's about **distance**: past forms and modals give the other person an easy way to say no.

SAY: "I was wondering whether it might be possible to move our reservation." Is the guest talking about the past? (No! Now.) Why "was wondering"? (It's softer, more polite.) Is the guest sure the answer is yes? (No, "might" and "possible" leave room for no.) Would you say this to a close friend? (No, too stiff.)

Meaning: sign-offs, US and UK.

SAY: You're writing to a company in Chicago. How do you end? (Sincerely, or Best regards,.) A company in London, and you started "Dear Sir or Madam"? (Yours faithfully,.) You started "Dear Ms. Ford"? (Yours sincerely,.) Will an American reader mind "Yours sincerely"? (No. It's fine, just a little old-fashioned.)

Form.

Words	phrasal verb / everyday word → single, often Latin-based verb	ask for → request · get → obtain / receive · find out → discover · put off →
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		postpone · need → require · tell → inform · help → assist · but → however · so → therefore
Contractions	formal writing spells them out	I'm → I am · haven't → have not · won't → will not
Sentences	short + <i>and / but / so</i> → longer, linked with <i>as, although, which, therefore</i>	The heater's broken. It's cold. → As the heating is no longer working, the apartment has become extremely cold.
Spoken requests	Could you...? · Would you mind + -ing? · I was wondering whether / if + past · Would it be possible to...? · ...if that's not too much trouble	I was wondering whether I could leave an hour early on Friday.
Email skeleton	① Dear... ② I am writing to inquire about / complain about / request... ③ detail ④ I would be grateful if you could... / I would therefore request... ⑤ I look forward to hearing from you. + sign-off	US: Dear Mr. Clarke: (or ,) ... Sincerely, · UK: Dear Mr Clarke, ... Yours sincerely, · Dear Sir or Madam, ... Yours faithfully,

Pronunciation. Register lives in the **voice** too. Casual speech is fast with heavy reductions (*gonna, wanna, can ya, lemme know*); polite speech is slower, with full forms and a **gentle fall-rise** on requests: "I was **wondering** whether it might be **possible**... ↘ ↗". A flat, fast "Could you move my appointment" sounds like an order; the same words with a softer, rising end sound like a request. In *I would be grateful*, *would* is weak /wəd/ and *be* is short; stress **grate**ful. *Inquire* /ɪn'kwaɪər/: stress on the second syllable. Contractions are *fine* in formal *speech* ("It's under Whitfield"); the no-contractions rule is for formal writing.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Flip the card** (word-pair flashcards, informal side up): T: "ask for" → S: "request." T: "put off" → S: "postpone." T: "find out" → S: "discover." T: "need" → S: "require." T: "tell" → S: "inform." Then reverse: T: "assist" → S: "help." Choral, then fast individuals.
- 2 Turn the dial up:** T (casual voice): "Can you send me the form?" → S (polite): "Could you possibly send me the form?" → S2 (formal writing): "I would be grateful if you could send me the form."
- 3 Soften it:** T: "Move my shift." → S: "I was wondering whether I could move my shift." T: "Give me a day off." → S: "Would it be possible to take a day off on Friday?" Model the fall-rise; learners copy the tune, not just the words.
- 4 Set-phrase ping-pong:** T: "Hi..." → S: "Dear..." · T: "Let me know." → S: "I look forward to hearing from you." · T: "Thanks!" → S: "Thank you for your assistance." · T: "Talk soon." → S: "Please do not hesitate to contact me."

- 5 **Open pairs → closed pairs:** S1 says a casual request to S2 ("Can I borrow your charger?"); S2 turns to S3 and "asks the manager" the same thing politely. Then all pairs, 1 minute.

◆ REGISTER SWITCH WORKSHOP – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ Groups of 3. Each group takes one **situation card** (set C): e.g. *You can't work your Saturday shift and a coworker has agreed to cover it* · *The printer at work has been broken for a week* · *You'd like to take a first-aid course your employer mentioned* · *Your new washing machine was delivered with a dent*. Every card has the core facts, so nobody has to invent personal details.
- ◆ Roles: **A** writes a text to a friend or close coworker (1–3 lines), **B** an email to a manager (neutral-to-formal, 50–70 words), **C** a formal letter or email to an organization or company (five parts, 70–90 words). Rotate roles if the group does a second card.
- ◆ Pass the sheet to the right. The checker uses the four features as a checklist (words · contractions · sentences · set phrases) and **upgrades one line** in a different color. They may not rewrite the whole thing.
- ◆ Read-aloud round: the group reads its three versions in random order. The class says who the reader is and **which feature gave it away** ("It's the manager: no contractions but 'Hi Dan,' not 'Dear Mr.'"). This is the key learning moment: learners discover that the **manager email is in the middle of the dial**, and that's the one they'll write most in real life.
- ◆ **Dominant speakers:** give the strongest writer role **C** (the hardest) and the job of **reader** for the read-aloud round only if a quieter group member doesn't want it. The quietest learner may choose role A: short, and a real skill. Everyone reads at least one line aloud.
- ◆ Calling-in-sick card: remind the group that the message says "I'm unwell and unable to come in today", with no details. That is complete and professional in English.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE WORKSHOP

SAY: *How many versions does your group write? (Three.) · Who writes the formal letter? (C.) · Does the text to a friend need "Dear"? (No!) · When you check a partner's version, do you rewrite everything? (No, upgrade one line.) · When you read aloud, do you say "This is the email to the manager"? (No, the class guesses.) · Do you need to use your real job or your real boss's name? (No, the card has everything.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with two ends of the dial only (text to a friend ⇌ formal email) and one feature at a time: first the **set phrases**, which carry most of the register. Give a phrase strip with the five email parts already started ("Dear... / I am writing to... / I would be grateful if you could... / I look forward to hearing from you. / Sincerely,") so the learner fills in the facts. In the Workshop, take role A or B and copy the frame from the strip. Target: one text and one framed formal email, read aloud.

STRETCH

Aim for the **middle of the dial**: the warm-but-professional email to a manager ("Hi Dan, I hope your week's going well. I wanted to check whether..."). Use *would appreciate it if, further to our conversation, at your earliest convenience*, and a formal passive ("The item was delivered damaged"). C1 step: rewrite one sentence three ways and say *why* each word changed. Early finishers write the company's polite reply to the complaint.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Over-formal everywhere**: learners from languages with strong formal address (Spanish/Portuguese *usted/você/o senhor*, Korean and Japanese honorifics, Arabic, Russian *вы*, Vietnamese kinship pronouns) often assume "formal = always safer" and write stiff texts to friends. Praise the formal version, then show the casual one is equally correct in its place.
- ◆ **Too direct in requests**: Russian, Polish, German, Dutch, Arabic and Hebrew speakers may use a plain imperative or "I want" where English expects softening ("I want to change my shift"). It isn't rude in their L1; in English it can sound demanding. Teach *I was wondering whether...* as a chunk.
- ◆ **Over-long greetings and closings**: Arabic, Persian, Urdu, Spanish and Tagalog letters often open with good wishes and close with blessings or long thanks. In English formal email, the purpose comes in the first line ("I am writing to..."). A short "I hope you are well" is fine in a manager email, not in a complaint.
- ◆ **"I am writing for ask" / "I would be grateful if you can"**: Spanish *para preguntar*, Portuguese *para perguntar* → "for ask"; teach **writing to + verb**. Keep *would ... could* together: "I would be grateful if you could...".
- ◆ **Honorific without a surname**: "Dear Mr. Daniel" (Tagalog, Arabic, Vietnamese, Thai and many African Englishes use a title + first name). In US formal email: **Mr. / Ms. + last name**, or the first name alone if the workplace uses first names.
- ◆ **Ms. vs Mrs. vs Miss**: teach **Ms. /mɪz/** as the safe default for any woman in business; learners from many backgrounds use *Mrs.* for all women.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_19.html. Listen to the two exchanges and the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back in the matching voice; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. (Note for learners: the online lesson follows the British sign-off rule; in the US, *Sincerely*, works after

any greeting.) Workbook 7.1: finish Ex 5 (Ana's message to her manager) if not done, write the project email (a complaint or an inquiry, 80–120 words) and read it aloud once at home, "My new words" and the journal (one real casual message rewritten formally, with the changed words listed).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A Yours sincerely, (UK rule; in US English *Sincerely*), · Q2 B I am writing to inquire whether any places are still available. · Q3 (new) C "Dear Ms. Ortiz, I am writing to request a copy of my contract. Thanks a bunch, see ya!" mixes registers. Script 7.1-A differences: *Hey Sam, it's me / Hello, Mr. Patel, this is Ana Silva from the evening team · can't make it / I'm afraid I won't be able to · can you cover? / I was wondering whether it would be possible to... · Lemme know! / Please let me know if that works for you.*

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ shape a spoken anecdote with an arc: **open** (a hook) → **build** (scene, then events) → **climax** → **land** (the point or punchline)
- ◆ open with a hook (*You'll never guess what happened...* · *So the other day...* · *This reminds me of the time...*) and set the scene with the **past continuous**
- ◆ control the pace with varied connectors (*at first, then, a few minutes later, just as, all of a sudden, before I knew it*) instead of "and then... and then"
- ◆ bring the climax alive with the **historic present**, **direct speech** (*he goes / she was like*, informal speech only) and emphasis (*absolutely furious, the worst... ever*)
- ◆ react as a listener (*No way!* · *You must have been mortified.* · *What happened next?*) and land the ending (*In the end...* · *To cut a long story short...* · *And that's why...*)

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 7.2 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–5, Priya & Tom dialogue, story-arc planner)
- ◆ Slides 9–13 · Connector and opener flashcards · Extreme-adjective picture cards (angry → furious, excited → thrilled, cold → freezing, hot → boiling, nervous → terrified) · **Anecdote prompt cards** (12) · **Listener-reaction cards** (1 set per circle) · **Story-arc planners** · Talking-turn tokens · New identity cards
- ◆ Listening scripts 7.2-A (the same story told flat, then shaped) and 7.2-B (a story with pauses for listener reactions)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the arc drawn as a hill: **OPEN** (hook) ↗ **BUILD** (scene → events) ↗ **CLIMAX** (the big moment) ↘ **LAND** (point / punchline). Under OPEN: *You'll never guess...* · *So the other day...* · *Did I ever tell you about...?* Under LAND: *In the end...* · *To cut a long story short...* · *And that's why...* · *Lesson learned!*

Center: tenses on a timeline: **scene** = past continuous (*I was walking home...*) · **events** = past simple (*a bus drove through a puddle*) · **backstory** = past perfect (*I'd just bought the suit*) · **climax** = historic present (*So I'm standing there, and he goes...*). Connectors along the hill: *at first* → *then* → *a few minutes later* → **just as** → **all of a sudden** → **before I knew it**.

Right: the listener's column: 😊 No way! · 😄 That's hilarious! · 😱 Oh no! · You must have been mortified. · ➡ Then what? · What did you do? Bottom: ~~very~~ **furious** → **absolutely furious** · ~~and then...~~ **and then...**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: turn the dial	8	S-S → T-S	Review C20. Pairs swap their homework emails and find the five parts, then point to one feature that makes it formal. Fast dial round: T reads a casual line ("Can't make it Friday, sorry!"); pairs say it to "the manager," then write it for "the company." Two volunteers read their best formal line.
Lead-in: flat vs shaped	7	T-S	Slide 9. Read Script 7.2-A : first the flat version (monotone, "and then"), then the shaped version (with energy). "Same events? (Yes.) Which one would you listen to at a party? Why?" Elicit the differences onto the board: a hook, a scene, surprise words, what people said, an ending. Draw the arc.
Arc, openers, scene, connectors	13	T-S	Slides 10–11. Openers and when to use them. Scene-setting with the past continuous (revisit B2 1.1: the narrative tenses; this is extension, so ask learners to <i>tell you</i> the tense). The connectors and their effect on pace: which ones slow down, which ones speed up. CCQs (below). Stick the connector cards along the arc.
Keeping it alive	8	T-S	Slide 12. The historic present ("So I'm standing

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			there..."), direct speech with <i>goes / was like</i> , and emphasis. Extreme adjectives with the picture cards: <i>angry</i> → <i>furious</i> , <i>excited</i> → <i>thrilled</i> , <i>cold</i> → <i>freezing</i> ; the rule absolutely + extreme, very + normal. CCQs.
Drill	6	T-S → S	See Drill script: hooks with a suspense tune, the "just as" chain, the historic-present switch, and <i>absolutely</i> + extreme adjectives.
Controlled practice	10	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1–4 alone (order the anecdote, connectors, tenses, extreme adjectives), then check in pairs. Pairs read the Priya & Tom dialogue with feeling: Priya rushes the exciting part; Tom reacts on time.
Listener reactions	6	T-S → S	Slide 13. Read Script 7.2-B . At each pause (🔊), hold up a hand: learners call out a reaction; hold up a reaction card to prompt quieter learners. Drill the intonation of <i>No way!</i> ↗↘ and <i>Oh no...</i> ↘. Workbook Ex 5 orally.
Freer: Anecdote Circle	22	S (plan) → S-S (circles of 4) → T-S	(1) Each learner chooses a story: true, a prompt card , a new identity card seed, or invented. They fill in the story-arc planner in key words only (5 min). (2) Circles of 4 with a talking-turn token and a set of

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			reaction cards. Each teller has 2 minutes ; listeners must use at least two reactions and ask one follow-up question at the end (12 min). (3) Each circle chooses one story for a "second telling": the teller moves to a new circle and tells it again, better and a bit shorter (3 min). (4) Two volunteers tell the class the best <i>ending</i> they heard, not the whole story (2 min). ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Two columns. Fix it: "When I walked home, it started to rain." (scene → <i>was walking</i>) · "I was very furious." · "Suddenly, all of a sudden..." · "He said me, 'Is your car?'" Upgrade it: "and then... and then" → "just as... before I knew it" · "... so, yeah, anyway" → "And that's why I always...". Praise the best hook and the best listener.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 7.2; the story script mark-up; tell the story once at home or record it.
Total	90		8 + 7 + 13 + 8 + 6 + 10 + 6 + 22 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Skip the "second telling" in the Anecdote Circle and move Workbook Ex 3–4 to homework. Don't cut the listener-reactions stage: without it, the circle turns into four monologues. If a story is running long, the timekeeper says "To cut a long story short...?" as a friendly signal to land it.

Meaning: a hook signals "a story is starting." Without it, the listener doesn't switch into listening mode.

SAY: "You'll never guess what happened to me this morning." Is this a real question? (No.) Does the speaker want you to guess? (No, to listen.) What's a good answer? ("What?" / "Go on!") · "This reminds me of the time..." When do you use it? (When the story links to what someone just said.)

Meaning: scene vs events.

SAY: "I was waiting for the bus when a dog ran off with my sandwich." Which action was in progress, the background? (Waiting.) Which one was short and sudden? (The dog ran.) Which tense for the background? (Past continuous.) · "Just as I opened the door, the phone rang." One thing after the other, or at the same moment? (The same moment.)

Meaning: the historic present.

SAY: "So I'm standing there, and this guy walks up and goes, 'Is this your car?'" Is this happening now? (No, it's a past story.) Why present tense? (It pulls the listener into the moment.) Is "goes" about walking? (No, here it means "says," informal.) Would you write this in a formal report to your manager? (No, spoken stories only.)

Meaning: extreme adjectives.

SAY: "I was absolutely furious." Stronger than "very angry"? (Yes.) Can I say "very furious"? (No, absolutely or really.) Can I say "absolutely angry"? (No, very angry.) · Freezing = very... (cold). Thrilled = very... (excited, happy).

Form.

Open	hook phrase	You'll never guess what happened... · So the other day... · The funniest thing happened to me...
Scene	past continuous (+ <i>when</i> + past simple)	We were sitting in a café when the lights went out.
Backstory	past perfect	I'd just bought the suit the day before.
Build	varied connectors	At first... · Then... · A few minutes later... · Just as I... · All of a sudden... · Before I knew it...
Climax	historic present · direct speech · emphasis	So I'm standing there, soaked, and he goes, "Lovely weather!" · It was the worst day ever.
Extreme adj.	absolutely / really + extreme · very + gradable	absolutely furious / thrilled / freezing / boiling / terrified / exhausted · very angry / excited / cold

Land	ending phrase + stop	In the end... · To cut a long story short... · And that's why... · I still can't believe it. · Lesson learned!
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Pronunciation. A story is a **performance**. Teach three tools: (1) **Pace**: slower for the scene, faster at "all of a sudden," then a **pause** just before the punchline. (2) **Pitch**: a higher, wider pitch range for direct speech ("and he goes, 'Is this **your** car?'"). (3) **Stress** on the intensifier: "I was **absolutely soaked**." Hooks have a rising, inviting tune: "You'll **never** guess what happened ↗." *No way!* is a high rise then fall; *Oh no...* is low and falling. In fast speech, *was* is weak /wəz/: "I wəz walking home..."

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Hook it** (suspense tune): T: "I lost my keys." → S: "You'll never guess what happened: I lost my keys!" T: "A strange thing at work." → S: "The strangest thing happened at work..." Choral, then individuals with a dramatic face.
- 2 **Set the scene**: T: "walk home · rain start" → S: "I was walking home when it started to rain." T: "cook dinner · power go out" → S: "I was cooking dinner when the power went out."
- 3 **Just as chain**: S1: "Just as I sat down, ..." S2 finishes: "...the phone rang." S2 starts a new one: "Just as I opened the fridge, ..." Around the room.
- 4 **Switch to now**: T: "He walked up to me and said, 'Is this your dog?'" → S: "So he walks up to me and goes, 'Is this your dog?'" Two or three more.
- 5 **Absolutely!** (picture cards): T holds up *angry*: "Were you very angry?" → S: "Angry? I was absolutely furious!" · *cold* → "absolutely freezing" · *excited* → "absolutely thrilled" · *nervous* → "absolutely terrified."

◆ ANECDOTE CIRCLE – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Choosing a story.** Spread the 12 **prompt cards** face-up (e.g. *The wrong bus*, *A cooking disaster*, *The small world coincidence*, *Lost and found*, *The misunderstood message*, *A kind stranger*, *The pet that...*). Each card has three story-starter facts, so an invented story is easy. Say: "True, card, or invented: all equal. Nobody will ask which."
- ◆ **Planning.** The story-arc planner has five boxes (hook · scene · 2–3 events · climax with one line of direct speech · ending). **Key words only**; collect any full-sentence scripts before the telling. Learners talk from notes, not read.
- ◆ **Circles of 4.** The teller holds the token. Listeners hold the reaction cards and must "spend" at least two during the story and ask one follow-up question at the end ("What did your boss say?"). The fourth person in each round is the **range spotter**: they write down one great phrase the teller used and read it back ("You said 'before I knew it!'").
- ◆ **Second telling.** Research on fluency (the 4/3/2 technique) shows that telling the same story again, shorter, makes it faster and more accurate. Ask each circle's chosen teller to retell in 90 seconds in a new

circle. Watch how much better the second version is and tell them so.

- ◆ **Dominant speakers:** the 2-minute limit is firm (a phone timer in the middle of the circle). A strong storyteller becomes the **range spotter** in the first round so they listen first. A learner who dominates as a *listener* (interrupting) gets the job of asking the one follow-up question only.
- ◆ **Quiet learners** may tell a 4-sentence version (hook, scene, one event, ending). That's a complete anecdote. Anyone can say "Pass" once and tell their story to you at the end instead.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE ANECDOTE CIRCLE

SAY: *Does your story have to be true? (No: true, card, or invented.) · Do you write full sentences on the planner? (No, key words.) · How long is each story? (Two minutes.) · Listeners: how many reactions? (At least two.) And at the end? (One follow-up question.) · Can we ask "Is that true?" (No!) · Who holds the token? (The teller.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Use a picture prompt card and a 4-box planner with sentence starters printed: "You'll never guess... / I was ___ing when... / All of a sudden... / In the end...". Let the learner draw in the boxes instead of writing. In the circle, the learner tells the 4-sentence version and uses the reaction cards (read aloud from the card) as a listener. Target: one complete short anecdote and three reactions.

STRETCH

Use the past perfect for a backstory twist ("What I didn't know was that she'd already..."), *What I didn't realize was...* clefts (from 4.2), and a planned pause before the punchline. C1 step: **understatement** for humor ("It wasn't my finest moment.") and an ending that ties back to the hook. Early finishers retell a classmate's story in reported speech for the class, keeping it short.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Tense avoidance in stories:** Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai, Indonesian and Malay speakers mark time with words, not verb forms, and may tell a whole story in the present simple ("Yesterday I go..."). That's different from the *chosen* historic present. Teach the contrast: past for the story, present only at the climax, on purpose.
- ◆ **Past continuous for everything:** some Spanish, Portuguese and Italian speakers transfer the imperfect and write "I was going to the store and I was seeing my friend." Past continuous is for **background**; the events are past simple.
- ◆ **"Suddenly, all of a sudden" and "very furious / very exhausted":** common everywhere. Upgrade in feedback, not during the story.
- ◆ **He / she in direct speech:** Tagalog (*siya*), Chinese (spoken *tā*), Turkish, Persian, Finnish and Hungarian speakers mix *he* and *she*, which confuses who said what in a story. Point to the character on the planner.

- ◆ **Listening culture:** in some cultures listeners stay quiet to show respect, and loud reactions feel rude; in others, overlapping talk is warm; and Japanese listeners give frequent small responses (*aizuchi*) that English speakers can mistake for agreement. Present English reactions as a *tool*, not a personality change, and model a quiet "Oh no..." as well as a big "No way!".
- ◆ **Final consonants** in past-tense verbs (*walked, stopped, laughed*): Vietnamese, Cantonese, Thai and Korean speakers may drop /t/ or /d/, which makes the story sound present. Accept it in the circle; drill it briefly in feedback.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_20.html. Listen to the Priya & Tom anecdote with 🎧 and perform both roles; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 7.2: write your anecdote as a short script and mark it up (underline the hook, circle each connector, box the ending, star the direct speech); tell it aloud once at home or record it. "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** You'll never guess what happened to me. · Q2 **A** Oh no! What did you do? · Q3 (new) **C** "I was waiting for the elevator when the fire alarm went off." sets the scene. Script 7.2-A differences (shaped version): a hook, scene with *was walking, just as*, direct speech, *absolutely*, an ending with a point. Script 7.2-B reactions: any natural reaction at each 🟥 (see the answer key).

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ signpost a short talk so the audience always knows where they are: *Today I'll cover...* · *First, let's look at...* · *Moving on to...* · *To sum up...*
- ◆ build an argument: a **claim** + **reasons** + **evidence** (a figure or a vivid example): *The main advantage is...* · *Research suggests...* · *Take, for example...*
- ◆ use persuasive techniques: **rhetorical questions**, **tripling**, **contrast** (*It's not a cost; it's an investment.*), and **appealing to the listener** (*you, we, together*)
- ◆ **concede and counter** an objection: *Admittedly... However...* · *That said...* · *While it's true that..., ...*
- ◆ handle questions calmly: *That's a good question.* · *If I understand you correctly, you're asking...* · *I don't have the exact figure, but I'll follow up.*, and close with a call to action

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 7.3 (New words, Grammar box, Exercises 1–4, Q&A dialogue, Pitch Planner)
- ◆ Slides 14–18 · Signpost and technique flashcards · **Pitch topic cards** (8) · **Objection cards** (16) · **Pitch planners** (1 per team) · **Persuasion Bingo** grids (versions A and B) · A timer on screen · Optional "podium"
- ◆ Listening scripts 7.3-A (a model 90-second pitch: bike parking at work) and 7.3-B (a Q&A exchange)

BOARD PLAN

Left: the pitch shape: **SIGNPOST** (tell them the plan) → **ARGUE** (problem → solution → claim + reasons + evidence) → **PERSUADE** (techniques + concede/counter) → **CLOSE** (sum up + call to action). Under it: *Today I'll cover...* · *First...* · *Moving on to...* · *For instance...* · *To sum up...*

Center: four techniques with an example each: ? *Wouldn't we all like a safer walk home?* · 3 *cheaper, faster and greener* · ⚖️ *It's not a cost; it's an investment.* · 🤝 *Think about your own commute. Together, we can...*

Right: **CONCEDE** → **COUNTER**: *Admittedly, it costs more at first... → however, it pays for itself within a year.* · *That said,...* · *While it's true that..., ...* · Q&A buttons: *That's a good question.* · *If I understand you correctly,...* · *Let me come back to that.* · *I'll follow up.* · *Does that answer your question?*

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: 60-second story	6	S-S → T-S	Review C21. New pairs: each tells their homework anecdote in 60 seconds (shorter again!). The listener reacts and names the

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			hook afterwards. One volunteer tells the class the ending only. Point out: "A short true story is great evidence in a pitch. Keep yours."
Lead-in: weak vs strong	4	T-S	Slide 14. Read both versions of the remote-work talk from the online lesson (the "um, like, and stuff" one, then the strong one). "What did the strong speaker do?" Elicit: said the plan, gave reasons, gave evidence, admitted a weakness. Draw the pitch shape.
Signposting & argument	10	T-S → S-S	Slide 15. Signposts by stage, then claim + reasons + evidence (<i>The main advantage is... · There are two reasons for this... · Research suggests... · Take, for example...</i>). The pause at each signpost. CCQs. Pairs do Workbook Ex 1 (complete the phrases) and check quickly.
Persuasive techniques	8	T-S	Slide 16. Read Script 7.3-A (the bike-parking pitch). Learners use a Persuasion Bingo grid as a listening demo : tick what they hear. Check: which techniques, which signposts? Then name the four techniques on the board with the pitch's examples. Workbook Ex 2 together (name the technique).
Concede- counter & questions	8	T-S → S-S	Slide 17. Concede-and-counter pairs; why it makes you <i>more</i> convincing. Then the Q&A phrases with Script 7.3-B (two voices: a panelist's tough question and the presenter's calm answer). CCQs. Workbook Ex 3 (match the halves) in pairs.
Drill	5	T-S → S	See Drill script: signposts with a pause, tripling rhythm, concede-counter in one breath, and the "buy time" phrases.
Controlled practice	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 4 (choose the best response to a question) alone, then pairs compare.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Early finishers write two rhetorical questions for their team's topic.
Pitch planning	10	S-S (teams of 3)	Teams take a pitch topic card (a community or workplace improvement with a problem, a solution, a cost and two facts). They fill in the pitch planner : who says which part (Speaker 1: signpost + problem · Speaker 2: solution + evidence + technique · Speaker 3: concede-counter + close + call to action), and they predict two panel questions. Key words only. ICQs first.
Freer: The Pitch Panel	22	S-S (team → panel) → T-S	Slide 18. The rest of the class is the panel (a community board or a company's management team), each holding 2-3 objection cards and a Persuasion Bingo grid. Each team pitches for 2 minutes (timer on screen), then takes 2 minutes of questions : panelists read or adapt an objection card. After all pitches, each panelist gives one "vote" (a sticky note) to the pitch that persuaded them most. With a large class, run two panels at the same time in two corners.
Feedback + module wrap	5	T-S	Fix it: "Research suggest that..." · "I will cover about two points." · "Admittedly it is expensive, but however..." · "It's a good question." (said flatly, then silence). Upgrade it: "I think it is good" → "The main advantage is..." · "Any questions? No? OK bye." → "To sum up... So let's... I'm happy to take questions." Announce the winning pitch; learners tick the three Module 7 "I can..." lists.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Online lesson 7.3; the marked-up one-paragraph "case"; preview C23: "Next class we switch from speaking to <i>listening</i> : how people really talk, fast. <i>Whaddaya wanna do?</i> "

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Total	90		6 + 4 + 10 + 8 + 8 + 5 + 7 + 10 + 22 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

This class is full. Cut Workbook Ex 4 to homework and shorten the drill; do the bingo demo with Script 7.3-A only if time allows (the bingo is used again in the panel anyway). With more than 5 teams, run two panels in parallel rather than cutting the Q&A: the questions are where learners grow most.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: signposts are for the listener. A reader can look back; a listener can't. Signposts tell them where they are.

SAY: "Moving on to my second point..." Is the speaker starting, changing topic, or finishing? (Changing to the next point.) What should you do right after a signpost? (Pause for a beat.) • "To sum up..." Will the talk go on for a long time? (No, it's ending.)

Meaning: an argument = claim + support.

SAY: "Bike parking is better." Opinion or argument? (Opinion only.) "Bike parking is better because twelve people already cycle and there's nowhere safe to lock a bike." (An argument: a claim + a reason + evidence.) • "Take my coworker Ana..." Is a story allowed as evidence? (Yes, an example makes it real.)

Meaning: the techniques.

SAY: "Wouldn't we all like a safer walk home?" Does the speaker want an answer? (No, it makes you think and agree.) • "It's not a cost; it's an investment." How many ideas are set against each other? (Two: that's contrast.) • "It saves time, saves money and saves stress." How many? (Three: tripling. Why three? It's memorable, rhythmic.)

Meaning: concede and counter.

SAY: "Admittedly, it costs more at first. That said, it pays for itself within a year." Does the speaker agree that it costs more? (Yes, they admit it.) Do they change their mind? (No.) Which part is stronger, the first or the second? (The second.) Why admit the weakness? (It builds trust; you look fair, not naive.)

Form.

Signpost	Introduce • first point • move on • add • example • conclude	Today I'll cover... • To begin with... • Moving on to... / That brings me to... • What's more... • For instance... / Take, for example... • To sum up... / In conclusion...
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Argue	benefit · reasons · evidence · result	The main advantage is... · There are two reasons for this. First,... Second,... · Research suggests / The figures show... · As a result,... / This means that...
Techniques	rhetorical question · tripling · contrast · appeal	Isn't that worth it? · cheaper, faster and greener · not a problem, an opportunity · Think about how this affects you. Together, we can...
Concede → counter	Admittedly / Of course / While it's true that... → however / that said / nevertheless / but	While it's true that there are risks, the benefits clearly outweigh them.
Q&A	buy time · check · answer · check back	That's a good question. · If I understand you correctly, you're asking... · I'm not sure, but my sense is... · Let me come back to that. · Does that answer your question?
Close	sum up + call to action	To sum up,... So let's... / I'm asking you to... · Thank you. I'm happy to take questions.

Pronunciation. Pause after every signpost (count "one" silently). **Tripling** has a list tune: rise, rise, fall: "cheaper ↗, faster ↗, and greener ↘." **Contrast** stress falls on the two contrasting words: "It's not a **cost**; it's an **investment**." Rhetorical questions usually **fall** (they're really statements): "Isn't that worth it? ↘". *Admittedly* /əd'mɪtɪdli/: four syllables, stress on **mit**. Chunk the talk into thought groups and **slow down**: nerves make everyone fast; a pitch at 80% speed sounds confident.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Signpost and pause:** T shows a stage card (START · NEXT · EXAMPLE · END) → S: "Today I'll cover two points. (pause)" · "Moving on to my second point... (pause)" · "Take, for example,... " · "To sum up... (pause)." Choral; exaggerate the pause.
- 2 Rule of three:** T: "cheaper, faster..." → S: "...and greener!" T: "save time..." → S: "save time, save money and save stress." Keep the rise-rise-fall tune.
- 3 Not X; Y:** T: "cost / investment" → S: "It's not a cost; it's an investment." T: "problem / opportunity" → S: "It's not a problem; it's an opportunity." T: "a luxury / a necessity."
- 4 Concede in one breath:** T: "expensive" → S: "Admittedly, it's expensive. That said, it pays for itself." T: "takes time" → S: "While it's true that it takes time, the benefits are huge."
- 5 Buy time:** T asks a hard question fast ("How much will it cost exactly?") → S: "That's a good question. I don't have the exact figure, but I'll follow up." Then S asks S: open pairs → closed pairs.

◆ THE PITCH PANEL – HOW TO RUN IT

- ◆ **Topics** (set F, 8 cards): bike parking at work · a staff language-buddy program · a community tool library · better lighting in the parking lot · a shared-shift swap board · an after-school homework club at the library · a community garden on an empty lot · water refill stations at the community center. Each card has **the problem, the solution, the cost, and two facts** for evidence. Teams may add an invented anecdote as an example.
- ◆ **Teams of 3**, one part each (see the planner). A pair is fine; a solo learner can pitch with you as the "team." Everyone speaks. The strongest speaker in a team takes Part 3 (concede-counter + close), which is the hardest.
- ◆ **Pitch: 2 minutes, strict.** Show the timer. At 1:45 hold up a "wrap up" card. Speakers talk from the planner, not a script.
- ◆ **Q&A: 2 minutes.** The **panel chair** (rotate the job; give it to a dominant speaker, with the rule "call on someone who hasn't asked yet first") picks panelists. Panelists read or adapt an **objection card** ("Who's going to maintain it?" · "What if nobody uses it?" · "Has this worked anywhere else?"). Because the questions come from cards, **nobody is attacking or revealing their own view**, and nobody has to be against a classmate's idea.
- ◆ **Persuasion Bingo** keeps the panel listening: tick each technique or signpost you hear. A line of three = a quiet "Bingo!" at the end of the pitch (not during). The team gets the credit.
- ◆ **Voting:** one sticky note per panelist on the board under the most persuasive pitch, *not their own*. Award the "best answer to a question" too, so a team that pitched quietly but answered well is recognized.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE PITCH PANEL

SAY: *How long is the pitch? (Two minutes.) · Does everyone in the team speak? (Yes, one part each.) · Can you read a script? (No, key words.) · Panel: where do your questions come from? (The objection cards.) · What do you say first when you get a hard question? ("That's a good question.") · When do you say "Bingo"? (At the end, not during the pitch.) · Can you vote for your own team? (No!)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give Part 1 (signpost + problem) with a frame strip: "Today I'll talk about _____. The problem is _____. For example, _____." Use a topic card with a picture (bike, garden, lamp) and read the facts aloud with the learner. In Q&A, the learner's job is the first line only: "That's a good question," and a teammate continues. Target: three signposted sentences, spoken without reading.

STRETCH

Build a pitch that **anticipates** the objection before the panel asks ("Now, you might be thinking: who's going to maintain it?"). Use *not only... but also*, a conditional call to action ("If we act this month, we could open by spring."), and one figure + one example together. C1 step: answer a question you *can't* fully answer honestly and still sound in control. Early finishers draft the email to the community board (C20 register!) that would follow the pitch.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"Research suggest" / "Studies shows":** third-person -s slips appear under pressure for almost everyone, especially Chinese, Vietnamese, Thai and Haitian Creole speakers (no verb agreement in L1). Put *research suggests* · *studies show* on the board.
- ◆ **Double connector:** "Although it is expensive, but it saves money." / "Admittedly..., but however...". Chinese (*suīrán... dànshì*), Vietnamese (*tuy... nhưng*), Korean and Arabic use a pair of linkers. English uses **one**: *Although..., ... or ..., but....*
- ◆ **Hedging vs over-claiming:** some learners (e.g. from Japanese, Korean, Thai and some East African contexts) soften so much that there is no claim ("Maybe perhaps it could be a little good"); others state opinion as fact ("Everybody knows this is the best"). Aim for a clear claim + a fair concession.
- ◆ **Rhetorical questions answered:** learners from classrooms where every question must be answered may reply to the presenter's rhetorical question. Explain the falling tune and the "don't answer" rule; enjoy the laugh.
- ◆ **"I will cover about two points" / "I will talk about the bike":** Spanish/Portuguese *hablar sobre* → "talk about" is fine, but "cover about" isn't. **cover / discuss / explain** + object directly.
- ◆ **Stress on long words:** *adMITtedly, inVESTment, opportUnity, eVidence*. Speakers of syllable-timed languages (Spanish, French, Tagalog, Yoruba) may give every syllable equal weight, which flattens the rhetoric. Tap the stressed syllable on the desk.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 7.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_21.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and say them back with the pauses; do Exercises 1–3 and the Quick Quiz. Workbook 7.3: write a one-paragraph "case" for something you want to persuade someone of (an everyday or workplace topic; your

team's pitch is fine) and mark it up (underline the signposts, box the reasons and evidence, star each technique and the concede-counter move). "My new words" and the journal.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** Admittedly, it's expensive; however, it saves money long-term. · Q2 **B** "That's a good question — I don't have the exact figure, but I'll follow up." · Q3 (new) **B** "It's not a cost; it's an investment." is contrast. Script 7.3-A: signposts *Today I'd like to...*, *First...*, *Moving on to...*, *To sum up...*; techniques: rhetorical question, tripling (*healthier, cheaper and greener*), contrast (*not a luxury; it's basic*), concede-counter (*Admittedly... That said...*), appeal (*Think about...*), call to action.

CLOSING THE MODULE

END OF C22: MODULE 7 WRAP-UP

Recap on the last slide: **fit the reader** (one message, three registers, one register per message) → **hold the listener** (hook, scene, connectors, the historic present, a landed ending, and good reactions) → **move the audience** (signpost, claim + evidence, a technique, concede and counter, handle the question, call to action). Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you; review it in the C23 warmer.

Watch for in Module 8: Lesson 8.1 (connected speech) explains the reductions learners heard in casual register (*gonna, wanna, lemme*): link back to the informal end of the dial. Lesson 8.2 (vague language: *sort of, around, or so*) is the informal cousin of hedging; remind learners it belongs at the casual end, not in a formal email.

Lesson 8.3 / C25 is a structured debate: the signposts, concede-counter and Q&A phrases from C22 carry straight over, so keep the Persuasion Bingo grids and the objection cards for C25.

Final assessment (C26): the speaking interview is a natural place for a short anecdote ("Tell me about a time something funny or surprising happened") and a mini-case ("Persuade me that..."). The writing section can include a register task (a casual message → a formal email). Use the "Fix it / Upgrade it" notes you kept in this module to give each learner one accuracy target and one range target before C26.

Module 8 — Fluency & the Final Project

The last three classes of the course. First, a listening lab on natural, connected speech: weak forms and the schwa, *can* vs *can't*, linking, elision and assimilation, and casual reductions (*gonna*, *wanna*, *gotta*, *kinda*, *d'you*, *whatcha*), practiced through micro-dictation and a dictogloss. Next comes vague language: approximating (*about*, *around*, *-ish*, *or so*, *give or take*), general nouns and placeholders (*stuff*, *and that kind of thing*, *or something*) and hedges (*sort of*, *a bit*, *in a way*), and knowing when vagueness is natural and when it is sloppy. Last, the B2 review project: a structured debate with a motion, teams on assigned sides, a chair, a timekeeper, rebuttals and questions from the floor.

3 Lessons

Lessons 8.1–8.3

Classes C23–C25

Weeks 12–13

90 min per class

CEFR B2

HOW TO USE THIS GUIDE

- One lesson block = one 90-minute class. C23 and C24 follow the usual shape: **warmer** → **lead-in** → **Meaning / Form / Pronunciation** with concept-checking questions (CCQs) → **drill** → **controlled practice** (workbook) → **freer practice** → **feedback** with delayed error correction → **homework**. C23 is a **listening lab**, so its "controlled practice" is mostly listening and its freer stage is a group reconstruction task. C25 is a task-based class: pre-task → planning → rehearsal → task (two debates) → feedback.
- The **stage plan** is your clock. Each one adds up to 90 minutes. The numbers in the Time column are minutes.
- Present from [slides/module-8-debate.html](#). Print [materials/module-8/classroom-materials.html](#) before C23. It holds the flashcards (reductions, weak forms, vague expressions, debate moves), the **listening-lab scripts** (each with a natural-speed and a slow version), the Decode It A/B cards, the "Appropriate or sloppy?" sort cards, the Register Switch role cards, the **Roughly Speaking** board game, the new identity cards, the debate kit (motion cards, side cards, role cards, the chair's script, timekeeper cards, floor-question and voting slips), the **debate rubric** and the **teacher observation checklist**.
- The online lessons are the learners' **homework and review**. Each has  Listen buttons and an audio control that can **slow speech down**, which is exactly what learners need after C23.
- Extension, not a first meeting.** Learners met weak forms informally in every earlier pronunciation note, hedging in 7.1 (register) and 7.3 (persuasion), and conceding and countering in 7.3. Many already say *about* and *stuff*. The new B2 work is (1) naming the connected-speech processes so learners can *decode* fast speech on purpose, (2) using vagueness **deliberately** and knowing when it becomes sloppy, and (3) sustaining a formal, rule-bound exchange where you must answer what the other side actually said.

- ◆ **American English is the classroom standard.** The online lessons use British forms and British sounds: *recognise, favour, centre, neighbourhood, colour, practise, memorise, film, shop, quid, veg, cycle lanes*, and the phonemic table gives British vowels (*of* /ɒv/, *was* /wɒz/, *are* /ɑː/). Teach *recognize, favor, center, neighborhood, color, practice, memorize, movie, store, bucks / dollars, vegetables, bike lanes*, and the American strong forms *of* /ʌv/, *was* /wʌz/, *are* /ər/. The **weak** forms are the same in both. Accept British forms when learners use them.
- ◆ Dashed boxes = lines to say out loud, CCQs and ICQs (instruction-checking questions). Green boxes = scripts you read aloud. **Amber** = watch-outs.

THE THROUGH-LINE

Hear it → loosen it → argue it. In C23 learners stop waiting for clear, separate words and learn how fast English really arrives: "*I wz gonna callya*" = *I was going to call you*. In C24 they learn that fluent speakers are often *deliberately* imprecise (*about thirty or so, give or take*) and that the skill is judging when to be vague and when to be exact. In C25 they put the whole level into one formal event: a debate in which they must **listen** to the other team at natural speed, **concede** what is fair, **counter** it, and switch between a formal backbone (the passive, conditionals, comparison, inversion) and natural spoken touches (hedges, vague language). Every class ends the same way: understanding and responding to real, fast, spoken English.

FLUENCY BEFORE ACCURACY — FEEDBACK ON ACCURACY AND RANGE

During freer stages, **do not interrupt**. Walk around with a notepad divided into three columns: **Fix** (errors that matter), **Upgrade** (correct but plain sentences a B2 speaker could lift), and **Wow** (great language to praise). Correct **after** the task, on the board, without names. At B2, feedback is not only about mistakes: every feedback stage in this module boards **two errors to fix and one or two sentences to upgrade**, e.g. "*Cars are bad for health.*" → "*It's widely accepted that car fumes damage our health.*" Correct on the spot only when the error blocks meaning or is the target of a drill.

Dominant speakers are the biggest risk in C24's board game and in C25's debate. Use structure, not criticism: (1) the **timekeeper** is real: when the card says STOP, the speaker stops mid-sentence (make it a joke, but keep it); (2) give a dominant learner the **chair** or the **rebuttal** role (they must respond to others, not deliver a speech); (3) floor questions use **one slip per person**: when your slip is used, you're done; (4) a quiet word before class: "You're a strong speaker. Today, can you help your team by making sure everyone gets their turn?" Quieter learners get the **opening** speech (fully prepared from notes) or the **summary** (short, planned), and 30 seconds of thinking time before any spontaneous turn.

TRAUMA-INFORMED: ASSIGNED SIDES AND SAFE MOTIONS

A debate asks people to argue in public, and for some learners disagreement with a group, a raised voice, or "taking a side" carries real risk from past experience. Three rules protect everyone. (1) **Sides are assigned by drawing a card**, never chosen. Say it every time: "You argue the side you're given. It says nothing about what you believe. Lawyers and debaters do this every day." Nobody explains their own view, ever. (2) **Motions stay in everyday, community and workplace territory**: phones at dinner, a four-day week, homework for children, a car-free main street on weekends. The online lesson's examples include "*University should be free*": in class, don't use it or any motion about politics, religion, immigration, policing, or national identity. (3) **The vote is secret and it is about the debate**: "Which team made the stronger case?"; never "What do you think?" In C24, personal description tasks (your week, your neighborhood) always allow a **new identity card** or an invented answer, and anyone can say "Pass."

BEFORE THE MODULE

- ◆ Print the **flashcards** (reductions, weak forms, vague expressions, debate moves) once for the board. Cut them before C23.
- ◆ For C23: rehearse the **listening-lab scripts** aloud at home. The natural version must sound natural: read the "sounds like" line as a guide, don't exaggerate, and keep your normal speed. Practice the slow version too (clear, not robotic). One set of **Decode It A/B** cards per pair.
- ◆ For C24: one set of "**Appropriate or sloppy?**" sort cards per group of 3–4, one **Roughly Speaking** board + a die (or a coin: heads = 1, tails = 2) + counters per group, one set of **Register Switch A/B** cards per pair, and the **new identity cards** on a side table.
- ◆ For C25 (set up at the **end of C24**): decide the teams and debates, cut the **motion cards**, the **side cards** (Proposition / Opposition) and the **role cards**. Print one **chair's script** per debate, one set of **timekeeper cards** per debate, floor-question slips and voting slips for everyone, one **debate rubric** per learner and the **teacher observation checklist** on a clipboard. A big timer on the screen helps.
- ◆ **Know your C26 plan**. Read "Looking Ahead" at the end of this chapter and check the kit's B2 final assessment (**assessment/**) before C25, so what you tell learners matches it. Order or print certificates (the shared ESL toolkit has a template).
- ◆ **Room for C25**: two tables facing each other (Proposition on the chair's right, Opposition on the left), the chair and timekeeper at the front, the floor facing the teams. Set it up before class; it changes the atmosphere at once.

MODULE AT A GLANCE

LESSON	CLASS	FOCUS	LEARNERS CAN...
8.1	C23 · wk 12	Listening lab: English as a stress-timed language; weak forms and the schwa /ə/ (<i>to, of, and, for, can, was, are, them</i>); <i>can</i> /kən/ vs <i>can't</i> /kænt/; linking (consonant → vowel; /w/ and /j/ glides); elision (<i>nex(t) day</i>) and assimilation (<i>don't you</i> → "doncha"); reductions (<i>gonna, wanna, gotta, kinda, d'you, whatcha, lemme, gimme</i>); micro-dictation and a dictogloss	follow fast, natural speech by anchoring on stressed words, hear <i>can</i> vs <i>can't</i> , decode reductions back to full forms, and rebuild a short spoken message in correct written English
8.2	C24 · wk 12	Vague language : approximating (<i>about, around, roughly, or so, -ish, give or take, more or less, thirty-odd, a couple of</i>); general nouns and placeholders (<i>stuff, things, and that kind of thing, and so on, or something, thingy</i>); hedges (<i>sort of, kind of, a bit, in a way, I guess</i>); register : appropriate vs sloppy vagueness	sound relaxed and natural in casual talk with deliberate vague language, and switch to precise language for a manager, a doctor, a landlord or a safety instruction
8.3	C25 · wk 13	Review project: A Structured Debate . The shape of a balanced argument; formal debate format (chair, timekeeper, proposer, opposer, rebuttal and summary speakers, floor questions, a secret vote); concede and counter; the whole B2 toolkit (conditionals, the passive, comparison, cleft and inversion, register, hedging)	argue an assigned side of a motion in a timed formal debate, answer the other team's actual points, ask and answer floor questions, and chair or time a debate
—	C26 · wk 13	Final assessment + celebration (see the kit's B2 final assessment)	show what they can do in a friendly assessment, then celebrate the end of B2

8.1 · C23

Understanding Natural Speech — A Listening Lab

90 min

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ explain why fast English is hard to catch: content words are stressed and clear, grammar words are squeezed (English is **stress-timed**)
- ◆ recognize the **weak forms** of *to, of, and, for, can, was, are, them, at, some, than, that* with the schwa /ə/, and hear the difference between *can* /kən/ and *can't* /kænt/
- ◆ follow **linking** (*turn it off* → "tur-ni-toff"), **elision** (*nex(t) day, san(d)wich*) and **assimilation** (*don't you* → "doncha")
- ◆ decode casual reductions (*gonna, wanna, gotta, kinda, sorta, d'you, whatcha, lemme, gimme, dunno, 'em*) and always write the full forms
- ◆ rebuild a short message heard at natural speed (dictogloss), putting every "invisible" grammar word back

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.1 (terms, weak-form box, Exercises 1–5, Sam & Jo dialogue, Decode It)
- ◆ Slides 3–9 · Reduction and weak-form flashcards · **Decode It** A/B cards (1 set per pair)
- ◆ Listening-lab scripts **8.1-A** (careful vs natural), **8.1-B** (can or can't?), **8.1-C** (micro-dictation), **8.1-D** (dictogloss: Dana's voicemail) — each with a natural-speed and a slow version
- ◆ Optional: a phone to "play" Dana's voicemail (read the script holding the phone to your ear)

BOARD PLAN

Left — STRESS-TIMED: I was **GO**ing to **CALL** you → "I wz **gonna callya**" · big words = **clear** · small words = **squeezed** · schwa /ə/ = "uh"

Center — FOUR DISGUISES: 1 weak forms: *to* /tə/ · *of* /əv/ · *and* /ən/ · *can* /kən/ ≠ *can't* /kænt/ · 2 linking: *turn_it_off* · *an_apple* · *go (w) on* · 3 elision: *nex(t) day* · *san(d)wich* · 4 reductions: *gonna* · *wanna* · *gotta* · *kinda* · *d'you* · *whatcha* · *lemme*

Right — THE RULE: 👂 hear "gonna" → ✎ write **going to**. Never write "gonna" in an email. Listen for the **stressed beats**, not the gaps.

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: 30-second pitch	8	S-S → T-S	Review C22 (7.3, persuasion). Each learner draws an everyday object or idea (a pen, Monday mornings, the bus, cold coffee) and "sells" it to a partner in 30 seconds with one persuasive technique (a rhetorical question, a rule of three, "Imagine..."). The partner asks one tough question; the speaker handles it ("That's a great question..."). Swap twice. Two volunteers perform for the class.
Lead-in: careful vs natural	7	T-S	Read Script 8.1-A : the Sam & Jo conversation, first in "dictionary English" (every word careful), then at natural speed. "Which one sounds like real people? What happened to the words?" Elicit: words disappear, run together, get shorter. Slide 3. "Your listening isn't weak. Nobody showed you the disguises. Today you learn four of them."
Weak forms & can / can't	13	T-S → S	Slides 4–5. Clap the stressed beats of "I was going to call you" and show how the small words squeeze between the claps. Present the weak-form table and the schwa. CCQs (below). Weak-form drill. Then Script 8.1-B : learners write <i>can</i> or <i>can't</i> (Workbook Ex 1), first at natural speed, then check with the slow version.
Linking, elision, assimilation	10	T-S → S-S	Slides 6–7. Consonant → vowel linking (write <i>turn it off</i> and draw the <u> </u> arcs), the little /w/ and /j/ glides, then elision and assimilation. Linking drill (backchaining, below). Pairs do Workbook Ex 3 (the hidden word; mark the links and cross out the silent letters) and read the phrases aloud to each other.
Reductions	8	T-S → S	Slide 8. Flash the reduction cards: T says "gonna," learners say "going to"; T says "going to," learners say "gonna." Stress the rule: these are for listening ; write the full forms. Workbook Ex 2 alone, check in pairs.
Micro-dictation	8	S → S-S	Script 8.1-C , Workbook Ex 4. Each sentence: natural speed twice (learners count the words on their fingers, then write), then the slow version once to check. Pairs compare. "Which words did you miss?" It is almost always the small ones: that's the point.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Dictogloss: Dana's voicemail	20	S → S-S → groups	Slide 9. Script 8.1-D , Workbook Ex 5. (1) Predict: "A coworker leaves a voicemail about work. What might she say?" (1 min). (2) Read once at natural speed: just listen (1 min). (3) Read again at natural speed: learners write stressed content words only (2 min). (4) Pairs pool their notes (3 min). (5) Groups of 3–4 rebuild the message in full, correct written English, with every grammar word back (8 min). (6) Read the slow version, or show the text; groups compare and find what they missed and <i>why</i> (weak form? linking? elision?) (5 min). ICQs first.
Freer: Decode It	6	S-S	Pairs, Decode It A/B cards. A says six sentences naturally (the card shows the full form and a "say it like this" hint); B writes the full form, then answers the sentence as a real reply ("D'you wanna grab lunch?" → writes <i>Do you want to grab lunch?</i> → says "Sure, where?"). Swap. Early finishers read the Sam & Jo dialogue at natural speed.
Feedback	5	T-S	Board 2 errors from the dictogloss reconstructions (no names), usually missing grammar words: "I was going call you" · "They want us bring a copy." Learners fix them (<i>going to call, want us to bring</i>). Then 1 upgrade : praise the group that kept the passive "The meeting has been moved ." Which disguise tricked the class most? Tick it on the board.
Homework set-up	5	T-S	Show online lesson 8.1; point at the  speed control and a  button. Set the homework (below): the online transcribe-and-decode project. Learners tick the "I can..." box.
Total	90		8 + 7 + 13 + 10 + 8 + 8 + 20 + 6 + 5 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Do Workbook Ex 3 as homework and shorten the reductions stage to the flashcard drill. **Never cut the dictogloss below 15 minutes.** It is the heart of the lab: learners discover for themselves where their ears fail, and the group talk while rebuilding the text is real B2 negotiation ("No, I think she said *has been* moved, because...").

Meaning: stress-timing. In English the stressed syllables come at roughly regular beats, and everything between them is squeezed to fit. Content words (nouns, main verbs, adjectives, adverbs, negatives) carry the beat; grammar words (articles, prepositions, auxiliaries, pronouns, conjunctions) are squeezed.

SAY: "I was GOing to CALL you." How many beats? (Two, on go- and call.) Which words are squeezed? (I, was, -ing to, you.) Are they gone? (No, still there, just short and quiet.) Is this lazy English? (No, everyone speaks like this, newsreaders too.)

Meaning: weak forms and the schwa. Most grammar words have a strong form (alone or stressed) and a weak form (most of the time). In the weak form the vowel becomes the schwa /ə/, the most common sound in English.

SAY: "It's for you." Do you hear "four"? (No, /fər/.) · When do we say the strong "FOR"? (When it's stressed: "Who's it FOR?", or at the end of a sentence.) · "a cup of tea" → "a cuppa tea": which word disappeared? (of.) Is it still in the meaning? (Yes.)

SAY: **can / can't:** "I can go." Is can long or short? (Short, /kən/.) · "I CAN'T go." Long or short? (Long, stressed, /kænt/, and the t is often almost silent.) · So how do you know which one you heard? (The vowel and the stress: short "kn" = can; long "kænt" = can't. Don't wait for the t.)

Meaning: linking, elision, assimilation.

SAY: "turn it off" → "tur-ni-toff." Where did the n go? (To the start of the next word.) · "go on" → "go-won." Is there a new word "won"? (No, a small /w/ glide.) · "next day": do you hear the t? (No.) Is it spelled? (Yes.) Do we write "nex day"? (Never.) · "Don't you know?" → "doncha": is that a new word? (No, /t/ + /j/ blend into "ch.")

Meaning: reductions. Some chunks shrink so often that they have informal spellings. They show the *sound*, not a new word.

SAY: "I'm gonna call her." Full form? (I'm going to call her.) · Can I write "gonna" in a work email? (No.) In a text to a friend? (Some people do; in class, practice the full form.) · "I'm going to the store." Can this be "gonna"? (No! Only going to + verb becomes "gonna.") · "I gotta go." Full form? (I've got to go / I have to go.)

Form.

Word	Strong (US)	Weak	You hear...
to	/tu/	/tə/	I want tə go.

of	/ʌv/	/əv/, /ə/	a cup ə tea · kind ə cold
and	/ænd/	/ən/, /n/	fish 'n' chips · you 'n' me
for	/fɔr/	/fər/	It's fər you.
can	/kæn/	/kən/	I kən go. (≠ I CAN'T go.)
was	/wʌz/	/wəz/	She wəz late.
are	/ɑr/	/ər/	They ər ready.
them	/ðɛm/	/ðəm/, 'em	Tell 'em.
at · some · than · that		/ət/ · /səm/ · /ðən/ · / ðət/	at ət six · səm milk · bigger ðən · I think ðət...

Reductions	gonna = going to · wanna = want to · gotta = (have) got to · kinda / sorta = kind of / sort of · d'you = do you · whatcha = what are you / what do you · lemme = let me · gimme = give me · dunno = don't know · 'em = them · didja = did you · doncha = don't you
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Pronunciation (American English). The **flap t**: between vowels, American *t* sounds like a quick soft *d*: *water* "wadder," *got a* "godda," *what about* "whadabout," *let it* "ledit." Many learners have never been told this, and it explains a lot of "missing" words. Final *t* before a consonant is often a **glottal stop**: *can't go* [kæ? gou], *not now* [nɑ? nau]. **Production goal**: learners don't need to *produce* reductions. Clear full forms are always fine. What helps their own speech is the rhythm: stress the content words, and let the grammar words be light.

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 Clap the beat:** T claps two beats and says "CALL you LATER." Class repeats. Add small words without adding beats: "I'll CALL you LATER." → "I was GOing to CALL you LATER." The claps don't slow down, so the small words must squeeze. Choral, then rows, then individuals.
- 2 Strong or weak?** T: "Who's it for?" (strong, end of sentence) → "It's for you." (weak) · T: "Can you swim? Yes, I can." (strong) → "I can swim." (weak). Learners repeat both and say which is strong.
- 3 can / can't hands:** T says a sentence naturally; learners show a thumbs-up for *can*, thumbs-down for *can't*. Then pairs: A says one, B shows the thumb.
- 4 Backchaining for linking:** T: "off" → S: "off" · T: "toff" → S: "toff" · T: "ni-toff" → S: "ni-toff" · T: "turn it off" (linked) → S: "turn it off." Repeat with *pick it up, this evening, far away*.
- 5 Reduce / expand ping-pong:** T: "going to" → S: "gonna" · T: "wanna" → S: "want to" · T: "let me" → S: "lemme" · T: "dunno" → S: "don't know." Fast, choral, then individuals.

- ◆ **Natural means natural.** Read Script 8.1-D at your normal speaking speed, both times. The temptation is to slow down "to help." Don't: the slow version comes at the *end*, as the check.
- ◆ **Content words only** on the second listening. Learners who try to write everything fall behind and panic. Model it: write "Dana ... call ... yesterday ... ran out ... time" on the board.
- ◆ **Rebuild, don't transcribe.** Groups write a correct, complete text with the same meaning. It doesn't have to be word for word, but every grammar word must be there. Circulate and ask: "What's missing between *going* and *call*?"
- ◆ **One writer per group**, and the writer is *not* the strongest learner. The strong learner is the "checker": they may only ask questions ("Are you sure it's *want us bring*?"). This keeps the group talking and stops one person doing it all.
- ◆ **The check:** read the slow version while groups compare, then show the text (project the Script 8.1-D page from the classroom materials, or write it on the board). Groups underline their misses and label each: WF (weak form), L (linking), E (elision), R (reduction). "Which label did you write most?"

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE DICTOGLOSS

SAY: *How many times do I read it before you write? (Once: just listen.) · Second time, what do you write? (Only the big, stressed words.) · Then? (Share notes with a partner, then rebuild it in a group.) · Do you write "gonna"? (No, the full form.) · Must it be word for word? (No, same meaning, correct English, every small word.) · Who writes in your group? (The writer; the checker only asks questions.)*

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Focus on three things only: *can / can't* (thumbs), *gonna / wanna / gotta* (flashcards with the full form on the back), and "listen for the big words." In the micro-dictation, give a gapped version with the content words already printed ("I ____ call ____, but I ran ____ time.") so learners listen only for the small words. In the dictogloss, be the note-taker's partner: learners say the words they heard and you (or a partner) write them. Target: Ex 1 with 6/8 correct and 4 reductions expanded aloud.

STRETCH

Explore the American **flap t** and the **glottal stop** (above) and find three examples in the dictogloss. Notice when a reduction is *impossible*: "I want **her** to come" can never be "I wanna her come"; "I'm going to the store" never becomes "gonna the store." Toward C1: listen to 60 seconds of an unscripted podcast and transcribe it, then compare with the auto-captions and find where the captions are wrong. Early finishers write the Sam & Jo dialogue as a formal message (no reductions, full sentences).

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **Syllable-timed languages** (Spanish, Portuguese, French, Italian, Turkish, Tagalog, and many West African languages) give every syllable similar length, so learners expect to hear *to*, *of*, *was* as full words and "lose" the sentence when they don't. Clapping the beats is the fix. Japanese (mora-timed) speakers have the same issue.
- ◆ **Adding vowels to clusters:** Spanish and Portuguese speakers ("es-tudent"), Arabic speakers ("nex-i-t day"), Japanese and Korean speakers ("nexu-to"). When the English speaker *drops* a sound (*nex(t) day*), these learners hear something very different from what they expect. Show both on the board: what they'd say vs what they hear.
- ◆ **Dropped final consonants:** Vietnamese, Cantonese, Mandarin and Thai speakers often release final consonants weakly, and so miss the consonant that *links* to the next vowel (*pick_it_up* → they hear "pi... i... up"). Train them to listen for the consonant at the start of the next word.
- ◆ **French speakers** have an advantage: English linking is like French *liaison*. Tell them so; it builds confidence.
- ◆ **Missing articles** in the dictogloss (Russian, Polish, Chinese, Japanese, Korean): "meeting has been moved to next Tuesday," "bring copy of report." Their L1 has no articles, and the English weak form /ə/ is almost silent, so they neither hear nor expect them. Board the missing *the* / *a* in feedback.
- ◆ **can / can't:** learners from every background wait for the final *t*, which in American English is often silent. Teach the vowel: /ə/ vs /æ/.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.1: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_22.html. Use the  control to hear the model sentences slowly, then at normal speed, and repeat them; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz. Do the lesson's project: transcribe 15–30 seconds of a clip with subtitles, compare, and label every miss (weak form, linking, elision, reduction). Workbook 8.1: "My new words" and the journal (three "disappearing words" from real listening this week, and the full forms).

◆ CHECK – SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 A I was going to call you. · Q2 A "I can help" (a weak, unstressed *can*). · Q3 (new) A I don't know. Let me check. Ex 1 (Script 8.1-B): 1 can't · 2 can · 3 can · 4 can't · 5 can · 6 can't ... can · 7 can · 8 can't ... can.
Dictogloss: see the answer key and Script 8.1-D.

◆ OBJECTIVES – LEARNERS CAN...

- approximate numbers, amounts and times naturally: *about / around / roughly twenty · ten minutes or so · seven-ish · fifty, give or take · thirty-odd · a couple of · more or less*
- use general nouns and placeholders: *stuff, things, and that kind of thing, and so on, or something, and everything, the thingy*
- soften statements and opinions with hedges: *sort of, kind of, a bit, a little, in a way, I guess, I suppose*
- judge **register**: tell natural, friendly vagueness from **sloppy** vagueness (too many placeholders, or vagueness where precision is needed: dosages, deadlines, safety, contracts)
- describe the same situation twice: relaxed and vague for a friend, clear and precise for a manager, doctor or landlord

◆ MATERIALS

- Workbook 8.2 (phrase bank, grammar box, Exercises 1–5, Alex & Priya dialogue, Register Switch, Describe It Naturally)
- Slides 10–14 · Vague-expression flashcards (approximators, placeholders, hedges) · **"Appropriate or sloppy?"** sort cards (1 set per group) · **Roughly Speaking** board game (1 per group + die or coin + counters) · **Register Switch** A/B cards (1 set per pair) · New identity cards
- Listening scripts 8.2-A (Alex & Priya) and 8.2-B (Leo's two voicemails: to a friend, to his manager)
- For the C25 set-up: motion cards, side cards, role cards, the debate prep sheet (Workbook 8.3)

BOARD PLAN

Left — 1 APPROXIMATE: *about / around / roughly 20 · 10 minutes or so · seven-ish · 50, give or take · thirty-odd guests · a couple of minutes · more or less finished*

Center — 2 GENERAL NOUNS: *stuff* (uncountable! no "stuffs") · *things* · milk, bread, *that kind of thing* · pizza *or something* · pen, paper, *and so on* · the *thingy* · 3 HEDGES: *sort of / kind of · a bit expensive · in a way · I guess*

Right — READ THE ROOM: 😊 friend: "done-ish, sevenish" · 🧑‍💼 manager: "nearly complete; by 7 p.m." · 💊🔥📄 dosage · safety · contract = **PRECISE**

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: decode it	6	T-S → S-S	Review C23. Say 5 sentences at natural speed ("Whatcha gonna do this weekend?" · "I dunno,

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
again			lemme think." · "D'you wanna cuppa coffee?" · "I gotta go." · "It's kinda cold."). Teams write the full forms; 1 point each. Then pairs share one "disappearing word" from their homework.
Lead-in: robot or human?	5	T-S	Slide 10. Read the two versions: "The trip takes 34 minutes. I bought 6 items. It cost \$12.50." vs "It takes about half an hour. I picked up a few things. It was twelve bucks or so." "Which one is a robot? Why does the human sound friendlier?" Elicit the four reasons: precision can sound cold; we often don't know exactly; vagueness shows shared understanding; it softens.
Clarify: three jobs	15	T-S	Slides 11–12. Job 1: approximate (positions matter: <i>about</i> before, <i>or so</i> after, <i>-ish</i> attached). Job 2: general nouns and placeholders (picture slide: "I picked up a few things: milk, bread, that kind of thing"). Job 3: hedges. Stick the flashcards on the board in three columns as you go. CCQs and drill (below).
Controlled practice	7	S → S-S	Workbook Ex 1 (insert the vague expression) and Ex 2 (soften the over-precise sentence) alone, then check in pairs. Board-check only the items pairs disagree on.
Listening: two voicemails	7	S → T-S	Script 8.2-B , Workbook Ex 5. Read Leo's voicemail to his friend, then his voicemail to his manager. Learners complete the table: what's approximate for the friend and exact for the manager? What's missing from the manager version, and why? (The boxes and "stuff" aren't her business; the hours he'll make up are.)
Appropriate or sloppy?	11	S-S (groups) → T-S	Slide 13. Groups of 3–4 sort the 12 situation cards into  NATURAL and  SLOPPY, then fix every  card aloud (a precise version). Check against the key. Then Workbook Ex 3 (the same idea, new items) alone as a quick check. CCQs on register.
Freer 1: Roughly	12	S-S (groups)	Groups of 3–4, one board. Roll (or flip a coin) and move. Answer the square's question for about 30

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Speaking			seconds using the vague language it asks for; the group checks with the flashcard columns. On a PRECISE square, the vague rule flips: answer with exact facts. STOP squares: the next player asks a follow-up ("Roughly how far is it?"). ICQs first.
Freer 2: Register Switch	12	S-S (pairs)	Slide 14. Pairs, A/B cards. Each card has one situation and two listeners: first tell it to a friend (relaxed, vague, warm), then to a manager / doctor / landlord / child's teacher (clear, precise). The partner plays each listener and asks one question. Swap. Personal details can come from a new identity card. ICQs first.
Feedback	5	T-S	Board 2 errors ("I have many stuffs to do." · "More or less, thanks." as an answer to "How are you?") and 1–2 upgrades (plain → natural: "There were 31 people." → "There were thirty-odd people."; sloppy → precise: "The thingy is kind of broken." → "The kitchen faucet is leaking.").
Homework & C25 set-up	10	T-S → groups	Online lesson 8.2 + workbook Ex 4 and journal. Then C25 set-up (slide 15): form the teams (see "Setting up the debates" in 8.3), each team draws a motion card and a side card, and learners draw role cards. Teams meet for 4 minutes: read the motion, share first ideas, and take the debate prep sheet (Workbook 8.3) home to fill with key words. "You argue the side on your card. It says nothing about what you believe."
Total	90		6 + 5 + 15 + 7 + 7 + 11 + 12 + 12 + 5 + 10

IF YOU RUN LONG

Cut Roughly Speaking to 8 minutes (or skip it: it's also a good C26 celebration game) and move Workbook Ex 3 to homework. Keep the Register Switch: it is where learners *choose* the level of vagueness, which is the real B2 skill. **Never cut the C25 set-up.** Teams that know their motion and side before C25 plan better arguments at home, and the debates are far stronger.

◆ MEANING · FORM · PRONUNCIATION

Meaning: approximating.

SAY: "There were thirty-odd people." Were the people strange? (No! -odd = a bit more than thirty.) · Exactly thirty? (No, 31, 33, 35...) · "Let's meet at seven-ish." Can I arrive at 7:10? (Yes.) At 8:30? (No, too late.) · "Fifty people, give or take." Could it be 47? (Yes.) Could it be 90? (No.) · "It's more or less finished." Is it 100% finished? (No, almost.)

Meaning: general nouns and placeholders.

SAY: "We need milk, bread, and that kind of thing." Only milk and bread? (No, similar things too: eggs, butter...) · Does the speaker know every item? (Maybe not, and it doesn't matter.) · "Pass me the thingy, the remote." Why "thingy"? (The word didn't come to mind right away.) · "I've got lots of stuffs." Correct? (No: stuff is uncountable, like water.)

Meaning: hedges.

SAY: "It's a bit expensive." Is it cheap? (No.) Is the speaker angry? (No, polite, soft.) · "I kind of see it differently." Does she agree? (No.) Why not just say "I disagree"? (Softer; keeps the relationship.) · Can you hedge too much? (Yes: "It's sort of kind of a bit maybe difficult" = nobody knows what you mean.)

Meaning: register, the key B2 judgment.

SAY: Medicine label: "Take two-ish tablets every four hours or so." OK? (No! Dangerous.) · Email to your manager: "The report's more or less done, I'll send it sevenish." OK? (No: "The report is nearly complete. I'll send it by 7 p.m.") · To a friend: "I'll be there sevenish." OK? (Perfect.) · At the doctor's: "It hurts sort of here, for about a week." OK? (Yes, honest; then give the facts you do know.)

Form.

Before the number	about · around · roughly · approximately (more formal) · a couple of · a few	about twenty · roughly \$50
After the number	or so · give or take · or thereabouts · -odd (after a round number)	ten minutes or so · thirty-odd
Attached	-ish on times, numbers, ages, colors, some adjectives	seven-ish · fortyish · bluish
End of a list	and that kind of thing · and stuff like that · and so on · and everything · or something	pizza, snacks, that kind of thing
Before an adjective / verb	sort of · kind of · a bit · a little · more or less	a bit tired · kind of boring · more or less agreed
Whole sentence	in a way · I guess · I suppose · to be honest	In a way, you're right.

Pronunciation. Vague expressions are **light and quick**, like the weak forms from C23: *kinda, sorta, a bit*, "abou' twenny." The **number or noun** keeps the stress: "about **TWENTy**," "**SEVen**-ish," "**PIZza** or something." A rising, trailing voice on *or something...* ↗ invites the listener in; a falling voice on the precise version ↘ sounds firm and professional. *-ish* can even stand alone as an answer: "Are you ready?" "**Ish**." (very informal, a nice stretch item).

◆ DRILL SCRIPT

- 1 **Make it vague:** T: "There were 31 people." → S: "There were about thirty people." / "thirty-odd" / "thirty or so." T: "We'll meet at 7:00." → S: "We'll meet at seven-ish." T: "It took 58 minutes." → S: "It took about an hour."
- 2 **Finish the list:** T: "We need milk, bread..." → S: "...and that kind of thing." T: "Let's get pizza..." → S: "...or something." T: "Bring a pen, paper..." → S: "...and so on."
- 3 **Soften it:** T (blunt): "This is expensive." → S: "This is a bit expensive." T: "I disagree." → S: "I kind of see it differently." T: "You're wrong." → S: "In a way that's true, but..."
- 4 **Now be precise** (flip): T: "The report's done-ish. Sevenish." (to your manager) → S: "The report is nearly complete. I'll send it by 7 p.m." T: "Take a couple of pills or so." → S: "Take two tablets every six hours."

◆ ROUGHLY SPEAKING AND REGISTER SWITCH – HOW TO RUN THEM

- ◆ **Roughly Speaking** (board game, classroom materials set F): 22 squares between START and FINISH. Each square names a job (≈ APPROXIMATE, 🛒 GENERAL NOUN, 🍪 HEDGE, 🎯 PRECISE, ⏸ STOP) and a prompt ("How long does it take you to get here?"). Answer for about 30 seconds. The group gives a thumbs-up if you used the right kind of language. First to the finish wins, but the real point is the talk. Everyone may "pass" a personal prompt and take the next square's prompt instead.
- ◆ **The PRECISE squares** are the twist: "Tell a new coworker how to get out of the building in a fire." A learner who says "go out that way or something" goes back 2 squares. It makes the register rule memorable.
- ◆ **Register Switch** (A/B cards, set E): the speaker tells the **same** facts twice. Listener 1 (friend) reacts warmly; listener 2 (manager, doctor, landlord, teacher) asks for exact details ("What time exactly?" "How many?"). Afterward pairs say which facts they made vaguer or more precise, and why.
- ◆ Dominant speakers: in Roughly Speaking, the **30-second rule** is timed by the player on the right. In Register Switch the roles are fixed and short, so turns stay even.

◆ ICQS BEFORE THE GAMES

SAY: *Roughly Speaking: how long do you talk? (About 30 seconds.) · On a PRECISE square, do you use "about" and "stuff"? (No, exact facts.) · Don't want to answer a personal question? (Say "Pass" and take the next square's prompt.) · Register Switch: how many times do you tell the story? (Twice.) · Who is the*

first listener? (A friend.) The second? (The person on the card: a manager, a doctor...) · Are the facts different? (No, the same facts, different language.)

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Work with 8 expressions only: *about, around, -ish, or so, stuff, or something, a bit, kind of*, using the flashcards with emoji (≈, 🛒, 🍪). In the sort, give the learner the  /  decision only (a partner writes the fix). In Register Switch, use a picture-supported card (clock, calendar, 🕒) and a two-line frame: "Friend: *It was about... / ...or something.* Manager: *It was exactly... / at ... o'clock.*" Target: 3 vague expressions used in speech and 1 correct "be precise" decision.

STRETCH

Vague language in **writing** registers: in a formal report, *approximately, roughly, in the region of, a number of, various, tends to, appears to* are "vague" but professional. Rewrite one casual sentence formally ("thirty-odd people turned up" → "approximately thirty people attended"). Toward C1: hedging in argument (*It could be argued that..., This may suggest...*) is vague language for grown-ups, and it's exactly what C25 needs. Early finishers write the lesson's journal paragraph and a "robotic" version of it.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"More or less" as "so-so":** Spanish *más o menos*, Portuguese *mais ou menos*, Italian *più o meno* answer "How are you?" In English, "How are you?" "More or less." sounds strange. English *more or less* = almost / basically ("It's more or less finished"). For "so-so," teach *not bad, OK, could be better*.
- ◆ **"stuffs," "informations," "equipments":** many languages count these nouns. *Stuff* is uncountable: *a lot of stuff*, never *many stuffs*.
- ◆ **"-odd" and "odd":** learners who know *odd* = strange hear "thirty-odd people" as "thirty strange people." Teach it as a chunk after round numbers.
- ◆ **Hedging feels dishonest** to some learners from more direct communication styles (German, Dutch, Russian, Hebrew, Polish): "Why say 'a bit' if it's very expensive?" Explain that in English the hedge is politeness, and everyone decodes it. Learners from indirect styles (Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Thai, Filipino) may hedge *everything* and bury the message. Aim for the middle: one hedge per opinion.
- ◆ **"like" as a filler:** learners who picked up English from TV and social media may use *like* in every sentence ("It was, like, like thirty people"). Fine among friends, sloppy in an interview. It goes in Ex 3.

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.2: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_23.html. Listen to the model sentences with 🎧 and repeat them with the relaxed rhythm; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz, and record the lesson's "Describe It Naturally" project (60–90 seconds). Workbook 8.2: Ex 4 (robotic → natural, sloppy →

clear), "My new words" and the journal. **For C25:** fill the debate prep sheet in Workbook 8.3 with **key words only**, for your assigned side and role.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **B** About thirty or so, give or take. · Q2 **A** Writing dosage instructions on medicine. · Q3 (new) **B** "I put the stuff with the thingy near the whatsit." (too many placeholders: nobody can follow it). Ex 5 (Script 8.2-B): see the answer key.

◆ OBJECTIVES — LEARNERS CAN...

- ◆ follow a structured debate at natural speed and identify how each speaker presents, concedes and counters
- ◆ build a case for an **assigned side** of a motion: 2–3 arguments, each with a reason and an example or consequence
- ◆ deliver a timed **opening**, **rebuttal** or **summary** speech from notes, with signposting
- ◆ **concede and counter** ("While I accept that..., the fact remains...") and answer what the other team *actually said*, not what they expected
- ◆ ask and answer a **floor question**, and **chair** or **time** a debate with the right formal language
- ◆ use the B2 toolkit in extended speech: a conditional, an impersonal passive, an advanced comparison, a cleft or inversion, and a natural hedge

◆ MATERIALS

- ◆ Workbook 8.3 (the format, language bank, Exercises 1–5, **debate prep sheet**, rubric self-check, final B2 journal)
- ◆ Slides 15–18 · The debate kit (classroom materials set G): **motion cards**, **side cards**, **role cards**, the **chair's script** (1 per debate), **timekeeper cards** (1 set per debate), **floor-question slips** and **voting slips** (1 each per learner) · **Debate rubric** (set H, 1 per learner) · **Teacher observation checklist** (set I, C25 → C26) on a clipboard · a big timer on the screen
- ◆ Listening scripts **8.3-A** (the model debate: car-free city centers) and **8.3-B** (your model opening speech and a model rebuttal)
- ◆ Learners' own prep sheets (started at home after C24)

BOARD PLAN

Left — THE ORDER: 🪑 Chair opens · 🗳️ secret vote 1 · 🟦 Proposer (2 min) · 🟥 Opposer (2 min) · 🛑 1-min huddle · 🟦 Rebuttal (1½) · 🟥 Rebuttal (1½) · 🗣️ Floor questions (4) · 🟥 Summary (1) · 🟦 Summary (1) · 🗳️ vote 2 · 🪑 Chair closes

Center — CONCEDE → COUNTER: Admittedly... / That may be true, **but**... · While I accept that..., I still believe... · Even so, we might ask whether... · My opponent claimed that... However... · 🗣️ My question is for the proposition: if..., how would...?

Right — B2 toolkit: If we **introduced**..., ...**would**... · It is **widely believed** that... · **by far** the most... · **What really matters is**... · **Not only does it**..., but... · **sort of** a trade-off · **on balance**

Corner: Your side = your card, not your opinion. · Attack ideas, never people. · The vote = which team argued better. · C26 = final class 🎉

◆ STAGE PLAN

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Warmer: vague to precise	5	S-S	Review C24 and C23. Pairs: A describes last weekend in a relaxed, vague way for 45 seconds; B asks two "precise" follow-ups ("What time exactly?"). Swap. Then teams sit together (the seating from C24) and check that everyone has their prep sheet and role.
Pre-task 1: the model debate	10	S → S-S	Read Script 8.3-A (the online lesson's debate, three voices; ask two confident learners to read Maya and Tom with you as the chair, or read all three). Listen 1, gist: "What's the motion? Who is for, who against? Who wins, in your view?" Listen 2: Workbook Ex 1 (five questions + tick the moves you hear). Pairs check. Slide 16: point out how Tom concedes before he counters.
Pre-task 2: debate language	10	T-S → S-S	Slides 15–16. The format and the roles (chair, timekeeper, proposer, opposer, rebuttal, summary, floor). Concede-and-counter drill and the chair drill (below). Workbook Ex 4 (match the concession and the counter) and Ex 5 (blunt → balanced) in pairs.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			Ex 2 and Ex 3 (mixed B2 review) are homework unless your class is fast.
Team planning	14	Groups (teams)	Read Script 8.3-B once: your model opening speech (about 2 minutes) and a model rebuttal (1 minute). "How did the rebuttal use what the opening <i>actually said</i> ?" Then teams finish the prep sheet : agree 2–3 arguments, share them out between speakers, predict the other side's 3 strongest arguments and plan a concede-and-counter for each. Tick the B2 toolkit items each speaker will plant. Chairs and timekeepers read their cards with you (see "Setting up the debates"). You circulate and help each team sharpen one argument.
Rehearsal	5	S-S (in teams)	Each speaker gives the first 30 seconds of their speech to their own team. The team gives one star and one wish . Floor members (in the other debate) write one question for each team on their slips. Chair and timekeeper set up the front of the room.
TASK: Debate 1	17	Whole class (teams + chair + floor)	Slide 17. Debate 1 runs from the chair's script: welcome and motion → secret vote 1 → proposer → opposer → huddle → two rebuttals → floor questions → opposition

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
			summary → proposition summary → secret vote 2 → the chair announces which team moved more votes and thanks both teams. You sit at the side with the observation checklist and a notepad (Fix / Upgrade / Wow). Don't step in unless the chair needs rescuing.
TASK: Debate 2	17	Whole class	Roles swap: the Debate 1 teams become the chair, timekeeper and floor; the Debate 2 teams debate their motion. Same order, same timing.
Feedback & language focus	7	T-S	First the message: name one strong argument and one excellent concede-and-counter from each debate. Then board 2 errors to fix and 2 sentences to upgrade (no names), e.g. "I am agree with my opponent, but..." · "If we will ban phones, families will talk more." · upgrade "Phones are bad at dinner." → "What really damages family meals is the constant checking." Learners fill the rubric self-check.

STAGE	TIME	INTERACTION	PROCEDURE
Looking ahead & homework	5	T-S	Slide 18: preview C26 (see "Looking Ahead"): the final assessment and the celebration. Homework: the online capstone lesson, the final B2 journal, and Ex 2-3 if not done. Learners tick the 8.3 "I can..." list.
Total	90		5 + 10 + 10 + 14 + 5 + 17 + 17 + 7 + 5

IF YOU RUN LONG

Protect planning and both debates. Cut in this order: (1) do Workbook Ex 4 and Ex 5 as homework (keep the drills); (2) shorten the model debate to one listening with the gist questions only; (3) shorten the floor questions to 3 minutes per debate. **Never cut a debate** (a team that planned and doesn't speak will be hurt), and **never cut Looking Ahead**: learners must leave knowing exactly what C26 looks like.

WHY A TEAM DEBATE IN CLASS, BUT A SOLO BALANCED TALK ONLINE?

The online lesson (8.3) lets self-study learners give a 2-3 minute balanced talk alone, presenting *both* sides and concluding. In class you have an audience and opponents, so the real B2 challenge becomes possible: **listening** to an argument at natural speed and **answering it** on the spot. That's why the rebuttal and the floor questions matter more than the prepared opening. If a learner's opening is short but their rebuttal answers a real point, that is a strong B2 performance. Note it on the checklist.

◆ MEANING • FORM • PRONUNCIATION (REVIEW)

No new grammar. The job today is **structure** (the debate format), **interaction** (responding to the other team), and **range**: planting the B2 structures on purpose. Keep CCQs fast.

SAY: "The motion is that phones should be switched off during family meals." Who argues FOR it? (The proposition.) Against? (The opposition.) · Does the opposition have to prove the opposite, that phones are good at dinner? (No, only that the motion is a bad idea or goes too far.) · You're on the proposition, but at home you love your phone at dinner. Is that a problem? (No! You argue your card.)

SAY: "Admittedly, cleaner air is a real benefit. That said, a total ban would hurt shift workers." Does Tom agree with anything? (Yes, cleaner air is a benefit.) Does he agree with the motion? (No.) Why concede first? (He sounds fair and reasonable, so his counter is more convincing.) · "No, you're completely wrong." Good rebuttal? (No: no concession, no reason, and it attacks the person.)

SAY: *Rebuttal: do you read a speech you wrote at home? (Mostly no: you answer what the other team just said. You can prepare predicted answers.) · Floor question: "What do you think about phones?" Good? (Too general. Better: "My question is for the proposition: if a parent is on call for work, would the rule still apply?")*

 Chair	Good evening and welcome to tonight's debate. · The motion is that... · I call on the first speaker for the proposition. · Thank you. I now call on... · We'll now take questions from the floor. · Please keep your question short. · Time is up, thank you. · Let's move to the vote. · The result is... Please thank both teams.	neutral, formal, never gives an opinion
 Timekeeper	(cards) 1 MINUTE LEFT · 15 SECONDS · TIME · (spoken, if needed) "Time, please."	fair to both sides
 Opening	Madam / Mr. Chair, ladies and gentlemen... · We are here to argue that... · Our case rests on three points. · First of all... · What's more... · Finally... · For these reasons, we urge you to support / oppose the motion.	2–3 arguments, each + reason + example
 Rebuttal	My opponent claimed that... · Admittedly... / That may be so, but... · While I accept that..., I still believe... · Even if that's the case,... · That argument ignores... · The other side would have you believe... However,...	concede → counter → new point
 Floor	My question is for the proposition / opposition. · You said that... Could you explain...? · What would happen if...? · How would that work for...?	one short question, to a named team
 Summary	Let's look at what we've heard tonight. · The other side argued..., but... · Weighing it all up... · On balance... · The evidence points to... · So we urge you to vote for / against the motion.	no new arguments: weigh the debate

Pronunciation for debating. Contrastive stress makes a rebuttal clear: "They say it's **CHEAP**er. It's **NOT** cheaper, it's **SLOW**er." Pause after the signpost ("Our second point... [pause] is safety."). Slow down: speed hides good English, and the timekeeper is on your side, not against you. The concession has a **fall-rise**: "Ad**MIT**tedly ↘ ↗, it's cheaper.." (= *but wait*). And now, use C23 in reverse: the other team speaks naturally and fast. Anchor on their stressed words and write those in your notes.

◆ **DRILL SCRIPT (QUICK, CHORAL → INDIVIDUAL)**

- 1 **Concede and counter chain:** T gives a claim: "Remote work saves time." S1: "Admittedly, it saves time." S2: "That said, it can be isolating." S3: "So on balance, a hybrid model might work better." New claim, new chain.

- 2 **Blunt → balanced:** T (blunt): "That's wrong." → S: "That may be true in some cases, but..." · T: "Bad idea." → S: "While I accept that it sounds attractive, I still believe it would cost too much."
- 3 **The chair's voice:** T: "(start)" → S: "Good evening and welcome. The motion is that..." · T: "(first speaker)" → S: "I call on the first speaker for the proposition." · T: "(too long)" → S: "Thank you, time is up." · T: "(end)" → S: "Please thank both teams."
- 4 **Plant the toolkit:** T gives a structure and a motion; S makes a debating sentence. T: "impersonal passive · four-day week" → S: "It is often argued that a shorter week makes people more productive." T: "inversion · phones at dinner" → S: "Not only do phones interrupt conversation, but they also..."

◆ SETTING UP THE DEBATES (END OF C24) – TEAMS, SIDES, ROLES

Motions (set G, 12 cards): all everyday, community or workplace, e.g. *Phones should be switched off during family meals* · *Our workplace should switch to a four-day week* · *Children under 12 should get no homework* · *Remote work should be the default for office jobs* · *Our main street should be car-free on weekends*. You choose two motions (or let each debate draw one). **Sides are drawn, never chosen:** each team draws a Proposition or Opposition card. If a learner is uncomfortable with a motion, swap the motion, not the learner.

Class size	How to run it
12–16	Four teams of 3–4. Debate 1: Team A (proposition) vs Team B (opposition); Teams C and D give the chair, the timekeeper and the floor. Debate 2: the reverse. Team roles: opening speaker · rebuttal speaker · summary speaker (· a 4th member shares the rebuttal or is the team's "note-taker," who hands the rebuttal speaker the other side's key words).
8–11	Four teams of 2 (opening + rebuttal/summary) or two debates of 3 v 3 with fewer floor members. Everyone still gets one speaking role and one support role.
6–7	One debate, 3 v 3 (or 3 v 2 + a timekeeper); you are the chair; run it twice with sides swapped (the same teams, a second motion) so everyone speaks twice.
17+	Run the two debates at the same time in two corners with learner chairs, and float between them with the checklist. Or run three debates of 3 v 3 at 14 minutes each (cut the huddle and shorten the floor to 3 minutes).

Who does what: give the **opening** to learners who prepare well but find spontaneity hard (it is fully planned), the **rebuttal** to quick thinkers and to dominant speakers (they must listen first), the **summary** to careful learners who like a short, clear turn. The **chair** needs a calm, confident learner, or a dominant one (the chair must be neutral and bring others in). The **timekeeper** is a good role for an anxious learner who still wants to be at the front.

SAY: ICQs: *Who chose your side? (Nobody, we drew it.) · Does your side show your real opinion? (No.) · Opening speech: how long? (Two minutes.) Rebuttal? (A minute and a half.) Summary? (One minute, no*

new arguments.) · Can you read a full script? (No, key words only.) · Floor: how many questions each? (One, to a named team.) · The vote asks what? (Which team argued better, not what you believe.) · When the timekeeper shows TIME? (Finish your sentence and stop.)

◆ RUNNING A DEBATE – THE CHAIR'S ORDER AND TIMING (ABOUT 16–17 MINUTES)

- 1 **Chair opens** (1 min): welcome, the motion, the teams, the rules (time limits, one question each, respect). **Secret vote 1**: floor members write P or O on a slip: "Which side do you *expect* to argue better?" (No personal views.)
- 2 **Proposer** (first proposition speaker, 2 min) → **Opposer** (first opposition speaker, 2 min).
- 3 **Huddle** (1 min): teams whisper and pass notes; rebuttal speakers choose which points to answer.
- 4 **Proposition rebuttal** (1½ min) → **Opposition rebuttal** (1½ min): concede → counter → one new point if time.
- 5 **Floor questions** (4 min): the chair takes questions one by one, alternating teams. Any team member may answer, briefly. Each floor member asks one question at most.
- 6 **Summaries** (1 min each): the **opposition first**, then the proposition (the proposition always opens and closes).
- 7 **Secret vote 2 + close** (1 min): "Which team made the stronger case?" The timekeeper counts. The chair announces the result and which team **gained** more votes since vote 1, then: "Please thank both teams."

◆ THE RUBRIC AND THE OBSERVATION CHECKLIST → C26

The **debate rubric** (classroom materials set H, and the self-check in Workbook 8.3) has six criteria: **1** structure & signposting · **2** arguments & support · **3** rebuttal: concede & counter · **4** range of B2 language · **5** accuracy & register · **6** fluency, delivery & interaction. Three levels: ★★★ strong B2 (reaching toward C1) · ★★ B2 · ★ not yet. Floor members fill a peer star and wish for one speaker (assign who listens for whom). Learners self-assess at home. **You** can use the full rubric for your notes, but **don't grade C25**: it's practice. Tell learners so.

The **observation checklist** (set I) has one row per learner and 10 can-do items. Three marks: ✓ did it clearly · ~ did it with help, or errors that affect meaning · ○ not yet / not observed. You won't see every learner do everything: listen to each learner for their whole speech and at least one floor question or answer. After class, use it to:

- ◆ **Plan each learner's C26 assessment.** The B2 final assessment is an **individual speaking interview (about 8–10 minutes) plus short listening, reading and writing tasks — see the kit's B2 final assessment**. Before C26, read it and match your checklist notes to its speaking criteria: which topics suit each learner, and where to start so that each learner begins with something they did well.
- ◆ **Plan the C26 warm-up:** the two items with the most ~ / ○ across the class become a short review before the assessment starts.

- ◆ **Give each learner one sentence of feedback** at the end of C25 or the start of C26: one real strength from the debate, named specifically ("Your concession to Omar's point was excellent").
- ◆ **Spot who needs reassurance:** anyone who froze or stopped early gets a quiet word at the end of C25: "Next class is one-to-one and friendly. No team, no timer on the wall. You'll be fine."

◆ DIFFERENTIATION

LITERACY SUPPORT

Give the **timekeeper** or **opening** role. The prep sheet can be three boxes with symbols and 3–4 key words each; allow a 1-minute opening from a phrase card: *We are here to argue that... · First... · What's more... · For these reasons....* For the floor, give a question already started on a slip: "My question is for the _____. What would happen if _____?" Rehearse the opening with you or a patient partner during team planning. Target: a 1-minute opening with two signposted points, and one floor question.

STRETCH

Take the **rebuttal** or **chair**. Plant six toolkit items (a mixed or third conditional, an impersonal passive, *by far*, a cleft, a *not only* inversion, a hedge). Toward C1: use a **point of information** ("On a point of information: ...") if you agree the rule with the chair, refute with evidence rather than opinion ("The figures suggest otherwise..."), and use C1 concession frames (*Granted,... nevertheless... · It's hard to argue with..., yet... · Be that as it may,...*). Write the team's case up as a 250-word balanced essay at home.

◆ L1 WATCH-OUTS

- ◆ **"I am agree" / "I am not agree"** (Spanish *estoy de acuerdo*, French *je suis d'accord*, Portuguese *estou de acordo*): still common at B2 under pressure. *I agree / I don't agree*. Board it after the debate, not during.
- ◆ **False friends in argument:** *actually* ≠ "currently" (Spanish *actualmente*, French *actuellement*, German *aktuell*); *eventually* ≠ "possibly" (Spanish *eventualmente*, French *éventuellement*); *sensible* ≠ "sensitive." A speaker who says "Actually, 40% of people work from home" means "currently."
- ◆ **"On the other side"** for *on the other hand* (Spanish *por otro lado*, Portuguese *por outro lado*), and "In my opinion, I think..." (double opinion markers, many L1s). Accept in fluency, fix in feedback.
- ◆ **Very direct disagreement** ("This is not true," German, Dutch, Russian, Hebrew, Polish) or **none at all** (Japanese, Korean, Chinese, Thai, Vietnamese and Filipino learners may find public disagreement very uncomfortable). The assigned side helps both groups: it's a role, not a relationship. Teach both the English middle: concede, then counter.
- ◆ **Written-style speeches:** learners from exam systems that reward memorized speeches may write and read the whole opening. Allow a full script at home for confidence; in class, the prep sheet has **key words only**. Collect scripts at the start of the debate if needed, kindly.
- ◆ **"Discuss about"** (Spanish *discutir sobre*, Arabic, Hindi and others) and **"explain me"** (Romance

languages): *discuss something · explain it to me.*

◆ HOMEWORK

Online lesson 8.3: https://rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-b2/lesson_24.html. Listen to the model debate with  and repeat one speaker's part; do Exercises 1–2 and the Quick Quiz. Do the capstone as a **solo balanced talk** on the *other* motion from class (both sides + a conclusion, 2–3 minutes) and record it on your phone. Workbook 8.3: Ex 2 and Ex 3 (if not done in class), the rubric self-check and the final B2 journal. Bring the workbook to C26.

◆ CHECK — SELF-CHECK ANSWERS

Q1 **A** "While I accept that it's expensive, I still believe it's worth it." · Q2 **A** a reasoned conclusion that weighs both sides and takes a position. · Q3 (new) **B** answers the other team's arguments, conceding what is fair and countering it. Ex 1 (Script 8.3-A): 1 public health: car emissions damage our lungs, so car-free centers would have cleaner air (+ space for parks and bike lanes) · 2 older people, people with disabilities, shift workers, and small shops that need deliveries (the online lesson says "the elderly, the disabled"; teach the person-first forms) · 3 she concedes access matters, then says exemptions can be arranged for people who really need them · 4 whether public transportation is good enough yet · 5 the transition must be gradual and fair.

CLOSING THE MODULE AND THE COURSE

END OF C25: MODULE 8 AND B2 WRAP-UP

Recap on slide 18: "I wz gonna callya" → *I was going to call you* · about thirty, give or take (to a friend) → exactly 31 (to the fire marshal) · Admittedly..., but... → on balance. Learners tick the three "I can..." lists in the workbook and look back at the "I can..." lists from Module 1. Anything still unticked goes on a sticky note for you, for the C26 warm-up.

The C26 final assessment covers the whole B2 course. From this module the most relevant skills are: understanding natural, connected speech; using vague language appropriately and switching to precision; and presenting, conceding and countering in an extended spoken turn. Check the kit's B2 final assessment for exactly how it tests them.

WHAT TO TELL LEARNERS AT THE END OF C25 (SLIDE 18)

C26 has two parts. First, the **B2 final assessment: an individual speaking interview (about 8–10 minutes) plus short listening, reading and writing tasks** — see the kit's **B2 final assessment**. Read it before C26 and tell learners how the class will be organized (the order of the tasks and when each learner will be interviewed), so there are no surprises. Then a **celebration**: certificates, a look back at what everyone can do now, and the next step, the C1 course, **Advanced English**.

Say it simply: "Next class is our last class. You'll talk with me one-to-one for about ten minutes, and do some short listening, reading and writing. It's everything we've practiced. Then we celebrate!"

Reduce anxiety: show B2 lesson 1.1 on screen and ask: "Week 1: could you have argued a side you didn't choose, for two minutes, in front of everyone, and answered questions?" Let them hear how far they've come. Remind them that the online lessons stay open for review, and that the recording of their balanced talk is the best practice for an extended turn.

Celebration planning: if learners want to bring food to share in C26, great. Ask everyone to label their dish with its main ingredients (allergies, halal, vegetarian). Nobody should feel they have to bring anything. Invite 2–3 volunteers to give a 1-minute "closing speech" using the summary language from the debate ("Weighing it all up, this course has been...").

TEACHER REFLECTION (AFTER C25)

Look at your checklist and answer three questions: Which two can-dos need a C26 warm-up? Which learners need a quiet word of encouragement, and which strength will you name for each? Which learners are clearly ready for C1, and which would benefit from more B2 practice first? Write your answers on the back of the checklist.